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4000: Creation

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4005: creation

The created order, established as a sovereign decision on the part of God. The creation is dependent upon and under the authority of its Creator. Scripture affirms the role of both Jesus Christ and the Holy Spirit in the work of creation.

4006: creation, origin of

The free act of God based on his own wisdom and power, forming the whole natural order by his word.

God is Creator of the universe and everything in it

NEH 9:6 See also GEN 1:1, GEN 2:1; PSA 24:1–24:2; PRO 8:22–8:31; ECC 3:11, ECC 11:5; ISA 66:1–66:2; JER 10:16, JER 51:19; JHN 1:3; ACT 4:24, ACT 7:50, ACT 14:15, ACT 17:24

Light and darkness

GEN 1:3–1:5 See also ISA 45:7

The heavens

PSA 136:5 See also GEN 1:6–1:8; PSA 33:6, PSA 96:5; AMO 5:8; REV 14:7

The land

GEN 1:9–1:10 See also PSA 95:5, PSA 102:25, PSA 104:5–104:6; GEN 1:14; EXO 20:11; PSA 74:17, PSA 118:24

The sea and sea creatures

PSA 95:5 See also GEN 1:20–1:22

Birds

GEN 1:20–1:22

Land animals

GEN 1:24–1:25 See also JOB 40:15

The human race

GEN 1:26–1:27 Genesis witnesses to order and progression in God's creative activity. The creation of Adam and Eve is not merely the end point, but the

climax to the sequence. See also GEN 2:7, GEN 2:21–2:22, GEN 5:1–5:2; DEU 32:6; PSA 100:3, PSA 139:14; PRO 14:31, PRO 17:5, PRO 22:2; ECC 12:1, ECC 12:7

The role of Jesus Christ in creation

JHN 1:3 See also JHN 1:10; 1CO 8:6; COL 1:16; HEB 1:2

The role of the Spirit in creation

JOB 33:4 See also GEN 1:2; PSA 104:30; ISA 40:12–40:13

The creation of the world

GEN 1:1; HEB 11:3 See also PSA 33:9, PSA 148:5; ROM 4:17

The original creation was complete and perfect

Its completion

GEN 2:1 See also GEN 2:2–2:3; EXO 20:11; ISA 48:12–48:13; HEB 4:3

Its perfection

GEN 1:31 See also GEN 1:10, GEN 1:12, GEN 1:18, GEN 1:21, GEN 1:25; ECC 7:29; ISA 45:18; 1TI 4:4

The witness of creation

Creation should cause people to worship God

REV 4:11 See also NEH 9:6; PSA 19:1–19:4, PSA 95:6, PSA 148:5, PSA 148:13; ROM 1:20 God's power and deity is witnessed through the created order.

Sinners refuse the witness of creation

ROM 1:18–1:20

Believers receive the witness of creation by faith

HEB 11:3 See also GEN 6:6

4007: creation, and God

The natural world is sustained by God and speaks of God.

God sustains the creation

He upholds the natural order

HEB 1:3 See also JOB 38:33–38:37; PSA 104:1–104:35, PSA 135:6–135:7, PSA 145:16–145:17; MAT 10:29–10:30; COL 1:17

He sustains humanity

ACT 17:28 See also JOB 33:4; PSA 36:6; DAN 4:34–4:35; 1CO 8:6

Creation is upheld for the good of humanity

GEN 8:22 See also GEN 9:12–9:16; MAT 6:11

God's sustaining power reserves the world for judgment

2PE 3:7 See also 2PE 3:9–3:12 Time is being given for sinners to repent.

God has given humanity responsibility to preserve creation

GEN 1:28 See also GEN 2:15, GEN 9:1–9:3; PSA 8:6–8:8, PSA 115:16; HEB 2:8; JAS 3:7

Creation is spoilt by sin

GEN 3:17–3:19 See also ROM 8:20–8:22; HEB 6:8

Creation speaks of God's nature and character

His revelation of himself

JOB 12:7–12:10 This is not to suggest that animals can talk to human beings, rather it is a poetic device to stress what can be learnt from created things.

His eternal power and divine nature

ROM 1:20 See also JER 32:17

His authority

JOB 38:4–39:30; ; JER 33:2

His glory and majesty

PSA 19:1–19:2 See also PSA 8:1–8:9

His love and faithfulness

PSA 36:5 See also MAT 6:30

His power

ISA 40:25–40:28

His wisdom

PSA 136:5 See also PRO 8:27–8:29

His unchangeableness and eternity

PSA 102:25–102:27 See also PSA 90:1–90:2; HEB 1:11

His spiritual work in believers' lives

MAT 13:3–13:43

4008: creation, and Jesus Christ

See [2303: Jesus Christ, as creator](#)

4009: creation, and Holy Spirit

See [3266: Holy Spirit, in creation](#)

4010: creation, renewal of

God's creation, spoilt by sin, will one day be completely renewed. The old order will pass away and a new everlasting order established.

The renewal of creation

The passing away of the old order

2PE 3:10–3:12 See also PSA 102:25–102:26; ISA 34:4, ISA 51:6; MAT 5:18, MAT 24:35; REV 6:14, REV 21:4

The expectancy of nature

ROM 8:19–8:22 See also GEN 3:17–3:19, GEN 5:29

Jesus Christ's destruction of all his enemies

1CO 15:24–15:28 See also PSA 110:1; ACT 2:34–2:35; HEB 1:13, HEB 10:13

The new heavens and new earth

REV 21:1–21:2 See also ISA 65:17, ISA 66:22; ACT 3:21; HEB 11:10, HEB 11:16, HEB 12:22; 2PE 3:13; REV 3:12, REV 21:3–21:5, REV 21:10

The purity of the new creation

REV 21:27 See also PSA 37:20; ISA 52:1; JOL 3:17; REV 20:10, REV 22:14–22:15

The creation of the new humanity

The new birth

2CO 5:17 See also JHN 3:3, JHN 3:5–3:8; ROM 6:4; GAL 6:15; EPH 2:15; TIT 3:5

Renewal in God's image

COL 3:10 See also EPH 4:24

A new heart and a new spirit

EZK 36:26 "new" refers to the work of the Holy Spirit in renewing Christians as they believe in Jesus Christ. This renewing will be complete in the new creation. See also PSA 51:10; JER 31:33; EZK 11:19, EZK 18:31; 2CO 4:16; COL 3:1

A new mind

EPH 4:23 See also ROM 12:1–12:2

A new song

REV 5:9–5:10 See also PSA 33:3, PSA 40:3, PSA 144:9, PSA 149:1; ISA 42:10; REV 14:3, REV 15:3–15:4

The future glorification of humanity

The desire for a new body

ROM 8:23–8:25 See also ROM 8:17–8:18; 2CO 5:1–5:5

The resurrection of a new body

ROM 8:11 See also JOB 19:25–19:27; DAN 12:2–12:3; JHN 5:28–5:29; ACT 24:15

The nature of the resurrection body

1CO 15:42–15:54 See also PHP 3:21

The absence of sorrow and pain

REV 21:4 See also ISA 25:7–25:8, ISA 35:10, ISA 51:11, ISA 60:20, ISA 65:19; REV 7:17

A new name

ISA 56:5 See also ISA 62:2, ISA 65:15; REV 2:17, REV 3:12

A new home

JHN 14:2 See also 2CO 5:1

God will dwell with his people

REV 21:3 See also EZK 48:35; ZEC 2:10

4015: life

The state of being alive, characterised by vitality, growth and development.

4016: life, human

Seen by Scripture as the climax of the work of creation, life is a gift of God and is to be treated with reverence and respect.

Life is from God

GEN 2:7; ACT 3:15, ACT 17:25 See also 1SA 2:6; JOB 33:4; PSA 139:13; DAN 5:23; ACT 17:28; JAS 4:14–4:15

The ultimate duration of life is unknown to people

PSA 39:4 See also GEN 27:2; JAS 4:13–4:14

Life is precious

MAT 10:31 See also GEN 1:26–1:27 Since all people are made in the image of God they are of value to him and should be so to each other; GEN 9:5–9:6; PSA 49:7–49:9, PSA 139:14; MAT 16:26 parallel LUK 9:25

God's presence in life

DEU 30:16; PSA 23:6 See also PSA 71:5–71:6, PSA 71:9

Life is to be lived for God

ECC 12:13; ; JER 10:23; ; MIC 6:8; ; MAT 10:39; ; PHP 1:21

The span of human life

ECC 11:8–12:8 See also PSA 90:10

Life is temporary

2CO 5:1 See also PSA 49:12, PSA 103:15–103:16; ISA 38:12; 2PE 1:13–1:14

Life is short

1CH 29:15; JOB 14:1; JAS 4:14 See also JOB 7:6–7:7, JOB 8:9, JOB 9:25, JOB 14:2; PSA 39:4–39:6, PSA 89:47, PSA 90:12, PSA 102:11, PSA 144:4; ECC 6:12; ISA 40:6–40:8

The termination of life by death is due to sin

ROM 5:12 See also GEN 2:17; 1CO 15:22

Examples of long life

GEN 5:3–5:32, GEN 9:29, GEN 11:10–11:32

A full span of years

PRO 3:16 See also EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16; EXO 23:25–23:26; 1KI 3:14; JOB 5:26; PRO 3:2, PRO 9:11, PRO 10:27

Attitudes to life**Life loved**

1PE 3:10 See also PSA 34:12–34:13; JOB 8:21; PSA 91:16

Life despised

ECC 2:22–2:23 See also JOB 7:16, JOB 10:1; ECC 2:17; JON 4:8

4017: life, animal and plant

All living creatures and plants were made by God and are sustained by him.

Animal life**Animals were created by God**

GEN 2:19; PSA 104:24 See also GEN 1:20–1:25

Animals are cared for by God

PSA 145:15–145:16; MAT 6:26 parallel LUK 12:24 See also DEU 22:7; PSA 104:10–104:12, PSA 104:14, PSA 104:17–104:18, PSA 104:21, PSA 104:27, PSA 136:25, PSA 147:9; JON 4:11; MAT 10:29

Animal life is controlled by God

DAN 6:22 See also NUM 22:28; JON 1:17; HEB 11:33

Animal life has been placed under human care

GEN 1:26 See also GEN 1:28, GEN 2:19, GEN 9:2; PSA 8:6–8:8; DAN 2:38; HEB 2:8; JAS 3:7

Animals serve human needs

GEN 3:21; ; MAT 21:1–21:3 parallels MRK 11:1–11:3, LUK 19:29–19:31

Animal life saved by Noah from the flood

GEN 6:19–6:22

Animals subsequently given to humanity for food

GEN 9:3–9:4; ; DEU 12:20–12:25

Clean and unclean animals

GEN 7:2–7:3; ; LEV 11:47

Animals used in sacrifice

GEN 4:4 See also GEN 8:20; LEV 17:11; HEB 9:22

Animal life glorifies God

PSA 148:7, PSA 150:6

Plant life**Plants were created by God**

GEN 1:11–1:12

Plant life is often short-lived

MAT 6:30 parallel LUK 12:28 See also PSA 90:5–90:6, PSA 103:15–103:16; ISA 37:27, ISA 51:12; 1PE 1:24; ISA 40:6–40:8

Plants are provided for food

GEN 1:29–1:30 See also GEN 2:16–2:17, GEN 3:2, GEN 9:3; 1KI 18:5; JOB 28:5; PSA 104:14, PSA 147:8–147:9; DAN 4:32; JOL 2:22

Plant life glorifies God

PSA 96:12–96:13

4018: life, spiritual

Life embraces more than physical existence; it includes humanity's relationship with God. Human beings come to life spiritually only through faith in the redeeming work of God in Jesus Christ. This spiritual life is a foretaste of the life which believers will finally enjoy to the full in the new heaven and earth. Life in the Spirit means keeping in step with the promptings and guidance of the Holy Spirit, and always being open to his gifts and empowerment.

The nature of spiritual life**It is new life****ACT 5:20** See also ACT 11:18; 2PE 1:3; 1JN 3:14**It is true life****1TI 6:19****It is eternal life****ROM 5:21** See also DAN 12:2; MAT 19:29; JHN 6:27; 1JN 5:11, 1JN 5:20**It is abundant life****PSA 16:11; JER 17:8** See also PSA 1:3; JHN 10:10**The origins and nature of spiritual life****Spiritual life is the work of the Holy Spirit****JHN 3:6, JHN 3:8** See also EZK 36:26; JHN 3:3, JHN 3:5–3:7; ROM 8:11; TIT 3:5–3:7**Spiritual life unites believers to Jesus Christ****EPH 2:4–2:5** See also ROM 6:3–6:5, ROM 8:10; 1CO 12:13; COL 2:13; 1JN 5:12**Spiritual life makes believers the children of God****JHN 1:12–1:13** See also DEU 30:20; MAT 6:9; ROM 8:15; JAS 1:18; 1JN 4:7, 1JN 5:1**Spiritual life brings people to know God****JHN 17:3** See also MAT 11:27**Spiritual life brings about faith****JHN 3:15, JHN 20:31** See also JHN 3:16, JHN 3:36, JHN 5:24, JHN 6:40, JHN 11:25**Keeping in step with the Spirit****A new way of life is made possible****GAL 5:25** See also ROM 8:5–8:6, ROM 8:9–8:16; GAL 5:16–5:18, GAL 5:22–5:24**Bondage to the written law is ended****ROM 2:29** See also ROM 7:6, ROM 8:2; 2CO 3:6; GAL 5:17–5:18**Obedience to God is made possible****ROM 8:4** See also EZK 36:27; ROM 8:13; GAL 5:16; 1TH 4:7–4:8**Deepening unity is encouraged****EPH 4:3** See also COL 2:13; PHP 2:1–2:4**Strength and encouragement are received**

ACT 9:31

Gifts for those living in the Spirit**Gifts are given for building up the church****1CO 12:4–12:11** See also ROM 12:6–12:8; 1CO 12:27–12:30**Visions are given**

ACT 2:17; ; JOL 2:28; ; REV 1:10, REV 1:12–1:13, REV 4:2, REV 17:3, REV 21:10

Miracles are worked**MAT 12:28** See also ACT 10:38; ROM 15:19; GAL 3:5**Ministry is enhanced****2CO 3:6** See also 2CO 3:7–3:9**Those living in the Spirit receive revelation and guidance****God is revealed as Father****GAL 4:6** See also ROM 8:14–8:16**God's purposes are revealed****1CO 2:9–2:10** See also ROM 15:13; 2CO 5:2–5:5; GAL 5:5; EPH 1:17–1:18**Guidance is given to believers****ACT 8:29** See also ACT 10:19, ACT 11:12, ACT 13:2, ACT 16:6–16:7, ACT 20:22–20:23**Help is given to pray**

ROM 8:26–8:27; ; EPH 6:18; ; JUD 1:20

The Holy Spirit sanctifies those in whom he lives**Through the Spirit, Jesus Christ lives in believers**

EPH 3:16–3:17

The Spirit transforms believers**2CO 3:18** See also ROM 15:16; 2TH 2:13; 1PE 1:2**The fruit of the Spirit is seen in believers' lives**

ACT 13:52; ; ROM 5:5, ROM 8:6, ROM 14:17, ROM 15:30; ; GAL 5:22–5:23; ; COL 1:8; ; 1TH 1:6

Examples of life in the Holy Spirit**Jesus Christ**

MAT 4:1 parallels MRK 1:12, LUK 4:1; ; MAT 12:18, MAT 12:28; ; LUK 4:14, LUK 4:18, LUK 10:21; ; ACT 10:38

Simeon

LUK 2:25–2:27

Peter

ACT 4:8, ACT 10:19, ACT 10:44

Stephen

ACT 6:5, ACT 6:10, ACT 7:55

The first Christians

ACT 4:31, ACT 6:3–6:5, ACT 11:24, ACT 11:27–11:29, ACT 13:1–13:3, ACT 15:28

4019: life, believers' experience of

God is at work in all that happens to believers, whether to warn them, to draw them to himself or to do them good.

God has a purpose in all the experiences that believers have in life

ROM 8:28; EPH 1:11 See also GEN 21:22, GEN 28:16, GEN 39:20–39:21, GEN 45:5–45:8; 1SA 2:6–2:9; 1CH 29:11–29:12; JOB 42:10–42:13; PSA 75:6–75:7; ACT 17:28; 1PE 4:12

Rejection of this conviction leads to despair

ECC 1:1–1:2, ECC 1:16–1:17

God uses every experience in the lives of believers for good**To warn and correct**

PSA 119:67 See also GEN 12:17; 2CH 7:13–7:14; JOB 5:17; ISA 38:17, ISA 48:9–48:10; AMO 4:10–4:11; ROM 2:4; HEB 12:5–12:11; REV 9:20–9:21

To test and exercise believers' trust in God

DEU 8:15–8:16 See also EXO 15:22–15:25; JDG 2:21–2:22; PSA 23:1–23:6, PSA 81:7; ISA 43:1–43:2; NAM 1:7; ROM 8:35–8:39; PHP 4:12; HEB 11:17–11:19, HEB 13:6

To purify and prepare believers for glory

2CO 4:16–4:17 See also JOB 23:10; PSA 66:10; ISA 48:10; JER 9:7; ZEC 13:8–13:9; ROM 5:3–5:5, ROM 8:28–8:30; 1PE 1:6–1:7

To benefit others

EST 4:14; ; 2CO 1:3–1:6, 2CO 4:15; ; PHP 1:12–1:14; ; 2TI 2:10

In all of life's experiences believers should be thankful and trusting

PHP 4:6 See also GEN 8:20 Noah's sacrifice would, among other things, express his thankfulness; DEU 8:18; JOB 1:20–1:21; PSA 103:1–103:2; PRO 3:5–3:6; ACT 16:25; EPH 5:20; 1TI 4:4–4:5

Believers do not merit the blessings they receive

PSA 103:10 See also GEN 32:10, GEN 50:19–50:21; EZR 9:13; LAM 3:22; LUK 7:6; ROM 6:23

4020: life, of faith

The way by which believers journey through this world and into the life to come. Jesus Christ himself is the way to life.

Life seen as travelling with God**Walking with God**

GEN 17:1 See also GEN 5:22, GEN 5:24, GEN 6:9, GEN 48:15; PSA 56:13, PSA 89:15; MIC 4:5; ZEC 10:12

Journeying from the old to the new

ISA 43:19 See also EXO 18:8; ISA 40:3–40:5; MIC 2:13

God's guidance along the way

EXO 13:21 See also EXO 23:20; DEU 1:32–1:33, DEU 8:2; NEH 9:12, NEH 9:19; PSA 25:9; JER 2:17; GAL 5:25

God's ways**Walking in God's way**

ISA 35:8; 1JN 2:6 See also GEN 18:19; EXO 18:20; DEU 10:12–10:13, DEU 13:5, DEU 28:9; JOS 22:5; JOB 23:10–23:12; PSA 1:1–1:2, PSA 18:30; 2TI 3:10

God teaches believers his way

ISA 48:17 See also 1SA 12:23; 1KI 8:35–8:36 parallel 2CH 6:26–6:27; PSA 25:8–25:9, PSA 25:12, PSA 86:11, PSA 119:30; PRO 6:23; ISA 2:3, ISA 30:20–30:21 PSA 16:11, PSA 23:2; PRO 8:20; JER 6:16; MIC 6:8; GAL 5:22–5:23

Sinners refuse to follow God's way

ISA 53:6 See also ISA 56:11; ACT 14:16; 2PE 2:15

All other routes end in death

PRO 14:12 See also DEU 11:28, DEU 31:29; JDG 2:17; 2KI 21:22; PSA 1:6; PRO 15:10, PRO 16:25

Those who travel God's way are blessed

PRO 4:18 See also DEU 5:33; 1KI 8:23; PRO 11:5; ISA 26:7–26:8; MAT 5:3–5:12

Jesus Christ is the way to life

JHN 14:6; COL 2:3 See also JHN 8:12; HEB 12:2 ACT 9:2, ACT 19:9, ACT 19:23, ACT 22:4, ACT 24:14, ACT 24:22

Entrance to the way to life**Entrance is restricted**

MAT 7:13–7:14 See also JHN 10:9, JHN 14:6

Entrance is by faith

HEB 11:8–11:10 See also JHN 3:15–3:16; 2CO 5:7; HEB 11:6, HEB 11:13–11:16

4025: world, the

Scripture understands “the world” in a number of senses. It initially refers to the world as God's good creation. However, that same world has now fallen

into sin, with the result that it can be a threat to believers. Believers are called to live in the world, maintaining contact with it, while remaining distinct from it, and avoiding being contaminated by it.

4026: world, as God's creation

The heavens and the earth were created by God, and ordered by him and for him.

The world was created out of nothing

By the will of God

GEN 1:1 See also PSA 96:5, PSA 102:25, PSA 148:5; ISA 40:28; HEB 11:3; REV 4:11, REV 10:6

By the word of God

JHN 1:1–1:3 Jesus Christ as the eternal Word is creator of all things. See also GEN 1:3; JHN 1:10; 1CO 8:6; HEB 1:2; 2PE 3:5

By the Spirit of God

GEN 1:2 See also JOB 26:13, JOB 33:4; PSA 33:6

By the hand of God

HEB 1:10 See also PSA 8:3

By the mind of God

PSA 136:5 See also PSA 104:24; PRO 3:19–3:20

The world God created was perfect

GEN 1:31 See also 1TI 4:4

God created the world for a purpose

For his glory

PSA 19:1–19:2 See also PSA 50:6, PSA 148:1–148:4; ROM 1:20, ROM 11:36

That people might worship and revere him

PSA 147:4–147:5 See also GEN 15:5; NEH 9:6; JOB 22:12; ISA 40:25–40:26; JER 31:35

For his possession and use

DEU 10:14; COL 1:16–1:17 See also PSA 24:1–24:2, PSA 50:12, PSA 89:11; ACT 7:49 God reigns within the world he has made.

4027: world, as fallen

The world has fallen into sin and rebellion against its Creator. As a result, it has come under the power of Satan.

The world is under the power of Satan

He is prince of this world

JHN 14:30 See also JHN 12:31; 2CO 4:4; 1JN 4:4

He holds the world in his grasp

1JN 5:19 See also EPH 2:1–2:4

The world is opposed to God

It is evil

JHN 7:7 See also JHN 3:19–3:20; GAL 1:4; 1JN 2:15–2:16

Evil extends to the unseen world of the heavenly realms

EPH 6:12

It is opposed to God's wisdom

1CO 1:21 See also 1CO 1:25, 1CO 2:6–2:8, 1CO 3:19

It is opposed to the life of faith

JHN 15:18–15:19 See also JHN 1:10–1:11, JHN 17:6, JHN 17:9, JHN 17:14–17:18, JHN 17:25; JAS 2:5, JAS 4:4; 1JN 3:1

It is opposed to Jesus Christ's kingdom

JHN 18:36 See also ISA 40:23; MAT 4:8–4:10 parallel LUK 4:5–4:8; MAT 24:14; LUK 12:30; JHN 8:23, JHN 14:17; 2CO 10:3; HEB 11:38; 1PE 2:11

The world is under judgment

It is condemned

1CO 11:32 See also GEN 6:5–6:7, GEN 7:4, GEN 7:21; ISA 13:11; ZEP 3:8; MAT 18:7; JHN 12:31, JHN 16:11; 1JN 2:17

It will be judged in righteousness

PSA 9:8 See also PSA 96:13; ISA 26:9; NAM 1:5–1:6; ACT 17:31; ROM 3:19

It will be judged by the saints

1CO 6:2

4028: world, as redeemed

Though fallen, the world is offered the hope of redemption and restoration through Jesus Christ.

This world has an end

It is temporary

1PE 1:24 See also ISA 40:6–40:7; MAT 5:18, MAT 24:35 parallels MRK 13:31, LUK 21:33; 1CO 7:31; HEB 1:10–1:12, HEB 12:26–12:27

It is under God's judgment

ISA 13:13 See also ISA 34:4, ISA 51:6; JOL 2:30–2:31; 2PE 3:10; 1JN 2:17; REV 20:11

Through Jesus Christ there is redemption and renewal for the world

For humanity

1JN 2:2 See also MAT 1:21; JHN 1:29, JHN 3:16–3:17; ROM 5:18; 2CO 5:18–5:19

For creation

ROM 8:19–8:21 See also MAT 24:7–24:8 parallels MRK 13:8, LUK 21:10–21:11; COL 1:20

The promise of a new heaven and a new earth

2PE 3:13 See also ISA 65:17; 1CO 15:24–15:28; EPH 1:10; REV 21:1–21:4

4029: world, human beings in

The world is intended to be the dwelling-place of humanity, as the height of God's creation. Human beings are organised within the world into groupings and nations and have a God-given authority to rule.

The responsibility of human beings to rule**Over the earth**

GEN 2:15–2:16 See also GEN 1:25–1:26, GEN 1:29; PSA 8:4–8:6

Over the animal kingdom

GEN 1:28 “subdue” and “rule” do not give liberty to exploit and abuse but responsibility for caring for and bringing the best out of God's world. See also GEN 9:1–9:5; DEU 22:6–22:7; PRO 27:23–27:27; MAT 6:25–6:26; ACT 10:11–10:13

The response of human beings to God's commission to rule**Failure through abuse**

HOS 4:2–4:3 See also GEN 3:12, GEN 6:11–6:12; DEU 28:15–28:21

Refusal to fill the earth

GEN 11:5–11:7 See also GEN 4:17

Obedience and blessing

DEU 28:4–28:5 See also GEN 49:25

The ordering of nations within the world**By language**

GEN 11:8–11:9 See also GEN 10:5; NEH 13:24; EST 1:22; ACT 2:6–2:8; REV 14:6

By race

REV 7:9 See also REV 5:9, REV 13:7

By territory

ACT 17:26 See also GEN 13:11–13:12; NUM 13:27–13:29

By their rise and fall

JER 18:7–18:10 See also 2CH 15:6; ISA 19:2; JER 1:10; DAN 7:17–7:18; MAT 24:7 parallels MRK 13:8, LUK 21:10–21:11

By government

ROM 13:1 See also DAN 2:21, DAN 4:17; 1PE 2:13–2:14

The world as the object of the gospel proclamation**God sent Jesus Christ to this world**

JHN 3:16 See also ISA 45:22; JHN 1:10, JHN 1:29; 1JN 2:2, 1JN 4:9

Believers are commanded to evangelise this world

MAT 28:18–28:19 See also MRK 16:15; LUK 24:46–24:47; ACT 1:8

4030: world, human behaviour in

Human behaviour in the world is now characterised by self-centredness as a result of sin. Believers are called upon to renounce such sinful behaviour.

Human passion in the world is expressed in various ways**In physical desires**

1JN 2:15–2:16 See also EXO 20:17; PRO 27:20; LUK 12:15, LUK 21:34; JAS 4:4; 2PE 2:18–2:20

In indulgence

JAS 5:1, JAS 5:5 See also JOB 21:7–21:13; PSA 73:2–73:3; 2TI 4:10

In intellectual pursuits

COL 2:8 See also GAL 4:3–4:5; EPH 2:3

In a weak will

EXO 23:2 See also JOB 31:34; ROM 6:17–6:19

Though remaining in the world, believers are not of the world

JHN 17:6–17:19

Believers are to renounce the passions of the world**Through a renewed mind**

ROM 12:2 See also GAL 1:4; EPH 4:23; COL 3:5–3:10

Through obedience

1PE 1:14–1:15 See also 2CO 10:2–10:5; GAL 5:24, GAL 6:15; EPH 5:17; TIT 2:12; JAS 1:27; 2PE 1:4

Through having spiritual priorities

LUK 12:29–12:31 parallel MAT 6:31–6:33 See also MAT 10:39; LUK 14:26–14:27, LUK 17:33; JHN 12:24–12:26; 1TI 6:6

Through growing to maturity

1CO 3:1 See also HEB 5:12, HEB 6:1–6:3

The futility of worldly pursuits**They bring no lasting material gain**

1TI 6:7 See also JOB 1:21; PSA 49:17; ECC 5:15; 1TI 6:17–6:19

They bring no spiritual gain

MRK 8:36–8:37 parallel LUK 9:25 See also JOB 20:4–20:5; PSA 17:14; LUK 16:25–16:26

4035: abundance

A state of plenty. Since Israel was often restricted in resources, abundance was an important feature of her future hope, and became a symbol of spiritual well-being.

Examples of material abundance**Rain**

DEU 32:2 See also 1KI 18:41, 1KI 18:45; JOB 36:28; PSA 68:9; JOL 2:23

Water, streams and rivers

PSA 78:20 See also NUM 24:7; 2CH 32:4; PSA 1:3; ISA 44:4; EZK 47:5

Luxuriant growth and fruitfulness

EZK 47:12 See also EZK 19:10, EZK 31:2–31:9; DAN 4:12, DAN 4:21; REV 22:2

Harvest, food, milk and wine

AMO 9:13 See also 2CH 31:10; PSA 4:7, PSA 23:5, PSA 37:19; PRO 3:10; ISA 7:22; JER 44:17; JOL 3:13; MIC 2:11

Spaciousness

PSA 31:8 See also GEN 26:22; PSA 66:12

Wealth and possessions

GEN 24:35 See also GEN 30:43, GEN 36:7; 2SA 19:32; 2CH 1:15, 2CH 9:22; JOB 1:3

Canaan

EXO 3:8 See also NUM 13:27; DEU 8:8; JER 2:7

Material abundance a reward for obedience

LEV 26:5 See also DEU 30:9; JOB 42:12; PSA 132:15

Obedience not always rewarded in this way

JOB 1:12, JOB 2:6; ; PHP 4:12

Examples of spiritual abundance**The abundance of divine power**

DEU 9:26; ; PSA 93:4; ; JOL 2:29–2:32; ; EPH 1:18–1:20, EPH 3:20

The abundance of divine grace

ROM 5:20; ; 2CO 9:8–9:14; ; EPH 1:7, EPH 2:6–2:7; ; 1TI 1:14; ; 1PE 1:2; ; 2PE 1:2

The abundance of human thanksgiving

2CO 4:15 See also PSA 119:171

The abundance of God's future blessing

2CO 4:17 See also PSA 36:8; ISA 64:4; JHN 10:10; 1CO 2:9; 2PE 1:11; REV 14:3

4040: beauty

A physical or spiritual quality which brings pleasure to those who behold it. Scripture stresses the beauty of God himself and his creation, while noting that the beauty of the creation can lead away from God or become idolised.

Beauty in nature

JOB 38:31; ECC 3:11 See also GEN 49:21; EZK 20:6, EZK 31:7–31:9

Beautiful people**Women**

GEN 29:17; EST 1:11 See also GEN 6:2, GEN 12:11, GEN 12:14, GEN 24:15–24:16, GEN 26:7; DEU 21:11; 1SA 25:3; 2SA 13:1, 2SA 14:27; 1KI 1:3–1:4; EST 2:7, EST 2:17; JOB 42:15; PSA 45:11; SNG 2:14, SNG 4:7, SNG 7:1

Men

GEN 39:6 See also 1SA 16:12, 1SA 17:42; 2SA 14:25; 1KI 1:6; SNG 1:16, SNG 5:10; EZK 23:6, EZK 23:23

An enhanced quality

EST 2:2–2:3 See also EST 2:9, EST 2:12; ISA 3:24; EZK 7:20

Beauty and lack of beauty as external impressions

ISA 53:2 See also PRO 11:22, PRO 31:30; 1PE 3:3

May lead to pride and lust

PRO 6:25–6:26; EZK 28:17 See also GEN 12:11–12:12, GEN 39:7; 2SA 11:2–11:4; EZK 23:12

Beautiful artefacts

LUK 21:5 See also JOS 7:21; EZK 27:3–27:4, EZK 27:11, EZK 27:24; ACT 3:2

The beauty of Jerusalem

PSA 50:2 See also PSA 48:2; JER 6:2; LAM 2:15; EZK 16:10–16:15, EZK 16:25; DAN 11:45; REV 21:2

The beauty of God as the joy of believers

PSA 27:4 See also 1CH 16:29; PSA 29:2; ISA 4:2, ISA 28:5, ISA 33:17, ISA 52:7, ISA 61:3; JER 11:16; ROM 10:15

4045: chaos

A state of complete disorder or confusion. The first stage of creation where, having brought something out of nothing, God had not yet brought order to the universe. This primeval chaos, often symbolised by surging waters, threatens to disrupt God's order at any time. God sometimes allows a return to chaos as judgment.

God creates order out of chaos

God creates something out of nothing

GEN 1:1–1:2 See also PSA 33:9; PSA 148:5–148:6; ROM 4:17; HEB 11:3

God brings order to his creation

ISA 45:12 See also GEN 1:14–1:19; JOB 9:8; PSA 8:3; ISA 48:13

Chaos threatens God's order

Life and order in creation must be sustained by God
PSA 104:29; COL 1:16–1:17 See also JOB 12:10; JOB 34:14–34:15; ISA 42:5; HEB 1:2–1:3

The raging sea as a symbol of chaos

PSA 46:2–46:3 The raging sea is a frequent symbol of the chaos from which the world was created and to which it could return. Yet those whose confidence is in the God who brought order out of chaos have nothing to fear; **PSA 104:7–104:9** See also EXO 15:8; PSA 69:2; PSA 69:15; PSA 77:16; PRO 8:29; ZEC 10:11; MAT 8:23–8:27 parallels MRK 4:36–4:41; LUK 8:22–8:25

Threatening nations are likened to the raging seas as bringers of chaos

ISA 17:12–17:13 See also PSA 46:6; JER 46:7

Spiritual and political chaos

JDG 17:6 A period of anarchy, when no spiritual or political authority was recognised in Israel; **EPH 4:14** See also GAL 1:7

God uses chaos as a judgment

ISA 34:11 See also ISA 24:1; ISA 24:3–24:4; ISA 24:10–24:12; ISA 24:17–24:21; ISA 27:10; ISA 32:14; ZEP 1:14–1:15; REV 6:15–6:17

Floodwaters as a symbol of the chaos of judgment

JON 2:3 See also GEN 6:17; JOB 20:28; JOB 22:16; ISA 8:7

Panic and destruction characterise the chaos that follows judgment

ZEC 14:13 See also JDG 7:22; 1SA 14:20; 2CH 20:22–20:23; ISA 19:2; EZK 38:21; HAG 2:22

4050: dust

Human beings were created from the dust by God and will return to it at death. Dust is therefore taken as a symbol of poverty, lowliness and humility. In Scripture dust is shaken off the feet to warn of future judgment, and is also used as a means of expressing grief.

Human beings were created from the dust by God

GEN 2:7 See also GEN 18:27; PSA 103:14; 1CO 15:47

We will all return to dust when we die

GEN 3:19 God's curse upon Adam affected all humanity; **PSA 90:3** See also JOB 10:9; JOB 34:15; ECC 12:7

Dust as a symbol of poverty, lowliness and humility

1SA 2:8 See also GEN 18:27; 1KI 16:2; JOB 30:19

Dust as a simile for a multitude

GEN 13:16 See also GEN 28:14; PSA 78:27

Dust is shaken off the feet as a warning of judgment

MRK 6:11 parallels MAT 10:14; LUK 9:5 See also LUK 10:10–10:11; ACT 13:51

Dust is used in expressing grief and repentance

JOB 42:5–42:6; LAM 2:10 See also JOS 7:6; JOB 2:12; EZK 27:30; REV 18:19

4055: heaven and earth

An expression which in the original Hebrew refers to the whole of creation. It is frequently used in relation to God both as Creator and Lord in order to emphasise his power and authority.

Heaven and earth in relation to God

He is the Creator of heaven and earth

ISA 37:16 parallel 2KI 19:15 See also GEN 14:18–14:23; 2CH 2:12; PSA 115:15; PSA 121:2; PSA 124:8; PSA 134:3; PSA 146:5–146:6; ACT 14:15; ACT 17:24

He is Lord of heaven and earth

MAT 11:25 parallel LUK 10:21 See also 1CH 29:11–29:12; EZR 5:11; JER 23:23–23:24; JER 33:25–33:26

The personification of heaven and earth

DEU 31:28 See also DEU 4:26; DEU 30:19; PSA 69:34; JER 51:48

Allusions to the end of heaven and earth

MAT 24:35 parallels MRK 13:31; LUK 21:33 See also MAT 5:18; LUK 16:17

The expression ``between heaven and earth''

1CH 21:16 See also ZEC 5:9

4060: nature

God's creation, often with special reference to plant and animal life.

Nature is God's creation

PSA 89:11 See also ISA 45:12; JER 27:5; ACT 4:24; ACT 14:15; ACT 17:24; REV 4:11; REV 10:6

Plants

GEN 1:11–1:12 See also GEN 2:4–2:9; PSA 104:14–104:16

Land and sea

PSA 24:1 See also GEN 1:9–1:10; JOB 38:4–38:11; ISA 40:12; AMO 5:8; JON 1:9

The sun, moon and stars

JOB 9:9 See also GEN 1:14–1:18; PSA 8:3; PSA 148:3–148:5; JER 31:35

Animals

GEN 1:20–1:22 See also JOB 12:7–12:10; PSA 104:25

Human beings

EXO 4:11; ISA 45:12 GEN 1:26–1:27, GEN 2:7; PSA 95:6, PSA 100:3; ; PRO 22:2; ; JER 27:5

The distinction between humanity and the rest of nature

God created human beings alone in his image

GEN 1:26–1:27; COL 3:9–3:10 See also GEN 5:1, GEN 9:6; JAS 3:9

Humanity is the steward of nature

PSA 115:16 See also GEN 1:26–1:30, GEN 2:15; PSA 8:5–8:8

God is active in nature

In sustaining nature

MAT 10:29 parallel LUK 12:6 See also PSA 147:1–147:17; ACT 17:24–17:28; COL 1:17; HEB 2:10

In providing for plant life

LEV 26:4; MAT 6:28–6:29 parallel LUK 12:27 See also JOB 38:25; PSA 104:14–104:16; JON 4:6–4:10

In the elements and seasons

PSA 135:7 See also GEN 8:22; JOB 5:10, JOB 36:27, JOB 37:11–37:13; JER 10:13

God makes himself known through the natural order

JOB 36:24–36:26 See also PSA 8:1–8:4, PSA 19:1–19:3; ACT 14:15–14:17, ACT 17:24–17:28; ROM 1:18–1:21

4065: orderliness

In his creating, sustaining and saving work, God reveals himself as a God of order. Likewise, the life of his people and of society as a whole should be orderly.

Orderliness in creation

ISA 45:12 See also GEN 1:31; JOB 26:7–26:10, JOB 38:4–38:11; PSA 8:3, PSA 19:1, PSA 104:5–104:9; ISA 40:26; ACT 17:26

Orderliness in providence

GEN 8:22 See also PSA 65:9, PSA 104:14–104:27, PSA 145:15; ACT 14:17

Orderliness in salvation

Salvation was planned by God

ROM 8:29 See also 1CO 2:7; EPH 1:4–1:5; 2TI 1:9; TIT 1:2; 1PE 1:2; REV 13:8

Jesus Christ's coming was prepared in advance

LUK 24:26–24:27 See also JHN 5:46; ACT 2:23, ACT 3:18; GAL 4:4

Orderliness in the life of God's people

Corporate worship must be orderly

EXO 25:9; 1CO 14:40 See also 1CH 28:12; ACT 7:44; 1CO 14:32–14:33

Personal devotion includes orderliness

1TH 5:6 See also PRO 25:28; ROM 13:13; 1CO 7:17; EPH 5:16; 1TI 3:2–3:5

Respect for leaders as part of God's order

EXO 22:28; HEB 13:17 See also 1SA 24:6; 1TI 5:17; HEB 13:7

Order in pastoral care

1CO 12:28; TIT 1:5 See also ACT 6:3, ACT 14:23; ROM 12:4–12:8; EPH 4:11; 1PE 4:10, 1PE 5:1–5:3

Orderliness in society

God gives responsibility in his administration to men and women

PSA 82:6; ; DAN 6:2–6:7; ; ROM 13:1; ; TIT 3:1; ; 1PE 2:13–2:14

Governing authorities are ordained by God

ROM 13:1 See also JHN 19:11; ROM 13:6

Those in authority are to be honoured

TIT 3:1 See also MAT 22:21 parallels MRK 12:17, LUK 20:25; 1TI 2:1–2:2; 1PE 2:13

Order in the home and workplace

1TI 3:4 See also EXO 6:14, EXO 20:12; 1SA 3:13; JOB 1:5; EPH 6:1, EPH 6:5; 1TI 3:4, 1TI 3:12, 1TI 6:1; TIT 1:6, TIT 2:4–2:5, TIT 2:9–2:10; 1PE 2:18

4100: Supernatural beings

- 4110: angels
- 4120: Satan
- 4130: demons
- 4140: angel of the Lord
- 4145: archangels
- 4150: cherubim
- 4155: divination
- 4160: driving out

- 4165: exorcism
- 4170: host of heaven
- 4175: mediums
- 4180: seraphim
- 4185: sorcery and magic
- 4190: spiritism
- 4195: spirits

4110: angels

Spiritual beings who assist God, especially in his work of salvation, conveying his word to human beings and attending to the needs of God's people.

4111: angels, as God's servants

Angels have specific yet limited roles to play in declaring God's will and purposes for humanity.

Angels are God's servants

PSA 103:20 See also HEB 1:7; PSA 104:4

Named angels

The archangel Michael: DAN 10:13, DAN 12:1; ; JUD 1:9; ; REV 12:7; DAN 8:16, DAN 9:21; ; LUK 1:19, LUK 1:26

Angels as agents of God's salvation

HEB 1:14 See also EXO 23:23, EXO 32:34, EXO 33:2; NUM 20:16; ISA 63:8–63:9

Angels do not fully understand God's salvation

1PE 1:10–1:12

Angels deliver God's people from their enemies

2KI 19:35 parallels 2CH 32:21, ISA 37:36; ; ACT 5:19, ACT 12:6–12:11

Angels as mediators

ACT 7:53 The law was mediated by angels to Moses and Israel See also JOB 33:22–33:26; ACT 7:38; GAL 3:19; HEB 2:2

Angels as revealers of God's will

ZEC 1:8–1:10 See also DAN 7:15–7:16; ZEC 4:11–4:14; REV 17:1, REV 21:9

Angels convey and fulfil God's instructions

ZEC 3:4 See also NUM 22:21–22:35; ZEC 3:6–3:7; MAT 2:13; GAL 1:8; REV 7:2

Angels attend to the needs of God's people

Angels provide food at special times

1KI 19:5–19:7 See also PSA 78:23–78:25

Angels provide protection

PSA 91:11–91:12 See also GEN 19:15, GEN 48:16; PSA 34:7; DAN 3:28, DAN 6:22; MAT 18:10; ACT 27:23–27:24

Angels give guidance

EXO 23:20 See also GEN 24:7, GEN 24:40; ACT 8:26

Angels serve Jesus Christ

Angels care for Jesus Christ's needs

MAT 4:11 parallel MRK 1:13 See also LUK 22:43

Angels are ready to protect Jesus Christ

MAT 26:53 See also MAT 2:13, MAT 2:19–2:20, MAT 4:6 parallel LUK 4:10; PSA 91:11–91:12

Angels are inferior to Jesus Christ

HEB 1:5–1:13

4112: angels, as God's messengers

Spiritual messengers with the special role of making known God's work of salvation.

Angels give hope through the words of the prophets

ISA 40:3–40:5 The voice in this passage may be that of an angel. ISA 40:1–40:2, ISA 40:6–40:8; DAN 8:15–8:16, DAN 10:12, DAN 10:14–10:21, DAN 12:8–12:13; ZEC 1:12–1:21, ZEC 2:3–2:5, ZEC 4:1–4:7

Angels and the coming of the Messiah

An angel foretells the birth of John the Baptist

LUK 1:11–1:13 See also LUK 1:14–1:19

Angels foretell Jesus Christ's birth

MAT 1:20–1:21 See also LUK 1:26–1:38

Angels announce Jesus Christ's birth

LUK 2:8–2:11 See also LUK 2:12–2:20

Angels announce Jesus Christ's resurrection

MAT 28:5–28:7 parallel MRK 16:5–16:7 See also LUK 24:4–24:7, LUK 24:23; JHN 20:10–20:14

Angels foretell Jesus Christ's second coming

ACT 1:10–1:11

Angels reveal the gospel for the Gentiles

ACT 11:13 See also ACT 10:1–10:5, ACT 10:30–10:33; REV 14:6–14:7

Angels foretell God's final triumph

REV 1:1 See also REV 19:9, REV 22:1, REV 22:6, REV 22:16

4113: angels, as agents of God's judgment

Spiritual beings who assist God in carrying out his judgments. Angels will be especially active when Jesus Christ returns for the last judgment.

Angels as agents of earthly judgments

PSA 78:49

Against Sodom and Gomorrah

See also GEN 19:13, GEN 19:24–19:25

Against opponents of God

EXO 12:23; ; 2KI 19:35 parallels 2CH 32:21, ISA 37:36; ; PSA 35:4–35:6

Against Israel

EXO 32:35; ; 2SA 24:16–24:17 parallel 1CH 21:15–21:16; ; 1CO 10:10

Against Herod Antipas

ACT 12:18–12:23

Angels restrained by God's mercy

1CH 21:15–21:16 parallel 2SA 24:16–24:17 See also GEN 18:20–18:32

Angels and final judgment**Angels proclaim God's sovereignty**

REV 12:10–12:12 See also REV 10:1–10:4, REV 11:15

Angels announce God's final invitation

REV 14:6–14:7 See also REV 14:9–14:13, REV 19:9

Angels hold back the final judgment

REV 7:1–7:3

Angels carry out preliminary warning judgments

REV 8:1–8:13, REV 9:1–9:16, REV 10:5–10:7

Angels accompany Jesus Christ when he returns to judge

2TH 1:7 See also MAT 16:27, MAT 25:31; MRK 8:38 parallel LUK 9:26; 1TH 3:13

Angels gather everyone for the final judgment

MAT 13:37–13:41 See also MAT 13:49–13:50, MAT 24:31; REV 14:15–14:19

Angels announce the final judgment

REV 14:15 See also REV 10:8–10:11, REV 17:1–17:3, REV 17:7, REV 17:15, REV 18:1–18:2, REV 18:4

Angels enact the final judgment

REV 15:1 See also REV 14:16–14:19, REV 15:6–15:8, REV 16:1–16:21, REV 18:21, REV 19:17–19:18, REV 20:1–20:3

Angels are subject to judgment

1CO 6:3 See also 2PE 2:4; JUD 1:6

4114: angels, and praise of God

Spiritual beings who praise God in a manner that is beyond human capacity.

Angels worship God in his presence

REV 7:11 See also REV 3:5, REV 8:2

Angels praise God for his works**Angels praise God's work of creation**

JOB 38:4–38:7 See also PSA 148:1–148:5; NEH 9:6

Angels praise God's work of redemption

LUK 2:13–2:14 The angels are praising God for Jesus Christ's birth. See also ISA 44:23, ISA 49:13; LUK 15:10; HEB 1:6; DEU 32:43

Angels praise God's kingdom

PSA 103:19–103:21 See also PSA 96:10–96:11 parallel 1CH 16:30–16:31; PSA 145:10–145:11; REV 11:15

Angelic beings praise God

ISA 6:2–6:4 See also REV 4:8, REV 5:8–5:10, REV 7:11–7:12

Thousands of angels worship God

HEB 12:22 See also DEU 33:2; PSA 68:17; DAN 7:10; REV 5:11–5:12

Images of angelic beings decorate Israel's sanctuaries

1KI 6:23–6:29 parallels 2CH 3:7, 2CH 3:10–3:13 See also EXO 26:1; EZK 41:18–41:20, EZK 41:25 The images of the cherubim represent the angels who worship God in heaven.

Angels are not to be worshipped

REV 22:8–22:9 See also MAT 4:9–4:10 parallel LUK 4:7–4:8; ROM 1:25; COL 2:18

4115: angel, of the Lord

See [4140: angel of the Lord](#)

4116: angels, opposed to God

Spiritual beings who fell with Satan. They are under God's judgment and are subject to the authority of believers.

Spiritual authorities led by Satan

2CO 11:14 See also JHN 12:31, JHN 16:11; EPH 6:12; REV 9:11

Angels opposed to God will be judged

JUD 1:6 See also JOB 4:18, JOB 15:15; MAT 25:41; 2PE 2:4; REV 20:10

Jesus Christ has defeated Satan and his angels

COL 2:15 See also GEN 3:15; EPH 1:19–1:21

Satan's angels are resisted by God's faithful angels

REV 12:7–12:9 See also DAN 10:13, DAN 10:20 The princes of Persia and Greece appear to be spiritual powers who resist God's rule over these regions.

Jesus Christ gives authority over Satan and his angels to believers

LUK 10:18–10:19 See also ROM 8:38–8:39, ROM 16:20; 1CO 6:3; EPH 6:10–6:13; JAS 4:7

4120: Satan

The one who opposes the person and purposes of God. Satan is especially associated with deceit, temptation and testing, through which he attempts to deflect believers from obeying God.

4121: Satan, as the enemy of God

Scripture provides numerous examples of ways in which Satan opposes the presence and purposes of God in his world.

Satan and God's people

Satan opposes believers

1CH 21:1 See also JOB 2:1–2:7; ZEC 3:1–3:2; 1TH 2:18

Satan accuses believers

REV 12:10 See also JOB 1:8–1:11; ZEC 3:1–3:2

Satan slanders believers

1TI 5:14

Satan tests believers and causes their suffering

REV 2:10 See also EPH 6:11–6:13, EPH 6:16

Satan opposes the work of the archangel Michael

JUD 1:9 DAN 10:13, DAN 10:21, DAN 12:1; ; REV 12:7

Satan opposes God

Satan opposes God's purposes

MAT 16:23 parallel MRK 8:33

Satan opposes God's word

See also MAT 13:3–13:19 parallels MRK 4:3–4:16, LUK 8:4–8:12 the parable of the sower; MAT 13:24–13:39 the parable of the weeds and its explanation; ACT 13:8–13:10 Elymas, the sorcerer, acts on Satan's behalf to oppose Barnabas and Paul.

Satan opposes God's righteousness

1JN 3:7–3:10

Satan blasphemes God

REV 13:6

Satan's opposition to God's work will not succeed

ZEC 3:2 God rebukes him; ; LUK 10:19 His reign is temporary.

Satan's role as adversary earns him varied titles

The devil

He is the adversary because he deceives: REV 12:9, REV 20:2–20:3

Belial

He is the adversary because he is the troublemaker or scoundrel (the same Hebrew word is used in the OT passages as in 2Co 6:15 to describe Satan's work): DEU 13:13; ; 1KI 21:10; ; PRO 6:12; ; 2CO 6:15

The dragon

He is the adversary because he is the enemy: REV 12:4, REV 12:13–12:14

The serpent

He is the adversary because he thwarts spiritual insight: GEN 3:1–3:5, GEN 3:13; ; 2CO 11:3

The prince of this world

He is the adversary because his rule is temporary, not absolute: JHN 12:31, JHN 14:30, JHN 16:11

The angel of the Abyss

REV 9:11 He is the adversary because he is the destroyer.

4122: Satan, as tempter

God's people are incited to evil by Satan. He seeks to exploit their weaknesses in order to deflect them from obedience to God.

Satan incites God's people to evil

Satan exploits human weaknesses

GEN 3:1–3:5 Rev 12:9 identifies the serpent with Satan. See also JOB 2:4–2:5; EPH 4:26–4:27

He tempts Christians to fall away

1TH 3:5 See also LUK 22:31; 1TI 3:7; 2TI 2:26

He inspires people to put God to the test

ACT 5:3–5:9 See also PSA 78:18, PSA 78:41, PSA 106:14; ACT 15:10; 1CO 10:9

He makes sin attractive

Lack of integrity: MAT 5:37; ; ACT 5:3; 1CO 7:5; ; 1TI 5:14–5:15; 2CO 2:10–2:11 unforgiveness; ; JAS 3:14–3:16 envy and selfish ambition

Jesus Christ is tempted by Satan

In the wilderness

MAT 4:1–4:11 parallels MRK 1:13, LUK 4:1–4:13

Through Simon Peter

MAT 16:23 parallel MRK 8:33

Jesus Christ identifies with believers

HEB 4:15 See also HEB 2:8

Satan tests Christians**REV 2:10** See also LUK 22:31; REV 3:10**Satan's temptations can be resisted****By being alert****1PE 5:8****By prayer****MAT 26:41** parallels MRK 14:38, LUK 22:40 See also MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4; LUK 22:32, LUK 22:46**By relying on God's faithfulness****1CO 10:13** See also 2PE 2:9; REV 3:10**By Jesus Christ's service as high priest**

HEB 2:18, HEB 4:15

4123: Satan, as deceiver

Satan's character is deceitful, devious and cunning as in a variety of guises he seeks to influence people for his own ends.

Satan's deceitful character**He is evil****MAT 6:13** See also MAT 5:37, MAT 13:19; JHN 17:15; 2TH 3:3; 1JN 2:13–2:14, 1JN 3:8, 1JN 3:12, 1JN 5:18**He is a liar****JHN 8:44** See also GEN 3:4–3:5; JOB 1:11, JOB 2:5; REV 3:9**He is devious****2CO 11:14** See also 2CO 11:3; EPH 6:11; 2TH 2:9; 1TI 3:7; 2TI 2:26**He is scheming****EPH 6:11** See also 2CO 2:10–2:11**He is a slanderer****JOB 1:9–1:11** See also 1TI 5:14–5:15; REV 2:9**Satan's deceitful work****He deceives individuals****1TI 2:14** Eve was deceived by Satan the serpent. See also DAN 8:25; 2TI 3:13; REV 12:9, REV 20:3, REV 20:10**He works counterfeit miracles****2TH 2:9–2:10** See also EXO 7:11–7:12, EXO 7:22; DEU 13:1–13:2; MAT 24:24 parallel MRK 13:22; REV 13:13–13:14, REV 19:20**He appoints false prophets****MAT 7:15** See also DEU 13:5; JER 23:26, JER 28:15, JER 29:21; EZK 13:6–13:10; 2PE 2:1–2:3, 2PE 2:18–2:19**He misuses Scripture**

MAT 4:6 parallel LUK 4:10

He blinds unbelievers**2CO 4:4****4124: Satan, kingdom of**

Satan is depicted as the prince of this world, having power over demons and over godless people. He is, however, subject to God's sovereignty and therefore his power is limited and his rule temporary.

Satan's power**He has power in the world****1JN 5:19** See also JHN 7:7, JHN 8:44, JHN 14:17, JHN 15:18–15:19, JHN 16:20, JHN 17:14; ACT 26:18; 2CO 4:4; EPH 2:2; COL 1:13; 1JN 2:15–2:16, 1JN 4:4–4:5; REV 13:12**He claims power over this world**

MAT 4:8–4:9 parallel LUK 4:6

He is called the prince" or thegod" of this world**JHN 12:31** JHN 14:30, JHN 16:11; ; 2CO 4:4**He is responsible for some illnesses****LUK 13:16** See also JOB 2:7; ACT 10:38; 2CO 12:7 Paul's "thorn in the flesh" may or may not have been a physical illness.**He is responsible for death****HEB 2:14****Satan's kingdom****He has a kingdom****MAT 12:26** parallel LUK 11:18**COL 1:13** See also ACT 26:18; EPH 2:2**He has a throne****REV 2:13****He is the prince of demons****MAT 9:34** The name Beelzebub is used elsewhere to name the prince of the demons. This name was used also to identify Satan. See also MAT 12:24 parallels MRK 3:22, LUK 11:15**Satan's authority is limited****He cannot do more than God allows****JOB 1:12** See also JOB 2:6; 1CO 10:13; REV 12:12, REV 20:3**His rule is temporary**

ROM 16:20; ; REV 20:10

4125: Satan, agents of

Satan works in this world through people and through those spiritual beings who acknowledge his authority. His agents oppose God's will and purposes.

Satan works through people

Satan's human agents pursue his evil desires

JHN 8:44 Jesus Christ speaking of the relationship of some unbelieving Jews to Satan. See also ACT 13:10; 1JN 3:8–3:10, 1JN 3:12

Satan works through people to oppose God's purposes

ACT 5:1–5:9 Ananias and Sapphira; ; MAT 16:23 parallel MRK 8:33 Simon Peter; LUK 22:3; ; JHN 6:70, JHN 13:2, JHN 13:27; ACT 13:8–13:10 Elymas, the sorcerer

Examples of people doing Satan's work

False prophets

DEU 13:5; ; JER 23:26–23:27, JER 28:15, JER 29:21; ; EZK 13:6–13:9; ; MAT 7:15, MAT 24:24; ; 2PE 2:1–2:3

Others who lead people away from God

DEU 13:13; ; 2KI 21:9–21:26 Manasseh and his son, Amon; ; PRO 7:21 the adulteress; ; ISA 3:12; ; JER 50:6; ; 2PE 2:18–2:19

Satan works through his spiritual agents

Satan's angels

MAT 25:41 See also 2PE 2:4; REV 12:7 “angel” and “messenger” are the same word in Greek

Satan's demons

LUK 13:11–13:16 See also MAT 12:22; LUK 11:14–11:15

Satan's agents are identified by various images and titles

The little horn

DAN 8:9–8:12 This probably represents Antiochus Epiphanes.

The prince of Persia

DAN 10:13 probably representing a demon with influence over the Persian kingdom

The king of the North

DAN 11:28 probably representing Antiochus Epiphanes

The antichrist

1JN 4:1–4:4; ; 2JN 1:7

The man of lawlessness

2TH 2:3–2:10

The beast

REV 11:7, REV 13:1–13:8, REV 13:11–13:18, REV 14:9–14:11, REV 16:13, REV 17:8, REV 19:20, REV 20:10

The false prophet

REV 16:13, REV 19:20

The prostitute or Babylon the Great

REV 14:8, REV 16:19, REV 17:1–17:18, REV 18:1–18:10, REV 18:18, REV 19:2

4126: Satan, resistance to

Jesus Christ resisted Satan in his ministry, and believers are commanded to follow his example in this respect. God assists believers in this struggle.

Satan can be resisted

His power is limited

JOB 1:12, JOB 2:6; ; 1CO 10:13; ; REV 12:12, REV 20:3

Jesus Christ resists Satan

MAT 4:1–4:11 parallel LUK 4:1–4:13; ; JHN 1:5; ; HEB 2:18, HEB 4:15

Christians can resist Satan

JAS 4:7 See also LUK 10:19; ROM 6:13; EPH 4:26–4:27, EPH 6:11–6:13; 1PE 5:8–5:9; 2PE 3:17; 1JN 2:13–2:14

God protects his people from Satan

2TH 3:3 See also 1JN 5:18

God's protection is to be sought in prayer

JHN 17:15 See also MAT 6:13; LUK 22:31–22:32; EPH 6:11, EPH 6:18

Jesus Christ has the victory over Satan

Jesus Christ's defeat of Satan on the cross

COL 2:15 See also JHN 12:31; REV 12:11

Jesus Christ's name is powerful against Satan

PHP 2:10 See also ISA 45:23; PSA 118:10–118:12; MRK 16:17–16:18; LUK 10:17; ACT 16:18

God's love cannot be thwarted

ROM 8:38–8:39

Resisting Satan brings reward

2TI 4:7–4:8 See also JAS 1:12; REV 2:7, REV 2:17, REV 2:26, REV 3:5, REV 3:12, REV 3:21

4127: Satan, defeat of

Though defeated on Jesus Christ's cross, Satan is still active in this world, but his final overthrow by God is certain.

Satan is defeated by Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ is stronger than Satan

JHN 14:30 See also MAT 12:28; LUK 13:16; ACT 10:38; GAL 1:4

Jesus Christ came to destroy Satan's work

1JN 3:8 See also HEB 2:14–2:15

Satan is defeated on the cross

COL 1:13; ; TIT 2:14; ; REV 3:21

Satan's defeat is foreseen by Jesus Christ**JHN 12:31** See also MAT 25:41; LUK 10:18; JHN 16:11**Satan's agents are also defeated****COL 2:15** See also ROM 8:38–8:39**Satan is defeated by Christians****REV 12:11** See also ACT 5:40–5:42; 1JN 2:13–2:14**Satan's final overthrow****Satan and his agents will be destroyed****ROM 16:20** See also REV 17:14**Satan's final destiny**

1TI 3:6 judgment; REV 20:1–20:3, REV 20:10

Death, the result of Satan's work, will be defeated

1CO 15:26; ; REV 20:13–20:14

4130: demons

Evil spiritual forces; Scripture stresses the reality of demonic forces and recognises a number of categories to which they may be assigned. Jesus Christ's authority over such demonic forces is seen at work in his ministry and in that of his disciples.

4131: demons, kinds of

Scripture uses a number of terms to refer to demonic forces, stressing both their reality and hostility to God.

Demons**DEU 32:17; 1CO 10:20–10:21** See also PSA 106:37; MAT 8:16; MRK 7:26; ROM 8:38; JAS 2:19; REV 9:20**Evil spirits****MAT 10:1; ACT 5:16, ACT 8:7** See also MAT 12:43–12:45; MRK 1:23–1:26, MRK 3:11; REV 18:2**Other terms for demons****Spirits****ACT 16:16** See also MRK 9:17**Spirits of demons****REV 16:14****Deceiving spirits****1TI 4:1****Authorities, powers and forces****EPH 6:12; COL 2:15; 1PE 3:22****4132: demons, malevolence of**

Demons are opposed to the person and work of God and seek to lead human beings, including believers,

away from him. For this reason, believers are forbidden to be involved with them.

Demons harm individuals**Demons cause torment and pain**

Saul's torment: 1SA 16:14–16:16, 1SA 16:23, 1SA 18:10–18:11, 1SA 19:9–19:10; MAT 15:22, MAT 17:15 parallels MRK 9:18–9:20, LUK 9:39–9:42 the boy with an evil spirit; ; MRK 5:5; ; LUK 6:18, LUK 13:11; ; ACT 5:16, ACT 19:16 the seven sons of Sceva

Demons cause dissension

JDG 9:23–9:25

Demons cause illness and handicaps**MRK 9:17–9:27** parallels MAT 17:14–17:18, LUK 9:37–9:42 See also MAT 9:32–9:33; LUK 11:14, LUK 13:11**Demons are deceitful****Demons inspire false prophets**

1KI 22:21–22:23 parallel 2CH 18:21–18:22

Demons incite war

REV 16:13–16:14

Demons lead people away from God**1JN 4:1–4:6** See also 1TI 4:1–4:2; REV 16:13–16:14**The inspiration of pagan religions by demons****Pagan gods are identified as demons****1CO 10:20–10:21** See also DEU 32:16–32:17; PSA 106:36–106:39; REV 9:20**Demons inhabit ruins of pagan cities**

REV 18:2

All involvement with spirits and mediums is forbidden**LEV 19:31** See also EXO 22:18; LEV 20:6, LEV 20:27; DEU 18:10–18:14; JER 27:9**Witchcraft is identified as a work of the sinful nature**

GAL 5:19–5:20

Involvement with sorcery or witchcraft is futile**ISA 47:9** See also 1SA 28:7, 1SA 28:14–28:20; ISA 8:19–8:22, ISA 19:3–19:4, ISA 47:12–47:15; NAM 3:3–3:4**Examples of renunciation of the work of demons****ACT 19:19** See also 1SA 28:9; 2KI 23:24**4133: demons, possession by**

A recognised condition in Jesus Christ's lifetime in which an individual is dominated by the influence of a demon. In his ministry, Jesus Christ encountered and delivered many people in such a condition. Many of

Christ's critics unsuccessfully sought to ascribe his authority and powers to demonic possession.

Unfounded accusations of demon-possession

Against John the Baptist

MAT 11:18 parallel LUK 7:33

Against Jesus Christ

JHN 10:20–10:21 See also MAT 9:34, MAT 12:24 parallels MRK 3:22, LUK 11:15; JHN 7:20, JHN 8:48–8:52

Unfounded accusations of demon-possession against Jesus Christ are refuted

MAT 12:25–12:28 parallels MRK 3:23–3:30, LUK 11:17–11:20; ; JHN 10:21

Demon-possession arising from sin

ISA 18:9–18:10

The consequences of demon-possession

Irrational behaviour

ISA 18:10–18:11 See also ISA 19:9–19:10

Unnatural physical strength

MRK 5:4 parallels MAT 8:28, LUK 8:29 See also ACT 19:16

Self-harm

MRK 5:5

Violent behaviour

MRK 9:18 parallel LUK 9:39 See also MAT 8:28 parallels MRK 5:3–5:5, LUK 8:27–8:29

The impairment of faculties

MAT 12:22 parallel LUK 11:14 See also MAT 9:32; MRK 9:17; LUK 13:11

Suffering

MAT 15:22 parallel MRK 7:25–7:26 See also ISA 16:14–16:16; MAT 17:15 parallels MRK 9:18, LUK 9:39; LUK 6:18

Jesus Christ delivers from demon-possession

MAT 8:16 parallels MRK 1:32, LUK 4:40 See also MAT 4:24, MAT 9:32, MAT 12:22, MAT 15:22 parallel MRK 7:25–7:26

Multiple demon-possession

Jesus Christ encounters cases of multiple demon-possession and is able to deliver

MRK 16:9 See also MRK 5:1–5:17 parallel LUK 8:26–8:35; LUK 8:2

Further evidence of the possibility of multiple demon-possession

MAT 12:43–12:45 parallel LUK 11:24–11:26

Demons recognise divine authority and their own limited powers

JAS 2:19

Demons know Jesus Christ's identity

MRK 1:24 parallel LUK 4:34 See also MAT 8:29 parallels MRK 5:7, LUK 8:28; MRK 1:34 parallel LUK 4:41; MRK 3:11; ACT 19:15

Demons recognise Jesus Christ's disciples

ACT 16:16–16:17

Jesus Christ's disciples have power to release from demon-possession by calling on Jesus' name

See also ACT 5:16, ACT 19:13–19:16

4134: demons, exorcism of

Jesus Christ drove out many demons during his earthly ministry and he delegated this authority to his disciples.

Jesus Christ understood exorcism as part of his ministry

LUK 13:32 See also LUK 4:18

He drove out demons from individuals brought to him

MAT 8:16 parallels MRK 1:32–1:34, LUK 4:40–4:41 See also MAT 4:24

He drove out demons from individuals whom he encountered

MRK 1:23–1:26 parallel LUK 4:33–4:35 See also MRK 1:39

Jesus Christ had power over demons

He was able to drive demons out at a distance

MAT 15:22–15:28 parallel MRK 7:25–7:30

He used words of rebuke to drive out demons

MAT 17:18 parallels MRK 9:25, LUK 9:42 See also MRK 1:25 parallel LUK 4:35; LUK 4:41

Jesus Christ identifies the spiritual resources needed for exorcising demons

The Spirit of God

MAT 12:28 parallel LUK 11:20

Faith

MAT 17:19–17:20

Prayer (and fasting)

MRK 9:28–9:29

The ministry of exorcism was an indication of the kingdom's presence

MAT 12:28 parallel LUK 11:20

The results of being delivered from demon-possession

Visible transformation and healing

MRK 5:15 parallel LUK 8:35 See also MAT 9:33; LUK 11:14, LUK 13:13

Devotion to Jesus Christ

LUK 8:1–8:2 See also MRK 5:18 parallel LUK 8:38

Loss of supernatural faculties

ACT 16:16–16:19

Demons seek to return

MAT 12:43–12:45 parallel LUK 11:24–11:26

The impact of exorcism on those who observe it

Amazement

MAT 9:33, MAT 12:23; ; MRK 1:27 parallel LUK 4:36; ; LUK 11:14

Fear

MAT 8:34 parallels MRK 5:17, LUK 8:37

4135: demons, Jesus Christ's authority over

Demons are subject to the authority of Jesus Christ during his ministry and subsequently in the ministry of the church.

All spiritual powers are subject to Jesus Christ who has supreme authority

EPH 1:19–1:22 See also ROM 8:38; EPH 3:10; COL 1:16, COL 2:10, COL 2:15

Demons are powerless before Jesus Christ

Demons can only do what he permits

MAT 8:31–8:32 parallels MRK 5:12–5:13, LUK 8:32–8:33

Demons obey his command

MAT 17:18 parallels MRK 9:25–9:26, LUK 9:42 See also MAT 9:33–9:34; MRK 1:34, MRK 16:9; LUK 11:14

Demons disperse at his word

MRK 9:25 See also MRK 1:25 parallel LUK 4:35

The name of Jesus Christ has power against demons

Jesus Christ's name is used by his disciples

MRK 16:17 See also MRK 9:38–9:39 parallel LUK 9:49–9:50; LUK 10:17; ACT 16:18

Jesus Christ anticipates the misuse of his own name

MAT 7:22–7:23 See also ACT 19:13–19:16 an example where Jesus' name is used in cases of demon-possession-but not by Jesus Christ's disciples, and not successfully

Jesus Christ's disciples have delegated power over demons

In Jesus Christ's own lifetime

MAT 10:1 See also MAT 10:7; MRK 3:14–3:15, MRK 6:7 parallel LUK 9:1; MRK 6:13; LUK 10:17, LUK 10:19

In the ongoing ministry of the church

MRK 16:17 See also ACT 5:16, ACT 8:7, ACT 16:18, ACT 19:12

Others will attempt to drive out demons

MAT 12:27 parallel LUK 11:19; ; MRK 9:38 parallel LUK 9:49; ; ACT 19:13–19:15

The final punishment of demons

2PE 2:4; ; JUD 1:6

4140: angel of the Lord

A title given to those angelic servants of God who are given specific tasks in furthering God's purposes among humanity. These tasks include the giving of revelations, guidance, encouragement, warnings and the execution of judgment on those who oppose God's purposes.

The status of the angel of the Lord

He is identified with the Lord

EXO 3:2–3:6 The angel of the LORD here speaks for God and is recognised as God and as a messenger from God. This may indicate that the angel speaks on God's behalf (compare with the role of the prophets) or, as some believe, this may be a manifestation of the pre-incarnate Jesus Christ. See also GEN 16:7, GEN 16:13, GEN 31:11–31:13; JDG 2:1–2:2, JDG 6:11–6:12, JDG 6:14, JDG 13:19–13:22; ZEC 3:1–3:2

He is distinguished from the Lord

2SA 24:16 parallel 1CH 21:15 See also ZEC 1:12–1:13; LUK 1:19; HEB 1:4

The angel of the Lord is active in various ways

He calls and speaks

GEN 16:7–16:8, GEN 21:17, GEN 22:11, GEN 22:15; ; 2KI 1:3, 2KI 1:15

He has physical contact with people

1KI 19:5, 1KI 19:7; ; ACT 12:7

He appears in human likeness

GEN 18:2, GEN 18:16, GEN 18:22, GEN 19:1; ; JDG 6:11–6:12; ; ACT 27:23

He appears in supernatural form, often evoking fear

EXO 3:2; ; NUM 22:22–22:24, NUM 22:31; ; 1CH 21:16; ; LUK 1:11–1:12, LUK 2:9

He appears in dreams and visions

GEN 31:11; ; ZEC 1:8, ZEC 1:11, ZEC 3:1, ZEC 3:5; ; MAT 2:13, MAT 2:19; ; ACT 10:3

Functions of the angel of the Lord**He reveals information, often about forthcoming births**

JDG 13:3 See also MAT 1:20; LUK 1:11, LUK 1:13

He gives guidance and instruction

ACT 8:26 See also GEN 16:9, GEN 22:11–22:12, GEN 24:7, GEN 24:40; EXO 23:23; NUM 22:35

He comforts those in need

GEN 21:17 See also 1KI 19:5–19:7; ACT 27:23–27:25

He affirms promises and gives blessing

GEN 22:15–22:18 See also LUK 1:26–1:28, LUK 1:30–1:33, LUK 2:10–2:11

He leads, delivers and protects Israel

PSA 34:7 See also EXO 14:19; ISA 63:9

He rebukes sinful Israel

JDG 2:1–2:4

He rolls back the tombstone

MAT 28:2

He rescues those in prison

ACT 5:19, ACT 12:8–12:9

He executes judgment on sin

ACT 12:23 See also 2SA 24:15–24:16 parallel 1CH 21:14–21:15; 2KI 19:35 parallel ISA 37:36; PSA 35:4–35:6

4145: archangels**The archangel associated with the second coming**

1TH 4:16

The archangel Gabriel**Gabriel as an interpreter of visions**

DAN 8:15–8:26 See also DAN 9:20–9:27

Gabriel as a messenger of God

LUK 1:11–1:20 See also LUK 1:26–1:38

The archangel Michael**Michael described as a prince**

DAN 10:12–10:13 See also DAN 10:21

Michael depicted as a warrior and protector

DAN 12:1 See also REV 12:7

Associated with the death of Moses

JUD 1:9

4150: cherubim

Winged, heavenly creatures represented in the tabernacle and the temple.

Description of the cherubim

EZK 10:12–10:14 See also EZK 1:4–1:14, EZK 1:22–1:24, EZK 10:5, EZK 10:8, EZK 10:21–10:22, EZK 41:18–41:19; REV 4:6–4:8

Cherubim represented in the tabernacle and the temple**Cherubim as decorations**

EXO 26:1 See also EXO 36:8; 1KI 6:29 parallel 2CH 3:7; 1KI 7:29, 1KI 7:36

Cherubim at the entrance to the inner sanctuary

EXO 26:31–26:33, EXO 36:35; ; 1KI 6:32, 1KI 6:35; ; 2CH 3:14

Cherubim over the ark of the covenant

HEB 9:5 See also EXO 25:17–25:22, EXO 37:7–37:9; NUM 7:89; 1KI 6:23–6:28 parallel 2CH 3:10–3:13; 1KI 8:6–8:7 parallel 2CH 5:7–5:8; 1CH 28:18

Cherubim represented in Ezekiel's vision of the temple

EZK 41:18, EZK 41:20, EZK 41:25

Cherubim represent the place of God's throne

1SA 4:4 See also 2SA 6:2 parallel 1CH 13:6; 2KI 19:15 parallel ISA 37:16; PSA 80:1, PSA 99:1; EZK 10:1; REV 4:6, REV 5:6

Cherubim as guardians

GEN 3:24 See also EZK 28:14, EZK 28:16

Cherubim as God's chariot

2SA 22:11 parallel PSA 18:10 See also 1CH 28:18

Cherubim as agents of judgment**Cherubim remove God's glory**

EZK 9:3, EZK 10:3–10:4, EZK 10:15–10:19, EZK 11:22–11:23

God's judgment poured out

EZK 10:2, EZK 10:6–10:7; ; REV 6:1–6:8 the living creatures release the four horsemen of God's judgment on earth; ; REV 15:7

4155: divination

Attempts to discover the unknown or the future by supernatural means, involving communication with the spirit world. It is expressly forbidden by God and has disastrous consequences.

Divination was part of early beliefs and practices

GEN 41:24; ; EXO 7:11; ; ISA 31:1-31:2, ISA 47:9; ; JER 27:9; ; EZK 21:21; ; DAN 2:2, DAN 5:7

Examples of divination in NT times

ACT 8:9-8:13, ACT 8:18-8:24, ACT 13:6-13:12, ACT 16:16-16:18

The reality of a supernatural spirit world**The spirit world is real and alluring**

ACT 8:11 See also GEN 44:5, GEN 44:15; 1SA 6:2; ACT 8:9-8:10

The spirit world is powerful and dangerous

2KI 9:22 See also NUM 22:6-22:7, NUM 22:12; 2KI 17:17; ZEC 10:2; EPH 6:12; 2TH 2:9-2:10; REV 18:23

Deliberate involvement with divination forbidden

LEV 19:31 See also EXO 22:18; LEV 19:26; DEU 18:10-18:14; 2KI 21:6; ISA 8:19-8:20; EZK 13:23; MIC 5:12; MAL 3:5; GAL 5:20

It is God's divine privilege to reveal or conceal things

DEU 29:29 See also PRO 25:2

Examples of the evil of divination

1SA 28:7 See also 1SA 28:3-28:15

Casting lots to make decisions

Divination is clearly forbidden but some practices such as casting lots seem acceptable ways of discovering God's will in particular circumstances: 1CH 26:13-26:16; ; NEH 11:1; ; ACT 1:26

4160: driving out**Driving out demons****In Jesus Christ's ministry**

MRK 1:34 See also MAT 8:16, MAT 9:32-9:33 parallel LUK 11:14; MRK 1:39; LUK 13:32

Jesus Christ accused of using satanic power to drive out demons

MAT 12:24-12:28 parallels MRK 3:22-3:26, LUK 11:15-11:20 See also MAT 9:34

Jesus Christ commissioned his disciples to drive out demons

MAT 10:1 parallel LUK 9:1 See also MAT 10:8; MRK 3:15, MRK 6:13

The failure of the disciples to drive out demons

MRK 9:18

Others attempted to use Jesus Christ's authority

LUK 9:49; ; ACT 19:13

Driving out demons is no substitute for obedience to the will of God

MAT 7:22

Driving out demons and Satan as an aspect of Jesus Christ's overall ministry

JHN 12:31

Driving out people

NUM 33:51-33:52 See also EXO 10:11; PSA 44:2; PRO 19:26, PRO 22:10; JER 29:2; MAT 21:12

4165: exorcism

The expulsion of an evil spirit or spirits from a person. Jesus Christ has unique authority as an exorcist. He delegated this authority to the disciples.

Exorcism was practised with varying degrees of success by Jews and pagans

MAT 7:22, MAT 12:27 parallel LUK 11:19; ; ACT 19:13-19:16

Jesus Christ had unique authority as an exorcist

MRK 1:27 parallel LUK 4:36 **MAT 12:25-12:28** parallel LUK 11:17-11:18 The authority Jesus Christ exercised over evil spirits demonstrated that God's kingly authority was present in him. See also MAT 12:29 parallels MRK 3:27, LUK 11:21-11:22 Jesus Christ is the "strong man". His power over evil spirits shows that Satan is defeated.

Jesus Christ had a general ministry of exorcism

MAT 8:16 parallels MRK 1:34, LUK 4:41; ; MRK 1:39; ; LUK 6:17-6:18, LUK 7:21

Jesus Christ gave the apostles power to cast out evil spirits

MAT 10:1 parallels MRK 6:7, LUK 9:1; ; MRK 3:14-3:15, MRK 16:17; ; LUK 10:17

After the ascension the apostles cast out evil spirits

ACT 5:16, ACT 19:12

Various symptoms associated with the need for exorcism**Violent or self-destructive behaviour**

MRK 5:1-5:5 parallel LUK 8:27-8:29

Deafness and muteness

MAT 9:32; ; MRK 9:17; ; LUK 11:14

Seizures

MAT 17:14-17:15 parallels MRK 9:17-9:18, LUK 9:38-9:39

Various components of exorcism

A word of command

MRK 1:25 parallel LUK 4:35 See also MAT 8:32; MRK 9:25; ACT 16:18

The demons recognise the source of the authority addressing them

MRK 1:24 parallel LUK 4:34 See also MAT 8:29 parallels MRK 5:7, LUK 8:28; ACT 16:17

Exorcism was often accompanied by an element of violence or trauma

MRK 1:26 See also MRK 9:26; MAT 8:32 parallels MRK 5:13, LUK 8:32–8:33; ACT 19:16

Exorcism changes the behaviour or condition of the person delivered

MRK 5:15 parallel LUK 8:35 See also MAT 9:33 parallel LUK 11:14

An exorcised person may be “repossessed”

MAT 12:43–12:45 parallel LUK 11:24–11:26

Methods of exorcism other than the word of command

Exorcism may be achieved at a distance

MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30; ; ACT 19:12

On rare occasions an object is used

ACT 19:12 This was an unusual demonstration of power in a city noted for magic.

David’s music brought relief to Saul

1SA 16:14–16:16, 1SA 16:23

Intensive prayer is sometimes necessary

MRK 9:29

4170: host of heaven

God’s angelic attendants

PSA 148:2 See also 1KI 22:19–22:22 parallel 2CH 18:18–18:21; PSA 103:21; LUK 2:8–2:15

The stars in the sky

Created by God

PSA 33:6 See also NEH 9:6; ISA 40:26, ISA 45:12

Objects of worship

2KI 23:4–23:5 See also 2KI 17:16, 2KI 21:3–21:5 parallel 2CH 33:3–33:5; JER 19:13; ZEP 1:4–1:5

Portrayed symbolically

DAN 8:10 See also ISA 34:4

4175: mediums

People who claim to be channels through whom the spirits of the dead speak to the living.

God’s people must not be mediums

DEU 18:10–18:12

God’s people must not consult mediums

ISA 8:19–8:20 See also LEV 19:31, LEV 20:6; 2KI 23:24; JER 27:9

Examples of those who turned to mediums

King Saul

1SA 28:3–28:16; ; 1CH 10:13

King Manasseh

2KI 21:6 parallel 2CH 33:6

The Egyptians

ISA 19:3

4180: seraphim

An order of angels, mentioned only in one OT passage. Seraphim (the plural is also rendered seraphs) have a physical appearance and a moral and spiritual nature; they understand and use speech. Their functions include the worship of God and the communication of the assurance of forgiveness.

Their appearance

ISA 6:2 The covering of faces and feet expresses reverence, humility and awe before God.

Their functions

Worship of God

ISA 6:3 parallel REV 4:8

Communication with the prophet

ISA 6:6–6:7

4185: sorcery and magic

The attempt to discover or influence the future by means forbidden by God, including the use of divination, astrology or witchcraft. Such practices are strongly condemned in Scripture.

Examples of magic and sorcery

Magic practices

REV 18:23 Babylon, here, represents the world as the centre of seduction.

Divination

ZEC 10:2

Spiritism**ISA 8:19–8:20** See also 2CH 33:6**Astrology****2CH 33:3–33:5** parallel 2KI 21:3–21:5**Examples of those who practised sorcery**

Egyptian magicians: EXO 7:11, EXO 8:18; NUM 22:6, NUM 23:23; 2KI 21:6 Manasseh, king of Judah; ; ISA 47:9–47:13 the Babylonians; ; ACT 8:9–8:11 Simon of Samaria; ; ACT 13:6–13:8 Bar-Jesus of Cyprus; ; ACT 19:19 people in Ephesus

All sorcery and magic is strongly forbidden**DEU 18:9–18:12** See also LEV 19:26, LEV 19:31; JER 27:9–27:10; EZK 13:18, EZK 13:20**God is stronger than sorcerers and magicians**

EXO 7:11–7:12, EXO 8:16–8:19; ; ISA 44:24–44:25

God's judgment comes upon sorcerers and magicians

LEV 20:6; ; MIC 5:12; ; ACT 13:6–13:11; ; REV 21:8; ; GAL 5:19–5:21

God made participation in occult practices punishable by death

EXO 22:18; ; LEV 20:27

King Saul was judged for occult practices

1CH 10:13–10:14

Jesus Christ can deliver from occultism

ACT 16:16–16:18, ACT 19:18–19:19; ; ROM 8:38–8:39

4190: spiritism

The use of mediums or other spiritual intermediaries to communicate with the dead. Scripture forbids such practices, which are inconsistent with obedience to a living God.

Spiritism forbidden by God**LEV 19:31** See also DEU 18:10–18:12**Punishment for spiritism****LEV 20:27** See also LEV 20:6**Spiritism practised in Israel****2KI 21:6** parallel 2CH 33:6 See also 1SA 28:4–28:20**Spiritists expelled from Israel****2KI 23:24** See also 1SA 28:3**The futility of spiritism****ISA 8:19** See also ISA 19:2–19:3**4195: spirits**

Intelligent beings which exist separately from bodies. God is spirit and he has given human beings a spiritual entity. He has also created a realm of spiritual beings—some have remained good, others have become evil. Evil spirits seek to control and destroy people, but Jesus Christ has the victory over them.

God is spirit**JHN 4:24** See also GEN 1:2; JOB 33:4; REV 1:4, REV 3:1, REV 4:5, REV 5:6**Other spirits****The spirit of human beings****PRO 20:27** See also JOB 32:8; ECC 12:7; LUK 8:55, LUK 23:46; JHN 3:6; ACT 7:59; JAS 2:26**The spirits of the dead****ISA 26:14** See also PRO 2:18; ISA 14:9; HEB 12:23**Angels****HEB 1:14** See also JDG 6:21–6:22, JDG 13:20–13:21; ZEC 6:5; ACT 23:8**Satan****JOB 1:6** See also JOB 2:1; 2CO 11:14; EPH 6:11–6:12**Demons****REV 16:13–16:14** See also LUK 6:18, LUK 7:21; ACT 23:8; 1PE 3:19; REV 18:2**The role of spirits****As instruments of punishment****1SA 16:14** See also JDG 9:23; 1SA 18:10, 1SA 19:9; 1KI 22:20–22:22 parallel 2CH 18:19–18:21**As instruments of testing to inspire faith in believers****1PE 5:8–5:9** See also JOB 1:8–1:12, JOB 1:22, JOB 2:3–2:6, JOB 2:10; MAT 4:1 parallels MRK 1:13, LUK 4:2; JAS 4:7–4:8**Evil spirits and humanity****Possession by spirits****MRK 9:17–9:18** parallel LUK 9:39 See also MAT 8:28 parallel LUK 8:27; MAT 15:22 parallel MRK 7:25; MRK 1:23 parallel LUK 4:33**Casting out spirits****MAT 8:16** parallels MRK 1:34, LUK 4:40 See also MAT 12:28 parallel LUK 11:20; MAT 17:18 parallels MRK 9:25–9:26, LUK 9:42; ACT 5:16, ACT 8:7**Consultation with spirits forbidden****DEU 18:10–18:11** See also LEV 19:31, LEV 20:6; 1SA 28:8–28:9; 2KI 21:6 parallel 2CH 33:6; ISA 8:19, ISA 19:3**Discernment and testing of spirits****1JN 4:1** See also 1CO 12:10; 1JN 4:2–4:6

Jesus Christ has supremacy over all created spirits

COL 2:10 See also MRK 1:24–1:27, MRK 1:34 parallel LUK 4:41; LUK 4:33–4:36, LUK 10:17–10:19; COL 2:15

4200: Places

- 4203: earth, the
- 4206: land
- 4212: astronomy
- 4215: Babylon
- 4218: cave
- 4221: cistern
- 4224: cities of the plain
- 4227: deep, the
- 4230: desert
- 4233: field of blood
- 4236: fountain
- 4239: garden
- 4245: hills
- 4248: islands
- 4251: moon
- 4254: mountains
- 4257: pit
- 4260: rivers and streams
- 4263: Rome
- 4266: sea
- 4269: Sinai, Mount
- 4272: sky
- 4275: Sodom and Gomorrah
- 4278: spring of water
- 4281: stars
- 4284: sun
- 4287: universe
- 4290: valleys
- 4293: water
- 4296: wells
- 4299: wilderness

4203: earth, the

Created and sustained by God, the world is both his possession and the dwelling-place of his creatures. As such, it should bring him glory, and will one day be judged by him.

God created the earth from nothing

EXO 20:11; NEH 9:6; ACT 14:15 See also GEN 1:1–1:2; EXO 31:17; 2KI 19:15; JOB 26:7; PSA 74:17, PSA 115:15, PSA 119:90; ISA 44:24, ISA 45:12, ISA 48:13; JER 10:12, JER 27:5, JER 32:17, JER 33:2; AMO 4:13; JHN 1:3; ACT 4:24; HEB 11:3; 2PE 3:5; REV 10:6, REV 14:7

The earth belongs to God

DEU 10:14; PSA 24:1, PSA 95:4–95:5 See also EXO 9:29; JOS 3:13; ISA 2:8; 1CH 29:11; PSA 47:9, PSA 89:11; 1CO 10:26

God controls and sustains the earth

PSA 135:6–135:7 See also GEN 9:16–9:17; JOB 5:10, JOB 28:5; PSA 104:13–104:14, PSA 147:8; JER 10:13, JER 33:25; HOS 6:3; COL 1:17; HEB 1:3

God's character seen on earth

PSA 33:5 See also PSA 85:11, PSA 119:64; ISA 6:3, ISA 11:9; JER 9:24

The earth should resound to God's glory and praise

PSA 96:1; ISA 44:23 See also PSA 47:2, PSA 66:4, PSA 72:9, PSA 108:5, PSA 148:7; ISA 49:13; HAB 3:3; REV 5:13

The earth is the habitation of human beings and the animals

PSA 115:16 See also GEN 1:22, GEN 1:26, GEN 1:28–1:30, GEN 8:17, GEN 9:1; ACT 17:26

God judges the earth

1CH 16:14; NAM 1:5 See also GEN 18:25; DEU 32:22; 1SA 2:10; 2SA 22:16; JOB 9:6; PSA 46:6, PSA 77:18; ISA 2:21, ISA 26:9; JER 10:10

God will destroy the earth one day

PSA 102:25–102:26; 2PE 3:10–3:12 See also ISA 24:1–24:6, ISA 51:6; JER 4:23–4:26; MAT 24:35 parallel MRK 13:31; 2PE 3:7; REV 20:11

God will create a new earth

2PE 3:13 See also ISA 65:17, ISA 66:22; REV 21:1

4206: land

Areas of territory, the possession of which was regarded as a sign of security and prosperity. The land of Israel was regarded as the land promised by God to his people and a sign of his covenant faithfulness.

4207: land, as a divine gift

God's gift of the land of Israel is fundamental to the covenant promises made to Abraham and his descendants.

Land as part of God's creation

GEN 1:9–1:10

The land (Canaan) promised to Abraham

GEN 12:7 See also GEN 12:1, GEN 13:15–13:17, GEN 17:8, GEN 24:7

The boundaries of the promised land

GEN 15:18–15:21 See also EXO 23:31; NUM 34:1–34:12

God's promise and its gradual fulfilment

The promise made to the patriarchs

GEN 26:3–26:4 See also GEN 23:17–23:20, GEN 28:13, GEN 35:12, GEN 48:3–48:4, GEN 50:24–50:25 The patriarchs maintained only a very small part of the land. But Genesis closes with the prospect of much more.

The promise confirmed during the wilderness wanderings

EXO 3:7–3:8 See also EXO 6:4, EXO 6:8, EXO 13:5, EXO 13:11, EXO 32:11–32:14, EXO 33:1–33:3; NUM 11:10–11:12

Exploration of the promised land

NUM 13:1–13:2 See also NUM 13:21–13:25

Entry delayed because of unbelief and rebellion

NUM 13:27–13:33 See also NUM 14:1–14:4, NUM 14:26–14:35, NUM 14:40–14:45

Critical importance of obedience in the promised land

DEU 5:32–5:33 Moses, at the end of his life, urges all the Israelites always to remember the LORD and his commands; enjoyment of the land is dependent upon the people's obedience. See also DEU 6:10–6:12

Invasion of the land

JOS 1:2 The theme of the book of Joshua is the land: chapters 1–12 its invasion and conquest, chapters 13–21 its division among the Israelite tribes. See also JOS 2:1

Gradual conquest of the land

JOS 13:1 See also JOS 7:2, JOS 8:1, JOS 9:1–9:2, JOS 10:29–10:30, JOS 13:2–13:6, JOS 14:12, JOS 17:12–17:18

The promise fulfilled

JOS 21:43–21:45

Division of the land

JOS 23:4–23:5

Conflict with the Philistines over the land

1SA 7:7–7:14 Philistine aggression had imperilled the prospect of a full possession of the land until David overpowered them. See also JDG 2:21–2:22, JDG 13:1, JDG 15:11; 1SA 4:10–4:11, 1SA 13:17–13:19, 1SA 17:1–17:2, 1SA 31:1, 1SA 31:7

Jerusalem captured by David

2SA 5:6–5:7

The land at rest and prosperous

Under David

2SA 7:1 See also 2SA 8:1–8:6, 2SA 8:14, 2SA 10:15–10:19

Under Solomon

1KI 5:4 See also 1KI 4:20–4:21

The exile and subsequent return to the land

Losing the land

LEV 26:14, LEV 26:32–26:33 See also DEU 28:63–28:65; JER 16:13, JER 17:4, JER 25:11, JER 44:22; LAM 5:2

Return to the land

JER 23:7–23:8 See also ISA 14:1, ISA 35:10, ISA 43:5–43:6; EZK 20:41–20:42, EZK 34:11–34:13; AMO 9:14–9:15

4208: land, as a divine responsibility

Israel's land is a gift from God, though ultimately it remains under divine ownership. Life in the land is therefore characterised by both privilege and responsibility.

The land is a gift from God

DEU 26:5–26:9

It is Israel's inheritance

DEU 26:1 See also EXO 32:13; DEU 4:21, DEU 4:38, DEU 15:4, DEU 19:10

Eleven full tribes share the inheritance

NUM 26:52–26:55

Inherited land east of Jordan allotted by Moses

NUM 32:33 See also JOS 12:6, JOS 13:8, JOS 13:15, JOS 13:24, JOS 13:29

Inherited land west of Jordan allotted by Joshua and others

NUM 34:17–34:29 See also JOS 14:1, JOS 14:13, JOS 15:1, JOS 15:20, JOS 16:4, JOS 18:11, JOS 19:1, JOS 19:10, JOS 19:17, JOS 19:24, JOS 19:32, JOS 19:40, JOS 19:51

Levi receives no inheritance of land

NUM 26:62; ; DEU 18:1; ; JOS 13:14, JOS 13:33

Israelite households to hold their inheritance in perpetuity

NUM 36:7–36:9 See also 1KI 21:3; EZK 46:18

The land remains under divine ownership

LEV 25:23

Responsibility to God for the land

See also MAT 21:33–21:46

The tithe

LEV 27:30 The tithe of the land's produce given to the LORD, is a kind of rent, a way of acknowledging his ownership.

Harvest festivals

EXO 23:16 See also LEV 23:15–23:21, LEV 23:33–23:43

Sabbath rest**LEV 25:1–25:7****The Year of Jubilee****LEV 25:8–25:13****Responsibility to fellow Israelites in the land****Individual property rights to be respected****DEU 19:14** See also DEU 27:17; PRO 15:25, PRO 22:28, PRO 23:10; HOS 5:10**Violation of these rights severely condemned****ISA 5:8** See also 1KI 21:17–21:19; JOB 20:19; EZK 45:8–45:9; MIC 2:2, MIC 2:9**Responsibility to the poor in the land****The fallow (sabbath) year****EXO 23:10–23:11** See also LEV 25:6–25:7; DEU 15:1–15:3
Debts probably include the labour of a debtor's dependants, working to pay off his debt.**The Year of Jubilee****LEV 25:8–25:13****Harvesting conventions****LEV 19:9–19:10** See also LEV 23:22; DEU 24:19–24:22; RUT 2:2–2:3**The land reflects God's blessing and curse****Blessing****DEU 28:1–28:6, DEU 28:11–28:12** See also LEV 25:18–25:19; DEU 11:13–11:15; PSA 65:9–65:13, PSA 67:5–67:6**Curse****DEU 28:15, DEU 28:18, DEU 28:21** See also LEV 18:24–18:28, LEV 20:22–20:24, LEV 26:42–26:45; 1KI 17:1**4209: land, spiritual aspects of**

Scripture presents land in a spiritual perspective. The whole earth, once perfect but now contaminated by the fall, will one day be renewed. There will be a new heaven and earth where life is abundant and God's presence is experienced for ever.

Eden: the original good land**GEN 2:8–2:9****Paradise lost: expulsion from the garden****GEN 3:17–3:19** See also ROM 8:19–8:20**The promised land: an echo of Eden****DEU 8:7–8:10** See also EXO 3:8, EXO 3:17, EXO 13:5; LEV 20:24; NUM 13:27; DEU 6:3, DEU 11:8–11:12, DEU 26:9, DEU 27:3**The land of Israel after the exile****Promise of a return to the land****AMO 9:14–9:15** See also ISA 14:1, ISA 35:1–35:10; EZK 20:41–20:42, EZK 34:11–34:13; AMO 9:11–9:12; ACT 15:16–15:17**Promise of a restored environment****ISA 51:3** See also ZEC 8:12–8:13**The final restoration of the land****ISA 65:17** See also ISA 66:22; ROM 8:21**Jesus Christ will reign eternally over new heavens and a new earth****ZEC 9:9–9:10** See also MAT 21:5; JHN 12:15; 2PE 3:13; REV 21:1–21:4, REV 22:1–22:5**Vision of life on the new earth****ISA 11:6–11:9** See also HOS 2:18–2:23; MIC 4:2–4:4**The new Eden: the Christian's inheritance****HEB 11:13–11:16** See also PSA 37:11; MAT 5:5; ROM 8:17; 2PE 3:13; REV 2:7, REV 21:7; LUK 23:43; 2CO 12:1–12:4**4212: astronomy**

The study of the stars and planets, with a view to understanding their movements and their use in fixing the time of significant events.

Astronomy as a study**It demonstrates the greatness of God and his creation****JOB 9:7–9:9; ISA 40:26** See also GEN 2:1; DEU 10:14; 1CH 16:26; NEH 9:6 Nehemiah's prayer reviews God's grace and power in creation; JOB 22:12, JOB 25:5, JOB 26:9; PSA 19:1–19:6, PSA 33:6, PSA 74:16, PSA 89:5, PSA 89:11, PSA 96:5, PSA 104:2, PSA 136:5, PSA 136:7–136:9, PSA 148:3; PRO 3:19 Divine wisdom permeates the whole creation; ISA 38:8 the LORD's sign to Hezekiah; ISA 45:12; JER 31:35; MAT 5:45; HEB 1:10 credited to Jesus Christ**It demonstrates the humility of the human race****PSA 8:3–8:4****The use of astronomy to determine dates****GEN 1:3–1:5; PSA 81:3, PSA 104:19****The mysteries of astronomy are beyond human understanding****JOB 38:31–38:33****God's judgment and astronomical disturbances****JOL 2:31; MAT 24:29** parallels MRK 13:25, LUK 21:25 See also ISA 13:10, ISA 24:23, ISA 30:26, ISA 34:4, ISA 51:6,

ISA 60:9–60:20 the glory of Zion; EZK 32:7–32:8; JOL 2:10, JOL 3:15; AMO 8:9; ACT 2:20; 2PE 3:10; REV 8:12

Lessons from astronomy

The stars as symbols of plenty
GEN 15:5

The regularity of the heavens as a symbol of the bleakness of life
ECC 1:5

The differing splendour within the creation
1CO 15:41

Wandering stars as a symbol of lostness
JUD 1:13

4215: Babylon

In OT times, the commercial, religious and political capital of Babylonia, which was the dominant power in the Near East in the sixth century B.C. In the NT, “Babylon” signifies the world and its forces in opposition to God. It is often contrasted with “the new Jerusalem”, in which God will finally reign supreme.

The founding of Babylon

GEN 10:8–10:10 Shinar was an alternative name for Babylon.

Biblical events prior to the exile in Babylon

Inhabitants of Babylon exiled to Samaria
See also 2KI 17:24–17:33

Envoys from Babylon visit Hezekiah

2KI 20:12–20:19 parallel ISA 39:1–39:8 Hezekiah’s reception of the envoys was designed to lead to a coalition against Assyria, but in the end it brought about the very opposite of what he had hoped for.

Manasseh, king of Judah, exiled to Babylon
2CH 33:10–33:11

Jehoiakim, king of Judah, becomes a vassal of Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon
2KI 24:1–24:2 parallel 2CH 36:6–36:7

Nebuchadnezzar lays siege to Jerusalem
2KI 24:10–24:17 parallel 2CH 36:9–36:10

Nebuchadnezzar conquers Jerusalem and deports the population
2KI 25:1–25:21 parallels 2CH 36:17–36:20, JER 39:1–39:10, JER 52:4–52:27

Exile in Babylon

The people of Judah exiled in Babylon
1CH 9:1 See also 2CH 36:20; PSA 137:1–137:9; DAN 1:1–1:7

Advice for those exiled in Babylon
JER 29:4–29:14

Cyrus king of Babylon decrees that the Jerusalem temple should be rebuilt
EZR 5:13–5:16 See also 2CH 36:22–36:23 parallel EZR 1:1–1:4

Exiles return from Babylon
EZR 2:1–2:2 parallel NEH 7:6–7:7

Babylon, an instrument of divine judgment
2KI 24:2–24:4 See also JER 20:4–20:6, JER 21:10

The fall of Babylon

Predictions of Babylon’s fall
JER 51:59–51:64 See also ISA 14:3–14:23, ISA 47:1–47:15; JER 50:1–50:10

Babylon conquered by Darius
DAN 5:30–5:31

Babylon used figuratively

By Peter
See also 1PE 5:13 Babylon is traditionally interpreted as Rome, but may also mean Mesopotamian Babylon, Egyptian Babylon, or Jerusalem.

Of the world opposed to God
REV 14:8 See also REV 17:3–17:6, REV 18:1–18:24

4218: cave

A natural cavity in a rock face, often used as a place of refuge.

Caves as places of refuge

JDG 6:2; 1SA 22:1–22:2 See also GEN 19:30; JOS 10:16–10:18, JOS 10:22–10:23, JOS 10:27; JDG 15:8, JDG 15:11; 1SA 13:6, 1SA 24:2–24:22 Saul comes to David’s cave, but David spares his life; 2SA 17:9, 2SA 23:13 parallel 1CH 11:15; 1KI 18:4, 1KI 18:13, 1KI 19:9; PSA 57:0, PSA 142:0; ISA 2:19–2:21 a place of refuge in the face of divine judgment; JER 48:28, JER 49:8; EZK 33:27; HEB 11:38 a place of refuge for those being persecuted for their faith; REV 6:15

Caves used as graves

JHN 11:38 See also GEN 23:8–23:20, GEN 25:9, GEN 49:29–49:32, GEN 50:13

4221: cistern

A reservoir for storing water collected from rainfall or from a spring. When empty, it was used for a variety of purposes. The word is also employed in a figurative sense.

Cisterns were used to collect water**2CH 26:10** See also 2KI 18:31 parallel ISA 36:16; JER 14:3**Other uses for cisterns****JER 38:6–38:13** See also GEN 37:19–37:24, GEN 37:28–37:30; JER 41:4–41:7, JER 41:9; ZEC 9:11**Cisterns used as symbols****Cisterns as symbols of spiritual well-being****JER 2:13****Cisterns as symbols of physical well-being**

See also PRO 5:15–5:19

4224: cities of the plain**The cities of the plain of the River Jordan, chosen by Lot as a place of residence****GEN 13:10–13:12****Abraham rescues their inhabitants**

See also GEN 14:1–14:24

Abraham prays for their inhabitants

GEN 18:17–18:33

Judgment on their sin

GEN 19:1–19:29

The cities of the plain as symbols of sin and judgment**DEU 29:23; LUK 17:28–17:29****4227: deep, the**

Unfathomed waters, sometimes seen as existing under the earth, held back by God's power. The term is also used of deep seas, and in metaphorical contexts.

Unfathomed waters**GEN 1:2; PSA 104:6–104:9** See also GEN 7:11, GEN 49:25; DEU 33:13; JOB 38:16; PSA 95:4, PSA 139:15; PRO 3:20, PRO 8:27–8:28; ISA 7:11; ROM 10:7**Deep seas****EXO 15:5; JON 2:3** See also JOB 7:12, JOB 38:30; PSA 42:7; ISA 44:27, ISA 51:10; HAB 3:10; MAT 18:6; LUK 5:4**The deep used metaphorically of a desperate situation****PSA 18:16** See also 2SA 22:17; PSA 30:1, PSA 69:2, PSA 69:15, PSA 130:1**4230: desert****The desert as a harsh place****JER 2:6** See also ISA 25:4–25:5, ISA 49:10; JER 4:26, JER 22:6; HOS 13:5**The desert as a place of human activity****Living in the desert****GEN 21:21** See also JDG 1:16; PRO 21:19; JER 25:24; EZK 34:25; LUK 1:80**Grazing livestock in the desert****EXO 3:1** See also GEN 36:24; 1CH 5:9; JOB 24:5**Hiding in the desert****1SA 23:14–23:15** See also 1SA 23:25**Dying in the desert****EXO 14:11–14:12; JHN 6:49** See also EXO 16:3; NUM 3:4, NUM 14:29, NUM 32:13; 1CO 10:5; HEB 3:17**God leading and caring for his people in the desert****DEU 2:7; NEH 9:19–9:21; PSA 78:52** See also EXO 13:18, EXO 17:1, EXO 17:5–17:6; DEU 1:19, DEU 8:2, DEU 29:5, DEU 32:10; JOS 24:7; PSA 136:16; AMO 2:10; ACT 7:36, ACT 13:18**John the Baptist in the desert****MRK 1:4** See also MAT 3:3 parallels MRK 1:2–1:3, LUK 3:4; ISA 40:3**Jesus Christ in the desert****MAT 4:1** parallels MRK 1:12–1:13, LUK 4:1**Specific deserts**

See also GEN 21:14 Beersheba; EXO 15:22 Shur; EXO 16:1 sin; EXO 19:1–19:2 Sinai; NUM 12:16 Paran; NUM 13:21 Zin; NUM 33:8 Etham; DEU 2:26 Kedemoth; JOS 18:12 Beth Aven; 1SA 23:24 Maon; 1SA 24:1 En Gedi; 1SA 26:2 Ziph; 1KI 19:15 Damascus; 2KI 3:8 Edom; 2CH 20:16 Jeruel; 2CH 20:20 Tekoa; PSA 29:8 Kadesh; PSA 63:0 Judah; MAT 3:1 Judea; ACT 8:26 the desert road from Jerusalem to Gaza

Deserts used figuratively**JER 2:31** See also ISA 35:6, ISA 40:3; JER 50:12; LAM 4:3; HOS 2:3**4233: field of blood****The field purchased by Judas Iscariot in which he subsequently died****ACT 1:18–1:19** See also MAT 27:3–27:10

4236: fountain

A source of natural spring water. Figuratively, it symbolises a place of cleansing, tears or sexual fulfilment. Significantly, God is pictured as a fountain of life.

The fountain as a source of spring water
PRO 18:4

Figurative use of fountains

A place of cleansing
ZEC 13:1

Tears of inconsolable grief
JER 9:1

Sexual fulfilment
SNG 4:12 See also PRO 5:15–5:18; SNG 4:15

A source of life
PRO 14:27 See also PSA 36:8–36:9, PSA 87:7; PRO 10:11, PRO 13:14, PRO 16:22; JOL 3:18

4239: garden

A piece of land where flowers, fruit and vegetables may be grown. The Garden of Eden was the garden entrusted to the care of Adam and Eve.

4240: garden, natural

A place of leisure for growing flowers, fruit and vegetables.

General references to gardens

1KI 21:2; ECC 2:5 See also SNG 4:12, SNG 5:1, SNG 6:2; ISA 5:7; JER 29:5; LAM 2:6; AMO 4:9, AMO 9:14; MAT 13:32; LUK 11:42, LUK 13:19

Gardens require irrigation

DEU 11:10; ISA 1:30 See also NUM 24:6; JOB 8:16; ISA 58:11; JER 31:12

Gardens attached to palaces

EST 1:5–1:6 See also 2KI 21:18, 2KI 21:26; NEH 3:15; EST 7:7; JER 39:4

Idolatrous worship in gardens

ISA 65:3 See also ISA 1:29, ISA 66:17

Jesus Christ betrayed in a garden

MAT 26:36 parallel MRK 14:32 Gethsemane was a garden.

Jesus Christ buried in a garden tomb

JHN 19:41–19:42

4241: Garden of Eden, the

The garden created by God and entrusted to the care of Adam and Eve.

The “garden of the LORD”

GEN 2:8, GEN 13:10 See also GEN 2:9–2:14; ISA 51:3; EZK 31:9, EZK 31:18 Ancient Egypt is likened to Eden; EZK 36:35; JOL 2:3

The place of fellowship with God
GEN 3:8

Where God spoke to Adam
 See also GEN 2:16–2:18

Where Adam was to work
 GEN 2:15, GEN 2:19

Where God made Eve and gave her to Adam
GEN 2:18 See also GEN 2:20–2:24

Where Adam and Eve lived in innocence
 GEN 2:25, GEN 3:7, GEN 3:11

Where God abundantly provided for Adam and Eve
 GEN 2:9–2:17 The trees of Eden are important. They are both the evidence of God’s love and one is the focus of Adam’s test.

The paradise that humanity has lost

Where Adam and Eve disobeyed God
GEN 3:6 See also GEN 2:17, GEN 3:1–3:7, GEN 3:11

Where humanity came under God’s curse
 GEN 3:16–3:19

The place from which Adam and Eve were banished
GEN 3:23 See also GEN 3:22, GEN 3:24

The picture of God’s blessing

ISA 51:3 See also ISA 58:11; JER 31:12

Where God first promised Satan’s destruction
GEN 3:14–3:15

Where God first provided a covering for sinners
 See also GEN 3:21

Eden as an anticipation of heaven

LUK 23:43 The word “paradise” (which means “park” or “walled garden”) clearly refers back to the idea of Eden. See also 2CO 12:3, 2CO 12:4; REV 2:7, REV 22:1–22:3; EZK 28:12–28:13 the former glory of the king of Tyre likened to that of Adam in the Garden of Eden

4245: hills

The promised land was a place of hills

The high ground to the east of Jordan

DEU 3:12 See also GEN 31:21

The high ground of Judah in the south

JOS 11:21 See also JOS 12:8; LUK 1:39

The high ground of Judah includes Jerusalem

JOL 3:17 See also PSA 2:6; ISA 10:32; DAN 9:16

The high ground to the north

JDG 3:27 See also JOS 20:7; 2KI 5:22

Topics associated with hills

Plenty

JOL 3:18 See also DEU 8:7–8:9; PSA 50:10, PSA 72:3, PSA 72:16; ISA 7:25; AMO 9:13

Age

JOB 15:7 See also GEN 49:26; DEU 33:15; PRO 8:25; HAB 3:6

Hiding

JOS 2:16; ; ISA 23:14

Grazing

1KI 22:17; ; JER 33:13; ; EZK 34:6; ; MAT 18:12

Idolatrous worship

DEU 12:2 See also 1KI 11:7, 1KI 14:23; 2KI 17:10, 2KI 23:13; JER 13:27; HOS 4:13

Hills used metaphorically

MAT 5:14 See also PSA 114:4; ISA 40:12, ISA 55:12

4248: islands

Used of the islands and coastlands of the eastern Mediterranean and, especially by Isaiah, as a more general term indicating distant nations that are called upon to respond to God. Several specific islands are mentioned in the NT.

The islands and coastlands of the Mediterranean

ISA 11:11 See also ISA 42:10, ISA 60:9; JER 2:10–2:11, JER 31:10; EZK 26:15–26:18, EZK 27:3–27:7; DAN 11:18, DAN 11:29–11:30

Islands as a symbol of human insignificance before God

ISA 40:15–40:17

Islands as a symbol of distant nations

Nations who do not know God

ISA 66:19 See also ISA 41:1, ISA 49:1

Nations who are not beyond God's law and judgment

ISA 59:18 See also EZK 25:16–25:17, EZK 39:6; REV 6:12–6:14, REV 16:17–16:20

Nations called to respond to God

ISA 42:10–42:12 See also ISA 24:15, ISA 42:4, ISA 51:4–51:5

Islands mentioned in the NT

Cos

ACT 21:1

Crete

ACT 27:7–27:26; ; TIT 1:5, TIT 1:12

Cyprus

ACT 4:36, ACT 11:19–11:21, ACT 13:4–13:12, ACT 15:39, ACT 21:16

Kios

ACT 20:15

Malta

ACT 27:39–28:11

Patmos

REV 1:9

Rhodes

ACT 21:1

Samos

ACT 20:15

Samothrace

ACT 16:11

Sicily

ACT 28:12 Syracuse was the leading city of Sicily.

4251: moon

The moon created by God

PSA 8:3 See also PSA 74:16

The moon listed among the heavenly bodies

GEN 37:9; ; PSA 148:3; ; ECC 12:2; ; 1CO 15:41

The moon as a basis for the calendar

The moon governs the night

GEN 1:16–1:18 See also PSA 136:7–136:9; JER 31:35

Seasons marked by the moon

PSA 104:19 See also GEN 1:14

Months marked by the new moon

NUM 28:14; ; 1CH 23:31; ; ISA 66:23

The moon as a symbol of permanence

PSA 89:37 See also PSA 72:5, PSA 72:7 ISA 60:19–60:20; REV 21:23

Idolatrous worship of the moon

DEU 4:19 See also DEU 17:3; 2KI 23:5; JOB 31:26; JER 8:2

Signs in the moon indicating divine intervention

At the close of history

ISA 13:10, ISA 30:26; ; JOL 2:10, JOL 2:31; ; ACT 2:20; ; MAT 24:29 parallel MRK 13:24–13:25; ; REV 6:12, REV 12:1

Other examples

JOS 10:12–10:13; ; EZK 32:7

The moon thought to affect the mind

PSA 121:6 The moon is indicated as a source of danger; ; MAT 4:24 The Greek expression translated “having seizures” originally meant “moonstruck”.

4254: mountains

These natural features of Palestine are often used as poetic symbols when describing God or his dealings with his people. Specific mountains are remembered because of their association with important events in the history of Israel. Some of the key events in the life and ministry of Jesus Christ take place on mountain sites.

Mountains and the character of God

Mountains and the steadfastness of God

PSA 125:2 See also PSA 11:1, PSA 90:2; ISA 54:10

Mountains tremble at God’s awesome presence

JDG 5:5 The violent physical response to the presence of the holy God evokes a sense of his might and majesty. See also EXO 19:16–19:19; PSA 97:5; ISA 64:1; MIC 1:3–1:4; HAB 3:3–3:6

Mountains cannot stand before the anger of God

PSA 18:7 See also JER 4:23–4:26; NAM 1:5–1:6; REV 6:12–6:14, REV 16:19–16:20

Mountains as places of encounter with God

EXO 34:1–34:3 See also 1KI 19:11–19:13; 2PE 1:16–1:18

Specific mountains as the sites of important events in Israel’s history

The mountains of Abarim: site of Israel’s camp

NUM 33:47–33:48

Mount Ararat: resting place of Noah’s ark

GEN 8:1–8:5

Mount Carmel: scene of Elijah’s defeat of the prophets of Baal

1KI 18:16–18:40

Mount Ebal: site of cursing; Mount Gerizim: site of blessing

See also DEU 11:29, DEU 27:12–27:13; JOS 8:30–8:35

Mount Gilboa: place of Saul’s suicide

1CH 10:1–10:12 parallels 1SA 31:1–31:13, 2SA 1:4–1:12

Mount Hermon: a boundary of Israel

See also DEU 3:8; JOS 11:16–11:17; PSA 42:6–42:7, PSA 89:12

Mount Hor: place of Aaron’s death

NUM 33:37–33:39 See also NUM 20:22–20:29

Mount Moriah: testing place of Abraham

GEN 22:1–22:3

Mount Moriah: site of Solomon’s temple

2CH 3:1

Mount Nebo: place of Moses’ death

DEU 32:48–32:52 See also DEU 34:1–34:5

Mount Sinai: God gives Moses the law

EXO 24:12 See also EXO 31:18; NEH 9:13–9:14

Mount Tabor: scene of Sisera’s defeat

JDG 4:12–4:16

Mountains as the sites of significant events in the NT

On the Mount of Temptation the devil offers Jesus Christ the kingdoms of the world

MAT 4:8–4:9 parallel LUK 4:5–4:7

In the Sermon on the Mount Jesus Christ teaches about life in the kingdom of God

MAT 5:1–5:2

On the Mount of Transfiguration Jesus Christ’s glory is revealed

MAT 17:1–17:8 parallels MRK 9:2–9:8, LUK 9:28–9:36

On the Mount of Olives Jesus Christ teaches about the destruction of the temple and the last things

MAT 24:3 parallel MRK 13:3–13:4

4257: pit

A hole in the ground

MAT 15:14 See also EXO 21:33–21:34; 2SA 18:17, 2SA 23:20; MAT 12:11; MRK 12:1; LUK 6:39

A pit used as a trap

PSA 35:7–35:8 See also PSA 7:15, PSA 9:15, PSA 57:6, PSA 94:13; PRO 26:27; ECC 10:8; ISA 24:17–24:18; JER 18:20–18:22, JER 48:43–48:44; EZK 19:4, EZK 19:8

A pit as a symbol of distress or grief

PSA 40:2 See also JOB 9:30–9:31; PSA 88:6; PRO 22:14, PRO 23:27; LAM 3:53–3:55; ZEC 9:11

The pit as a term for the grave

ISA 14:15 See also JOB 33:18, JOB 33:22, JOB 33:24, JOB 33:28, JOB 33:30; PSA 28:1, PSA 30:3, PSA 30:9, PSA 55:23, PSA 69:15, PSA 88:4, PSA 103:4, PSA 143:7; PRO 1:12; ISA 14:19, ISA 38:17–38:18; EZK 26:20, EZK 28:8, EZK 31:14, EZK 31:16, EZK 31:18, EZK 32:23–32:25, EZK 32:29–32:30; JON 2:6

The pit as a symbol of judgment

ISA 30:33

4260: rivers and streams

The term river is used to refer to all kinds of water-courses, including wadis (dried-up desert river beds) and permanent rivers. It is also used symbolically to refer to things which threaten or overwhelm people and nations, such as invading nations, the peace of God and the Holy Spirit.

Different kinds of rivers and streams**Wadis**

1KI 17:7 Wadis were dry river beds in summer but became raging torrents in the rainy season. See also GEN 32:22 The Jabbok was a wadi, here in full flow; NUM 21:13–21:15; JOB 6:15–6:17; JER 15:18

Springs

PSA 104:10 See also GEN 16:7; EXO 15:27; JDG 1:14–1:15; 2KI 2:19–2:22

Permanent rivers

GEN 2:10–2:14 See also GEN 41:1–41:3; NUM 22:1; DEU 1:7; ISA 18:1

Canals

DAN 8:2 See also EXO 7:19; EZR 8:21; EZK 1:1 Although called a river here, the Kebar was a canal of the Euphrates.

Some significant rivers and streams in Scripture**River Arnon**

The Arnon flowed through Moab to the mid point of the Dead Sea: NUM 21:13–21:15; ; JDG 11:18; ; ISA 16:2; ; JER 48:20

Rivers of Damascus

2KI 5:12 The Abana flowed through the city of Damascus and the Pharpar just to the south of it.

River Euphrates

The Euphrates flowed through Mesopotamia for some 1,700 miles (2,700 km) from its source in eastern Turkey to the Persian Gulf: DEU 1:7; ; 2KI 23:29 parallel 2CH 35:20; ; ISA 11:15; ; JER 51:63–51:64; ; REV 16:12

River Habor

2KI 17:6 parallel 2KI 18:11 The Habor was a tributary of the Euphrates.

River Jabbok

The Jabbok flowed westward through Gilead into the Jordan about 20 miles (32 km) north of the Dead Sea: GEN 32:22; ; NUM 21:23–21:24; ; DEU 3:16; ; JDG 11:13

River Jordan

The Jordan flowed from the slopes of Mount Hermon through Lake Huleh and the Sea of Galilee, and on into the Dead Sea, providing a fertile basin on either side of the river: GEN 13:10–13:11, GEN 32:9–32:10; ; NUM 22:1; ; JOS 3:14–4:9; ; 2KI 5:8–5:14; ; MRK 1:4–1:5 parallel MAT 3:5–3:6

River Kebar

The Kebar was a canal of the Euphrates in Babylon where the exiles gathered to pray: EZK 1:1, EZK 3:15, EZK 43:1–43:3

River Kerith

1KI 17:2–17:7 The exact location of this wadi is uncertain, but it ran from the east into the Jordan or one of its tributaries.

River Kishon

The Kishon flowed north-west across the Plain of Megiddo and could quickly flood as a result of storms: JDG 4:6–4:7, JDG 4:13, JDG 5:21; ; 1KI 18:40; ; PSA 83:9

River Nile

The Nile flowed north some 3,500 miles (5,600 km) from Lake Victoria to the Mediterranean, providing a natural irrigation system in the desert through its annual floodings: EXO 1:22–2:10, EXO 7:17–7:21; ; ISA 19:5–19:8; ; EZK 29:3–29:5

River Tigris

The Tigris flowed from the Armenian mountains through Mesopotamia to join the Euphrates some 40 miles (65 km) north of the Persian Gulf: GEN 2:14; ; DAN 10:4–10:5; ; NAM 2:6–2:8

The crossing of rivers and streams**Rivers crossed by fords**

JOS 2:7; ; JDG 3:28, JDG 12:5–12:6; ; 2SA 17:16

Rivers crossed by miraculous intervention from God
JOS 3:14–3:17; ; **2KI 2:7–2:8**, **2KI 2:13–2:14**

Human uses of rivers and streams

As boundaries

GEN 15:18 See also **JOS 1:2**, **JOS 12:2**; **1KI 4:21**

For irrigation

DEU 11:10 The reference may be to a machine operated by foot, or to the foot breaking through the mud walls of the irrigation channel to let the water flow into the fields. See also **EZK 17:5–17:8**, **EZK 19:10**

As places of prayer

ACT 16:13 See also **PSA 137:1–137:3**; **EZK 3:15**

For ritual washing and baptism

2KI 5:10 See also **MRK 1:5** parallel **MAT 3:6**; **ACT 8:36–8:38**

God as sovereign Creator is ruler and judge over all rivers and streams

PSA 74:15 See also **PSA 78:13–78:16**, **PSA 107:33–107:35**; **ISA 19:5–19:8**; **REV 8:10–8:11**, **REV 16:12**

The symbolic use of rivers and streams

A symbol of threatening circumstances

PSA 124:1–124:5 See also **PSA 32:6**, **PSA 88:16–88:17**

A symbol of invading nations

JER 47:2 See also **ISA 8:7–8:8**; **JER 46:7–46:8**

A symbol of God's judgment on his enemies

2SA 5:20 "Baal Perazim" means "the lord who breaks out". The picture is of a river bursting its banks. See also **JOB 20:28–20:29**; **ISA 59:19**; **NAM 1:7–1:8**

A symbol of God's peace

ISA 48:18 See also **ISA 66:12**

A symbol of God's sustaining power

PSA 46:4–46:5 See also **ISA 8:6**

A symbol of God's provision and blessing

JOL 3:18 See also **PSA 1:3**, **PSA 36:8–36:9**; **ISA 30:25**

A symbol of renewal and life

ISA 41:18 See also **EZK 47:1–47:12**; **REV 22:1–22:2**

A symbol of the Holy Spirit

JHN 7:37–7:39 See also **ISA 44:3**; **JHN 4:13–4:14**

4263: Rome

The city state at the heart of the great world empire of NT times, pictured in the book of Revelation as the embodiment of corrupt earthly power. A large church had been established in Rome long before Paul arrived there, towards the end of his life and his mission. His

letter to the believers in Rome includes a comprehensive explanation of the gospel.

Rome and the mission of Paul

Paul plans to visit Rome

ACT 19:21 See also **ROM 1:13–1:15**, **ROM 15:23–15:29**

Jesus Christ confirms that Paul will preach the gospel in Rome

ACT 23:11

Paul is sent for trial in Rome

ACT 25:10–25:12 See also **ACT 27:1–27:2**

Paul arrives in Rome

ACT 28:14–28:16

Paul preaches in Rome

ACT 28:30–28:31 See also **ACT 28:23–28:24**; **PHP 1:12–1:13**

The church in Rome existed long before Paul's arrival

ROM 15:23–15:24 See also **ACT 28:15**; **ROM 1:8**, **ROM 16:3–16:16** Although Paul had never been to Rome, he seemed to be personally acquainted with 26 people associated with the church there, so its overall size was probably quite considerable.

Paul's letter to the church in Rome presents the whole gospel

ROM 1:16–1:17 The gospel is God's offer of salvation to all.

Sin and the universal need for salvation

ROM 3:23 See also **ROM 3:10**, **ROM 6:23**

God's "rescue" through Jesus Christ available to all

ROM 3:22 See also **ROM 1:16**

Peace with God through believing in Jesus Christ

ROM 5:1–5:2 See also **ROM 4:23–4:25**, **ROM 5:8–5:10**

Gentiles obtain salvation

ROM 10:11–10:13

Rome is pictured as the embodiment of corrupt earthly power

REV 17:1–17:18 Verse 9 clearly identifies the city as Rome, widely known then as the city built on seven hills. See also **REV 14:8** Babylon was the great godless city of the OT and here is taken by most commentators to depict Rome, which in turn represents corrupt worldly power in general. However, some believe that only a general reference to the world system is in mind, and others that a literal reference to the actual city of Babylon is intended; **REV 16:19**, **REV 18:1–18:24**

4266: sea

The sea created and controlled by God

GEN 1:9–1:10; JER 5:22 See also PSA 95:5, PSA 107:29, PSA 146:6; ISA 50:2; AMO 5:8, AMO 9:6; ACT 4:24, ACT 14:15

Creatures of the sea

PSA 104:25 See also GEN 1:21; PSA 8:8; EZK 38:20; HOS 4:3; HAB 1:14

Sea monsters sometimes represented spiritual forces

PSA 74:13 See also JOB 26:12; ISA 27:1; REV 13:1

The sea represented hidden depths

AMO 9:3 See also 2SA 22:16; JOB 38:16; MIC 7:19; MAT 18:6

Named seas

The Red, or Reed, Sea

EXO 10:19 See also HEB 11:29

The Dead, or Salt, Sea

GEN 14:3 See also 2KI 14:25

The Sea of Galilee

NUM 34:11; JHN 6:1

The Great, or Mediterranean, Sea

NUM 34:6–34:7 See also EZK 47:10

The Adriatic Sea

ACT 27:27 In NT times referring to an area extending south of the present Adriatic Sea.

The Sea before the temple

See also 1KI 7:23–7:26, 1KI 7:39; 2KI 16:17, 2KI 25:13

The sea before the throne

REV 4:6, REV 15:2

Metaphorical references to the sea

ISA 17:12; JAS 1:6 See also JOB 7:12, JOB 11:9, JOB 14:11–14:12; PSA 93:4; ISA 5:30, ISA 11:9, ISA 48:18, ISA 57:20; JER 6:23, JER 49:23, JER 50:42, JER 51:42; LAM 2:13; EZK 26:3; ZEC 10:11; JUD 1:13

No more sea

REV 21:1

4269: Sinai, Mount

The mountain in the Sinai peninsula (probably present-day Jebel Musa), also called Horeb in the OT, where God made a covenant with Israel, establishing them as his people and giving them his laws. In the NT Sinai is seen as symbolising the old covenant.

Mount Sinai and the call of Moses

EXO 3:1–3:10 Most scholars agree that the names Horeb and Sinai are used interchangeably of the same mountain, although some see them as referring to separate peaks within the same range. See also ACT 7:30–7:34

God reveals himself to Israel at Mount Sinai

The people of Israel arrive at Mount Sinai three months after leaving Egypt

EXO 19:1–19:2

God promises to make Israel his people

EXO 19:3–19:6

God calls for holiness among his people

See also EXO 19:10–19:15, EXO 19:20–19:24

God appears in a theophany

EXO 19:16–19:19 See also DEU 4:10–4:12; HEB 12:18–12:21

God gives his laws to Israel on Mount Sinai

God gives Israel the Ten Commandments

EXO 20:1–20:17 parallel DEU 5:6–5:21

Israel responds with fear to God's revelation

See also EXO 20:18–20:21; DEU 5:23–5:27, DEU 18:16

God gives Israel the Book of the Covenant

EXO 20:22–23:19 These laws, largely an expansion and exposition of the Ten Commandments, are called “the Book of the Covenant” in Ex 24:7.

God establishes the covenant with Israel on Mount Sinai

Moses performs the ceremony establishing the covenant

EXO 24:4–24:8

Moses and other leaders ascend Mount Sinai to seal the covenant with a meal before God

EXO 24:9–24:11

Moses ascends Mount Sinai further to receive the stone tablets and the requirements of covenant worship

EXO 24:12–24:18 During Moses' 40 days on Mount Sinai, God revealed to him the requirements of covenant worship, as outlined in Ex 25:1–31:18. See also LEV 7:37–7:38, LEV 26:46

Moses descends Mount Sinai and discovers Israel's idolatry

EXO 32:19 See also EXO 32:1–32:6, EXO 32:21–32:35; DEU 9:8–9:21; PSA 106:19–106:23

God commands Israel to move on from Mount Sinai

EXO 33:1–33:6, EXO 33:15–33:16

God calls Moses up Mount Sinai again

Moses is commanded to prepare new stone tablets
EXO 34:1–34:4

God reveals his nature and name to Moses
EXO 34:5–34:7

God renews his covenant with Israel
See also EXO 34:10–34:28

Moses descends Mount Sinai, his face radiant
EXO 34:29–34:35

The people of Israel prepare to move on from Mount Sinai

God commands Moses to take a census of Israel in the Desert of Sinai
NUM 1:1–1:4, NUM 3:14–3:16

The Israelites celebrate the Passover at Mount Sinai
NUM 9:1–9:5

The Israelites leave Mount Sinai
NUM 10:11–10:13 The Israelites had been at Mount Sinai for almost a year (see also Ex 19:1); ; DEU 1:6–1:8

Later generations look back to God's revelation on Mount Sinai

JDG 5:5 Ascribing the title “the One of Sinai” to God, Deborah acknowledges the great importance of his revelation at Mount Sinai. See also 1KI 19:8–19:9 Elijah's return to Horeb, the mountain of God, shows his need to hear God clearly again; NEH 9:13–9:14; PSA 68:7–68:8, PSA 106:19–106:23; MAL 4:4; ACT 7:37–7:38

Mount Sinai seen by NT writers as a symbol of the old covenant

GAL 4:24–4:31 Hagar, Mount Sinai and the present city of Jerusalem stand for the old covenant and bondage to the law, while Sarah and the new heavenly Jerusalem stand for the new covenant and living by faith; ; HEB 12:18–12:29

4272: sky

The sky demonstrating God's creative power and providence

PSA 19:1; JER 14:22 See also GEN 1:8–1:9; JOB 26:7, JOB 37:15–37:18; PSA 36:5, PSA 68:34, PSA 71:19, PSA 77:16–77:18, PSA 78:23, PSA 147:8; ISA 50:3; HOS 2:21–2:22

The sky associated with heavenly bodies

GEN 1:14–1:15; DEU 4:19 See also GEN 22:17 a promise repeated many times in the OT; JOB 37:21; PSA 89:37

The sky associated with birds

GEN 1:20; ; PRO 30:19; ; JER 4:25, JER 8:7; ; LAM 4:19

The sky associated with rain and hail

GEN 8:2 See also EXO 9:22–9:23; JOS 10:11; 2SA 22:12; 1KI 18:45; PSA 147:8; LUK 4:25; REV 11:6, REV 16:21

The sky associated with unusual phenomena

ISA 34:4; MAT 24:29–24:30 See also EXO 20:21–20:22; JOS 10:13; JER 10:2; JOL 2:10, JOL 3:16; MRK 13:25; REV 6:13–6:14, REV 8:10, REV 9:1–9:2, REV 12:4, REV 20:11

The sky used figuratively

MAT 16:2–16:3 See also EXO 24:10; DEU 1:28; PRO 23:5; JER 51:53; MAT 11:23; LUK 17:24

4275: Sodom and Gomorrah

Two neighbouring cities, probably located at the eastern or south-eastern end of the Dead Sea, noted for their sinfulness. God's response in wrath and judgment serves as a warning to subsequent generations.

Sodom and Gomorrah's location

GEN 10:19, GEN 13:10–13:12

Sodom became Lot's home

GEN 13:10–13:12

Sodom and Gomorrah at war

Sodom and Gomorrah, with other cities of the plain, defeated by the alliance of four kings
GEN 14:1–14:12

Abram rescues Lot and is honoured by the king of Sodom and his allies
GEN 14:13–14:24

The wickedness of Sodom and Gomorrah

GEN 13:13 See also GEN 18:20–18:21, GEN 19:1–19:9

Abraham pleads for the righteous in Sodom and Gomorrah

GEN 18:16–18:32

God's judgment against Sodom and Gomorrah

GEN 19:13 See also GEN 19:23–19:29; DEU 29:23; LUK 17:29

The story of Sodom and Gomorrah becomes a picture of human sinfulness and divine judgment

JUD 1:7 See also ISA 3:9, ISA 13:19; JER 23:14; LAM 4:6; EZK 16:44–16:58; AMO 4:11; MAT 10:15 parallel LUK 10:12; MAT 11:23–11:24; LUK 17:28–17:30; 2PE 2:6–2:9

4278: spring of water

Springs of water were important to the life of Israel, providing fresh water for the people. Both God and the gospel are often compared to springs of living water, on account of their life-bringing and refreshing qualities.

The symbolic importance of springs of water to Israel

Living water as a sign of hope and prosperity

ZEC 14:8 See also ISA 12:3, ISA 49:10; JER 31:9

Living water as a source of fertility

JER 17:8 See also PSA 1:3

Living water as a sign of God's presence and power

EXO 17:1–17:7; ; NUM 20:1–20:11

God as a spring of water

JER 2:13 See also JER 17:13

The gospel as a spring of water

JHN 4:13–4:14 See also PSA 42:2; ISA 55:1; JHN 7:37; REV 21:6, REV 22:17

Other biblical uses of the image of a spring

PRO 25:26 spoiling what is good; ; JAS 3:9–3:11 the tongue compared to a spring; ; 2PE 2:17 a dry spring as a symbol of sterility

4281: stars

Heavenly luminaries other than the sun and moon, often worshipped as gods by pagan nations. Scripture stresses that the stars were created by God, and are subject to him. Stars are often treated as symbols of the generosity of God, and his faithfulness to his promises.

The relationship between God and the stars

God is the creator

PSA 33:6 See also GEN 1:16; NEH 9:6; PSA 136:7–136:9, PSA 148:3–148:6

The stars demonstrate the power of their maker

ISA 40:26 See also JOB 9:7–9:9, JOB 38:31–38:33; PSA 147:4–147:5; ISA 45:11–45:12; AMO 5:8

Worship of the stars

Prohibited by God

DEU 4:19 See also DEU 17:3; 2KI 23:4–23:5

God's judgment of star worshippers

JER 8:2 See also JER 19:12–19:13; AMO 5:25–5:27; ZEP 1:4–1:5; ACT 7:42–7:43

Examples of star worship

2KI 17:16, 2KI 21:3–21:5; ; 2CH 33:5; ; ACT 28:11

Reading the stars

ISA 47:13 See also DAN 2:2–2:5, DAN 4:7

Signs in the stars

ISA 34:4 See also EZK 32:7–32:8; REV 6:13

The star of Bethlehem

MAT 2:9–2:10 See also MAT 2:2, MAT 2:7

The stars illustrating God's promise to Abraham

GEN 15:5 See also GEN 22:17; DEU 10:22; 1CH 27:23; NEH 9:23; JER 33:22; HEB 11:12

Metaphorical references to the stars

A coming ruler

NUM 24:17

The morning star

REV 22:16 See also ISA 14:12–14:13; 2PE 1:19; REV 2:28

Wandering stars

JUD 1:13

Stars representing angels

REV 1:16, REV 1:20

God's people shining like stars

PHP 2:15 See also DAN 12:3

4284: sun

Created as a source of light and heat and an indicator of time and direction. The sun is also used as a metaphor for the splendour and light of God himself and the righteousness of his people.

Natural functions of the sun

A source of light

GEN 1:16–1:18 See also PSA 136:7–136:8

A marker of time

GEN 1:14 See also GEN 29:7; EXO 22:26; JDG 9:33; 1SA 11:9

An indicator of direction

NUM 21:11 See also EXO 27:13; DEU 11:30; JOS 19:12; PSA 113:3; ISA 45:6

A blessing, necessary for life**ECC 11:7** See also DEU 33:13–33:14; JOB 8:16; MAT 5:45**The scorching heat causing discomfort and harm****JON 4:8** See also PSA 121:6; ISA 49:10; MAT 13:6; JAS 1:11; REV 7:16**Worship of the sun****Forbidden to God's people****DEU 4:19** See also DEU 17:2–17:5; JOB 31:26–31:28**Practised in Israel and Egypt****EZK 8:16** See also 2KI 23:5, 2KI 23:11; JER 8:1–8:2, JER 43:13**Sunlight and God's judgment****JOL 2:31; MAT 24:29–24:30** parallels MRK 13:24, LUK 21:25–21:26 See also EXO 10:21–10:23; ISA 13:9–13:10; JER 4:28; EZK 32:7–32:8; JOL 3:14–3:15; AMO 5:20; MAT 27:45 parallels MRK 15:33, LUK 23:44 the crucifixion; ACT 2:20; REV 6:12–6:17**God and the sun****God as creator and controller****JOB 9:7; PSA 74:16** See also JOS 10:12–10:13; 2KI 20:8–20:11; PSA 19:1–19:6, PSA 148:3, PSA 148:5; ISA 38:8; JER 31:35–31:36; HAB 3:11**God likened to the sun****LUK 1:78–1:79** See also PSA 84:11; ISA 9:2; HAB 3:4; MAL 4:2; MAT 17:2; 2CO 4:6; REV 1:16**God's glory outshines the sun****REV 21:23** See also ISA 24:23, ISA 60:19–60:20; ACT 26:13; REV 22:5**Metaphorical allusions to the sun****In Paul's conversion experience****ACT 26:13****As righteousness****PSA 37:6; MAT 13:43** See also 2SA 23:3–23:4; PRO 4:18; ISA 58:8, ISA 58:10, ISA 62:1; DAN 12:3**As constancy and dependability****HOS 6:3** See also PSA 72:5, PSA 72:17, PSA 89:36**The setting sun signifying a premature end**

JER 15:9; ; AMO 8:9; ; MIC 3:6

Miracles and signs concerning the sun

Darkening of the sun: ISA 5:30, ISA 24:23; ; AMO 8:9; JOS 10:12–10:13; ; 2KI 20:11; ; ISA 38:8; ; HAB 3:11

4287: universe

All existing things, including the earth and its creatures and all the heavenly bodies. The universe was made by God and is sustained by Jesus Christ.

God as the Maker of all things**PSA 115:15; JER 10:16; REV 4:11** See also GEN 14:19; 2KI 19:15; ECC 11:5; ISA 37:16, ISA 44:24; ACT 14:15; ROM 11:33–11:36; 1CO 8:6; EPH 3:9; HEB 11:3**God as the ruler of the universe****1CH 29:12; ACT 17:24** See also PSA 119:91; JER 33:25; MAT 11:25**Jesus Christ, the one through whom the universe was made, now sustains all things****JHN 1:3; COL 1:15–1:17** The title “firstborn” implies that Jesus Christ is the heir, that everything belongs to him; **HEB 1:2–1:3** See also JHN 13:3; 1CO 8:6; EPH 1:22, EPH 4:10**The universe is temporary****MAT 24:35; 2PE 3:10–3:12** See also MAT 5:18, MAT 24:29; LUK 21:26**Future renewal of the universe****EPH 1:10; 2PE 3:13** See also ISA 65:17, ISA 66:22; MAT 19:28; ROM 8:19–8:22; EPH 1:10**Other references to the universe**

DEU 4:25–4:26, DEU 30:19; ; PHP 2:15

4290: valleys**Valleys used as places of permanent settlement****GEN 26:17** See also NUM 14:25; JOS 17:16; JDG 18:28; 1CH 12:14–12:15**Valleys as places for camp-sites****JDG 6:33** See also NUM 21:10–21:12; DEU 3:29; JDG 7:8–7:12; 1CH 11:15**Valleys used for pasture and crops****1CH 4:39–4:40** Palestine was noted as a dry land, but valleys provided the necessary moisture for pastures and crop growth. See also 1CH 27:29; PSA 65:13**Valleys used for battles****GEN 14:8** See also JOS 11:7–11:8; 1SA 17:1–17:3; 2SA 8:13; 2CH 25:11–25:12 parallel 2KI 14:7**Valleys as places of worship and sacrifice****2CH 28:3** See also DEU 21:1–21:9; 2CH 20:25–20:26; JER 2:23–2:25, JER 32:35

Valleys on the day of the LORD

ISA 22:5; ; MIC 1:3–1:4; ; ZEC 14:3–14:5

The metaphorical use of valleys

The valley of death

PSA 23:4 See also JOB 21:32–21:33

The valley of decision

JOL 3:14 See also JOL 3:1–3:2, JOL 3:12

The valley of dry bones

EZK 37:1–37:14

The levelling of valleys as a preparation for the coming of the Lord

LUK 3:4–3:5 See also ISA 40:3–40:4

The Valley of Hinnom

The Valley of Hinnom as part of the boundary between Judah and Benjamin, lying to the south of Jerusalem

JOS 15:8, JOS 18:16

The Valley of Hinnom as a place of child sacrifice

2CH 28:3 See also JER 32:35

The Valley of Hinnom as a place of God's judgment

JER 7:30–7:32 See also JER 19:1–19:15

The Kidron Valley

The Kidron Valley as a boundary of Jerusalem

1KI 2:36–2:37 See also 2SA 15:23; JER 31:38–31:40; JHN 18:1

The Kidron Valley as a place for the destruction of pagan cult objects

1KI 15:11–15:13; 2KI 23:4–23:6 parallel 2CH 34:3–34:4
See also 2KI 23:12

The Kidron Valley in prophetic visions

EZK 47:1–47:8; JOL 3:1–3:2 See also ZEC 14:8

4293: water

The colourless, odourless liquid that is essential for sustenance of life in human beings and animals. God is described as the spring of living water, being the source of life and salvation to those who come to him.

Water for drinking

For human beings

2SA 23:15–23:16 parallel 1CH 11:17–11:18 See also GEN 21:14–21:19 God provides water for Hagar and Ishmael; EXO 15:22–15:27, EXO 17:1–17:3; NUM 20:1–20:11; DEU 2:28; JDG 4:19, JDG 5:25; 1SA 30:11–30:12; 1KI 17:10 Elijah asks the widow at Zarephath for a drink of water; 2KI 6:22; 2CH 18:25–18:26; NEH 9:20; JOB 6:19; ISA 33:16; DAN 1:8–

1:16 Daniel's resolve to live on vegetables and water; HOS 2:5; MAT 10:42 parallel MRK 9:41; JHN 4:7; 1TI 5:23

For animals

2KI 3:9 See also GEN 24:13–24:19, GEN 29:1–29:10; EXO 2:15–2:16, EXO 17:3; 2KI 3:17; PSA 104:10–104:11; ISA 43:20; LUK 13:15

Water as a general descriptive term for liquid

EXO 23:25 See also 1SA 25:11; 1KI 13:6–13:22, 1KI 18:4; JOB 22:7; PRO 25:21

Abstinence from water during fasting

DEU 9:9 See also EXO 34:28; DEU 9:18; EZR 10:6

Water for washing

For general hygiene

GEN 18:4 See also GEN 24:32, GEN 43:24; LUK 7:44; JHN 13:1–13:17

For ritual cleansing

LEV 17:15 See also EXO 30:17–30:21; LEV 1:3–1:9, LEV 16:20–16:24; NUM 19:7–19:9; JHN 2:6; HEB 10:22

Water for cooking

EXO 12:9–12:10 See also EZK 24:3–24:5

Rainwater

JDG 5:4 See also GEN 7:11–7:12; JOB 5:10, JOB 37:13, JOB 38:25–38:28, JOB 38:37; PSA 77:17; ECC 11:3; HOS 6:3

Sources and stores of water

Wells

GEN 26:19–26:20 See also GEN 21:19, GEN 24:11; ISA 37:25; JHN 4:6

Springs

JAS 3:11–3:12 See also JOS 15:15–15:19 parallel JDG 1:11–1:15; REV 8:10–8:11, REV 14:7, REV 16:4

Cisterns

JER 2:13 See also LEV 11:36; 2KI 18:31 parallel ISA 36:16; PRO 5:15–5:16; JER 14:3, JER 38:6

Abundance of water as a sign of blessing

DEU 8:7 See also NUM 24:7; DEU 10:7; PSA 1:1–1:3; JER 17:7–17:8; EZK 17:5–17:6, EZK 19:10–19:11

Baptism in water

MAT 3:11 parallels MRK 1:8, LUK 3:16 See also MAT 3:13–3:17 parallels MRK 1:9–1:11, LUK 3:21–3:22, JHN 1:31–1:34; JHN 1:26–1:27, JHN 3:23; ACT 1:5, ACT 8:36–8:39, ACT 10:47, ACT 11:16; 1PE 3:20–3:22

Living water

JER 17:13 See also ZEC 14:8–14:9; JHN 4:4–4:26, JHN 7:37–7:39; REV 7:13–7:17, REV 21:6–21:8, REV 22:1–22:2, REV 22:17

Metaphorical references to water

As a symbol of affliction

2SA 22:17; ; PSA 69:1; ; ISA 30:20, ISA 43:2

As a symbol of salvation

ISA 12:3, ISA 49:10, ISA 55:1; ; EZK 36:25; ; JHN 7:38

As a symbol of life

JHN 4:14, JHN 7:37–7:39; ; REV 21:6, REV 22:17

Other metaphorical references

SNG 4:15; ; ISA 30:20, ISA 35:6, ISA 44:12; ; JER 9:1; ; EPH 5:25–5:26; ; 2PE 2:17

4296: wells

Artificial openings to tap underground water supplies. They were very important for life in a settled urban society and this is reflected in their symbolical use in Scripture.

The importance of wells in urban life

NEH 9:25 See also DEU 6:10–6:11

Women drew water for domestic use

GEN 24:11–24:20 See also 1SA 9:11; JHN 4:7–4:9

Livestock were watered at wells

GEN 29:2–29:3 See also GEN 29:7–29:10; EXO 2:15–2:17

Wells were sometimes a source of contention

GEN 21:25 See also GEN 26:12–26:22; NUM 20:17, NUM 21:22

Wells as landmarks

GEN 16:7 Verse 14 refers to this spring as a well. See also GEN 16:14, GEN 21:31 “Beersheba” means either “well of seven” or “well of the oath”; GEN 26:20–26:22; JHN 4:6

Figurative use of wells

Associated with God and his goodness

ISA 12:3; JER 17:13 See also JER 2:13; JHN 4:14; REV 7:17

Associated with human love

PRO 5:15

In warnings against and judgment of sin

JER 6:7 See also PRO 23:27; JER 51:36

4299: wilderness

Wilderness as a wild, uncultivated area of land, frequently interchangeable with “desert”

JER 2:6 See also JER 50:12

Good news for the wilderness

ISA 35:1–35:10 See also ISA 40:3–40:5; MAT 3:3 parallels MRK 1:3, LUK 3:4

4300: Metals and minerals

- 4303: metals
- 4306: minerals
- 4309: bitumen and tar
- 4312: bronze
- 4315: clay
- 4318: coal
- 4321: copper
- 4324: dross
- 4327: flint
- 4330: glass
- 4333: gold
- 4336: iron
- 4339: ivory
- 4342: jewels
- 4345: metalworkers
- 4348: mining
- 4351: refining
- 4354: rock
- 4357: salt
- 4360: sand
- 4363: silver
- 4366: stones
- 4369: sulphur
- 4372: tin

4303: metals

Gold, silver, bronze, iron, copper, tin and lead are all mentioned in Scripture. Prized for their value, they were used in a variety of ways. Scripture uses as an image a metal refiner’s fire for the purification of the lives of believers.

Gold

JOB 23:10 See also EXO 25:10–25:22, EXO 38:21–38:24; 1KI 6:27–6:35, 1KI 7:48–7:50, 1KI 10:14–10:21; PSA 19:7–19:11; REV 3:18, REV 17:4

Silver

PSA 12:6 See also GEN 37:26–37:28; EXO 38:25–38:28; 2CH 9:26–9:27; PSA 119:72; MAT 27:3–27:10

Bronze

GEN 4:22 See also EXO 27:1–27:7, EXO 38:29–38:31; NUM 16:31–16:40; 2CH 4:9–4:18

Iron

DEU 3:11 See also DEU 8:7–8:9; JDG 4:2–4:3; JOB 40:15–40:18; EZK 27:19

Copper

JOB 28:2 See also MRK 12:41–12:44 parallel LUK 21:1–21:4

Tin

EZK 27:12 See also EZK 22:18

Lead

It was an exceptionally heavy metal

EXO 15:10 See also ZEC 5:5–5:8

It was refined before use

JER 6:29 See also NUM 31:21–31:23; EZK 22:18–22:20

Inscriptions were sometimes made on lead

JOB 19:23–19:24

It was traded between nations

EZK 27:12

The value of metals

All metals were of value

JOS 22:8 See also 1CH 18:10, 1CH 22:14, 1CH 29:1–29:7; REV 18:11–18:12

The relative value of metals

ISA 60:17 See also 1KI 10:21 parallel 2CH 9:20; 1KI 14:25–14:28

Trade with metals

1KI 10:22 parallel 2CH 9:21 See also GEN 37:28; 1KI 10:11, 1KI 10:14–10:15 parallel 2CH 9:13–9:14; 1KI 22:48; EZK 27:13, EZK 27:22; ZEP 1:11

Idols were often made from various metals

LEV 19:4 See also 1KI 14:9; PSA 106:19; ISA 48:5; DAN 5:22–5:23, DAN 11:8

The refining of metals as an image of purification

ISA 48:10; MAL 3:2 See also PSA 12:6; ZEC 13:9

4306: minerals

Material mined from the earth, especially metal ores and other substances of neither animal nor vegetable origin.

Bitumen

GEN 11:1–11:4

Chalk

ISA 27:9

Crystal

See also JOB 28:17; REV 4:6

Flint

EZK 3:9 See also JOB 28:9; ZEC 7:12

Lime

AMO 2:1 See also ISA 33:10–33:12

Marble

EST 1:6 See also 1CH 29:2; SNG 5:15; REV 18:11–18:12

Pitch

GEN 6:14 See also EXO 2:3; ISA 34:9

Salt

LEV 2:13 See also DEU 29:23; JOB 39:5–39:6; EZK 47:6–47:11

Soda

PRO 25:20 “soda” in this instance is probably sodium carbonate, which would react violently with vinegar. See also JOB 9:30–9:31; JER 2:22

Sulphur

GEN 19:24 See also DEU 29:23; LUK 17:29; REV 19:20

Tar

GEN 14:10 See also EXO 2:3

Precious stones

EZK 28:13 See also EXO 28:15–28:21; JOB 28:5–28:6; ISA 54:11–54:12; EZK 27:16; REV 21:18

Metals

ISA 60:17 See also NUM 31:21–31:23; DEU 8:7–8:9; JOB 28:2; PSA 119:72; EZK 27:12

Stone

PRO 27:3 See also JOS 7:3–7:5; JOB 6:12, JOB 38:29–38:30; JER 5:3

Sand

MAT 7:24–7:27

4309: bitumen and tar**Tar**

GEN 14:10 See also EXO 2:1–2:3 the infant Moses placed in a basket coated with tar

Bitumen

GEN 11:1–11:4

4312: bronze

A metal highly prized for its strength and durability. It had a variety of uses in biblical times and was employed extensively in both the tabernacle and temple.

Bronze as a material used by craftsmen

GEN 4:22 See also EXO 31:1–31:6 parallel EXO 35:30–35:34; 1KI 7:13–7:14; 1CH 22:15–22:16; 2CH 2:7, 2CH 2:13–2:14, 2CH 24:12

Characteristics of bronze

It was renowned for its strength

JER 15:12 See also LEV 26:18–26:19; DEU 28:23; JOB 6:12, JOB 37:18, JOB 40:18, JOB 41:27; ISA 48:4; JER 1:18, JER 15:20; DAN 7:19; MIC 4:13

It was noted for its brilliance

DAN 10:5–10:6 See also EZK 40:3; REV 1:15, REV 2:18

The monetary value of bronze

It was an expensive metal

REV 18:11–18:12 See also 1CH 18:8–18:10; EZR 8:26–8:27; EZK 27:13

It was less valuable than gold or silver

ISA 60:17 See also 1KI 14:25–14:28 parallel 2CH 12:9–12:11

Offerings of bronze were made at various times

EXO 35:24 See also EXO 25:1–25:7 parallel EXO 35:4–35:9; EXO 38:29–38:31; 1CH 18:9–18:11, 1CH 22:14, 1CH 29:6–29:7

Bronze was used in the tabernacle

For the altar and its utensils

2CH 1:5–1:6 See also EXO 27:1–27:6 parallel EXO 38:1–38:6; EXO 35:16 parallel EXO 39:39; NUM 4:13, NUM 16:39–16:40

For the laver

EXO 30:18 See also EXO 35:16, EXO 38:8

For the tent and the framework of the tabernacle

EXO 27:17–27:19 parallel EXO 38:17–38:20 See also EXO 26:10–26:11, EXO 26:36–26:37, EXO 27:9–27:11 parallel EXO 38:9–38:11; EXO 36:18, EXO 36:37–36:38

Bronze was used extensively in the temple

2CH 4:18 See also 1KI 7:23–7:33, 1KI 7:38–7:45 parallel 2CH 4:9–4:16; 1KI 8:64; 2KI 16:17, 2KI 25:13–25:17 parallel JER 52:17–52:23; 1CH 18:8, 1CH 29:2; 2CH 4:1

Other uses of bronze

For armour

ISA 17:5–17:6 See also 1SA 17:38

For weapons

2SA 21:16 See also 1SA 17:6; 2SA 22:35 parallel PSA 18:34

For shackles

JDG 16:21 See also 2KI 25:7 parallels JER 39:7, JER 52:11; 2CH 33:11, 2CH 36:6; DAN 4:15, DAN 4:23

For gates

PSA 107:16 See also DEU 33:25; 1KI 4:13; 1CH 22:3; ISA 45:2

For the bronze snake

NUM 21:9 See also 2KI 18:4

For idols

DAN 5:4 See also DAN 5:23; REV 9:20

For mirrors

EXO 38:8 See also JOB 37:18

For cooking utensils

LEV 6:28

For tools

GEN 4:22

For musical instruments

1CH 15:19

For statues

See also DAN 2:32, DAN 2:35, DAN 2:45

Bronze as booty in war

JOS 22:7–22:8 See also NUM 31:21–31:23; JOS 6:24; 2SA 8:8 parallel 1CH 18:8

The metaphorical use of bronze

DAN 2:39 See also LEV 26:19; DEU 28:23; JOB 40:18; JER 1:18, JER 1:18; ZEC 6:1

4315: clay

Clay was a basic building material in biblical times and clay pottery was widely used.

Clay pottery

Moulded by potters

JER 18:3–18:4 See also ISA 29:16, ISA 41:25, ISA 45:9

Used to make pots

LEV 6:28 See also LEV 11:33, LEV 14:5, LEV 14:50, LEV 15:12; LAM 4:2

Used to make jars

JER 19:1–19:3 See also NUM 5:17; JER 32:14; 2CO 4:7

Other uses of clay

To make idols

DAN 2:31–2:35 See also DAN 2:41–2:45

To make moulds**1KI 7:46** parallel 2CH 4:17**To make bricks****NAM 3:14** See also JER 43:9**In plastering****LEV 14:42****To make furnaces****PSA 12:6****To seal documents****JOB 38:14****Clay tablets were used for writing on****EZK 4:1****Clay was a relatively weak material****JOB 13:12** See also JOB 4:18–4:19**Clay was a very common material****JOB 27:16** See also 2TI 2:20**God and his people compared to a potter and the clay****ISA 64:8** See also JOB 10:9, JOB 33:6; JER 18:6; ROM 9:19–9:21**4318: coal**

Carbonised vegetable material of wood, woody matter or charcoal, used for burning.

Coal used to burn incense**LEV 16:12–16:13** See also NUM 16:16–16:18, NUM 16:35–16:38**Coal burned in the Most Holy Place****ISA 6:4–6:7****Coal used for baking and cooking****1KI 19:6** See also ISA 44:19; EZK 24:9–24:11; JHN 21:9**Coal used for domestic fires****ISA 47:14** See also ISA 30:12–30:14**Coal used by blacksmiths****ISA 44:12** See also ISA 54:16**Burning coal associated with divine punishment****PSA 11:6** See also PSA 120:3–120:4, PSA 140:9–140:10**Burning coal in descriptions of God****In poetic passages****2SA 22:8–22:9** parallel PSA 18:7–18:8**In visions****EZK 1:4–1:14** See also EZK 10:1–10:2**Metaphorical use of coal****2SA 14:7** See also PRO 6:27–6:29, PRO 25:21–25:22; ROM 12:17–12:21**4321: copper****The mining of copper****DEU 8:7–8:9** See also JOB 28:2–28:10**The smelting of copper****EZK 22:20–22:21** See also EZK 22:18, EZK 24:11**Coins made of copper****MAT 10:9** See also MRK 12:41–12:42 parallel LUK 21:1–21:2 Coins of various denominations were made of copper in late OT and in NT times.**4324: dross**

Impurities removed from molten metal during refining. In a spiritual sense, wicked people whom God removes in judgment, and also impurities in believers which are removed by discipline and trials.

God removes the wicked like dross**PSA 119:119** See also ISA 30:28; JER 6:28–6:30; EZK 22:19–22:22**Dross as a metaphor for impurity in God's people****EZK 22:18** See also ISA 1:21–1:23; EZK 24:11–24:13, EZK 36:25; AMO 9:8–9:10; JAS 1:21**God purges the dross from his people****ISA 1:25–1:26** See also PRO 17:3, PRO 25:4; DAN 12:10; MAL 3:2–3:3; 2CO 7:1; 1PE 1:7**By the blood of Jesus Christ**

ZEC 13:1; ; HEB 9:14; ; 1JN 1:7

By the work of the Holy Spirit

EZK 36:25–36:27; ; MAT 3:11–3:12 parallel LUK 3:16–3:17

By testing and affliction

PSA 66:10–66:12; ; ISA 48:10; ; JER 9:7; ; ZEC 13:9

4327: flint**Flint tools****JOS 5:2–5:3** See also EXO 4:25; JER 17:1**Flinty rock****JOB 28:9** See also DEU 32:13–32:14**Metaphorical use of flint****EZK 3:9** See also ISA 5:28, ISA 50:7; ZEC 7:12

4330: glass

A substance remarkable for its transparency. Two phenomena seen by John in his vision in the book of Revelation are likened to glass.

The sea of glass

REV 15:2 See also REV 4:2–4:6

The gold in the new Jerusalem likened to glass

REV 21:21 See also REV 21:15–21:18

4333: gold

The most valuable of all metals, gold was indicative of wealth and prosperity in biblical times. It had a wide variety of uses and was employed extensively in both the tabernacle and the temple.

Gold was of great value

ISA 60:17 See also JOS 6:18–6:19, JOS 6:24; 1KI 20:1–20:6; 2KI 7:8, 2KI 14:14; 2CH 21:3; JOB 28:12–28:19 Wisdom cannot be bought with gold; PSA 45:9, PSA 45:13, PSA 72:15, PSA 105:37; PRO 20:15; EZK 28:13; DAN 11:8, DAN 11:38; JOL 3:4–3:5; 2TI 2:20; REV 21:18, REV 21:21 The streets of the new Jerusalem are to be paved with gold.

Gold was indicative of wealth

GEN 13:2 See also GEN 24:35; DEU 8:12–8:14, DEU 17:17; JOS 22:8 Joshua sends the eastern tribes home; 2KI 20:13 parallel ISA 39:2; 2CH 1:15, 2CH 32:27; JOB 3:15, JOB 31:24–31:28; ECC 2:8; ISA 2:7; EZK 16:13 the adornments of unfaithful Jerusalem; EZK 28:4; ZEP 1:18; ZEC 9:3, ZEC 14:14; JAS 2:2; REV 18:16

Gold was relatively rare

ISA 13:12

Gold was mined from the earth

JOB 28:5–28:6 See also GEN 2:11–2:12

Gold was refined by fire

REV 3:18 See also NUM 31:21–31:23; JOB 28:1; PRO 17:3, PRO 27:21; ZEC 13:9; MAL 3:3; 1PE 1:7

Gold was obtained through trade

1KI 10:22 parallel 2CH 9:21 See also 1KI 9:26–9:28 parallel 2CH 8:17–8:18; 1KI 10:11 parallel 2CH 9:9; 1KI 22:48; ISA 60:6; JER 10:9; EZK 27:22; REV 18:11–18:13

Gold was worked by goldsmiths

ISA 46:6 See also 1CH 29:4–29:5; 2CH 2:7, 2CH 2:13–2:14; JER 10:9

Gold was presented as offerings to God

EXO 35:22 See also EXO 25:1–25:7, EXO 35:5; NUM 7:84–7:86, NUM 31:50–31:54; 2SA 8:11; EZR 1:1–1:11, EZR 2:69, EZR 7:12–7:18, EZR 8:24–8:34; NEH 7:70–7:72

Gold was given to rulers as tribute and bribes

1KI 10:14–10:15 parallel 2CH 9:13–9:14 See also 1KI 10:24–10:25 parallel 2CH 9:23–9:24; 2KI 12:18, 2KI 16:7–16:9, 2KI 18:13–18:16, 2KI 23:33–23:35 parallel 2CH 36:3; 2CH 16:2–16:3

Gold was given as gifts

JOB 42:11 See also GEN 24:53; 2SA 8:9–8:10 parallel 1CH 18:9–18:10; 1KI 10:10 parallel 2CH 9:9; 2KI 5:5; MAT 2:11

The use of gold in the tabernacle

EXO 38:21–38:24 See also EXO 25:11–25:13, EXO 25:17–25:18 the atonement cover and cherubim; EXO 25:28–25:29, EXO 25:31, EXO 25:36, EXO 25:38, EXO 26:6, EXO 26:29, EXO 26:32, EXO 26:37, EXO 30:1–30:5 the altar; EXO 39:37–39:38, EXO 40:5; LEV 24:4; NUM 8:4

The use of gold in priestly vestments

EXO 28:4–28:5 See also EXO 28:11–28:15, EXO 28:22–28:27, EXO 28:33–28:38, EXO 39:15–39:20, EXO 39:25–39:26, EXO 39:30–39:31

The use of gold in the temple

1CH 22:14 See also 1KI 6:28, 1KI 6:30, 1KI 6:32, 1KI 6:35, 1KI 7:48–7:51; 2KI 18:16; 1CH 28:14–28:18, 1CH 29:1–29:7; 2CH 3:4–3:10, 2CH 4:7–4:8, 2CH 4:19–4:22

Gold symbols of office

Crown

2SA 12:30 parallel 1CH 20:2 See also EST 8:15; PSA 21:1–21:3; ZEC 6:11; REV 4:4, REV 14:14

Throne

1KI 10:18–10:20 parallel 2CH 9:17–9:19

Sceptre

EST 4:11 See also EST 5:2, EST 8:4

Chain

DAN 5:7 See also GEN 41:42; DAN 5:16, DAN 5:29

Other uses of gold

Jewellery

EXO 35:22 See also GEN 24:53, GEN 24:22; EXO 3:22, EXO 11:2, EXO 12:35, EXO 32:2, EXO 32:24 used to make the golden calf; NUM 31:50; JDG 8:24–8:26 used to make Gideon's ephod; 2SA 1:24; PRO 11:22, PRO 25:11; SNG 1:11; JER 4:30; DAN 10:5; 1PE 3:3

Idols

EXO 20:23 See also EXO 32:31; DEU 7:25; DEU 29:17; PSA 115:4; PSA 135:15; ISA 2:20; ISA 30:22; ISA 31:7; ISA 40:19; ISA 46:6; JER 10:3–10:5; EZK 16:17; DAN 3:1 Nebuchadnezzar's image of gold; DAN 3:4–3:7; DAN 3:14; DAN 5:4; DAN 5:23; HOS 8:4; HAB 2:19; ACT 17:29; REV 9:20

Currency

MAT 10:5–10:10 See also NUM 22:18; NUM 24:13; 2SA 21:4; 1CH 21:25; PSA 119:72; EZK 7:19; DAN 11:43; ACT 3:6; ACT 20:33; 1PE 1:18

Models

1SA 6:4 See also 1SA 6:8; 1SA 6:11; 1SA 6:15; 1SA 6:17–6:18

Shields

1KI 10:16–10:17 parallel 2CH 9:15–9:16 See also 2SA 8:7; 1KI 14:26 parallel 2CH 12:9

Goblets

1KI 10:21 parallel 2CH 9:20 See also EST 1:7; JER 51:7; DAN 5:2–5:3; DAN 5:23; REV 17:4

Couches

EST 1:6

Metaphorical and proverbial use of gold

JOB 22:23–22:25 See also JOB 23:8–23:10; PSA 19:9–19:10; PSA 68:13; PRO 3:13–3:14; PRO 16:16; PRO 22:1; PRO 25:11; SNG 5:10–5:15; LAM 4:1–4:2; DAN 2:37–2:38

4336: iron**Iron ore is mined from the earth**

JOB 28:2 See also DEU 8:7–8:9

Iron ore is refined by smelting in a furnace

Such imagery is often used of God's testing of his people

EZK 22:20 See also NUM 31:21–31:23; JER 6:27–6:29; EZK 22:18

Egypt is described as an iron-smelting furnace

DEU 4:20 See also 1KI 8:51; JER 11:4

Iron was a valuable metal

REV 18:11–18:12 See also JOS 22:6–22:8; ISA 60:17; EZK 27:12; EZK 27:19

Iron was prized for its great strength

DAN 2:40–2:43 See also LEV 26:19; DEU 28:23; JOB 40:15–40:18; JOB 41:27; PSA 2:9; REV 2:27; REV 19:15; ISA 48:4; JER 1:18; JER 15:12; DAN 2:31–2:35; DAN 7:7; DAN 7:19; MIC 4:13

Iron objects were taken as booty in war

JOS 6:24 See also JOS 6:15–6:19; JOS 22:8

Iron was used in the construction of the temple

1CH 29:2 See also 1CH 22:14–22:16; 1CH 29:7; 2CH 2:7; 2CH 2:13–2:14; 2CH 24:12

Other uses of iron**For tools**

GEN 4:22 See also DEU 27:5; JOS 8:30–8:31; 2SA 12:31 parallel 1CH 20:3; 2SA 23:7; 1KI 6:7; 2KI 6:5–6:6; JOB 19:23–19:24; JER 17:1; AMO 1:3; 1TI 4:2

For chains, shackles and fetters

PSA 105:18 See also PSA 107:10; PSA 149:6–149:9; DAN 4:15; DAN 4:23; MRK 5:1–5:4

For chariots

JDG 1:19 See also JOS 17:15–17:18; JDG 4:2–4:3; JDG 4:12–4:13

For gates and gate fittings

ACT 12:10 See also DEU 33:25; 1CH 22:3; PSA 107:15–107:16; ISA 45:2

For weapons and armour

1SA 17:7 See also NUM 35:16; JOB 20:24; REV 9:9

For idols

DAN 5:4 See also DAN 5:23

For yokes

DEU 28:48 See also JER 28:13–28:14

For horns

1KI 22:11 parallel 2CH 18:10

For cooking utensils

EZK 4:3

For a bed

DEU 3:11

4339: ivory**Ivory, a semiprecious substance derived from elephant tusks, was procured through trade**

1KI 10:22 parallel 2CH 9:21 See also EZK 27:15; REV 18:11–18:13

Articles inlaid with ivory were a sign of wealth

1KI 10:18 parallel 2CH 9:17 See also 1KI 22:39; PSA 45:8; EZK 27:6; AMO 3:15; AMO 6:4

The metaphorical use of ivory

SNG 5:14 See also SNG 7:4

4342: jewels

Precious stones, prized for their beauty and value are mentioned frequently in Scripture.

The breastpiece of the high priest was set with twelve jewels

EXO 28:15–28:21 parallel EXO 39:8–39:14

The king of Tyre is depicted as having been adorned with jewels

EZK 28:11–28:13

The new Jerusalem is described as being constructed of jewels

REV 21:18–21:21

Jewels in royal crowns

2SA 12:30 parallel 1CH 20:2 See also ZEC 9:16

Jewels acquired through trade

EZK 27:22 See also 1KI 10:2 parallel 2CH 9:1; 1KI 10:10–10:11 parallel 2CH 9:9–9:10; REV 18:11–18:12

Wisdom is said to be more precious than jewels

PRO 8:10–8:11 See also JOB 28:12–28:19; PRO 3:13–3:15, PRO 20:15

Jewels mentioned elsewhere in Scripture

Carnelian

REV 4:3 See also REV 21:20

Chrysolite

EZK 10:9 See also SNG 5:14; EZK 1:16; DAN 10:6

Coral

EZK 27:16

Emeralds

REV 4:3

Jasper

REV 4:3

Onyx

EXO 28:9–28:14 parallel EXO 39:6–39:7 See also GEN 2:10–2:12; EXO 25:1–25:7 parallel EXO 35:4–35:9; EXO 35:27; 1CH 29:2

Pearls

MAT 7:6 See also MAT 13:45–13:46; 1TI 2:9–2:10; REV 17:4, REV 18:11–18:12, REV 18:15–18:17

Rubies

PRO 31:10 See also ISA 54:11–54:12; LAM 4:7; EZK 27:16

Sapphires

ISA 54:11 See also EXO 24:9–24:10; JOB 28:5–28:6; SNG 5:14; LAM 4:7; EZK 1:26, EZK 10:1

Turquoise

EZK 27:16 See also 1CH 29:2; ISA 54:11

4345: metalworkers

The work of goldsmiths

Making idols

ISA 40:19 See also ISA 41:6–41:7, ISA 46:6; JER 10:8–10:10, JER 10:14–10:15, JER 51:17–51:18

Rebuilding the wall of Jerusalem

NEH 3:31–3:32 See also NEH 3:8

The work of silversmiths

Making idols

JDG 17:4 See also ACT 19:23–19:41

Working with refined silver

PRO 25:4

The work of blacksmiths

Making idols

ISA 44:9–44:12

Manufacturing weapons

ISA 54:16–54:17 See also 1SA 13:19

The work of other metalworkers and craftsmen

Making idols

DEU 27:15 See also HOS 8:4–8:6; 2TI 4:14–4:15

The construction of the tabernacle

EXO 31:1–31:6, EXO 35:30–36:2, EXO 39:2–39:3

The construction of the temple

1CH 22:14–22:16, 1CH 29:1–29:5; ; 2CH 2:7, 2CH 2:13–2:14

4348: mining

Metal ores and precious stones mined from the earth

JOB 28:1–28:11 See also DEU 8:7–8:9; 1KI 7:13–7:50

4351: refining

The process of heating metals to high temperatures in order to burn away impurities. It is often used in a metaphorical sense to depict God refining his people to get rid of impurities in their faith.

Precious metals produced by refining

PSA 12:6 See also 1CH 28:14–28:18, 1CH 29:3–29:5; JOB 28:1–28:2; 1PE 1:7; REV 3:18

God refines his people

Refining involves suffering

PSA 66:10–66:12 See also ISA 48:9–48:11; JER 9:7–9:9

Refining for purging and purification

ZEC 13:8–13:9 See also JER 6:27–6:30; DAN 11:35, DAN 12:10; MAL 3:2–3:4

4354: rock

A symbol of strength and permanence and a place where people in danger often took refuge. God is depicted as the Rock of Israel, being the strength, security and deliverance for his people.

Rock as a symbol of strength, stability and permanence

ZEC 12:3 See also JOB 18:4, JOB 19:23–19:24, JOB 41:24; NAM 1:6

Rocks as places of refuge and shelter

ISA 13:6, ISA 23:25 David's hiding-place from Saul; ; JOB 24:8, JOB 30:6; ; PSA 27:5, PSA 40:2; ; SNG 2:14; ; ISA 2:10, ISA 2:19, ISA 2:21, ISA 32:2; ; JER 4:29, JER 16:16, JER 48:28, JER 49:16 parallel OBA 1:3; ; REV 6:15–6:16

God as a rock**Symbolising his strength and faithfulness**

ISA 26:4 See also GEN 49:23–49:25; DEU 32:3–32:4; 1SA 2:2; 2SA 23:2–23:4; PSA 28:1, PSA 42:9, PSA 62:6, PSA 92:14–92:15; ISA 44:8; HAB 1:12

Symbolising safety and refuge in him

PSA 71:3 See also DEU 32:30; 2SA 22:31–22:32 parallel PSA 18:30–18:31; PSA 31:2–31:3, PSA 61:1–61:3, PSA 62:7, PSA 94:22, PSA 144:1–144:2; ISA 17:10

Associated with salvation and deliverance

DEU 32:15–32:18; ; 2SA 22:47 parallel PSA 18:46; ; PSA 19:14, PSA 62:2, PSA 78:35, PSA 89:26, PSA 95:1

Associated with judgment and punishment

ISA 8:13–8:15; ; ROM 9:33; ; 1PE 2:8

Other gods as rocks

DEU 32:31 See also DEU 32:36–32:38

Water from the rock

NUM 20:8 See also EXO 17:6; NUM 20:10–20:13; DEU 8:15; NEH 9:15; PSA 78:15–78:16, PSA 78:20, PSA 105:41; ISA 48:21; 1CO 10:3–10:4

Rocks as foundations

MAT 7:24–7:25 parallel LUK 6:47–6:48 See also MAT 16:13–16:20

Rocks in mining, quarrying and building

DEU 8:9; ; JOB 28:5–28:6, JOB 28:9–28:10; ; ISA 51:1–51:2; ; JER 23:29, JER 51:26; ; DAN 2:34–2:35, DAN 2:45

Rocks used as altars

JDG 6:20–6:21, JDG 13:19–13:20

Rock and burial places**Rocks erected over graves**

JOS 7:26, JOS 8:29; ; 2SA 18:17

Tombs quarried in rock

LUK 23:53 parallels MAT 27:59–27:60, MRK 15:46 See also ISA 22:16

Rocks used to seal caves and tombs

JOS 10:17–10:18, JOS 10:27; ; MAT 27:59–27:60 parallel MRK 15:46; ; MAT 27:66, MAT 28:2; ; MRK 16:2–16:4 parallels LUK 24:2, JHN 20:1

Rocky soil in the parable of the sower

MAT 13:20–13:21 parallels MRK 4:16–4:17, LUK 8:13 See also MAT 13:5 parallels MRK 4:5, LUK 8:6

Rocks in place-names

JDG 7:25, JDG 15:8–15:13, JDG 20:45–20:47, JDG 21:13; ; 2SA 20:8; ; 1CH 11:15

4357: salt

A basic commodity, used for seasoning and preserving food in biblical times.

The importance of salt in the sacrificial system

LEV 2:13 See also EXO 30:34–30:35 The addition of salt to incense was probably to make it burn more easily and quickly; EZR 6:6–6:10, EZR 7:21–7:23; EZK 43:22–43:24

The covenant of salt

NUM 18:17–18:19 See also LEV 2:13; 2CH 13:4–13:5

Believers as the salt of the earth

MAT 5:13 This teaching reflects the importance of salt as a preservative and seasoning. See also MRK 9:50; LUK 14:34–14:35

Salt as a symbol of desolation

ZEP 2:9 See also DEU 29:23–29:25; JOB 39:5–39:6; PSA 107:33–107:34; JER 17:5–17:8

Salt sown on arable land to render it worthless

JER 48:8–48:9 See also JDG 9:42–9:45

Lot's wife turned into a pillar of salt

GEN 19:23–19:26

The Dead Sea an important source of salt

EZK 47:11

Salt water

JAS 3:9–3:12 See also EZK 47:7–47:9

Salt herbs**JOB 30:4****Practical uses of salt****Salt used as a seasoning****JOB 6:6–6:7****Salt rubbed on newborn infants****EZK 16:4****Symbolic use of salt****2KI 2:19–2:22****Figurative use of salt****MRK 9:49** See also EZR 4:14 The literal translation of the Hebrew phrase used here is “... we eat the salt of the palace ...”; COL 4:6**Salt in place-names****The Dead Sea****JOS 12:3** The Dead Sea was known as “the Salt Sea” or “the Sea of the Arabah” in biblical times. See also GEN 14:3; NUM 34:3–34:4, NUM 34:10–34:12; DEU 3:16–3:17; JOS 3:15–3:16, JOS 15:2–15:3, JOS 15:5–15:6, JOS 18:19**The Valley of Salt****2SA 8:13** See also 2KI 14:7 parallel 2CH 25:11; 1CH 18:12**The City of Salt****JOS 15:62****4360: sand**

A fine granular substance formed by the erosion of rocks, and found especially in the deserts and by the sea. It is often used as a symbol of innumerability and occasionally as a symbol of instability.

Sand as a fine granular substance**In the desert****EXO 2:12** See also JOB 39:13–39:15; ISA 35:6–35:7**At the sea****JER 5:22** See also DEU 33:18–33:19; ACT 27:39**Sand-bars****ACT 27:41** See also ACT 27:17**The weight of sand****JOB 6:2–6:3** See also PRO 27:3**Sand representing innumerability****God promised that Israel would be as innumerable as sand****GEN 22:15–22:18** See also GEN 32:9–32:12; 1KI 4:20; ISA 10:20–10:22, ISA 48:17–48:19; JER 33:19–33:22; HOS 1:8–1:10; ROM 9:22–9:27; HEB 11:11–11:12**Armies described as being as innumerable as sand****1SA 13:5** See also JOS 11:1–11:5; JDG 7:12; 2SA 17:11; REV 20:7–20:8**Other comparisons with the innumerability of sand****GEN 41:49** See also 1KI 4:29; JOB 29:18; PSA 78:27–78:29, PSA 139:17–139:18; JER 15:8; HAB 1:8–1:9**The instability and impermanence of sand****MAT 7:24–7:27** parallel LUK 6:46–6:49**4363: silver**

A precious metal often surpassed in value only by gold. It had a variety of uses and by NT times was common in coinage.

Silver mined**JOB 28:1–28:4****Silver acquired through trade****1KI 10:22** parallel 2CH 9:20 See also JER 10:9; EZK 27:12; REV 18:11–18:12**Silver refined****PSA 66:10** See also PRO 17:3, PRO 27:21; ISA 48:10; EZK 22:20–22:22; ZEC 13:9; MAL 3:3**Silver worked by silversmiths****PRO 25:4** See also 2CH 2:7, 2CH 2:13–2:14; ACT 19:24**Possession of silver a sign of wealth****GEN 13:2** See also GEN 24:35; NUM 22:18; DEU 8:13, DEU 17:17; JOS 22:8; 2CH 32:27 Hezekiah's riches; JOB 3:13–3:15, JOB 27:16; PSA 105:37; ECC 2:8; ISA 2:7, ISA 60:17; EZK 16:13 the adornments of unfaithful Jerusalem; EZK 28:4; DAN 11:43; HOS 2:8; ZEC 9:3, ZEC 14:14**Silver given as offerings to God****EXO 25:1–25:3** See also EXO 35:5, EXO 35:24; NUM 7:84–7:85; 2SA 8:11 parallel 1CH 18:11; 1CH 29:7; EZR 1:1–1:11, EZR 2:68–2:69, EZR 7:13–7:16, EZR 8:24–8:30; NEH 7:71–7:72**Silver in the tabernacle****EXO 38:17** See also EXO 26:18–26:25 parallel EXO 36:23–36:30; EXO 26:31–26:32 parallel EXO 36:35–36:36; EXO 27:9–27:11 parallel EXO 38:9–38:12; EXO 27:17, EXO 38:18–38:19, EXO 38:25–38:28; NUM 10:2**Silver in the temple****1CH 22:14** See also 1KI 7:51 parallel 2CH 5:1; 1KI 15:15 parallel 2CH 15:18; 2KI 25:15 parallel JER 52:19; 1CH 28:14–28:17, 1CH 29:2–29:5; 2CH 24:14; DAN 5:2

Silver abundant in Jerusalem in Solomon's time

1KI 10:27 parallels 2CH 1:15, 2CH 9:27 See also 1KI 10:21 parallel 2CH 9:20

Silver as currency

GEN 37:28 See also GEN 20:16, GEN 23:15–23:16, GEN 33:19, GEN 42:35; EXO 21:32, EXO 38:25; LEV 5:15, LEV 27:6, LEV 27:16; NUM 3:50, NUM 18:16 the redemption of firstborn males; DEU 2:6, DEU 2:28, DEU 14:22–14:26, DEU 22:19, DEU 22:28–22:29; JOS 24:32; JDG 9:4, JDG 16:5 The rulers of the Philistines offer to pay Delilah for the secret of Samson's great strength; JDG 17:10; 1SA 9:8; 2SA 18:11, 2SA 24:24 David buys Araunah's threshing-floor and oxen; 1KI 10:29 parallel 2CH 1:17; 1KI 16:24, 1KI 20:39; 2KI 6:25; 1CH 19:6; 2CH 25:6; EZR 7:21–7:22; NEH 5:15; EST 3:9 Haman promises to pay those who destroy the Jews; JOB 42:11; ISA 7:23; JER 32:9–32:10, JER 32:44; HOS 3:1–3:2; AMO 2:6, AMO 8:5–8:6; ZEP 1:11; ZEC 11:12–11:13; MAT 10:9, MAT 26:15, MAT 27:3–27:10 Judas returns the thirty silver coins; LUK 10:35; ACT 3:6

Silver as tribute

2KI 23:33–23:35 parallel 2CH 36:3 See also 1KI 15:18–15:19 parallel 2CH 16:2–16:3; 2KI 16:8, 2KI 18:14–18:15; 2CH 9:13–9:14, 2CH 9:23–9:24, 2CH 17:11, 2CH 27:5

Silver as plunder

JDG 5:19 See also EXO 3:22; NUM 31:21–31:23; JOS 6:18–6:19, JOS 6:24, JOS 7:21; 2KI 14:14 parallel 2CH 25:24; EZK 38:13; NAM 2:9

Silver idols or statues

EXO 20:23 See also DEU 7:25, DEU 29:17; JDG 17:1–17:4; PSA 115:4; ISA 2:20, ISA 30:22, ISA 31:7, ISA 40:19, ISA 46:6; JER 10:3–10:4, JER 10:8–10:9; DAN 2:32 the statue in Nebuchadnezzar's dream; DAN 5:4, DAN 5:23; HOS 8:4, HOS 13:2; HAB 2:19; ACT 17:29, ACT 19:24; REV 9:20

Silver jewellery

GEN 24:53 See also SNG 1:11; EZK 16:17

Silver referred to metaphorically

JOB 22:23–22:25 See also PSA 12:6, PSA 68:13, PSA 119:72; PRO 2:1–2:5, PRO 3:13–3:14, PRO 8:10, PRO 8:19, PRO 10:20, PRO 16:16, PRO 22:1 Esteem is better than silver or gold; PRO 25:11; ECC 12:6; ISA 1:22

4366: stones

Pieces of rock, used extensively for building.

Stones used in building**The temple in Jerusalem**

1KI 5:17–5:18 See also 1KI 6:14–6:18, 1KI 6:36, 1KI 7:9–7:12; 1CH 22:2, 1CH 22:14, 1CH 29:2 2KI 22:3–22:7 par-

allel 2CH 34:8–34:11 repairing the temple; EZR 6:1–6:4 rebuilding the temple after the exile; MAT 24:1–24:2 parallels MRK 13:1–13:2, LUK 21:5–21:6 Jesus Christ prophesies the temple's destruction.

Other references to building with stone

GEN 11:1–11:3; ; LEV 14:39–14:45; ; 2CH 16:6; ; NEH 4:1–4:3; ; ISA 9:10; ; AMO 5:11

Boundary stones

DEU 19:14 See also DEU 27:17; JOB 24:2; PRO 22:28, PRO 23:10–23:11; HOS 5:10

Stones covering openings**Wells**

GEN 29:1–29:10

The lions' den

DAN 6:16–6:17

Tombs

MRK 15:42–15:46 parallel MAT 27:57–27:60 See also MAT 27:62–28:4 parallels MRK 16:1–16:5, LUK 24:1–24:3; JHN 11:38–11:44, JHN 20:1

Stone jars

EXO 7:19 See also JHN 2:1–2:10

Stones as weapons

JDG 20:16 See also NUM 35:17; 1SA 17:38–17:50; 1CH 12:2; 2CH 26:15

Stones in religious use**Stone altars**

EXO 20:24–20:26 See also DEU 27:1–27:8; JOS 8:30–8:32; 1KI 18:30–18:38

Memorial stones

1SA 7:12 See also GEN 28:10–28:22, GEN 31:43–31:53, GEN 35:14–35:15; EXO 24:3–24:4; DEU 27:1–27:8; JOS 4:1–4:24, JOS 24:26–24:27

Ten Commandments written on stone

EXO 31:18 See also EXO 24:12, EXO 34:1–34:4; DEU 4:13, DEU 5:22, DEU 9:9–9:11, DEU 10:1–10:3; 1KI 8:9; HEB 9:3–9:4

Sacred stones

1KI 14:22–14:23 EXO 23:24, EXO 34:13; ; DEU 7:5, DEU 12:3, DEU 16:22; 2KI 3:2, 2KI 10:26–10:27, 2KI 17:10, 2KI 18:4, 2KI 23:14; ; 2CH 31:1; ; ISA 27:9; ; HOS 3:4, HOS 10:1–10:2; ; MIC 5:13

Stone idols

HAB 2:19 See also DEU 4:28, DEU 28:36, DEU 28:64, DEU 29:17; 2KI 19:18 parallel ISA 37:19; ACT 17:29; REV 9:20

Stonecutters and stonemasons

1KI 5:15 parallel 2CH 2:2 See also 2SA 5:11; 2KI 12:11–12:12; 1CH 22:2, 1CH 22:15; 2CH 2:18

Death by stoning

LEV 24:10–24:16 See also EXO 19:12–19:13, EXO 21:28–21:32; LEV 20:2, LEV 20:27; NUM 15:32–15:36; DEU 13:6–13:11, DEU 17:2–17:5, DEU 21:18–21:21; JOS 7:25; 1KI 12:18 parallel 2CH 10:18; 1KI 21:1–21:13 MAT 21:33–21:35, MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34 ACT 7:54–7:60, ACT 14:19; 2CO 11:25

Jesus Christ described as a stone

1PE 2:4–2:8 See also PSA 118:22; ISA 8:14, ISA 28:16; MAT 21:42–21:44 parallels MRK 12:10–12:11, LUK 20:17–20:18; ACT 4:8–4:12; ROM 9:33

Believers described as living stones

1PE 2:5

Metaphorical references to stones

EZK 36:26 See also EXO 15:5, EXO 15:15–15:16; 1KI 10:27 parallels 2CH 1:15, 2CH 9:27; NEH 9:11; JOB 6:12, JOB 38:29–38:30; EZK 3:9, EZK 11:19

4369: sulphur

A yellow, crystalline substance, also known as brimstone, which ignites and burns readily. It is invariably associated with divine punishment in Scripture.

Burning sulphur causes desolation

DEU 29:23 See also JOB 18:12–18:17

Divine punishment by means of burning sulphur

PSA 11:5–11:6 See also ISA 30:31–30:33, ISA 34:8–34:10; EZK 38:21–38:23; REV 9:13–9:19, REV 14:9–14:11

Sodom and Gomorrah destroyed by burning sulphur

GEN 19:24–19:25 See also LUK 17:28–17:29

The lake of burning sulphur

REV 21:8 See also REV 19:19–19:21, REV 20:7–20:10

4372: tin**Tin smelted in furnaces**

EZK 22:20 See also NUM 31:21–31:23; EZK 22:18

Tin traded by merchants

EZK 27:12

4400: Vegetation and food

- 4402: plants
- 4404: food

- 4406: agriculture
- 4408: balm
- 4410: banquets
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- 4416: branch
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- 4430: crops
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- 4434: drinking
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- 4440: fig-tree
- 4442: firstfruits
- 4444: flax
- 4446: flowers
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- 4450: fruit
- 4452: gall
- 4454: gleaning
- 4456: grain
- 4458: grape
- 4460: grass
- 4462: grinding
- 4464: harvest
- 4466: herbs and spices
- 4468: horticulture
- 4470: hyssop
- 4472: lily
- 4474: manna
- 4476: meals
- 4478: meat
- 4480: milk
- 4482: millstones
- 4484: mustard seed
- 4486: myrrh
- 4488: oil
- 4490: ointment
- 4492: olive
- 4494: papyrus
- 4496: perfume
- 4498: ploughing
- 4500: poison
- 4502: reed
- 4504: roots
- 4506: seed
- 4508: sickle
- 4510: sowing and reaping
- 4512: staff
- 4514: stick
- 4516: straw

- 4518: sycamore-fig tree
- 4520: thorns
- 4522: threshing
- 4524: threshing-floor
- 4526: tree of life
- 4528: trees
- 4530: unleavened bread
- 4532: vegetables
- 4534: vine
- 4536: vinegar
- 4538: vineyard
- 4540: weeds
- 4542: wheat
- 4544: wine
- 4546: winepress
- 4548: wineskin
- 4550: winnowing
- 4552: wood
- 4554: yeast

4402: plants

Plants are an important aspect of God's creation, and a major source of food and materials. Scripture refers to many plants, with their various uses.

Plants as a source of food

GEN 1:29–1:30 See also GEN 1:11–1:12, GEN 3:17–3:19, GEN 9:3; PSA 104:14

Growth of plants dependent upon soil, sun and irrigation

DEU 32:2 See also GEN 2:4–2:5; 2KI 19:26 parallel ISA 37:27; JOB 8:16–8:19; ISA 61:11; ZEC 10:1; MAT 13:3–13:8 parallels MRK 4:3–4:8, LUK 8:5–8:8; JAS 1:11

Individual plants

Aloes

NUM 24:5–24:6 See also PSA 45:8; PRO 7:17; SNG 4:13–4:14

Calamus

JER 6:20 See also SNG 4:12–4:14; ISA 43:24; EZK 27:19

Crocus

ISA 35:1–35:2

Hyssop

1KI 4:33 See also EXO 12:22; PSA 51:7; JHN 19:29

Lily

LUK 12:27 parallel MAT 6:28–6:29 See also SNG 2:1–2:2; HOS 14:5

Lotus

JOB 40:21–40:22

Mandrake

SNG 7:13 See also GEN 30:14–30:16

Mustard

MAT 13:31–13:32 parallels MRK 4:30–4:32, LUK 13:18–13:19

Myrtle

ISA 55:13 See also ISA 41:18–41:20; ZEC 1:8–1:10

Reed

EXO 2:3 See also JOB 8:11; ISA 19:6–19:7

Rose

SNG 2:1

Rush

ISA 19:6–19:7

4404: food

Scripture contains references to varied foodstuffs, which comprised the diet of the people of the Near East in biblical times.

God made provision for food in creation

GEN 1:29–1:30

Flour

Flour the main ingredient in bread

GEN 18:6 See also EXO 29:2; JDG 6:19; ISA 28:24; MAT 13:33 parallel LUK 13:21

Flour figured largely in the staple diet

1KI 17:12–17:16 See also 2SA 17:27–17:29; 1KI 4:22–4:23; 2KI 4:41, 2KI 7:1, 2KI 7:16; 1CH 12:40

Fine flour more refined and more expensive than the common variety

EZK 16:13 See also EZK 16:19; REV 18:11–18:13

Flour in grain offerings

LEV 2:1–2:10 See also LEV 6:14–6:23, LEV 14:8–14:11; NUM 5:11–5:15, NUM 6:13–6:15, NUM 15:1–15:4, NUM 28:9, NUM 29:7–29:11; 1CH 23:29; EZK 46:14

Flour in other offerings

LEV 5:11 See also EXO 29:1–29:3, EXO 29:22–29:25; LEV 7:12, LEV 8:25–8:28, LEV 23:15–23:17

Honey

Honey a sweet delicacy

GEN 43:11 See also EXO 16:31; DEU 32:13; JDG 14:8–14:9; 1SA 14:25–14:26; 2SA 17:27–17:29; 1KI 14:1–14:3; 2KI 18:31–18:32; PSA 19:10, PSA 119:103, PSA 81:13–81:16; SNG 4:11, SNG 5:1; ISA 7:22; JER 41:8; EZK 16:13

The promised land described as flowing with milk and honey

EXO 3:7–3:8 See also EXO 3:17, EXO 13:5, EXO 33:3; LEV 20:24; NUM 13:27, NUM 14:8, NUM 16:12–16:14; DEU 6:3, DEU 11:8–11:9, DEU 26:9, DEU 31:20; JOS 5:6; JER 32:22; EZK 20:6, EZK 20:15

Prohibition against burning honey on the altar
LEV 2:11

Raisins

2SA 16:1 See also NUM 6:1–6:4; 1SA 25:18, 1SA 30:11–30:12; 2SA 6:19 parallel 1CH 16:3; 1CH 12:40; SNG 2:5; HOS 3:1

Lentils

GEN 25:29–25:34 See also 2SA 17:27–17:29, 2SA 23:11–23:12; EZK 4:1–4:10

Cheese

1SA 17:17–17:18 See also 2SA 17:27–17:29; JOB 10:8–10:11

Believers should not eat food offered to idols

ACT 15:19–15:20 See also ACT 21:25; 1CO 8:1–8:13; REV 2:14

4406: agriculture

The science of cultivation. The task, given to humanity, of cultivating the land is a reflection of God's own care for his creation.

A major activity for humanity

GEN 2:15 See also GEN 3:23, GEN 4:2, GEN 4:12, GEN 9:20, GEN 47:19; DEU 8:7–8:8; 1KI 19:19; 2CH 26:10; ISA 37:30

Growth is according to the sovereign will of God

He has established the seasons

GEN 8:22; ACT 14:17 See also LEV 26:4; JER 5:24

He provides for the growth of the crops

PSA 65:9 See also PSA 104:14, PSA 107:37–107:38, PSA 147:8; EZK 34:26–34:27; ZEC 8:12; MAT 6:30; 2CO 9:10

OT laws for agriculture showed how to co-operate with God

LEV 19:19 See also LEV 19:23, LEV 25:3–25:4; DEU 22:10

Harvest festivals were for thanking God for his provision

EXO 34:22 See also LEV 23:10, LEV 23:39–23:41; DEU 16:10, DEU 16:13

Cultivation was affected by the fall

GEN 3:17 See also GEN 3:18–3:19, GEN 4:12, GEN 5:29; ROM 8:20

Agricultural images of God's action among his people

ISA 5:7; MAT 9:37; JHN 12:24 See also ISA 17:5–17:6, ISA 24:13; JER 8:20, JER 50:16, JER 51:33; HOS 6:11; MAT 13:3–13:8 parallels MRK 4:3–4:8, LUK 8:5–8:8; MAT 13:18–13:23 parallels MRK 4:13–4:20, LUK 8:11–8:15; MAT 13:24–13:30; MRK 4:26–4:29; JHN 4:35–4:38

4408: balm

Balm was a herb valued for its healing properties

JER 8:22 See also 2CH 28:15; JER 46:11, JER 51:8

Balm was exported from Israel to other nations

GEN 43:11 See also GEN 37:25; EZK 27:17

4410: banquets

Grand, celebratory meals consisting usually of rich food and flowing wine. Banquets usually accompanied weddings, religious festivals and other celebrations. Prophecies of the Messianic age refer to a banquet to which the righteous will be invited.

Characteristics of banquets

They were usually held in a hall

SNG 2:4 See also EST 7:8; DAN 5:10

Honoured guests were given special places

LUK 14:7–14:11 See also PRO 25:6–25:7; MAT 23:6 parallels MRK 12:39, LUK 20:46

Guests reclined on couches

EST 1:6; ; MAT 26:7 parallels MRK 14:3, LUK 7:36; ; JHN 12:2

Invitations were sent out

LUK 14:17 parallel MAT 22:3

Occasions for holding banquets

To celebrate weddings

MAT 22:2 See also GEN 29:21–29:22 a feast celebrates Jacob's wedding; JDG 14:10 Samson gives a wedding feast; EST 2:18 Xerxes celebrates Esther's choice as queen with a banquet; MAT 25:10; LUK 12:36; JHN 2:8–2:9; REV 19:9 the marriage supper of the Lamb

To celebrate birthdays

GEN 40:20; ; MRK 6:21

To celebrate other events

GEN 21:8 Abraham celebrates Isaac's weaning.; EST 8:17, EST 9:17–9:19; LUK 15:23 The father celebrates the prodigal son's return.

Religious celebrations

PSA 22:29 See also 2CH 30:21–30:22, 2CH 35:13; ZEC 7:6

Activities at banquets

Good food and drink

ISA 25:6 See also JOB 1:4; ZEC 7:6; MAT 22:4; LUK 15:23

Drunkenness and revelry

ISA 25:36 See also EST 1:7-1:8, EST 1:10; ECC 10:19; JER 51:39; DAN 5:3-5:4

Music and dancing

ISA 5:12 See also MAT 14:6 parallel MRK 6:22; LUK 15:25

Further examples of banquets

GEN 26:30 Isaac holds a feast for Abimelech; ; GEN 43:34 Joseph feasts with his brothers; ; 2SA 3:20 David holds a feast for Abner; ; 1KI 3:15 Solomon gives a feast for all his court.; EST 1:3, EST 1:5; EST 1:9 Queen Vashti holds a banquet for the women of the palace.; EST 5:4-5:5, EST 5:8; DAN 5:1-5:2 Belshazzar has a banquet for 1,000 nobles; ; LUK 5:29 parallel MAT 9:10 Levi holds a banquet for Jesus Christ; ; LUK 14:1 Jesus Christ is the guest of a leading Pharisee.

An invitation to a banquet seen as a sign of God's grace

LUK 14:12-14:14 See also 2KI 6:23 The king of Israel prepares a banquet for captured Aramean troops; MAT 22:8-22:10 parallel LUK 14:21-14:23

The Messianic banquet

MAT 8:11 See also LUK 13:29, LUK 14:15

4412: binding corn

Binding corn as a feature of agricultural life

GEN 37:7 See also LEV 19:9 the law of the gleaner; LEV 23:10, LEV 23:22; DEU 11:14, DEU 24:19; RUT 2:16; ISA 17:5

Metaphorical usage

PSA 126:6 See also JOB 5:26; PRO 10:5; JER 9:22; MIC 4:12; MAT 9:37-9:38, MAT 13:30; LUK 10:2

4416: branch

The limb of a tree. The term is used literally, symbolically and metaphorically in Scripture. Branches are personified at times and the Messiah is referred to as the Branch.

Branches of various trees

Vine branches

GEN 49:22 See also NUM 13:23; ISA 18:5; JER 5:10, JER 6:9, JER 48:32; EZK 17:5-17:8, EZK 19:10-19:14; JHN 15:5-15:6

Olive branches

DEU 24:20 See also NEH 8:14-8:16; JER 11:16; ZEC 4:12

Palm branches

REV 7:9 See also NEH 8:15; ISA 9:14, ISA 19:15

Branches of other trees

JER 1:11 See also GEN 30:37-30:39; NEH 8:15; EZK 17:22-17:23, EZK 31:3; HEB 9:19

Branches cut down for Jesus Christ's triumphal entry into Jerusalem

MAT 21:7-21:9 parallels MRK 11:7-11:10, JHN 12:12-12:13

Branches providing shelter

MAT 13:31-13:32 parallel LUK 13:18-13:19 See also EZK 31:3-31:14; DAN 4:10-4:14, DAN 4:20-4:22

The symbolic use of branches

JER 1:11-1:12 See also ISA 9:14-9:15, ISA 19:13-19:15

Branches in visions

GEN 40:9-40:13 See also ZEC 4:1-4:14

The metaphorical use of branches

JOB 29:19 See also GEN 49:22; JOB 15:32-15:35, JOB 18:5-18:16

The personification of branches

In general

JHN 15:5-15:6 See also ROM 11:11-11:24

The Messiah as the Branch

JER 23:5 See also ISA 4:2, ISA 11:1-11:5; JER 33:15-33:16; ZEC 3:8, ZEC 6:12-6:13

The branches of the lampstand in the tabernacle

EXO 25:31-25:32 See also EXO 25:35-25:36, EXO 37:17-37:22

4418: bread

The basic component of the staple diet in biblical times. Consecrated bread was continually laid out in the Holy Place of the tabernacle and temple. Jesus Christ called himself the bread of life.

Bread the basic component of the diet

MAT 6:11 parallel LUK 11:3 See also GEN 14:18, GEN 18:3-18:6 Abraham entertains the three angels; GEN 25:34, GEN 27:17, GEN 45:23; DEU 8:7-8:9, DEU 23:4; JDG 8:5-8:6 Gideon asks for bread for his troops; JDG 19:19; RUT 2:14; 1SA 2:36, 1SA 17:17, 1SA 21:2-21:3, 1SA 25:7-25:11 Nabal refuses bread to David's men; 1KI 13:7-13:22, 1KI 17:10-17:16 The widow at Zarephath feeds Elijah and is rewarded; 1KI 19:5-19:6; JOB 23:12; PSA 104:14-104:15; PRO 30:8; ISA 33:16, ISA 51:14, ISA 55:2; JER 37:21 Jeremiah's rations in prison; JER 42:14; LAM 5:6;

EZK 4:9; DEU 8:3; MAT 4:3–4:4 parallel LUK 4:3–4:4 the temptation of Jesus Christ; MRK 6:8; 2CO 9:10

A diet consisting solely of bread was indicative of deprivation

1KI 22:27 parallel 2CH 18:26 See also PRO 6:26; LAM 1:11, LAM 2:12, LAM 4:4

Kinds of bread

Unleavened bread

EXO 12:39 See also EXO 12:8, EXO 12:14–12:20, EXO 13:3–13:7

Manna

EXO 16:31–16:35 See also EXO 16:4–16:8, EXO 16:11–16:12, EXO 16:14–16:19; NEH 9:15; PSA 78:23–78:25, PSA 105:40

Gifts of bread

GEN 45:23 See also 1SA 10:3–10:4, 1SA 16:20, 1SA 25:18; 2SA 6:19 parallel 1CH 16:3; 2SA 16:1–16:2; 1KI 14:3; 2KI 4:42

Offerings of bread

LEV 7:11–7:14 See also EXO 29:2, EXO 29:32–29:34; LEV 2:11, LEV 8:31–8:32, LEV 23:20; NUM 6:17–6:20; JDG 6:19–6:21

The bread of the Presence

LEV 24:5–24:8 EXO 25:23–25:30, EXO 35:10–35:13, EXO 39:33–39:36, EXO 40:22–40:23; ; NUM 4:4–4:8; 1SA 21:1–21:6 David and his men eat the consecrated bread; ; 1CH 9:31–9:32, 1CH 23:29; ; 2CH 2:4, 2CH 13:11; ; NEH 10:32–10:33; ; MAT 12:1–12:8 parallels MRK 2:23–2:28, LUK 6:1–6:5 Jesus Christ and his disciples in the cornfields on the Sabbath; ; HEB 9:1–9:2

Jesus Christ as the bread of life

JHN 6:25–6:35 See also JHN 6:41–6:59

Miracles of multiplication of bread

MAT 14:13–14:21 parallels MRK 6:32–6:44, LUK 9:10–9:17, JHN 6:1–6:13 See also MAT 15:32–15:38 parallel MRK 8:1–8:10

The breaking of bread as a symbol of the death of Jesus Christ

MAT 26:26–26:29 parallels MRK 14:22–14:25, LUK 22:17–22:20, 1CO 11:24–11:25 See also LUK 24:28–24:35; ACT 2:42, ACT 2:46, ACT 20:6–20:7, ACT 20:11, ACT 27:35; 1CO 10:16–10:17

4420: breakfast

Breakfast is the first meal of the day

JHN 21:1–21:13 See also JDG 19:5–19:10

4422: brier

Prickly vegetation, painful to the touch, often seen as a symbol of dereliction.

A brier as prickly vegetation

EZK 28:24 See also ISA 7:23–7:25; EZK 2:6; MIC 7:2–7:4

A brier as a symbol of dereliction

ISA 5:6 See also JOB 31:38–31:40; ISA 32:11–32:13, ISA 55:13; HOS 9:6

Briers are destroyed by fire

ISA 10:17 See also ISA 9:18, ISA 27:4

Briers as an instrument of punishment

JDG 8:16 See also JDG 8:4–8:7

4424: cedar

A tall, majestic tree, native to Lebanon. In OT times it was highly prized for its wood, which was used extensively in the construction of Solomon's temple.

Cedar trees associated with Lebanon

1KI 4:33 See also JDG 9:15; 2KI 14:9 parallel 2CH 25:18; 2KI 19:23 parallel ISA 37:24; PSA 29:5, PSA 92:12, PSA 104:16; SNG 5:15; ISA 14:8; JER 22:23; EZK 27:5; HOS 14:5–14:6; ZEC 11:1–11:2

The cedar as a tall, majestic tree

EZK 31:3 See also JOB 40:17; PSA 80:10; ISA 2:12–2:13; EZK 17:22–17:23, EZK 31:7–31:8; AMO 2:9

Cedar trees indicating a fertile, well-watered land

NUM 24:5–24:6 See also PSA 92:12–92:15; ISA 41:17–41:20

Cedar used allegorically

EZK 17:1–17:4 prophecy of a Davidic king being taken into captivity; ; EZK 17:22–17:23 prophecy of the Messiah coming from David's family

Cedar as a costly and valued wood

1KI 10:27 parallels 2CH 1:15, 2CH 9:27 See also SNG 8:8–8:9; ISA 9:8–9:10

Cedar wood used in ritual purification

LEV 14:48–14:53 See also LEV 14:1–14:7; NUM 19:1–19:6

Cedar wood imported from the north

EZR 3:7 See also 2SA 5:11; 1KI 5:1–5:11 parallel 2CH 2:3–2:16; 1KI 9:11; 1CH 22:4

Cedar wood used in the construction of buildings

Royal palaces and great houses

1KI 7:2–7:3 See also 2SA 5:11; 2SA 7:2; 1KI 7:7; 1KI 7:11–7:12; SNG 1:17; JER 22:11–22:15

The temple

1KI 6:18 See also 2SA 7:7; 1KI 6:9–6:10; 1KI 6:20; 1KI 6:36; 1KI 7:12

4426: chaff

Husks of wheat or other cereal. It was separated from the grain by threshing, whereupon it usually blew away, as it was lighter than the grain. Sometimes however, it was burned as fuel. The wicked are frequently likened to chaff in Scripture.

Grain was threshed on outdoor threshing-floors to separate the chaff

DAN 2:31–2:35 See also HOS 13:3

Characteristics of chaff

It is blown by the wind

JOB 13:25

It is light

JOB 41:28

It is useless

ISA 33:11

The wicked are compared to chaff

They will disappear as chaff is blown away

PSA 1:1–1:6 See also JOB 21:17–21:18; PSA 35:4–35:6; PSA 83:13–83:15; ISA 17:13; ISA 29:5; ISA 40:24–40:25; JER 13:24

Their punishment is compared to threshing

ISA 41:15–41:16 See also ISA 41:2

Their end will be like chaff which is burned

MAT 3:11–3:12 parallel LUK 3:16–3:17

4428: corn

A cereal crop cultivated for food use. An important agricultural crop in biblical times, it is mentioned frequently in Scripture.

The importance of corn

It was a basic foodstuff

PSA 65:9 See also 2KI 4:42–4:44; EZK 36:24–36:31; MAT 12:1–12:8 parallels MRK 2:23–2:28; LUK 6:1–6:5

It was an important cereal crop

PSA 72:16 See also JDG 15:1–15:6; PSA 65:11–65:13; ISA 36:16–36:17

Harvesting corn

MRK 4:26–4:29 See also DEU 16:9–16:10; JOB 24:22–24:24; ISA 17:4–17:6; JER 9:22

Legislation relating to corn

DEU 23:25 See also EXO 22:6

Corn featuring in dreams

GEN 37:5–37:8 See also GEN 41:5–41:7; GEN 41:22–41:32

The metaphorical use of corn

HOS 14:5–14:7 See also JER 50:11–50:13

4430: crops

Crops represent God's provision and are regulated by the Mosaic law. Their failure is associated with disobedience.

Crops related to the law of Moses

DEU 7:12–7:13 See also EXO 23:10–23:11; EXO 23:16; LEV 23:39; LEV 25:3; LEV 25:15–25:16; LEV 25:20–25:22; LEV 26:3–26:4; DEU 14:28–14:29; DEU 16:13 the Feast of Tabernacles; DEU 22:9; DEU 26:12; DEU 28:11; DEU 30:8–30:9; NEH 10:35–10:37; PRO 3:9–3:10; MAL 3:10–3:11

Crops representing God's goodness

PSA 65:9–65:10; ACT 14:17 See also GEN 26:12; JER 2:7; EZK 34:27–34:29; EZK 36:30; ZEC 8:12; JAS 5:17–5:18

The failure of crops as a result of disobedience

DEU 11:16–11:17 See also GEN 4:10–4:12; DEU 28:18; DEU 28:42; DEU 28:49–28:51; JDG 6:3–6:4; JOB 31:5–31:8; PSA 78:46; PSA 105:34–105:35; AMO 7:1; HAG 1:9–1:10

Crops used metaphorically

JAS 5:7 See also ISA 5:1–5:2; MAT 13:8; MAT 13:23; MAT 21:40–21:41; LUK 12:16–12:17; JHN 4:36; 2TI 2:6; HEB 6:7–6:8; REV 22:1–22:2

4432: dough

A mixture of flour and water to which yeast is added and which is then baked to produce bread. Scripture makes several comparisons with it to teach spiritual lessons.

Dough and the process of making bread

Yeast was normally added and the dough left to rise

EXO 12:33–12:34 See also EXO 12:39

Dough was kneaded before baking

JER 7:18 See also 2SA 13:8; HOS 7:4

Spiritual lessons from comparisons with dough

The dough offered as firstfruits

ROM 11:13–11:16

The influence of yeast on the dough

MAT 13:33 parallel LUK 13:20–13:21 See also 1CO 5:1–5:8; GAL 5:1–5:10

4434: drinking

Scripture lays down no general prohibition of the consumption of alcohol, but warns against its abuse.

4435: drinking

Wine as a gift of God

A sign of his blessing

DEU 7:13 See also GEN 27:28; DEU 33:28; PRO 3:9–3:10; JOL 2:18–2:19, JOL 2:22–2:24, JOL 3:18; AMO 9:13–9:14

Drinking wine has God's approval

DEU 14:26 See also JHN 2:1–2:10; 1TI 5:23 approval implicit in the advice given

Withdrawal of wine is evidence of divine judgment

ISA 24:6–24:7 See also JER 48:32–48:33

Drinking used extensively as a metaphor

Of suffering God's judgment

JOB 21:20; ; PSA 75:8; ; ISA 29:9; ; JER 25:15–25:17; ; EZK 23:31–23:34; ; HAB 2:16; ; REV 18:3

Of love

PRO 7:18

Of Jesus Christ's destiny of suffering

MAT 26:42 See also MAT 26:39 parallels MRK 14:36, LUK 22:42; MAT 20:22–20:23 parallel MRK 10:38–10:39; JHN 18:11

Of spiritual satisfaction

JHN 4:13–4:14

Of the Christian experience of the Holy Spirit

JHN 7:37

Jesus Christ's symbolic use of wine

MAT 26:27–26:29 parallels MRK 14:23–14:25, LUK 22:17–22:18, LUK 22:20 See also JHN 6:53–6:56 the believer's participation in Jesus Christ

4436: drinking, abstention from

Scripture indicates that the abuse of drinking, such as drunkenness, is unacceptable. It also indicates the advantages of abstention from drinking in certain situations.

For some, at certain times, total abstinence is right

LEV 10:8–10:9; ; EZK 44:21 priests; ; NUM 6:1–6:4, NUM 6:20 Nazirites; ; JDG 13:2–13:5, JDG 13:7, JDG 13:13–13:14; ; PRO 31:4–31:5; ; ISA 22:12–22:13; ; JER 35:1–35:14; ; DAN 1:5–1:16; MAT 11:18; ; LUK 1:15; MAT 27:34 Jesus Christ; ; ROM 14:21 the Christian who does not want to give offence

Warnings against the abuse of alcohol

ISA 5:11 See also PRO 20:1; ISA 5:22; HAB 2:15; LUK 21:34; ROM 13:13; 1CO 6:9–6:10, 1CO 11:20–11:21; GAL 5:19–5:21; EPH 5:18; 1TH 5:7–5:8; TIT 2:3

Christian leaders are to be sober

1TI 3:2–3:3 See also 1TI 3:8; TIT 1:7

Examples of drunkenness

GEN 9:20–9:21, GEN 19:30–19:35; ; ISA 25:36; ; 2SA 11:12–11:13; ; 1KI 16:9, 1KI 20:16; ; EST 1:10; ; ISA 28:7, ISA 56:10–56:12; ; MAT 24:49 parallel LUK 12:45

Some accusations of drunkenness were unfounded

ISA 1:13–1:15; ; MAT 11:19 parallel LUK 7:34; ; ACT 2:13–2:15 the disciples on the day of Pentecost

4438: eating

The consumption of food, necessary for survival. Scripture cites enjoyment of eating as a gift of God but emphasises that it is not the main priority in life, for God will provide abundantly for his children.

Eating for survival

NEH 5:1–5:2 See also GEN 28:20–28:22; 1KI 17:12, 1KI 19:3–19:8; 2KI 25:3

Eating as a sign of life and health

DEU 4:28 See also 2SA 13:5–13:10; PSA 102:4; MRK 5:35–5:43 parallel LUK 8:49–8:56; LUK 24:36–24:43; JHN 6:48–6:58

Enjoyment of eating as a gift of God

ECC 3:13 See also GEN 27:1–27:25; ECC 2:24–2:25, ECC 5:18, ECC 8:15, ECC 9:7

God blesses his people with sufficient food

PSA 37:25 See also LEV 26:3–26:5, LEV 26:23–26:26; DEU 8:16, DEU 11:15, DEU 12:7; JOS 24:11–24:13; PSA 22:26, PSA 78:23–78:29, PSA 127:2, PSA 128:1–128:2; PRO 13:25; ISA 1:19, ISA 7:22, ISA 65:13, ISA 65:21–65:22; JOL 2:26; AMO 9:14; MIC 6:9–6:16; HAG 1:5–1:11

Eating should not be one's chief priority

MAT 4:1–4:4 parallel LUK 4:1–4:4 See also DEU 8:3; NUM 11:4–11:34; MAT 6:25–6:34 parallel LUK 12:22–12:31; LUK 12:16–12:20; COL 2:13–2:17

Eating as a religious observance

Sacrificial meals

EXO 18:12 See also EXO 29:32–29:33, EXO 32:6; LEV 6:14–7:10, LEV 8:31, LEV 21:21–21:23; NUM 18:8–18:13; DEU 15:19–15:20; 1SA 1:1–1:5, 1SA 9:11–9:13, 1SA 20:24–20:29; EZK 44:3; HOS 8:13; HEB 13:9–13:10

Sacrificial meals for pagan gods

EXO 34:15 See also EZK 18:5–18:6, EZK 18:14–18:15, EZK 22:9; 1CO 8:4–8:13, 1CO 10:23–10:28

The Passover and Feast of Unleavened Bread

EXO 12:1–12:11 See also EXO 12:14–12:20; LEV 23:4–23:8; NUM 28:16–28:25; DEU 16:1–16:8; MAT 26:17–26:19 parallels MRK 14:12–14:16, LUK 22:7–22:13

The Lord's Supper

MAT 26:26–26:29 parallels MRK 14:22–14:25, LUK 22:17–22:20 See also 1CO 11:23–11:34

Restrictions on eating

GEN 9:1–9:4 See also GEN 2:15–2:17, GEN 3:1–3:7 Eve and Adam eat the fruit of the tree; GEN 3:22, GEN 32:22–32:32, GEN 43:32; EXO 22:31; LEV 7:19, LEV 7:22–7:27, LEV 11:1–11:47 parallel DEU 14:3–14:20 clean and unclean food; LEV 22:4–22:8, LEV 23:6; NUM 6:1–6:4; DEU 12:23–12:25; EZK 44:31; MRK 7:14–7:19; ROM 14:1–14:3, ROM 14:19–14:21

Eating and hospitality

Eating at a royal court

1KI 2:7 See also 2SA 9:1–9:13; 1KI 18:19; DAN 11:26

Eating as a guest in another's home

GEN 18:3–18:5 See also GEN 19:3, GEN 43:16; EXO 2:18–2:20; JDG 19:5–19:9; 2KI 4:8; PRO 23:6–23:7; MAT 9:9–9:13 parallels MRK 2:14–2:17, LUK 5:27–5:32; MAT 26:6–26:7 parallel MRK 14:3; LUK 14:1–14:14

Fasting

EST 4:16 See also 2SA 3:35; MAT 4:1–4:2 parallel LUK 4:1–4:2

Cannibalism

DEU 28:53 See also 2KI 6:24–6:29; JER 19:9

Metaphorical references to eating

JHN 6:50 Coming to faith in Jesus Christ; **REV 3:20** Having fellowship with Jesus Christ. See also PSA 14:4 parallel PSA 53:4; PSA 141:4; PRO 1:29–1:31, PRO 4:17, PRO

18:21, PRO 31:27; SNG 5:1; ISA 55:1–55:2; EZK 3:1–3:3; MIC 3:1–3:3; REV 2:7, REV 10:9, REV 17:16, REV 19:17–19:19

4440: fig-tree

A tree common in the Near East, with soft, sweet fruit which can be eaten fresh or dried. The fruit was an important part of the diet in biblical times and the tree was symbolic of peace and security.

Figs

Figs prized as a sweet, pleasant fruit

JDG 9:10–9:11 See also NUM 13:21–13:23

Figs a significant part of the diet in biblical times

NUM 20:5 See also DEU 8:7–8:9; 1SA 30:11–30:12; NEH 13:15

Figs given in gifts of food

1SA 25:18 See also 2SA 16:1; 1CH 12:40

Other uses of figs and fig leaves

2KI 20:1–20:7 See also GEN 3:6–3:7; ISA 38:21

Judah likened to figs

JER 24:1–24:10, JER 29:15–29:19

The fig-tree as a symbol of peace and security

1KI 4:25 See also 2KI 18:28–18:32 parallel ISA 36:13–36:18 **MIC 4:1–4:5** ZEC 3:10

Destruction of fig-trees

By God

HOS 2:12 See also PSA 105:33; AMO 4:9

By enemies

JOL 1:6–1:7 See also JER 5:17

Descriptions of the fig-tree and its fruit

Early figs

HOS 9:10 See also SNG 2:13; ISA 28:4; MIC 7:1; NAM 3:12

Late figs

REV 6:12–6:13

Failure of the crop

JER 8:13 See also JOL 1:12; HAB 3:17–3:18; HAG 2:19

Fig-trees in the teaching of Jesus Christ and the apostles

In parables and object lessons

JAS 3:9–3:12 See also MAT 7:15–7:20 parallel LUK 6:43–6:45; LUK 13:6–13:9

The lesson of the fig-tree

MAT 24:32–24:35 parallels MRK 13:28–13:31, LUK 21:29–21:31

Jesus Christ curses a fig-tree

MAT 21:18–21:22 parallels MRK 11:12–11:14, MRK 11:20–11:24

4442: firstfruits

Offerings of the produce of the land, being the first and best of the crops, given in acknowledgment of God's abundant blessings. The term is also used metaphorically to indicate the first of a much larger group that is to follow, such as those who will be raised from the dead.

Offering firstfruits

EXO 23:19 See also EXO 34:26; LEV 2:11–2:16; DEU 26:1–26:11; NEH 10:35–10:39, NEH 13:31; PRO 3:9–3:10; ROM 11:16

Firstfruits given to priests and Levites

NUM 18:8–18:13 See also DEU 18:1–18:5; 2CH 31:2–31:5; NEH 12:44–12:47; EZK 44:28–44:30

Firstfruits offered at feasts

The Feast of Firstfruits

LEV 23:9–23:14

The Feast of Weeks (Harvest)

See also EXO 23:16, EXO 34:22; LEV 23:15–23:20; NUM 28:26

Firstborn of human beings and animals regarded as firstfruits

PSA 78:51 See also EXO 13:1–13:2, EXO 13:11–13:16; NUM 18:14–18:19; PSA 105:36

Metaphorical use of firstfruits

Firstfruits of God's harvest

JER 2:1–2:3

Jesus Christ the firstfruits of the resurrection

1CO 15:20–15:28 See also ACT 26:22–26:23

Firstfruits of salvation

JAS 1:18 See also ROM 8:23; 2TH 2:13; REV 14:1–14:5

4444: flax

Flax is the linum plant from which linen is made

EXO 9:31; ; JOS 2:6; ; JDG 15:14

Making flax into linen

PRO 31:13; ; ISA 19:9

4446: flowers

The blossoming part of plants and trees, from which the seeds or fruit develop. Often admired for their

beauty, Scripture uses their fleeting existence as an illustration of the transience of human life.

Carvings of flowers

In the tabernacle

EXO 25:31–25:36 parallel EXO 37:17–37:22

In the temple

1KI 6:18 See also 1KI 6:29, 1KI 6:31–6:35, 1KI 7:15–7:22, 1KI 7:25–7:26 parallel 2CH 4:4–4:5

Metaphorical depictions of people as flowers

ISA 28:1–28:6 See also ISA 5:18–5:25

Human existence is likened to the short life cycle of flowers

1PE 1:24–1:25 See also ISA 40:6–40:8; JOB 14:1–14:2; PSA 103:13–103:18; JAS 1:9–1:11

Flowers and the changing seasons

SNG 2:11–2:13 See also ISA 18:5–18:6

The lily

Its beauty

LUK 12:27–12:28 parallel MAT 6:28–6:30 See also SNG 2:1–2:2; HOS 14:4–14:7

Lilies in psalm titles

PSA 45:0 See also PSA 60:0, PSA 69:0, PSA 80:0

Their metaphorical use

SNG 4:5 See also SNG 2:16, SNG 5:13, SNG 6:2–6:3, SNG 7:2

The crocus

ISA 35:1–35:2

The rose

SNG 2:1

4448: forests

Forests the source of timber

NEH 2:8 See also DEU 19:5; ISA 44:13–44:14; JER 10:3; EZK 39:10

Forests the habitat of wild animals

PSA 50:9–50:11 See also PSA 80:13, PSA 104:20–104:22; ISA 56:9; JER 5:6, JER 12:8; EZK 34:25; MIC 5:8, MIC 7:14

Destruction of forests

As punishment

JER 21:14 See also ISA 10:18–10:19, ISA 10:33–10:34; ZEC 11:1–11:3

As a demonstration of power

JER 46:23 See also 2KI 19:22–19:24 parallel ISA 37:23–37:25; EZK 20:46–20:48

To render land suitable for human habitation

JOS 17:14–17:18

Forest fires

JAS 3:5 See also PSA 83:14–83:15; ISA 9:18; JER 21:14

The Palace of the Forest of Lebanon

1KI 7:2 See also 1KI 10:17 parallel 2CH 9:16; 1KI 10:21 parallel 2CH 9:20

Location of forests

ISA 22:5 See also 2SA 18:6–18:17; EZK 20:46–20:48

Poetic references to forests

SNG 2:3 See also 1CH 16:33; PSA 29:9, PSA 96:12; ISA 7:2, ISA 44:23

4450: fruit

Edible produce of trees, usually sweet and pleasant-tasting. The climate of the Near East is particularly suitable for a wide range of fruit and several varieties are mentioned in Scripture.

Apples**Sweet, pleasant-tasting fruit**

SNG 2:3 See also PRO 25:11; SNG 2:5, SNG 7:8

Apple trees

JOL 1:12 See also SNG 2:3, SNG 8:5 DEU 32:10; PSA 17:8; PRO 7:2; ZEC 2:8

Dates

2SA 6:19 parallel 1CH 16:3

Figs

NUM 13:23 See also NUM 20:5; 1SA 25:18–25:20, 1SA 30:11–30:12; 2SA 16:1; 1CH 12:40; MRK 11:13

Grapes

DEU 32:3–32:14 See also GEN 40:9–40:11; NUM 13:23–13:24, NUM 20:5

Melons

NUM 11:5 See also ISA 1:8; JER 10:5

Pomegranates**Pleasant-tasting fruit**

DEU 8:7–8:8 See also NUM 13:23, NUM 20:5; SNG 6:11, SNG 7:12, SNG 8:2

Pomegranate trees

ISA 14:2 See also JOL 1:12; HAG 2:19 SNG 4:3, SNG 4:13, SNG 6:7

Representations of pomegranates in the tabernacle and temple

2KI 25:16–25:17 parallel JER 52:20–52:23 See also EXO 28:31–28:35 parallel EXO 39:22–39:26; 1KI 7:15–7:20, 1KI 7:40–7:42 parallel 2CH 4:11–4:13; 2CH 3:16

Fruit and the fall

GEN 3:12 See also GEN 3:1–3:7

General references to fruit

AMO 8:1–8:2 See also GEN 1:11–1:12, GEN 1:29; LEV 19:23–19:25; ECC 2:5; EZK 47:12; MIC 7:1; REV 22:1–22:2

Fruit as a symbol of spiritual growth

MAT 3:10, MAT 12:33

4452: gall**Gall is a bitter herb**

PRO 5:3–5:4 See also PSA 69:19–69:21; LAM 3:13–3:15, LAM 3:19–3:20

Gall was offered to Jesus Christ at the crucifixion

MAT 27:33–27:34

Gall is a secretion of the liver

JOB 16:12–16:13

4454: glean

Picking up grain or fruit left by the harvesters.

Commands concerning glean

LEV 19:9–19:10 See also LEV 23:22

People involved with glean

RUT 2:2–2:3, RUT 2:7–2:8, RUT 2:15–2:23; ; JOB 24:6

Gleaning used figuratively, to mean something insignificant

ISA 17:5–17:6 See also JDG 8:2; ISA 24:13; JER 6:9; MIC 7:1

4456: grain

The seed of cereals. Together with wine and oil, it was one of the three basic commodities in biblical times. Grain offerings were central to Israelite religion and tithes and firstfruits of grain were also given to God.

Grain was a basic foodstuff

DEU 7:12–7:13 See also DEU 11:13–11:15, DEU 28:49–28:51, DEU 33:28; RUT 2:14; 1SA 17:17, 1SA 25:18; 2SA 17:27–17:29; NEH 5:1–5:3, NEH 5:10–5:11

Harvesting and threshing grain

DEU 25:4 See also LEV 19:9–19:10; DEU 24:19; JDG 6:11; RUT 2:2–2:9, RUT 2:15–2:17, RUT 3:2

Storing grain

GEN 41:47–41:49 See also GEN 41:33–41:36; 2CH 32:27–32:28; PRO 11:26; JER 50:26; JOL 1:17; LUK 12:16–12:21

Tithes and firstfruits of grain

LEV 27:30 See also LEV 23:9–23:11; DEU 12:17, DEU 14:23, DEU 18:1–18:5; 2CH 31:4–31:5; NEH 10:37–10:39, NEH 13:12

The grain offering

LEV 2:1–2:16 See also LEV 6:14–6:23, LEV 23:15–23:16; NUM 5:11–5:28, NUM 15:1–15:12; 1KI 8:64

Barley as grain

The cultivation of barley

2SA 14:30 See also EXO 9:31; LEV 27:16; DEU 8:7–8:9; RUT 1:22, RUT 2:17–2:18, RUT 2:23, RUT 3:2; 2SA 21:9; 1CH 11:13; JOB 31:38–31:40; ISA 28:24–28:25; JOL 1:11

Trade in barley

HOS 3:2 See also 2KI 7:1, 2KI 7:16–7:18; 2CH 2:10, 2CH 2:15–2:16, 2CH 27:5; EZK 13:19; REV 6:6

The consumption of barley

EZK 4:9–4:12 See also JDG 7:13; RUT 3:15–3:17; 2SA 17:27–17:29; 1KI 4:28; 2KI 4:42–4:44; JER 41:8; JHN 6:5–6:13

Offerings of barley

EZK 45:13 See also NUM 5:11–5:15

Other kinds of grain

Corn

PSA 72:16 See also GEN 37:7; PSA 65:13; HOS 14:7

Millet

EZK 4:9

Spelt

ISA 28:24–28:25 See also EXO 9:22–9:32; EZK 4:9

Wheat

EZK 27:17 See also JDG 6:11; 2CH 27:5; PSA 147:14; JHN 12:24

Allusions to grain in the teaching of Jesus Christ

MRK 4:26–4:29 See also MAT 13:1–13:9 parallel MRK 4:3–4:8; MAT 13:18–13:23 parallel MRK 4:14–4:20; MAT 13:24–13:30, MAT 13:36–13:43; LUK 12:13–12:21, LUK 16:1–16:9, LUK 17:35; JHN 12:24

4458: grape

Fruit which grows in clusters on a vine. It was very widely cultivated in the Near East in biblical times and was used mostly for making wine.

The cultivation of grapes indicative of rich and fertile land

NUM 20:2–20:5 See also NUM 13:21–13:25

The failure of the grape harvest indicative of misfortune or disaster

ISA 32:10–32:13 See also JER 8:13; MIC 7:1; HAB 3:16–3:19

Grapes used to make wine

DEU 28:39 See also GEN 40:9–40:11, GEN 49:10–49:12; MIC 6:15

Treading grapes

AMO 9:13 See also JDG 9:27; NEH 13:15; JER 25:30

Harvesting grapes

JER 49:9–49:10 parallel OBA 1:5 See also LEV 26:5; NUM 13:20; ISA 62:8–62:9

Regulations concerning the grape harvest

LEV 19:10 See also LEV 25:1–25:7; DEU 23:24, DEU 24:21

Dried grapes: raisins

1SA 30:11–30:12 See also 1SA 25:14–25:19; 2SA 6:17–6:19 parallel 1CH 16:1–16:3; 2SA 16:1–16:2; 1CH 12:38–12:40; SNG 2:5; HOS 3:1

Nazirites were forbidden to consume grapes or grape products

NUM 6:1–6:4 See also JDG 13:2–13:14

The metaphorical use of grapes

JER 6:9 See also DEU 32:32–32:33; JDG 8:2; JOB 15:32–15:34; PSA 80:8–80:19; ISA 5:1–5:7, ISA 24:5–24:13, ISA 65:8; JER 48:32; HOS 9:10; JOL 3:12–3:13; REV 14:17–14:20

The proverbial use of grapes

MAT 7:15–7:16 parallel LUK 6:43–6:45 See also JER 31:29–31:30; EZK 18:1–18:2; 1CO 9:7; JAS 3:12

4460: grass

Green vegetation, which grows rapidly after rainfall, and serves as good food for many animals. The withering of grass in hot weather is often used in Scripture as a symbol of the frailty and brevity of human life.

Grass is food for animals

1KI 18:5 See also NUM 22:4; DEU 11:15; JOB 6:5, JOB 40:15; PSA 104:14, PSA 106:20; JER 14:5; DAN 4:25, DAN 4:32–4:33, DAN 5:21

Rain is essential for the growth of grass

JOB 38:25–38:27 See also DEU 32:2; 2SA 23:4; PSA 147:8; PRO 19:12; MIC 5:7

Grass grows quickly and abundantly

ISA 44:3–44:4 See also JOB 5:25; PSA 72:16, PSA 92:7; ISA 35:7, ISA 66:14

Grass withers, dies and burns easily

ISA 15:6 See also PSA 102:4, PSA 102:11; ISA 5:24; JER 12:4; REV 8:7

The life cycle of grass is short

PSA 129:6 See also ISA 37:27; MAT 6:28–6:34 parallel LUK 12:27–12:31

The brevity of human life is compared to that of grass

ISA 40:6–40:8 See also 2KI 19:25–19:26; JOB 8:11–8:13; PSA 37:1–37:2, PSA 90:5, PSA 103:13–103:19; ISA 51:12; 1PE 1:24–1:25

4462: grinding**Grinding using a hand mill**

EXO 11:5; MAT 24:41 parallel LUK 17:35 See also NUM 11:8; JDG 16:21 Samson doing a woman's work; ISA 47:2

Grinding grain into flour

NUM 15:20 See also NUM 15:21; 2CH 2:10; NEH 10:37; JOB 31:10; ISA 28:28; EZK 44:30

Grinding incense

EXO 30:36; ; LEV 16:12

Grinding as an act of destruction

DEU 9:21 See also 2KI 23:15

Grinding used figuratively

ISA 3:15 See also PRO 27:22

4464: harvest

The gathering of mature crops from the land. The successful culmination of the agricultural year was evidence of God's goodness and consequently marked with festivity. Harvest is also used widely in a metaphorical sense.

The harvest is evidence of God's goodness

GEN 8:22; 2CO 9:10 See also LEV 26:5, LEV 26:9–26:10; PSA 67:6, PSA 85:12, PSA 107:37; ISA 62:8–62:9; JER 5:24

Laws relating to the harvest

EXO 23:10–23:11, EXO 34:21; ; LEV 19:9, LEV 19:23–19:25, LEV 23:22, LEV 25:4–25:5, LEV 25:11–25:12, LEV 25:18–25:27; ; NUM 18:12–18:13; ; DEU 24:19–24:21

Harvest festivals

EXO 23:16, EXO 34:22; ; LEV 23:10–23:16, LEV 23:33–23:43; ; DEU 16:13–16:15

Harvest marked times of the year

RUT 1:22 See also JOS 3:15; JDG 15:1; ISA 6:13, ISA 12:17; 2SA 21:9–21:10, 2SA 23:13; JER 8:20

Characteristics of harvest**Rejoicing**

ISA 9:3 See also PSA 126:5–126:6; ISA 16:9

Hard work

PRO 10:5 See also PRO 14:4, PRO 20:4

Failed harvests are a sign of God's judgment**Poor harvests**

JER 12:13 See also ISA 17:10–17:11, ISA 32:10; JER 8:13; JOL 1:11; AMO 4:7; MIC 6:15; HAG 1:6

Others eating the harvest

JER 5:17 See also NEH 9:37; JOB 5:5, JOB 31:12

The metaphorical use of harvest

JOL 3:13; MAT 9:37–9:38; GAL 6:9; REV 14:15–14:16 See also PRO 18:20, PRO 25:13, PRO 26:1; ISA 17:5, ISA 18:4–18:5, ISA 24:13, ISA 28:4, ISA 33:4; JER 2:3, JER 51:33; HOS 6:11; MAT 13:30, MAT 13:39, MAT 25:24; MRK 4:29 the parable of the growing seed; MRK 12:1–12:9 the parable of the tenants; LUK 10:2; JHN 4:35–4:36; ROM 1:13; 1CO 9:10–9:11; HEB 12:11; JAS 3:18

4466: herbs and spices

Plants whose leaves or seeds are used as food or flavourings and sometimes for medicine. The rich variety of such plants in the Near East results in numerous references in Scripture.

Aloes

JHN 19:39–19:40 See also NUM 24:5–24:6; PSA 45:6–45:8; PRO 7:17–7:18; SNG 4:12–4:14

Balm

GEN 43:11 See also GEN 37:25; JER 8:22

Bitter herbs

EXO 12:5–12:8 See also NUM 9:9–9:11; LAM 3:15

Caraway

ISA 28:27 See also ISA 28:25

Cassia

PSA 45:8 See also EXO 30:22–30:25; EZK 27:19

Cinnamon

REV 18:11–18:13 See also EXO 30:22–30:25; PRO 7:17–7:18; SNG 4:12–4:14

Coriander**EXO 16:31** See also NUM 11:7**Cummin**

ISA 28:25, ISA 28:27; ; MAT 23:23

Dill**MAT 23:23****Henna****SNG 1:14** See also SNG 4:13**Mint**

MAT 23:23 parallel LUK 11:42

Myrrh**EST 2:12** See also SNG 1:13; MAT 2:11; JHN 19:38–19:39**Rue****LUK 11:42****Saffron****SNG 4:13–4:14****Salt herbs****JOB 30:1–30:5****Other spices****Given as gifts or as tribute****1KI 10:10** parallel 2CH 9:9 See also 1KI 10:1–10:2 parallel 2CH 9:1; 1KI 10:25 parallel 2CH 9:24**Traded between countries****GEN 37:25** See also EZK 27:22; REV 18:11–18:13**Used in burial customs****2CH 16:14** See also MRK 16:1 parallel LUK 23:56–24:1; JHN 19:40**Used for perfume or flavouring****EXO 30:34–30:35** See also PSA 75:8; SNG 4:10; EZK 24:10**Stores of spices****2CH 32:27** See also 2KI 20:13 parallel ISA 39:2; 1CH 9:29–9:30**4468: horticulture**

The art of garden cultivation, first practised in the Garden of Eden.

Horticulture in the Garden of Eden**The man and woman tended the garden****GEN 2:15–2:23**

The fall brought about a change in human priorities from horticulture to agriculture

GEN 3:17–3:19 See also GEN 4:2**Egyptian agriculture is likened to horticulture****DEU 11:10–11:11****Horticulture is totally dependent on good irrigation****ISA 58:11** See also GEN 2:4–2:14, GEN 13:10; NUM 24:5–24:7; JOB 8:16; SNG 4:12, SNG 4:15; ISA 51:3; JER 31:12**Those who practised horticulture****Kings****ECC 2:5–2:6** See also 1KI 21:2; 2KI 21:18, 2KI 21:26, 2KI 25:4 parallels JER 39:4, JER 52:7; NEH 3:15; EST 1:5–1:6, EST 7:7–7:8; SNG 8:13**Common people****JER 29:28** See also JER 29:1–29:7; JHN 19:41**Gardeners****JHN 20:15** See also ISA 5:7; JHN 15:1**Kinds of horticulture****Vegetable gardens****1KI 21:2****Fruit gardens****AMO 9:14** See also GEN 2:16–2:17, GEN 3:1–3:3**Herb gardens****LUK 11:42** See also SNG 6:2; MAT 13:31–13:32 parallels MRK 4:31–4:32, LUK 13:19**Horticultural diseases and pestilence****AMO 4:9****4470: hyssop**

A plant closely associated with cleansing in the OT, being used extensively in rituals for purification.

Hyssop associated with cleansing**PSA 51:2–51:7** See also HEB 9:19–9:22**Hyssop in religious ritual****At the Passover****EXO 12:21–12:25****At the slaughter of the red heifer****NUM 19:1–19:10****In rites of cleansing****NUM 19:17–19:20** See also LEV 14:1–14:7, LEV 14:48–14:53**Hyssop as a well-known plant****1KI 4:33****Hyssop at the crucifixion****JHN 19:28–19:30**

4472: lily

Lilies admired for their beauty

LUK 12:22–12:31 parallel MAT 6:25–6:34 See also SNG 2:16, SNG 4:5, SNG 6:2–6:3

The metaphorical use of lilies

SNG 2:1–2:2 See also SNG 5:13, SNG 7:2; HOS 14:5

Ornamental representations of lilies adorned Solomon's temple

1KI 7:19 See also 1KI 7:22, 1KI 7:25–7:26 parallel 2CH 4:4–4:5

Lilies mentioned in some titles of tunes in the Psalms

PSA 69:0 See also PSA 45:0, PSA 60:0, PSA 80:0

4474: manna

The source of food provided miraculously for the children of Israel during their desert wanderings. The NT sees this heavenly food as a symbol of Jesus Christ as the bread of life.

Manna provided by God

EXO 16:31; JOS 5:12 See also EXO 16:32–16:35; NUM 11:6–11:9; NEH 9:15; PSA 78:24–78:25; JHN 6:31, JHN 6:49; HEB 9:4

Manna as a type

A type of the word of God

DEU 8:3 See also DEU 8:16; NEH 9:20; MAT 4:4

A type of Jesus Christ

JHN 6:50–6:51 See also JHN 6:32–6:35, JHN 6:47–6:48, JHN 6:52–6:58

A symbol of future blessing

REV 2:17

4476: meals

Food eaten at set times, on special occasions or following significant events. Sacrificial meals formed part of Israelite worship in the OT, as does the Lord's Supper for worship by believers in the NT.

Regular daily meals

Breakfast

JHN 21:12

Lunch

LUK 14:12–14:14 See also GEN 43:16, GEN 43:31–43:34; RUT 2:14; ACT 10:9–10:10

Evening meal

LUK 17:7–17:8 See also MAT 9:10–9:13 parallels MRK 2:15–2:17, LUK 5:29–5:32; MRK 14:3 parallels LUK 7:36, JHN 12:1–12:2; LUK 14:12–14:14

Royal meals

GEN 40:20 See also 1SA 20:18–20:34; 2SA 9:9–9:13; 1KI 4:22–4:28, 1KI 18:19; EST 1:1–1:12, EST 2:18, EST 7:1–7:10; MAT 14:6–14:11 parallel MRK 6:21–6:28

Meals of the poor

PRO 15:17 See also 1KI 17:10–17:16

Sacrificial meals

GEN 31:53–31:54 See also EXO 12:1–12:11, EXO 29:31–29:34; LEV 6:14–6:29, LEV 7:1–7:6, LEV 8:31, LEV 10:12–10:15; DEU 16:1–16:8; 1SA 1:3–1:8, 1SA 9:11–9:24, 1SA 20:28–20:29

Symbolic meals

MAT 26:20–26:29 parallels MRK 14:17–14:25, LUK 22:14–22:22 See also 1CO 11:17–11:34

Wedding and funeral meals

MAT 22:1–22:14 parallel LUK 14:16–14:24 See also JER 16:5; JHN 2:1–2:10; REV 19:6–19:9

Meals and hospitality

2KI 4:8 See also GEN 18:1–18:8, GEN 19:1–19:3; JDG 5:24–5:25, JDG 13:15–13:16; 1SA 28:24–28:25

Meals as occasions of fellowship

REV 3:20 See also PRO 15:17; LUK 5:29–5:32, LUK 7:36

4478: meat

The flesh of animals, consumed as food. In biblical times it was a luxury, eaten on special occasions, usually in the context of sacrificial worship.

Meat a luxury food

EXO 16:3 See also NUM 11:4–11:5; 1SA 25:11; ISA 22:12–22:13; DAN 10:3

Meat served to honoured guests

1SA 28:21–28:25 See also GEN 18:1–18:8; JDG 6:11–6:21, JDG 13:9–13:16; 1SA 9:22–9:24; 2SA 12:1–12:4; 1KI 19:19–19:21; PRO 9:1–9:6; ISA 25:6; LUK 15:20–15:24

Meat provided by God

1KI 17:2–17:6 See also EXO 16:1–16:14; NUM 11:4–11:34; PSA 78:17–78:31

Restrictions on eating certain types of meat

Unclean meat

LEV 11:1–11:47 parallel DEU 14:3–14:20 See also ISA 65:2–65:5

Other prohibited meat

GEN 9:4 See also EXO 21:28, EXO 22:31; LEV 19:26; DEU 12:23, DEU 14:21; 1SA 14:33–14:34; EZK 4:14, EZK 33:25; ACT 15:20, ACT 15:29, ACT 21:25

Eating meat in worship

The Passover lamb

EXO 12:1–12:11 See also EXO 12:43–12:49; DEU 16:1–16:8

Other sacrifices

EXO 29:31–29:34 See also LEV 7:11–7:18; NUM 18:14–18:19; DEU 12:27; 1SA 1:3–1:8, 1SA 2:12–2:16; JER 7:21; HOS 8:13

Non-consecrated meat

DEU 12:4–12:25

Allegorical and metaphorical references to meat

MIC 3:1–3:3 See also EZK 11:1–11:12, EZK 24:1–24:13

Varying convictions about eating meat

ROM 14:1–14:23

4480: milk

A common source of food and nourishment, associated with rich and productive land. The term is also used figuratively as a form of spiritual food suitable for those who have yet to reach maturity in the Christian faith.

Milk as a source of nourishment

DEU 32:13–32:14 See also GEN 18:8; JDG 4:19; 2SA 17:29; PRO 27:27; EZK 25:4; 1CO 9:7 illustrating the support of the ministry

Milk as an indication of prosperity and well-being

DEU 6:3 A frequent description of the promised land; **ISA 55:1** See also EXO 3:8; LEV 20:24; NUM 13:27; ISA 7:22, ISA 60:16; EZK 20:6; JOL 3:18

Laws concerning milk

EXO 23:19, EXO 34:26; ; DEU 14:21

Elementary Christian teaching likened to milk

HEB 5:12–5:13 See also 1CO 3:2; 1PE 2:2

Milk used figuratively

PRO 30:33 See also GEN 49:12; JOB 10:10; SNG 4:11, SNG 5:12; LAM 4:7

4482: millstones

Pairs of upper and lower millstones were used for grinding grain in the ancient East. Millstones were common features of the daily life of ordinary people.

Millstones as a means of earning a living

DEU 24:6 See also ISA 47:1–47:2; JER 25:10; REV 18:22

Millstones were heavy and burdensome

MAT 18:6 parallels MRK 9:42, LUK 17:2

Millstones as potential weapons

JDG 9:50–9:53 See also 2SA 11:21

Millstones in figurative use

JOB 41:24

Millstones as symbols of destructive force

REV 18:21

4484: mustard seed

A very small seed which grew rapidly into a substantial plant. It was used in parables by Jesus Christ to encourage the faith of the individual and to illustrate the growth of the kingdom of God.

The mustard seed and the faith of the individual

LUK 17:5–17:6 See also MAT 17:14–17:20

The mustard seed and the kingdom of God

MAT 13:31–13:32 parallels MRK 4:30–4:32, LUK 13:18–13:19

4486: myrrh

A resinous substance derived from certain trees and bushes native to the Near East. It was a valuable commodity and had a variety of uses.

Myrrh was traded by merchants

GEN 37:25 See also REV 18:11–18:13

Myrrh was presented as a gift

MAT 2:11 See also GEN 43:11

Uses of myrrh

In the sacred anointing oil

EXO 30:22–30:28

As a perfume

SNG 1:13 See also PSA 45:8; PRO 7:10–7:18; SNG 3:6

In beauty treatments

EST 2:12 See also SNG 5:5

As a painkiller

MRK 15:22–15:23

In embalming**JHN 19:38–19:40****The metaphorical use of myrrh****SNG 5:13** See also SNG 4:1–4:7, SNG 4:12–4:14, SNG 5:1**4488: oil**

Normally olive oil, which was in plentiful supply in Israel and in general household use. Its ritual uses included the anointing of priests and kings and ceremonial cleansing; in the NT oil was used to anoint the sick. As a sign of God's provision for his people, oil was associated with prosperity and gladness, and was a mark of spiritual blessing.

The production of oil

JOB 24:11 Olives were pressed either with a pestle and mortar or in a stone press; ; MAT 26:36 "Gethsemane" means "oil press", named after the stone presses associated with the Mount of Olives.

General uses of oil**As a necessary provision**

1CH 12:40; ; 2CH 11:11

As a fuel for lamps

EXO 27:20 parallel LEV 24:2 See also EXO 35:14 parallel EXO 39:37; NUM 4:9; MAT 25:1–25:10

Mixed with flour in baking**1KI 17:12–17:16** See also EXO 29:23; NUM 11:8**As an ointment****ISA 1:6** See also PSA 55:21; LUK 10:34**Oil for use in the sanctuary**

NEH 10:39 See also EXO 25:6 parallel EXO 35:8; NUM 4:16; 1CH 9:29; EZR 6:9

Oil used for ceremonial anointing**Instructions for making and using the anointing oil****EXO 30:23–30:33** See also EXO 31:11, EXO 37:29**Holy objects were consecrated by anointing with oil**

Jacob twice anoints a pillar at Bethel: GEN 28:18, GEN 31:13, GEN 35:14; EXO 40:9–40:11; ; LEV 8:10–8:11

Priests were ordained by anointing with oil

LEV 8:12 parallel EXO 29:7 See also EXO 29:21 parallel LEV 8:30; LEV 10:7, LEV 21:10–21:12; PSA 133:2; ZEC 4:12–4:14

Kings were anointed with oil

1SA 10:1 Saul; 1SA 16:13; ; PSA 89:20; 1KI 1:39 Solomon; ; 2KI 9:1–9:6 Jehu

Further ceremonial uses of oil**In ceremonial cleansing**

LEV 14:15–14:18, LEV 14:24–14:29

In offerings

At the consecration of priests: EXO 29:2; ; NUM 8:8; EXO 29:40; ; NUM 28:5; LEV 2:1–2:7, LEV 6:20–6:21; ; NUM 7:13; LEV 7:12 with the thank offering; ; NUM 6:15 at the completion of the Nazirite's vow; NUM 28:9, NUM 28:28; ; EZK 46:4–46:5

Oil was excluded from certain offerings

LEV 5:11; ; NUM 5:15

Oil used to anoint the sick**JAS 5:14** See also MRK 6:13**God's provision of oil****Oil as a sign of God's blessing**

DEU 32:13 See also DEU 7:13, DEU 8:7–8:8, DEU 11:14; HOS 2:8

Oil withdrawn as a sign of judgment

DEU 28:40 See also DEU 28:51; JOL 1:10; MIC 6:15; HAG 1:11

Renewed provision of oil following restoration**JER 31:12** See also HOS 2:22; JOL 2:18–2:19, JOL 2:24**The firstfruits of the oil harvest**

NUM 18:12; ; DEU 18:4; ; 2CH 31:5; ; NEH 10:37

Tithes of oil

DEU 12:17, DEU 14:23; ; NEH 13:12

Oil as a commodity for trade

1KI 5:11 parallel 2CH 2:10; ; EZR 3:7; ; EZK 27:17; ; HOS 12:1

Oil as a sign of prosperity

JOB 29:6 See also DEU 33:24; 2KI 20:13 parallel ISA 39:2; PRO 21:20; ISA 57:9; EZK 16:18–16:19

Oil associated with celebration

PSA 45:7 The joy with which God anoints his servants is likened to the oil which anoints the bridegroom in preparation for his wedding. See also PSA 104:15; ECC 9:8; ISA 61:3; MAT 6:17 Oil draws attention away from the fact that a person is fasting; HEB 1:9

Oil as a sign of honour

PSA 23:5 Oil was used to anoint the heads of honoured guests at a meal. See also PSA 141:5; LUK 7:46

4490: ointment

A liquid blend of aromatic substances, usually spices, used as a cosmetic and also as a medicinal balm. Lotions were applied to the body to refresh, to improve appearance and to give a pleasing fragrance. Balm,

especially from Gilead, was used to soothe pain and to heal wounds.

Preparation of ointment

JOB 41:31 One way of making ointment was to crush solid ingredients and boil them together in olive oil.

Preparation of the holy anointing oil

EXO 35:28 See also EXO 25:6 parallel EXO 35:8; EXO 30:23–30:25, EXO 30:33 The holy anointing oil was to be prepared only by those authorised to do so.

Ointments made from blended spices

2CH 16:14; ; SNG 3:6; ; LUK 23:56

Containers for ointment

ISA 3:20; MAT 26:7 parallel MRK 14:3; LUK 7:37

Uses of ointment

As a cosmetic lotion

RUT 3:3 See also EST 2:12; SNG 1:12; EZK 16:9 **PSA 104:15** See also 2SA 12:20, 2SA 14:2; ECC 9:8; DAN 10:3; MAT 6:17; EXO 30:32

To anoint the heads of guests

PSA 23:5 See also PSA 133:2 This may reflect the custom of anointing a guest with perfumed ointment which melted and ran down the face and clothes to produce a pleasing fragrance; LUK 7:46

To anoint the dead

MAT 26:12 parallel MRK 14:8 See also JHN 12:7; GEN 50:2–50:3, GEN 50:26; MRK 16:1 parallel LUK 24:1; JHN 19:39–19:40

Expensive ointments

MAT 26:8–26:9 parallel MRK 14:4–14:5 (Spike)nard was an expensive import from India. See also PRO 21:17; SNG 4:13–4:14; AMO 6:6 The use of expensive ointments was a mark of luxury; JHN 12:5

Ointment used in healing

Oil used to soothe and heal

ISA 1:6 See also PSA 55:21; LUK 10:34

Medicinal balm

JER 8:22 Gilead was famous for its healing balsam. See also 2CH 28:15; JER 46:11, JER 51:8

4492: olive

An evergreen tree native to the Near East. Also the fruit of this tree, for which it is cultivated. The fruit can be eaten or pressed to produce oil for food or other uses.

Olive oil

Olives pressed to produce oil

MIC 6:15 See also EXO 29:40; LEV 24:2; NUM 28:5

Olive oil in food use

EZK 16:13 See also NUM 18:11–18:13; DEU 8:6–8:9; 1CH 27:28; 2CH 11:5–11:11; JOB 29:4–29:6

Olive oil used in the tabernacle

LEV 24:2 See also EXO 25:1–25:7, EXO 30:22–30:33, EXO 35:4–35:9, EXO 35:28

Offerings of olive oil

EXO 29:38–29:41 See also NUM 18:12–18:13, NUM 28:3–28:8; EZR 7:21–7:23; EZK 16:19

Payment, tribute and trade in olive oil

1KI 5:10–5:11 See also 2CH 2:8–2:10, 2CH 2:15–2:16; HOS 12:1; LUK 16:1–16:8; REV 18:11–18:13

Olive trees

Olive trees cultivated for their fruit

HAG 2:19 See also GEN 8:11; DEU 28:38–28:40; 2KI 18:31–18:32; ISA 41:19; AMO 4:9

Wild olive trees

NEH 8:15 See also ROM 11:24

Olive trees in visions

REV 11:3–11:6 See also ZEC 4:1–4:14

Metaphorical references to olive trees

PSA 52:8 See also JDG 9:8–9:9; JOB 15:33; PSA 128:3; ISA 17:4–17:6, ISA 24:10–24:13; JER 11:16–11:17; HOS 14:5–14:6; ROM 11:1–11:36 the grafting of olive trees

Olive groves

EXO 23:10–23:11 See also DEU 6:10–6:11; JOS 24:13; JDG 15:4–15:5; 1SA 8:11–8:14; NEH 5:9–5:11, NEH 9:25; JHN 18:1–18:3

Olive wood

1KI 6:23–6:28 See also 1KI 6:31–6:35

4494: papyrus

A large plant growing in marshland, sometimes to a height of six metres.

Papyrus was used for making boats

EXO 2:3; ; JOB 9:26; ; ISA 18:2

Papyrus indicates an ample water supply

JOB 8:11–8:13; ; ISA 35:7 Papyrus growing in what was once desert depicts the blessing coming on God's redeemed people.

4496: perfume

Substances used to make perfumes

By blending ingredients

EXO 30:23–30:24, EXO 30:34

Substances used as perfumes

SNG 4:13–4:14 See also SNG 1:12–1:14, SNG 3:6, SNG 5:13; MRK 14:3; JHN 12:3

Perfume ingredients as traded commodities

GEN 37:25; ; EZK 27:19; ; REV 18:13

The attractive fragrance of perfume

Its tempting allure

PRO 7:17 See also ISA 57:9; EZK 23:40–23:41

Its pleasing fragrance

PRO 27:9; ; SNG 1:3, SNG 4:10

Fragrance used metaphorically

2CO 2:14–2:16 See also EPH 5:2; PHP 4:18

Examples of the use of perfume

As a cosmetic

EST 2:12 See also RUT 3:3

To give fragrance to clothes

PSA 45:8 See also SNG 4:11

In burying the dead

MAT 26:12 parallel MRK 14:8 See also 2CH 16:14; MRK 16:1 parallel LUK 23:56–24:1; JHN 12:7, JHN 19:39–19:40

Perfumers

Commissioned to make oil and incense for the sanctuary

EXO 37:29 See also EXO 30:25, EXO 30:33 The manufacture of the sacred anointing oil by unauthorised persons was forbidden; EXO 30:35; 1CH 9:30

Other references to perfumers

1SA 8:13 perfumers in the service of the king; ; NEH 3:8 Hananiah

4498: ploughing

Cutting up the furrows in soil and turning it up before work can be done on the land.

Ploughing as a way of life

1KI 19:19–19:21; LUK 17:7 See also 1SA 8:12, 1SA 13:19–13:21; JOB 1:14; PRO 20:4; ISA 28:24; EZK 36:9; AMO 9:13

Rules concerning ploughing

EXO 23:10–23:11, EXO 34:21; ; DEU 22:10

Ploughing used figuratively

JOB 4:8; LUK 9:62 See also JDG 14:18; PSA 129:3, PSA 141:7; ISA 2:4; JER 4:3; HOS 10:11–10:12; AMO 6:12; 1CO 9:10

4500: poison

A substance obtained from plants or animals that can cause illness, pain, disability or death. It is often used symbolically to refer to distress or bitterness.

Kinds of poison

Poison from plants, water or food

EXO 15:23; ; DEU 32:32; ; 2KI 2:19–2:22, 2KI 4:39–4:40; ; HOS 10:4

Poison from animals or reptiles

NUM 21:6; ; DEU 32:24, DEU 32:33

Poison used symbolically

To refer to distress

In these incidences God himself is portrayed as the one who brings such bitter experiences: JOB 6:4; ; JER 8:14, JER 9:15, JER 23:15

To refer to evil and its effects

JOB 20:12–20:16 See also DEU 29:18, DEU 32:32–32:33; PSA 58:4; PRO 23:32; ISA 14:29; JER 8:17; AMO 6:12; ACT 14:2; ROM 3:13; PSA 140:1–140:3; JAS 3:8; REV 9:5

4502: reed

A plant that grows in water

JOB 8:11 See also GEN 41:1–41:4, GEN 41:17–41:21; EXO 2:1–2:6; 1KI 14:15; JOB 40:21; ISA 19:6, ISA 35:7

Reeds are weak and fragile plants

MAT 11:7 parallel LUK 7:24 See also 2KI 18:21 parallel ISA 36:6; ISA 58:5; MAT 12:20; ISA 42:3

Uses of reeds

For fuel

JOB 41:20

As measuring rods

REV 11:1

The metaphorical use of reeds

ISA 9:14–9:15 See also ISA 19:14–19:15; EZK 29:6–29:7

4504: roots

The source and foundation of a tree or plant, anchoring it to the soil, usually found beneath the surface of the ground. Scripture contains literal, metaphorical and figurative references to roots.

Roots of trees and plants

JOB 30:4 See also JOB 14:7-14:9; MAT 13:3-13:6 parallel MRK 4:2-4:6; MRK 11:20-11:21

Jesus Christ as the “Root of David”

REV 22:16 See also ISA 11:1-11:5, ISA 11:10-11:12, ISA 53:1-53:3; ROM 15:8-15:12; REV 5:5

The metaphorical use of roots

Individuals and nations depicted as trees or plants with roots

JOB 29:18-29:20 See also JDG 5:14; JOB 8:11-8:19, JOB 18:5-18:17; PSA 1:3, PSA 80:14-80:15; ISA 5:22-5:24, ISA 14:30, ISA 37:30-37:32 the LORD’s sign to Hezekiah; JER 17:7-17:8; EZK 17:1-17:10, EZK 31:3-31:9 DAN 4:13-4:16, DAN 4:23-4:26 HOS 9:16, HOS 14:5; MAL 4:1; MAT 3:10 parallel LUK 3:9; MAT 13:18-13:21 parallels MRK 4:13-4:17, LUK 8:11-8:13 the parable of the sower; MAT 15:13; ROM 11:13-11:21

Sources and foundations described as roots

1TI 6:10 See also JOB 19:28, JOB 28:9; PRO 12:12; ISA 14:29; AMO 2:9; JON 2:6

Bitter roots

HEB 12:15 See also DEU 29:18

Roots as a symbol of stability and growth

Taking root

COL 2:6-2:7 See also 2KI 19:30; JOB 5:3; PSA 80:8-80:9; ISA 27:6, ISA 40:24; JER 12:2; EPH 3:14-3:19

Being uprooted

JOB 19:10 See also 1KI 14:15; PSA 52:5; PRO 10:30, PRO 12:3; JER 1:10, JER 12:14-12:15, JER 31:28, JER 45:4; EZK 17:9, EZK 19:12; JUD 1:12

4506: seed

The means of propagating life from one generation to another. Figuratively, the term illustrates principles of spiritual life and growth, especially in later parts of the OT and throughout the NT.

How seed was used

Seed for eating

GEN 1:29, GEN 42:1-42:2; ; NEH 5:1-5:2; ; ISA 28:28; ; ECC 11:6

Seed as an offering

LEV 23:15-23:21 parallel NUM 28:26-28:31; ; 2CH 31:5

Seed to measure value

LEV 27:16

How seed was appreciated

The presence of seed was a blessing

ZEC 8:12 See also GEN 8:22; PSA 67:6, PSA 85:12

The absence of seed was a curse

JOL 1:16-1:17 See also DEU 28:38-28:42

Regulations in the law concerning seed

DEU 22:9 parallel LEV 19:19 See also LEV 11:37-11:38, LEV 27:30

Seed used figuratively to illustrate kingdom life

To illustrate those ready to enter the kingdom of God

JHN 4:35-4:38

To illustrate birth into eternal life

1PE 1:23 See also 1JN 3:9

To illustrate the growth of the kingdom of God

MAT 13:31-13:32 parallels MRK 4:30-4:32, LUK 13:18-13:19 **MRK 4:26-4:29** See also MAT 13:24-13:30, MAT 13:36-13:43

To illustrate the growth of the church

1CO 3:6-3:7

To illustrate God’s word and people’s response to it

See also MAT 13:1-13:23 parallels MRK 4:1-4:20, LUK 8:4-8:15 the parable of the sower

To illustrate faith

MAT 17:20

To illustrate the principle that death comes before life

JHN 12:23-12:25 See also 1CO 15:36

To illustrate the resurrection body

1CO 15:35-15:38

God calls his people to sow seeds of righteousness

JAS 3:18 See also PSA 126:5-126:6; PRO 22:8; JER 4:3-4:4; HOS 10:12; 2CO 9:6, 2CO 9:10; GAL 6:7-6:9

4508: sickle

A cutting tool with a short handle used in harvesting grain. Early blades were made of wood lined with flint teeth; these were later replaced with curved iron blades. The cutting down of grain at harvest with a sickle is used as a symbol of God’s judgment.

Sickles used to harvest grain

MRK 4:29 See also DEU 16:9, DEU 23:25 Sickles were not to be used in another person’s field; 1SA 13:19-13:21; JER 50:16

Cutting down grain as a symbol of judgment

JOL 3:13; REV 14:14–14:19 See also ISA 17:5; JER 51:33; MIC 4:12; MAT 13:30

4510: sowing and reaping

OT references are mainly agricultural with regulatory laws covering crop production and festivals of thanksgiving. God's blessing was reflected in the harvest. The NT refers more to the spiritual sowing and reaping that takes place in the kingdom of God.

Regulations concerning the sowing and reaping of crops

Laws of purity related to planting

LEV 19:23–19:25; ; DEU 22:9

Reapers are to leave gleanings for the poor

LEV 19:9–19:10, LEV 23:22; ; DEU 24:19; ; RUT 2:2–2:3, RUT 2:15–2:16

Harvest celebrations

EXO 23:16 See also LEV 23:9–23:11, LEV 23:39–23:41; DEU 16:9–16:10, DEU 16:13–16:15

The Sabbath-rest for the land and its cultivators

EXO 23:10–23:11, EXO 34:21; ; LEV 25:3–25:5, LEV 25:11

Reaping a good harvest is a blessing from God

It is a consequence of obedience

GEN 26:12; ; LEV 25:18–25:22, LEV 26:3–26:5, LEV 26:10

It is a promise to the remnant of God's people

AMO 9:13–9:14 See also ISA 30:23, ISA 62:8–62:9, ISA 65:21–65:22; JER 31:5; ZEC 8:11–8:12

God's judgment on Israel is reflected in reaping a poor harvest

A poor yield of crops

LEV 26:18–26:20; ; DEU 28:15, DEU 28:38–28:40; ; ISA 5:10, ISA 17:10–17:11; ; JER 8:13, JER 12:13; ; HAG 1:6, HAG 1:10–1:11

The harvesting of one's crops by others

LEV 26:15–26:16 See also NEH 9:36–9:37; JOB 31:7–31:8; JER 5:17; MIC 6:15

Proverbs and poems of sowing and harvest

PRO 10:5, PRO 20:4; ; ISA 28:23–28:29

Moral and spiritual sowing and reaping

Good and evil

JOB 4:8 See also PRO 11:18, PRO 22:8; HOS 8:7, HOS 10:12–10:13; GAL 6:7–6:8; JAS 3:18

Sowing and reaping in the kingdom of God

MRK 4:3–4:8 parallels MAT 13:3–13:8, LUK 8:5–8:8 See also MAT 13:18–13:23 parallels MRK 4:14–4:20, LUK 8:11–8:15; MAT 13:24–13:30, MAT 13:37–13:39; MRK 4:26–4:29

The certainty of reaping

PSA 126:5–126:6; GAL 6:9

Reaping where others have sown

See also JHN 4:35–4:38; ROM 1:13; 1CO 3:5–3:9

Reaping a material harvest from spiritual sowing

1CO 9:9–9:11

People and nations are reaped for judgment

JOL 3:13 See also JER 51:33; HOS 6:11; REV 14:15–14:19

Metaphorical use of sowing and reaping

ISA 5:1–5:7, ISA 17:4–17:6; ; JER 2:3, JER 2:21; ; 1CO 15:35–15:44; ; 2CO 9:6–9:11

4512: staff

The staff was a basic item of personal property

It was carried at most times

1SA 14:27 See also GEN 47:31; JDG 6:21; HEB 9:4

It was carried by travellers

GEN 32:10 See also EXO 12:11; MAT 10:5–10:10 parallels MRK 6:7–6:13, LUK 9:1–9:6

It was carried by shepherds

MIC 7:14 See also PSA 23:4; ZEC 11:7, ZEC 11:10–11:14

The staff was sometimes a symbol of authority

GEN 49:10 See also GEN 38:18, GEN 38:25; NUM 21:17–21:18; JDG 5:14; 2KI 18:21 parallel ISA 36:6; MAT 27:28–27:30 parallel MRK 15:19

God's miraculous power was manifest through Moses' and Aaron's staffs

EXO 4:2–4:5, EXO 4:15–4:17, EXO 7:8–7:12, EXO 7:14–7:20 the plague of blood; ; EXO 8:5–8:6 the plague of frogs; ; EXO 8:16–8:17 the plague of gnats; ; EXO 9:22–9:24 the plague of hail; ; EXO 10:12–10:14 the plague of locusts; ; EXO 14:15–14:16 the parting of the Red Sea; ; EXO 17:5–17:13; NUM 17:1–17:10; ; HEB 9:4; NUM 20:7–20:13

4514: stick

Literal uses of a stick of wood

For fuel

AMO 4:11 See also 1KI 17:8–17:12; ZEC 3:1–3:2

For beating

ISA 28:27 See also 1SA 17:41–17:44

To extend one's reach**MRK 15:33–15:36** parallel MAT 27:45–27:49**Elisha and the axe-head that floats**

See also 2KI 6:1–6:7

As an expression of contempt**HOS 4:10–4:12** See also EZK 21:8–21:12**Sticks used figuratively****Symbolic use**

EZK 37:15–37:28

Dry as a stick**LAM 4:8****4516: straw****Uses of straw****As animal bedding and fodder****GEN 24:32** See also GEN 24:22–24:25; JDG 19:16–19:19; 1KI 4:27–4:28; ISA 11:7, ISA 65:25**In brickmaking****EXO 5:6–5:7** See also EXO 5:10–5:13, EXO 5:15–5:18**The lightness and fragility of straw****JOB 21:18** See also JOB 41:26–41:29; ISA 5:24**Straw is of little value****ISA 33:11** See also ISA 25:10; JER 23:28; 1CO 3:10–3:15**4518: sycamore-fig tree****Sycamore-fig trees were plentiful in Judea****1KI 10:27** parallels 2CH 1:15, 2CH 9:27 See also LUK 19:4**The cultivation of sycamore-fig trees****AMO 7:14** See also 1CH 27:28; PSA 78:47**4520: thorns****Thorns and thistles as the result of the curse of the fall****GEN 3:17–3:19** See also NUM 33:55; JOS 23:12–23:13; ISA 5:5–5:6, ISA 7:23–7:25, ISA 55:8–55:13; JER 12:13; HOS 9:6**Thorns and thistles as worthless weeds****HEB 6:7–6:8** See also 2SA 23:6; 2KI 14:9 parallel 2CH 25:18; MAT 7:16 parallel LUK 6:44; MAT 13:1–13:8 parallels MRK 4:1–4:8, LUK 8:4–8:8; MAT 13:22 parallels MRK 4:18–4:19, LUK 8:14**Thorns unpleasant and to be avoided****2SA 23:6–23:7** See also PRO 15:19, PRO 22:5; SNG 2:2; HOS 2:6**Thorns associated with burning****ISA 33:12** See also EXO 22:6; PSA 118:12; ECC 7:6; ISA 9:18, ISA 10:17, ISA 27:4**Thorns used as instruments of punishment****JDG 8:16** See also JDG 8:4–8:7**Thorns indicative of desolation and dereliction****HOS 10:8** See also PRO 24:30–24:31; ISA 32:11–32:15**Jesus Christ crowned with thorns****MAT 27:28–27:29** parallels MRK 15:16–15:18, JHN 19:2–19:6**Metaphorical use of thorns****MIC 7:4** See also EZK 2:6, EZK 28:24; 2CO 12:7**4522: threshing**

The process of beating out or separating grain from harvested stalks.

Threshing and the harvest**LEV 26:5** See also JDG 6:11; 1CH 21:20; 1CO 9:9; DEU 25:4; 1TI 5:18 Paul is adapting a humane OT law to the support of Christian workers.**Threshing implements****2SA 24:22** parallel 1CH 21:23 A threshing-sledge was a board studded underneath with sharp stones which was dragged by oxen over the wheat ears in order to separate the kernels. See also JOB 41:30; ISA 28:27–28:28, ISA 41:15**Threshing used figuratively****ISA 27:12; HOS 10:11** See also 2KI 13:7; PRO 20:26; JER 50:11; MIC 4:13**4524: threshing-floor**

The place where winnowing and threshing took place at harvest time.

The threshing-floor and agriculture

GEN 50:10–50:11; ; JDG 6:37; ; RUT 3:2–3:14; ; ISA 23:1; ; 2SA 6:6 parallel 1CH 13:9; ; 1KI 22:10 parallel 2CH 18:9; ; JOB 39:12

The threshing-floor as a symbol of harvest**DEU 16:13** See also NUM 15:20, NUM 18:27, NUM 18:30; DEU 15:14; 2KI 6:27; HOS 9:1–9:2; JOL 2:24**The threshing-floor as a symbol of judgment****ISA 21:10; HOS 13:3** See also JER 51:33; DAN 2:35; MIC 4:12; MAT 3:12 parallel LUK 3:17

A threshing-floor was the site of the Jerusalem temple

2CH 3:1 See also 2SA 24:16–24:25 parallel 1CH 21:15–21:26

4526: tree of life

One of two trees situated in the centre of the Garden of Eden. It is also mentioned in Revelation, where it symbolises life and salvation.

The tree of life in the Garden of Eden

GEN 2:8–2:17 See also GEN 3:22–3:24

The tree of life in Revelation

REV 22:1–22:2 See also REV 2:7, REV 22:14–22:15, REV 22:18–22:19

The tree of life as a metaphor

PRO 15:4 See also PRO 3:13–3:18, PRO 11:30, PRO 13:12

4528: trees

Large, woody plants with trunk, branches, leaves and roots, noted for their long lives. Scripture refers to many different varieties of tree.

God's creation of trees

GEN 1:11–1:12

Acacia

EXO 37:1–37:5 See also EXO 25:1–25:16, EXO 25:23, EXO 26:15, EXO 26:26, EXO 27:1, EXO 27:6, EXO 30:1, EXO 36:36, EXO 37:25, EXO 38:1; DEU 10:3; ISA 41:19

Almond tree

JER 1:11–1:12 See also GEN 30:37–30:39; EXO 25:31–25:34 parallel EXO 37:17–37:20; ECC 12:5

Almug-wood

1KI 10:11–10:12

Balsam tree

2SA 5:22–5:25 parallel 1CH 14:13–14:16

Broom tree

JOB 30:4 See also 1KI 19:3–19:4; PSA 120:4

Cedar tree

EZK 31:3 See also 1KI 4:33, 1KI 10:27; PSA 92:12–92:15

Cypress tree

ISA 44:14 See also GEN 6:14; ISA 41:19, ISA 60:13; EZK 27:6

Fig-tree

MIC 4:4 See also DEU 8:7–8:9; LUK 21:29–21:31

Fir tree

ISA 41:19–41:20 See also ISA 60:13

Myrtle

ISA 55:13 See also ISA 41:19; ZEC 1:8–1:11

Oak tree

JOS 24:26 See also GEN 35:4, GEN 35:8; JDG 6:11–6:19; 2SA 18:9–18:14; 1KI 13:13–13:14; PSA 29:9, PSA 56:1; ISA 1:29–1:30, ISA 2:12–2:13, ISA 6:13, ISA 44:14, ISA 57:5, ISA 61:3; EZK 6:13, EZK 27:6; HOS 4:13; AMO 2:9; ZEC 11:2

Olive tree

PSA 52:8 See also JDG 9:8–9:9; ZEC 4:1–4:14; ROM 11:24

Palm tree

NUM 33:9 See also EXO 15:27; 1KI 6:29, 1KI 6:35; 2CH 3:5; PSA 92:12; SNG 7:8; EZK 40:16, EZK 41:17–41:20

Pine tree

ISA 60:13 See also 1KI 6:15, 1KI 9:11; 2KI 19:23 parallel ISA 37:24; ISA 14:8, ISA 41:19, ISA 55:13; EZK 27:5, EZK 31:8; HOS 14:8; ZEC 11:2

Plane trees

GEN 30:37 See also EZK 31:8

Poplar tree

ISA 44:4 See also GEN 30:37; HOS 4:13

Sycamore-fig tree

1KI 10:27 parallels 2CH 1:15, 2CH 9:27

Terebinth tree

ISA 6:13 See also HOS 4:13

Willow tree

EZK 17:5–17:6

Great trees

GEN 13:18 See also GEN 14:13, GEN 18:1; DEU 11:30

Symbolic use of trees

As a symbol of permanence or long life
ISA 65:22

As a symbol of well-being
PSA 1:3; ; JER 17:8

As a means of execution
DEU 21:23; ; ACT 5:30; ; GAL 3:13; ; 1PE 2:24

As bearers of fruit
MAT 3:10, MAT 7:17–7:19, MAT 12:33; ; LUK 6:43–6:44

The trees of life and knowledge
GEN 2:9; ; REV 2:7, REV 22:2, REV 22:14

As an example of distorted vision**MRK 8:24****4530: unleavened bread**

Bread baked without yeast, often made because of insufficient time to prepare bread in the conventional manner. It was also eaten at the Passover Feast and was presented with sacrifices and offerings.

Unleavened bread prepared in haste**EXO 12:39** See also GEN 19:1-19:3; EXO 12:8-12:11; JDG 6:17-6:19; ISA 28:21-28:25**Unleavened bread eaten to commemorate the Passover**

EXO 12:1-12:20, EXO 13:3-13:7, EXO 23:15, EXO 34:18; ; LEV 23:5-23:6 parallel NUM 28:16-28:17; ; NUM 9:9-9:11; ; DEU 16:1-16:4, DEU 16:8; ; EZK 45:21

Unleavened bread presented to God as an offering

LEV 2:11 See also EXO 29:2-29:4 parallel LEV 8:1-8:3; EXO 29:22-29:25 parallel LEV 8:25-8:28; LEV 2:4-2:5, LEV 6:14-6:17, LEV 7:11-7:12; NUM 6:13-6:20

Symbolism of unleavened bread

1CO 5:6-5:8

4532: vegetables**Vegetables in general****PRO 15:17** See also DEU 11:10-11:11; 1KI 21:1-21:2; DAN 1:3-1:16; ROM 14:1-14:4**Specific vegetables****NUM 11:5** See also 2SA 17:27-17:29; EZK 4:9**4534: vine**

A plant on which grapes grow, cultivated primarily for making wine. Jesus Christ described himself as the true vine, the source of life and growth for all believers.

The vine as an image of peace and security**1KI 4:25** See also 2KI 18:31 parallel ISA 36:16; MIC 4:4; ZEC 3:10**Laws relating to the cultivation of vines****LEV 25:1-25:5** See also LEV 25:8-25:12**Wild vines****JER 2:21** See also 2KI 4:38-4:40**The destruction of vines as punishment****JER 8:13** See also PSA 78:42-78:47, PSA 105:27-105:33, PSA 80:16; ISA 7:23, ISA 16:8-16:9, ISA 17:10-17:11, ISA 24:5-24:7, ISA 32:9-32:13; JER 5:14-5:17; HOS 2:12; NAM 2:2; HAG 2:19**Blessing on vines****ZEC 8:12** See also DEU 8:7-8:8; JOL 2:22; MAL 3:11**Vines in dreams and prophecies****GEN 49:10-49:12** See also GEN 40:9-40:13**Vines in parables****JDG 9:12-9:13** See also ISA 5:1-5:2; EZK 17:1-17:10; JON 4:5-4:11**Metaphorical references to vines****PSA 128:3** See also GEN 49:22; DEU 32:31-32:33; JOB 15:31-15:34; SNG 7:8; ISA 34:4; JER 48:32; EZK 15:1-15:6; HOS 14:7**Israel is described as a vine****HOS 10:1** See also PSA 80:8-80:17; JER 2:21, JER 6:9**Jesus Christ is the true vine****JHN 15:1-15:8****4536: vinegar****Vinegar made from wine****NUM 6:1-6:4** See also RUT 2:14**Vinegar as an acid, reacting vigorously with alkaline soda****PRO 25:20****Vinegar as a substitute for wine****Its unpleasantness****PRO 10:26** See also PSA 69:19-69:22**It was offered to Jesus Christ at the crucifixion****MAT 27:48-27:50** parallels MRK 15:36-15:37, LUK 23:36-23:37, JHN 19:28-19:30 See also PSA 69:21**4538: vineyard**

A cultivated field or garden, sometimes surrounded by a wall, in which vines and other trees were grown. Israel is sometimes compared to a vineyard. Some of Jesus Christ's parables concern vineyards.

Vineyards were sometimes surrounded by walls**MAT 21:33** parallel MRK 12:1 See also NUM 22:24

Vineyards were associated with a settled, peaceful life

ISA 65:20–65:22 See also GEN 9:20; DEU 6:10–6:11; 2KI 18:31–18:32 parallel ISA 36:16–36:17; 2KI 19:29 parallel ISA 37:30; 2CH 26:10; NEH 9:25; PSA 107:37–107:38; SNG 7:12; JER 31:3–31:5, JER 32:15, JER 35:6–35:10; EZK 28:26; AMO 9:14

Vineyards were important for agriculture

2KI 25:11–25:12 parallels JER 39:9–39:10, JER 52:15–52:16 See also NUM 20:17, NUM 21:22; DEU 20:6; JDG 14:5, JDG 15:4–15:5; 1SA 8:10–8:14; 1CH 27:27; NEH 5:1–5:5, NEH 5:11; ISA 61:5

Vineyards were a sign of wealth

1SA 22:7 See also 2KI 5:26; PRO 31:16; ECC 2:4

Regulations relating to vineyards

LEV 19:10 See also EXO 22:5, EXO 23:11; LEV 25:3–25:4; DEU 22:9, DEU 23:24, DEU 24:21

The produce of vineyards not enjoyed by owner

DEU 28:39 See also DEU 28:30; AMO 5:11; ZEP 1:13

Naboth's vineyard

1KI 21:1–21:19

Vineyards in parables

MAT 21:28–21:32 See also SNG 8:11–8:12; MAT 20:1–20:16 the parable of the workers in the vineyard; MAT 21:33–21:44 parallels MRK 12:1–12:11, LUK 20:9–20:18 the parable of the tenants; LUK 13:6–13:9; 1CO 9:7

The metaphorical use of vineyards

EZK 19:10 See also JOB 24:6; SNG 1:14, SNG 2:15; ISA 3:14, ISA 5:1–5:7; JER 12:10

4540: weeds

Uncultivated plants or shrubs, growing wild, often among cultivated crops or plants. Jesus Christ used the image of weeds in some of his parables to illustrate sin and worldliness.

The presence of weeds indicates desolation and neglect

ZEP 2:9 See also PRO 24:30–24:34; ISA 5:3–5:6, ISA 7:18–7:25, ISA 32:11–32:15, ISA 34:8–34:14, ISA 55:13; HOS 9:5–9:6

Weeds are worthless

ISA 7:23 See also MIC 7:4; LUK 6:44

Weeds were a serious problem for the farmer

HOS 10:4 See also JOB 31:38–31:40; MAT 13:24–13:30

Some varieties of weed were painful to the touch

NUM 33:55 See also JOS 23:9–23:13; JDG 2:1–2:3; 2SA 23:6–23:7; EZK 2:3–2:6, EZK 28:20–28:24

Weeds were destroyed by burning

ISA 27:4 See also EXO 22:6; ISA 9:18–9:19, ISA 10:16–10:17

Weeds in Jesus Christ's parables

The parable of the sower and its explanation: MAT 13:3–13:8 parallels MRK 4:3–4:8, LUK 8:5–8:8; ; MAT 13:18–13:23 parallels MRK 4:13–4:20, LUK 8:11–8:15; MAT 13:24–13:30, MAT 13:36–13:43

4542: wheat

A cereal widely cultivated for use as food. One of the main agricultural crops in biblical times, it is referred to throughout the Scriptures and features several times in Jesus Christ's teaching.

The cultivation of wheat

Sowing wheat

ISA 28:24–28:25 See also JER 12:13; 1CO 15:37–15:38

The growth of the plant

EXO 9:31–9:32 See also JHN 12:24

The wheat harvest

1SA 6:13 See also GEN 30:14; JDG 15:1; RUT 2:23; 1SA 12:16–12:18; JOL 1:8–1:11

Threshing wheat

JDG 6:11 See also 1CH 21:18–21:28

The parable of the wheat and the weeds

MAT 13:24–13:30, MAT 13:36–13:43

Wheat as food

PSA 81:13–81:16 See also DEU 8:7–8:8, DEU 32:13–32:14; 2SA 17:27–17:29; PSA 147:12–147:14; JER 41:4–41:8; EZK 4:9–4:13

Offerings of wheat

EXO 34:22 See also EXO 29:2–29:3; EZR 6:9, EZR 7:21–7:23; EZK 45:13

Trade in wheat

EZK 27:17 See also AMO 8:4–8:6; REV 18:11–18:13

Wheat as payment or tribute

2CH 2:8–2:10 parallel 1KI 5:11 See also 2CH 2:15–2:16, 2CH 27:5; LUK 16:1–16:7; REV 6:6

Metaphorical references to wheat

MAT 3:11–3:12 parallel LUK 3:16–3:17 See also SNG 7:2; LUK 22:31–22:32

4544: wine

Drink made from fermented grape juice, often drunk instead of water in biblical times. Scripture recognises the richness of wine and its value in bringing joy to people; however, it condemns the excessive drinking of wine, and recommends total abstinence in some situations.

Offerings of wine

NUM 15:5 See also EXO 29:40; LEV 23:12–23:13; NUM 28:14; DEU 32:37–32:38; ISA 1:24; EZR 6:8–6:10

Tithes and firstfruits of wine

NEH 13:12 See also NUM 18:11–18:12; DEU 12:17, DEU 14:23–14:26, DEU 18:4–18:5; 2CH 31:4–31:5

Wine as a sign of blessing

GEN 27:28 See also DEU 7:13, DEU 11:13–11:14, DEU 33:28; 2KI 18:31–18:32; 1CH 12:40; PSA 4:7; PRO 3:9–3:10; JER 31:12; JOL 2:18–2:24, JOL 3:18; AMO 9:13–9:14

Lack of wine as a sign of God's displeasure

JER 48:33 See also DEU 28:38–28:51; ISA 24:7–24:9; JOL 1:10; HAG 2:14–2:16

Wine as an alternative to water

1TI 5:23 See also GEN 14:17–14:18; JDG 19:19; LAM 2:12; MAT 27:48 parallels MRK 15:36, LUK 23:36, JHN 19:28–19:29

Wine with meals

GEN 27:25 See also RUT 2:14; JOB 1:18–1:19; PRO 9:1–9:6; ISA 22:13

The pleasant taste and effects of wine

ISA 25:6 See also JDG 9:12–9:13; PSA 104:14–104:15; ECC 9:7, ECC 10:19; SNG 1:2–1:4, SNG 4:10, SNG 7:8–7:9

The dangers of drinking wine

PRO 20:1 See also GEN 9:20–9:27 Noah; GEN 19:30–19:38 Lot and his daughters; 1SA 1:13–1:15; 2SA 13:28; EST 1:10–1:12; ISA 28:1, ISA 28:7; HOS 7:3–7:5; JOL 1:5; NAM 1:9–1:10; ACT 2:1–2:21; EPH 5:18

The irresponsibility of wine drinkers

PRO 21:17 See also PRO 23:19–23:21, PRO 23:29–23:35, PRO 31:4–31:7; ECC 2:3; ISA 5:11–5:12, ISA 5:22–5:23, ISA 22:13, ISA 56:12; MIC 2:11

Abstinence from wine

LEV 10:9 See also NUM 6:1–6:21; JDG 13:2–13:7; JER 35:1–35:19; EZK 44:21; DAN 1:3–1:16, DAN 10:1–10:3; AMO 2:11–2:12; LUK 1:11–1:17, LUK 7:33

Stores of wine

2CH 32:28 See also 1CH 9:29, 1CH 27:27; 2CH 11:11–11:12; NEH 10:37–10:39

Wine stewards

EST 1:7–1:8 See also GEN 40:1–40:13; NEH 1:11–2:1

Trade in wine

JOL 3:3 See also REV 18:11–18:13

Jesus Christ's miracle of water turned into wine

JHN 2:1–2:11

Drugged wine

MAT 27:34 parallel MRK 15:23

Metaphorical use of wine

PSA 75:8 God's wrath is often pictured as a cup of wine to be drunk. See also GEN 49:11–49:12; JOB 32:19; PSA 60:3, PSA 78:65; PRO 4:17; ISA 55:1 quenching spiritual thirst; JER 23:9, JER 25:15, JER 48:11, JER 51:7 illustrating judgment and the moral decadence of Babylon the Great; REV 14:8–14:10, REV 16:19, REV 17:1–17:2, REV 18:3

Wine as a symbol of the suffering and death of Jesus Christ

LUK 22:20 parallels MAT 26:27–26:28, MRK 14:23–14:24, 1CO 11:25–11:26

4546: winepress

The vat in which grapes were trodden to produce juice for making wine. Scripture sometimes uses the image of treading grapes at the winepress to depict scenes of divine wrath and punishment.

Winepresses were widely used

DEU 15:12–15:14 See also NUM 18:25–18:27, NUM 18:30; JDG 6:11; 2KI 6:24–6:27

Treading grapes at winepresses

Literal references

NEH 13:15 See also JOB 24:11; ISA 16:10; JER 48:33

Metaphorical references

LAM 1:15 See also ISA 63:1–63:6; JOL 3:13; REV 14:17–14:20, REV 19:11–19:16

The association of winepresses with harvest

REV 14:18–14:19 See also DEU 16:13–16:15

Winepresses in vineyards

ISA 5:1–5:2 See also MAT 21:33–21:34 parallel MRK 12:1

Winepresses in place-names

JDG 7:25 See also ZEC 14:10

4548: wineskin

A container or sack, made from animal skin to hold wine. Jesus Christ used the image of old and new wineskins to explain the differences between himself and John the Baptist.

Wineskins used to store or carry wine

1SA 10:2–10:4 See also 1SA 1:24; PSA 119:83; JER 13:12–13:14; HAB 2:15–2:16

Old and new wineskins

JOB 32:17–32:20 New wine was stored in new wineskins, which expanded with the wine as it fermented. See also JOS 9:3–9:13

Wineskins as gifts

2SA 16:1–16:2 See also 1SA 16:14–16:20, 1SA 25:14–25:20

The parable of old and new wineskins

MAT 9:14–9:17 parallels MRK 2:18–2:22, LUK 5:33–5:39

4550: winnowing

The exposing of grain to the air by either tossing or fanning so that the loose outer part is blown away. It is also used figuratively to refer to God's judgment.

Winnowing took place at the threshing-floor

See also RUT 3:2

Winnowing used figuratively

JER 15:7; MAT 3:12 parallel LUK 3:17 See also PRO 20:8, PRO 20:26; ISA 41:16; JER 4:11, JER 51:2

4552: wood

Trunks and branches of trees used as raw material for various objects and as fuel for burning. Acacia wood was used extensively in the tabernacle and olive wood in the temple.

Various kinds of wood

Acacia wood

EXO 27:1 See also EXO 25:10–25:13, EXO 25:23, EXO 26:15–26:17, EXO 26:26–26:27, EXO 27:6, EXO 30:1–30:5, EXO 35:4–35:7, EXO 35:24, EXO 37:1–37:4, EXO 38:1; DEU 10:1–10:3

Cedar wood

LEV 14:48–14:53 See also LEV 14:1–14:7; NUM 19:1–19:8

Olive wood

1KI 6:23 See also 1KI 6:31–6:35

Cypress wood

EZK 27:3–27:6

Items made from wood

EXO 7:19 See also LEV 11:29–11:32, LEV 15:11–15:12; NUM 31:19–31:20, NUM 35:16–35:18; NEH 8:4; ISA 10:15; JER 28:13; EZK 15:2–15:3, EZK 41:22, EZK 41:25; 2TI 2:20

Wooden idols

DEU 29:16–29:18 See also DEU 28:36, DEU 28:64; JDG 6:26; 2KI 19:18 parallel ISA 37:19; ISA 40:18–40:20, ISA 44:13–44:20, ISA 45:20, ISA 48:5; JER 2:26–2:28, JER 3:9, JER 10:6–10:8; EZK 20:32; DAN 5:1–5:4, DAN 5:23; HOS 4:12, HOS 10:5–10:6; HAB 2:19; REV 9:20

Carpentry

EXO 31:1–31:5 parallel EXO 35:30–35:33 See also 2CH 2:13–2:14

Wood for burning sacrifices

NEH 10:34 See also GEN 22:3–22:13; LEV 1:3–1:17, LEV 3:1–3:5; 1SA 6:14; 2SA 24:22–24:23 parallel 1CH 21:23; 1KI 18:22–18:24, 1KI 18:30–18:38

Wood as fuel

EZK 24:3–24:5 See also PRO 26:20–26:21; ISA 44:13–44:20; EZK 15:1–15:8

Chopping and gathering wood

DEU 19:5 See also NUM 15:32–15:36; DEU 29:10–29:11; JOS 9:3–9:27; 2KI 6:1–6:7

Metaphorical references to wood

ZEC 12:6 See also JOB 41:27; JER 5:12–5:14

Symbolic use of wood

EZK 37:15–37:28 See also EXO 15:23–15:26

4554: yeast

A raising agent commonly used in bread. Bread that was required quickly was baked without yeast, as at the first Passover, commemorated annually in the Feast of Unleavened Bread. Although some non-meat offerings contained yeast, it could not be burned on the altar.

Unleavened bread was made without yeast

EXO 12:39 See also GEN 19:3; EXO 12:8–12:11, EXO 12:34; JDG 6:17–6:19; ISA 28:24–28:25

The consumption of yeast was prohibited during the Feast of Unleavened Bread

EXO 12:14–12:15 See also EXO 12:17–12:20, EXO 13:3, EXO 13:6–13:7, EXO 23:15, EXO 23:18, EXO 34:18; LEV 23:6; NUM 28:17; DEU 16:1–16:4; EZK 45:21

Sacrifices burned on the altar were not to contain yeast

LEV 2:11 See also EXO 29:1–29:3, EXO 29:22–29:24, EXO 34:25; LEV 2:4–2:5, LEV 6:16–6:17, LEV 7:12–7:13, LEV 8:2–8:3, LEV 8:26, LEV 10:12; NUM 6:14–6:15, NUM 6:19

Some offerings contained yeast

LEV 23:17

Yeast as an image of the kingdom of God

MAT 13:33 parallel LUK 13:20–13:21

Metaphorical references to yeast as something evil

1CO 5:6–5:8 See also MAT 16:5–16:12 parallel MRK 8:14–8:21; LUK 12:1–12:3; GAL 5:2–5:12

4600: Living beings

- 4603: animals
- 4609: beast, the
- 4612: birds
- 4615: bull
- 4618: calf
- 4621: colt
- 4624: cow
- 4627: creatures
- 4630: dog
- 4633: donkey
- 4636: dove
- 4639: dung and manure
- 4642: fish
- 4645: fleece
- 4648: goad
- 4651: goat
- 4654: horn
- 4657: horse
- 4660: insects
- 4663: lamb
- 4666: lion
- 4669: locust
- 4672: manger
- 4675: nest
- 4678: pigeon
- 4681: ram
- 4684: sheep
- 4687: snake
- 4690: wings
- 4693: wool
- 4696: yoke

4603: animals

A category of living creatures that dwell mainly on the land, distinguished from fishes, birds and insects.

Scripture stresses that all animals are created by God and are subordinate to human beings.

4604: animals, nature of

As a class within the created order, their variety reflects God's generous giving. He makes human beings their stewards, though they themselves come into the category of creatures.

Animals in their profusion

GEN 1:24–1:25 See also GEN 7:1–7:3, GEN 7:13–7:16, GEN 8:15–8:19; PSA 50:9–50:11, PSA 148:7–148:10; ISA 43:20; EZK 36:11

Animals as illustrated by their variety

ISA 11:6–11:8 See also EXO 23:12 Ox, donkey; EXO 25:3–25:5 Goat, sea cow; LEV 11:4–11:7 Rabbit, pig; LEV 11:29–11:30 Weasel, rat; NUM 19:2 Heifer; DEU 14:4–14:5 Deer, gazelle, antelope; ISA 17:34–17:35 Sheep, bear, lion; JOB 40:15–40:24 possibly the hippopotamus; JOB 41:1–41:34 possibly the crocodile; PSA 58:4 Snake; PSA 105:30 Frog; SNG 2:15 Fox; ISA 13:21–13:22 Jackal, wild goat, hyena; ISA 51:8 Worm

Human beings within the animal creation

As part of creation

GEN 2:7; ECC 3:18–3:21 See also PSA 49:12

Significantly different from the rest of creation

GEN 1:26–1:27

Human beings as stewards of the animal kingdom

PSA 8:6–8:8 See also GEN 1:26–1:28, GEN 2:19–2:20, GEN 9:1–9:2; HEB 2:6–2:8; JAS 3:7–3:8

Animals as the objects of divine, and therefore human, care

GEN 9:8–9:10 See also GEN 8:1; EXO 9:4–9:6; 2KI 3:17; JOB 5:23, JOB 38:39–38:41, JOB 39:1–39:30; PSA 104:20–104:21; PRO 12:10, PRO 27:23; JOL 2:22; JON 4:11

Animals and Noah's ark

GEN 7:13–7:23

4605: animals, religious role of

Central to the OT sacrificial system, they were governed by strict laws within the Mosaic code.

Animals as defined by the Law of Moses

Animals for food

LEV 20:25–20:26 See also EXO 22:31; LEV 22:8; DEU 12:15–12:16, DEU 12:21, DEU 14:3–14:8; EZK 4:14, EZK 44:31; ACT 10:9–10:14, ACT 11:6, ACT 15:19–15:20

Animals dedicated to the LORD

EXO 13:1–13:2 See also LEV 27:9–27:13, LEV 27:26–27:28, LEV 27:32–27:33; NUM 18:15

Domestic animals

EXO 21:33–21:36, EXO 22:10–22:15; ; LEV 24:18–24:21

Relationships with animals forbidden

EXO 22:19; ; LEV 19:19

Animal carcasses

LEV 11:39

Animals in the context of Israel's sacrificial system**Used in various sacrifices**

LEV 1:1–1:2; PSA 66:15 See also GEN 8:20; LEV 3:1; NUM 7:87–7:88; DEU 16:2; 2CH 29:32–29:33, 2CH 35:10–35:13

Animals forbidden as sacrifices

MAL 1:8 See also LEV 22:24–22:25; DEU 15:21; MAL 1:13–1:14

Animals in the context of judgment**Involved in judgment**

ZEP 1:3 See also GEN 6:7, GEN 7:20–7:23 the flood EXO 9:22–9:25, EXO 13:15; PSA 135:8 JER 9:10, JER 12:4, JER 50:3; EZK 25:12–25:13; JOL 1:19–1:20; HAB 2:17; ZEC 14:15

As agents of judgment

LEV 26:21–26:22 See also EZK 33:27, EZK 39:4, EZK 39:17–39:18; DAN 4:31–4:32; HOS 2:12

4609: beast, the

In apocalyptic literature, symbol of the ultimate adversary of God in the great final spiritual battle.

Beasts represent rulers and nations opposed to God

DAN 7:3–7:7, DAN 7:11–7:12, DAN 7:17, DAN 7:19–7:23

The beast represents the antichrist in the final spiritual battle**The emergence of the beast**

REV 11:7, REV 13:1, REV 13:11, REV 17:3

The power and authority of the beast

REV 13:2–13:7, REV 13:12–13:15

Those who will worship the beast, and those who will not

REV 13:8, REV 13:16–13:18, REV 14:9–14:11, REV 16:2, REV 20:4

The defeat of the beast and the fulfilment of God's purposes

REV 16:10–16:11, REV 17:7–17:14, REV 17:16–17:17, REV 19:19–19:20

4612: birds

Part of the created world, used for food. In OT times they were also used in sacrifices. In Scripture, birds are used in many metaphors.

Part of creation

GEN 1:21 See also GEN 1:20–1:30, GEN 2:20; 1CO 15:39; JAS 3:7

Cared for by God

LUK 12:24 parallel MAT 6:26 See also JOB 38:41; PSA 50:11, PSA 147:9

To be cared for by humanity

DEU 22:6–22:7

Specific varieties of bird**Raven**

GEN 8:7; ; 1KI 17:4; ; SNG 5:11

Eagle

EXO 19:4; ; JOB 39:27; ; PRO 23:5; ; ISA 40:31; ; JER 49:16; ; EZK 17:3; ; DAN 4:33; ; HOS 8:1

Hen

MAT 23:37

Cock

PRO 30:31; ; MAT 26:74

Ostrich

JOB 39:13–39:18; ; LAM 4:3

Owl

PSA 102:6; ; ISA 34:11, ISA 34:15; ; JER 50:39; ; MIC 1:8; ; ZEP 2:14

Quail

EXO 16:13; ; NUM 11:31–11:32; ; PSA 105:40

Sparrow

PSA 84:3; ; PRO 26:2; ; MAT 10:29–10:31

Stork

PSA 104:17; ; JER 8:7; ; ZEC 5:9

Vulture

JOB 15:23; ; PRO 30:17; ; MIC 1:16; ; HAB 1:8; ; MAT 24:28

Birds of prey

DEU 28:26; ; 1SA 17:46; ; 1KI 16:4; ; ISA 18:6; ; JER 12:9; ; REV 19:17–19:18

Protected at the flood

GEN 6:20 See also GEN 8:17–8:19

Used in sacrifice

GEN 8:20 See also GEN 15:10; LEV 1:14, LEV 12:8, LEV 14:3–14:7, LEV 14:49–14:53; LUK 2:22–2:24

Used as food

DEU 14:11 See also LEV 17:13–17:14

Some not to be eaten

LEV 20:25 See also LEV 11:13–11:19 parallel DEU 14:12–14:18

Not to be used as an object of worship

DEU 4:15–4:17 See also ROM 1:23

Appearing in dreams and visions

GEN 40:17; ; ACT 11:6; ; REV 4:7, REV 12:14

Used metaphorically**Of freedom**

PSA 55:6 See also PSA 11:1

Of isolation

PSA 102:7

Of powerlessness

HOS 11:11

Of being trapped

PSA 124:7 See also PRO 6:5, PRO 7:23; JER 5:26; LAM 3:52; EZK 13:20; HOS 7:12; AMO 3:5

Of cruel invaders

ISA 46:11 See also DEU 28:49–28:50

Of an object of hatred

JER 12:9

4615: bull

Bulls were particularly prized as sacrifices on account of their considerable value. The sacrifice of a bull was especially associated with the sin offering.

Bulls offered as sacrifices

EXO 29:36; 2SA 6:12–6:13; ACT 14:13 Also used in pagan sacrifices. See also NUM 23:1–23:4; JOB 42:7–42:8; PSA 66:15; HEB 9:13

Instructions for the offering of a bull

LEV 4:13–4:21 See also LEV 1:3–1:9

Bulls sacrificed on significant occasions

NUM 28:16–28:20 The Passover. See also EXO 24:4–24:5 the covenant confirmed; EXO 29:10–29:14; LEV 9:2, LEV 16:11–16:14 the Day of Atonement; NUM 8:5–8:12, NUM 29:12–29:13; 1SA 1:24; 1CH 15:25–15:26, 1CH 29:21–29:22; 2CH 29:20–29:24; EZR 6:9–6:10, EZR 8:35; EZK 43:19–43:27, EZK 45:18–45:24

Godly sacrifices in contrast to pagan ones

1KI 18:22–18:24 See also JDG 6:25–6:28

Even the sacrifice of bulls invalid without the spiritual conditions being fulfilled

PSA 69:30–69:31; ISA 1:11 See also PSA 50:9, PSA 50:13; ISA 66:3; HOS 12:11

Provisional nature of the OT sin offering of a bull

HEB 10:4

The bull as a symbol of strength

DEU 33:17 See also PSA 22:12, PSA 68:30

Laws concerning bulls

EXO 21:28–21:36

Bulls in the design of the temple

1KI 7:25–7:29 parallel 2CH 4:3–4:4; ; 2KI 16:17; ; JER 52:20

Bulls in the setting of judgment

ISA 34:6–34:7; ; JER 50:27

Bulls and idolatry

PSA 106:20

4618: calf

A young animal prized as the source of tender meat, suitable for celebrations. However, it also had associations with both the OT sacrificial system and idolatry.

The association of the calf with idolatry

EXO 32:2–32:8; 1KI 12:28–12:29 See also EXO 32:19–32:24; DEU 9:16–9:21; 2KI 10:28–10:29, 2KI 17:16; 2CH 11:15; NEH 9:16–9:18; PSA 106:19–106:20; HOS 8:5–8:6, HOS 10:5, HOS 13:2; ACT 7:41

The sacrifice of calves

MIC 6:6 See also LEV 9:1–9:4, LEV 9:8–9:11; 2SA 6:12–6:13; 1KI 1:9–1:10; HEB 9:11–9:12, HEB 9:19–9:20

The flesh of the calf as a prized food

PRO 15:17; LUK 15:22–15:23 See also GEN 18:6–18:8; 1SA 14:31–14:32, 1SA 28:24–28:25

The metaphorical use of calves

JER 31:18; MAL 4:2 See also PSA 29:6, PSA 68:30; JER 34:18, JER 46:20–46:21

4621: colt

A young, untrained horse or donkey, associated in Scripture with humility or peace.

A colt is a young donkey

JOB 11:12 See also GEN 49:11

The use of a colt by the coming king

ZEC 9:9 See also MAT 21:2–21:7 parallels MRK 11:2–11:7, LUK 19:30–19:35; JHN 12:15

4624: cow

Cows, in OT times, often symbolised wealth and material well-being.

Cows as evidence of prosperity

JOB 21:10 Part of Job's complaint about the prosperity of the wicked. See also GEN 12:16, GEN 24:35, GEN 32:5, GEN 32:13–32:15, GEN 41:1–41:4, GEN 41:17–41:21, GEN 41:25–41:27; 2SA 12:2; 2CH 32:27–32:28; PSA 50:10 evidence of God's wealth; HAB 3:17–3:18 the believer's joy despite the absence of prosperity

In the history of Israel

1SA 6:7–6:14

Cows in God's new earth

ISA 11:7 See also ISA 30:23, ISA 32:20

Cows as a source of nourishment and fuel

2SA 17:29; ; EZK 4:15

Laws concerning cows

EXO 22:30; ; LEV 22:28

Cows in metaphors

Of stupidity

JOB 18:3

Of godless women

AMO 4:1

4627: creatures

Generally, living beings within God's creation, especially the exotic animals seen in visions, which often have a deep symbolic significance.

Creatures representing angelic beings who worship God

EZK 1:5–1:6; REV 4:6–4:8 The strange creatures of Ezekiel and Revelation seem to stand for the fulness and variety of God's creation. See also EZK 1:7–1:25, EZK 3:12–3:13, EZK 10:15–10:22 The creatures are here identified as cherubim; REV 4:9–4:11, REV 5:6–5:14, REV 6:1–6:3, REV 6:5–6:6, REV 7:11, REV 14:3, REV 15:7, REV 19:4

Creatures representing kings or kingdoms

DAN 7:17, DAN 8:20–8:21 The "beasts" here are unnatural, and represent the hostility of human empires to the rule of God. The horns represent individual kings within an imperial dynasty.

Creatures representing Satan

The beast here represents Satan, with the horns representing royal authority at a time of Roman persecution of the church: REV 12:3–12:4, REV 12:7–12:9, REV 13:1; DAN 7:2–7:8, DAN 7:19–7:26, DAN 8:3–8:12; ; REV 11:7, REV 13:2–13:8, REV 13:11–13:18, REV 17:3, REV 17:7–17:13

4630: dog

Although used by shepherds and occasionally kept as pets, in Bible times most dogs were semi-wild scavengers.

The animal

EXO 11:7; ; JDG 7:5; ; JOB 30:1

Dogs as scavengers

EXO 22:31; ; 1KI 14:11, 1KI 16:4, 1KI 21:19, 1KI 21:23, 1KI 22:38; ; 2KI 9:10, 2KI 9:36; ; PSA 59:6, PSA 59:14, PSA 68:23

Dogs as dangerous and bloodthirsty

JER 15:3; ; PSA 22:16, PSA 22:20; ; 2PE 2:22

Dogs in the teaching of Jesus Christ

MAT 7:6, MAT 15:26–15:27 parallel MRK 7:27–7:28 See also LUK 16:21

Dogs in proverbs

PRO 26:11, PRO 26:17; ; ECC 9:4

Dogs used as a term of abuse or low esteem

1SA 17:43, 1SA 24:14; ; 2SA 9:8, 2SA 16:9; ; 2KI 8:13; ; ISA 56:10–56:11; ; PHP 3:2; ; REV 22:15

4633: donkey

A beast of burden, used to carry both goods and people.

Used for carrying goods

1SA 16:20 See also GEN 22:3–22:5, GEN 42:27; EXO 23:12 parallel DEU 5:14 As beasts of burden they were afforded rest on the Sabbath.

Used for personal transport

1SA 25:20; MAT 21:7 See also EXO 4:20 NUM 22:22; 2PE 2:16 JOS 15:18; JDG 19:28; 2SA 17:23, 2SA 19:26; 1KI 13:23–13:29; ZEC 9:9; MAT 21:5; LUK 10:34; JHN 12:14

The value of donkeys

EXO 22:4 See also EXO 20:17 parallel DEU 5:21; EXO 22:9; NUM 16:15; DEU 22:3–22:4; 1SA 12:3; JOB 24:3; LUK 13:15

Mistreatment of donkeys

NUM 22:23 See also DEU 22:10

Sometimes found in the wild

JOB 39:5 See also JOB 6:5; JER 2:24; HOS 8:9

Figurative use of the donkey**GEN 16:12** See also GEN 49:14; 2KI 6:25; ISA 1:3; JER 22:19**Samson and the donkey's jaw-bone**

JDG 15:15–15:16

4636: dove

A common species of bird. In Scripture the dove symbolises the Spirit of God, and also certain kinds of human behaviour.

A kind of bird

GEN 8:8–8:12; ; SNG 2:12; ; JER 8:7

Doves as sacrifices for those who were poor

LEV 5:7 See also GEN 15:9; LEV 1:14, LEV 5:11, LEV 12:6–12:8, LEV 14:22, LEV 14:30, LEV 15:14, LEV 15:29; NUM 6:10; MAT 21:12 parallel MRK 11:15; LUK 2:24; JHN 2:14

‘Dove’ as a term of endearment

SNG 2:14, SNG 5:2, SNG 6:9

Israel as God's ‘dove’

PSA 68:13, PSA 74:19

‘Dove’ used figuratively

PSA 55:6; ; SNG 1:15, SNG 4:1, SNG 5:12; ; ISA 38:14, ISA 59:11; ; JER 48:28; ; EZK 7:16; ; HOS 7:11, HOS 11:11; ; NAM 2:7; ; MAT 10:16

The dove as a symbol of the Spirit of God**MAT 3:16** parallels MRK 1:10, LUK 3:22, JHN 1:32–1:34**4639: dung and manure****Human dung is considered unclean**

See also DEU 23:12–23:14; EZK 4:12–4:14

The Dung Gate of Jerusalem

NEH 2:13, NEH 3:13–3:14, NEH 12:31

Uses of manure**As fertiliser**

LUK 13:8, LUK 14:35

As fuel

EZK 4:15

Symbolic references to dung**As fuel**

1KI 14:10

As something perishable

JOB 20:7

As something trampled down

ISA 25:10

As something worthless

PHP 3:8

4642: fish

A basic ingredient of diet in biblical times. Fishing was regarded as a trade rather than a recreation.

Fish as part of God's creation

GEN 1:20–1:22 See also GEN 1:26, GEN 9:2; 1KI 4:33; PSA 8:8; 1CO 15:39

Fish as food

MAT 7:9–7:10 parallel LUK 11:11 **MAT 14:17** parallels MRK 6:38, LUK 9:16, JHN 6:9 See also NUM 11:5; NEH 13:16; MAT 15:34 parallel MRK 8:7; LUK 24:42; JHN 21:13

Rules about eating fish

LEV 11:9–11:12; ; DEU 14:9–14:10

Fish related to judgment

EXO 7:18; ISA 19:8 See also PSA 105:29; ISA 50:2; HOS 4:3; ZEP 1:3

Fish as the object of pagan worship

DEU 4:15–4:18 See also JDG 16:23 Dagon was the fish god.

Fish involved in miracles

JON 1:17; LUK 5:4–5:7 See also MAT 14:19–14:21 parallels MRK 6:39–6:44, LUK 9:14–9:17, JHN 6:10–6:13; MAT 15:35–15:38 parallel MRK 8:7–8:9; MAT 17:24–17:27; JHN 21:5–21:6

Figurative uses of fish**Fish as a symbol of entrapment****ECC 9:12** See also EZK 29:4–29:5; HAB 1:14–1:17**Fish as a symbol of the kingdom of God****MAT 13:47–13:48** See also EZK 47:10**Fish as a symbol of the resurrection****MAT 12:40****Fishermen as the first disciples****MAT 4:18** parallel MRK 1:16**Figurative use of fishermen**

JER 16:16; MAT 4:19 Describing the disciples' evangelistic role.

4645: fleece**The woolly covering of a sheep used as an article of clothing or for warmth**

See also JOB 31:20; HEB 11:37

Used by Gideon for reassurance that he was doing God's will

JDG 6:36–6:40

4648: goad

A spike used to drive animals on. The term is also figuratively applied to prompting and guiding people into action.

The goad as a farming implement

Used with animals

1SA 13:21

Used as a weapon

JDG 3:31

Goad as a symbol of discipline

God's word as a goad

ECC 12:11 See also ACT 2:37

Conscience as a goad

ACT 26:14 See also EXO 25:2; JOB 20:2; ROM 2:15

Encouragement as a goad

HEB 10:24 See also 1TH 1:3 The promptings of love and faith may be seen as symbolic goads.

People goaded into doing wrong

GEN 3:1, GEN 3:12; ; EXO 32:1, EXO 32:23; ; JOB 15:5; ; JHN 13:2

4651: goat

A common animal used both for food and within the sacrificial system.

The economic importance of goats

For food

GEN 27:9; JDG 13:15 See also DEU 14:4, DEU 14:21; JDG 6:19; PRO 27:27; LUK 15:29

For fabric

EXO 35:26 The tabernacle curtains were spun from goat hair, the ordinary material for making tents. See also EXO 26:7, EXO 36:14; REV 6:12

As a measure of wealth and payment

GEN 30:32; 1SA 25:2 See also GEN 32:5, GEN 32:13–32:14, GEN 47:17; PRO 27:26; EZK 27:21

Goats used in sacrifice

For worship

GEN 15:9; ; JDG 13:19; ; PSA 66:13–66:15

For atonement for sin

LEV 4:23; EZR 8:35 See also LEV 3:12, LEV 4:28, LEV 5:6, LEV 9:3; NUM 7:16, NUM 7:22, NUM 7:28, NUM 15:27

As a fellowship offering

NUM 7:17, NUM 7:23, NUM 7:29

At the dedication of the temple

1KI 8:63 parallel 2CH 7:5 See also 2CH 30:24; EZR 6:17

Flawless goats were required

EXO 12:5 See also LEV 1:10; EZK 43:22

The sacrifice of goats is unable to actually remove sins

ISA 1:11 In spite of their many sacrifices there was no evidence of repentance; ; HEB 9:12–9:14, HEB 10:3–10:4

Goats are symbolic of sinful humanity

MAT 25:32

4654: horn

The hard, pointed growth on the heads of certain animals; a projection resembling such a growth. The horns of animals were regarded as symbols of strength. In apocalyptic writings, horns may denote various powers and enemies of God. Altars were made with horn-like corner projections.

Horns of animals

See also GEN 22:13; LEV 11:16; DEU 14:15; PSA 22:21, PSA 69:31

Uses of animal horns

As musical instruments

EXO 19:13; ; JOS 6:4; ; 1CH 15:28; ; 2CH 15:14; ; PSA 81:3, PSA 98:6; ; DAN 3:5, DAN 3:7, DAN 3:10, DAN 3:15; ; HOS 5:8

As oil containers

1SA 16:1, 1SA 16:13; ; 1KI 1:39

Uses of imitation horns

As projections at corners of altars

EXO 27:2, EXO 29:12, EXO 30:2–30:3, EXO 30:10, EXO 37:25–37:26, EXO 38:2; ; LEV 4:7, LEV 4:18, LEV 4:25, LEV 4:30, LEV 4:34, LEV 8:15, LEV 9:9, LEV 16:18; ; 1KI 1:50–1:51, 1KI 2:28; ; PSA 118:27; ; JER 17:1; ; EZK 43:15, EZK 43:20; ; AMO 3:14; ; REV 9:13

As prophetic signs

1KI 22:11 parallel 2CH 18:10

Horns as symbols of strength

Describing God's saving power

2SA 22:2–22:3 parallel PSA 18:2 See also LUK 1:69

Describing human strength

DEU 33:17 See also 1SA 2:1, 1SA 2:10; PSA 75:10, PSA 89:17, PSA 89:24, PSA 92:10, PSA 112:9, PSA 132:17, PSA 148:14; JER 48:25; LAM 2:3, LAM 2:17; EZK 29:21, EZK 34:21; MIC 4:13

Symbolising the power of world rulers and enemies of God

DAN 7:7–7:25, DAN 8:3–8:4, DAN 8:5–8:11, DAN 8:19–8:22; ; ZEC 1:18–1:21; ; REV 12:3–12:9, REV 13:1–13:6, REV 13:11–13:14, REV 17:3–17:8, REV 17:12–17:17

Symbolising the power of Jesus Christ REV 5:6

4657: horse

The animal most commonly associated with war and battle, the horse also appears figuratively in poetic and prophetic literature. Its domesticated usage was mainly for personal travel and the haulage of heavy loads.

The military use of horses

EXO 15:1; JOS 11:4; 2KI 6:14–6:15 EXO 14:9, EXO 14:28; ; DEU 11:4; ; ISA 43:16–43:17; 1KI 20:1, 1KI 20:20–20:21; JOB 39:19–39:25; ; PSA 76:6; ; ISA 5:28; ; JER 4:13, JER 46:9, JER 51:21; ; EZK 38:4; ; HAB 1:8

Disabling horses in wartime

JOS 11:6 See also JOS 11:9; 2SA 8:4 parallel 1CH 18:4; MIC 5:10

Warnings against reliance on horses

ISA 31:1 See also DEU 17:16; PSA 20:7, PSA 33:17, PSA 147:10

The ritual use of horses

EST 6:7–6:9 See also 1SA 8:11; 2SA 15:1; JER 22:4

Horses as a means of exchange and a measure of wealth

GEN 47:17; 1KI 4:26 See also 1KI 9:19, 1KI 10:25–10:26 parallel 2CH 1:14; 2CH 9:28; ISA 2:7

Horses as a means of transport and for the haulage of loads

2KI 5:9 See also 2KI 14:20 parallel 2CH 25:28; EST 8:10, EST 8:14; ISA 21:7, ISA 21:9, ISA 66:20

Harness and tackle for horses

PSA 32:9 See also 2KI 19:28; JOB 41:13; ISA 30:28, ISA 37:29; REV 14:20

The figurative and prophetic use of horse imagery

JAS 3:2–3:3; REV 19:11 See also 2KI 13:14; ISA 28:28; JOL 2:4; ZEC 1:6–1:8; REV 6:1–6:8, REV 9:17, REV 19:14

Heavenly horses

2KI 2:11 See also 2KI 6:17, 2KI 7:6

4660: insects

A wide variety of insects are mentioned in Scripture. Some are useful in the provision of food, while others are viciously destructive. Their behaviour is used figuratively in the poetic and prophetic literature.

Regulations concerning insects as food

LEV 11:20–11:23 See also DEU 14:19

Kinds of insect

The ant

PRO 6:6 See also PRO 30:25

The bee

JDG 14:8 See also DEU 1:44; PSA 118:12; ISA 7:18

The flea

1SA 24:14, 1SA 26:20

The fly

EXO 8:24 See also EXO 8:21–8:22, EXO 8:29–8:31; PSA 78:45; ECC 10:1; ISA 51:6

The gnat

EXO 8:16; MAT 23:24 See also EXO 8:17–8:18; PSA 105:31

The grasshopper

ISA 40:22 See also NUM 13:33; 1KI 8:37 parallel 2CH 6:28; PSA 105:34; ECC 12:5; NAM 3:15

The hornet

EXO 23:28; ; DEU 7:20; ; JOS 24:12

The locust

JOL 2:25; MAT 3:4 parallel MRK 1:6 See also EXO 10:12–10:14; PSA 78:46; PRO 30:27; JER 46:23

The moth

JOB 13:28; MAT 6:19–6:20 See also JOB 4:19, JOB 27:18; PSA 39:11; ISA 50:9, ISA 51:8; HOS 5:12; LUK 12:33; JAS 5:2

The spider

Although not strictly an insect the spider is most conveniently included under this category: JOB 8:14; ; ISA 59:5

4663: lamb

A common source of clothing and meat, this animal was given heightened significance by its place in the

Jewish sacrificial system and was used figuratively of Jesus Christ.

The economic importance of lambs

As food

2SA 12:4 See also DEU 28:4; AMO 6:4

As a means of exchange

GEN 30:32 See also 2KI 3:4

The sacrificial significance of lambs

Their general use

GEN 22:7 See also EXO 29:38; LEV 3:7, LEV 14:12, LEV 14:24; ISA 7:9

The Passover lamb

EXO 12:21 See also EXO 12:3, EXO 12:7; 2CH 30:15–30:17; EZR 6:20; LUK 22:7

The best had to be chosen

NUM 6:14 See also LEV 4:32, LEV 23:12; NUM 28:3–28:4, NUM 28:11; EZK 46:4

They were costly

LEV 12:8 See also EXO 34:20

The figurative use of lambs

In general

PSA 114:4; LUK 10:3 See also ISA 40:11, ISA 65:25; JER 11:19; JHN 21:15

Describing Jesus Christ and his work

JHN 1:36; 1PE 1:18–1:19 See also ACT 8:32; ISA 53:7; 1CO 5:7; REV 5:12, REV 22:3

4666: lion

An important animal in the natural history of Palestine; a symbol of power and strength.

Lions seen as a threat to life

DAN 6:7 See also JDG 14:5; 1KI 13:24–13:28, 1KI 20:36; DAN 6:24

God's deliverance from lions

DAN 6:22 See also 1SA 17:34–17:37; 2TI 4:17; HEB 11:33

The figurative use of lions

As powerful

JOB 10:16 See also GEN 49:9; PSA 22:13, PSA 22:21

As cunning

PSA 10:9 See also PSA 17:12; LAM 3:10

As fearsome

JER 12:8, JER 51:38

As voracious

PSA 7:2 See also PSA 35:17, PSA 57:4; JER 2:30; ZEP 3:3

They are not invincible

PSA 34:10 See also JOB 4:10–4:11; PSA 58:6, PSA 91:13

Jesus Christ is likened to a lion

REV 5:5

Satan is likened to a lion

1PE 5:8

The lion in God's new creation

ISA 11:6 See also ISA 65:25

Lions as a decoration

1KI 7:29, 1KI 7:36, 1KI 10:20

Samson's riddle concerning a lion

JDG 14:12–14:18

4669: locust

The most destructive of all biblical insects, also used figuratively as a devouring pest.

There was no defence against locusts

JOL 2:4–2:5 See also PRO 30:27

Locusts were frequently a sign of God's judgment

DEU 28:38; AMO 4:9 EXO 10:4, EXO 10:12–10:14, EXO 10:19; DEU 28:42 curses for disobedience; ; 1KI 8:37 parallel 2CH 6:28; ; 2CH 7:13–7:14; ; PSA 78:46, PSA 105:34; ; JOL 1:4, JOL 2:25; ; AMO 7:1

Locusts were a source of food

LEV 11:22 See also MAT 3:4 parallel MRK 1:6

Locusts used figuratively

Of numerous and destructive invaders

JDG 7:12; ISA 33:4 See also JDG 6:5; JER 46:23, JER 51:14, JER 51:27; NAM 3:15–3:17

Of terrifying end-time activity

REV 9:3 See also REV 9:7

4672: manger

A feeding trough in a stable or stall, filled with fodder for donkeys, oxen, etc. The term is also used to refer to the stall in which animals were kept. The newborn Jesus was laid in a manger because there was no room at an inn.

A feeding place for livestock

Recognised by the animals of the household

ISA 1:3 Israel is like a wild animal which does not recognise or accept God's provision. See also JOB 39:9

Provision for farm animals

PRO 14:4 See also PRO 12:10; ISA 30:24

Provision for beasts of burden

GEN 24:32 See also GEN 24:25, GEN 42:27; JDG 19:19

Jesus Christ laid in a manger

LUK 2:7 See also LUK 2:12, LUK 2:16

Farm animals kept in stalls

Cattle kept in stalls

1KI 4:23 See also 2CH 32:28; PSA 50:9; HAB 3:17; MAL 4:2

Other animals kept in stalls

1KI 4:26 parallel 2CH 9:25; ; LUK 13:15

4675: nest

The nest as the home of a bird rearing its young

PSA 84:3 See also DEU 22:6–22:7; JOB 39:27–39:30; PSA 104:12, PSA 104:17; ISA 34:11, ISA 34:15; JER 48:28; EZK 17:23

The nest as a place of security

MAT 8:20 parallel LUK 9:58 See also DEU 32:10–32:11; PRO 27:8; HAB 2:9

The nest may not always be safe

ISA 10:14 See also NUM 24:21–24:22; ISA 16:2; JER 49:16; OBA 1:4

The nest as the home of the viper

ISA 11:8

4678: pigeon

A bird used, along with doves, for sacrifices, especially by those who could not afford lambs.

A pigeon offered as sacrifice

LEV 1:14 See also GEN 15:9; LEV 1:15–1:17, LEV 14:21–14:22, LEV 15:14, LEV 15:29; NUM 6:10

Pigeons offered as a sacrifice by the poor

LEV 5:7 See also LUK 2:22–2:24

4681: ram

The male sheep, part of an agrarian economy and used in sacrifice. Its skin had value and its horn was used in worship.

Rams as part of an agrarian economy

GEN 31:38 See also GEN 32:14; DEU 32:14; 2KI 3:4; EZK 27:21, EZK 34:17

Rams were used for religious purposes

As sacrificial victims

GEN 22:13 See also NUM 23:2; ISA 15:22; 1CH 15:26; MIC 6:7

In the making of a covenant

GEN 15:9–15:10

For guilt offerings

LEV 5:15 See also LEV 5:16–5:19, LEV 6:6, LEV 19:21–19:22; NUM 5:8; 2CH 29:21; EZR 10:19

For fellowship or burnt offerings

LEV 9:4 See also LEV 9:1–9:3, LEV 16:3–16:5; NUM 6:14–6:17, NUM 7:17, NUM 15:6–15:7, NUM 28:11, NUM 29:2; EZK 43:23–43:24, EZK 46:4

For Aaron's ordination

LEV 8:22 See also EXO 29:1–29:34; LEV 8:23–8:30

The ram's skin brought as an offering for the construction of the tabernacle

EXO 26:14 See also EXO 25:5, EXO 35:7, EXO 36:19

The ram's horn

PSA 81:3 See also EXO 19:13; JOS 6:4; 1CH 15:28; PSA 98:6

Daniel's vision of the ram

DAN 8:3 See also DAN 8:4–8:8, DAN 8:20

4684: sheep

Sheep were a major feature of ancient Israel's rural economy. Although they were of importance as a source of food and wool, they also symbolise helplessness and the need for guidance.

The economic importance of sheep

As a measure of wealth and God's blessing

1SA 25:2; PSA 144:13 See also GEN 12:16, GEN 30:43; EXO 9:3, EXO 22:1; DEU 22:1–22:2; JOS 6:21; 2SA 12:2–12:3; JOB 1:3, JOB 42:12

As a source of food

1SA 25:18 See also LEV 7:23; NUM 18:17–18:18; 1SA 14:32; 2SA 17:29; 1CH 12:40

As a source of wool

2KI 3:4 See also GEN 31:19, GEN 38:12–38:13; DEU 18:4; 1SA 25:7; 2SA 13:23–13:24; EZK 27:18

Sheep were used in striking a bargain

GEN 21:27 See also GEN 20:14, GEN 30:25–30:43

The care of sheep was a recognised occupation

ISA 16:11 See also GEN 29:2–29:3, GEN 37:13; ISA 17:34–17:35; SNG 1:7; HOS 12:12

Sheep were used in sacrifice

EXO 20:24 See also LEV 1:10, LEV 22:19, LEV 22:23; NUM 22:40; DEU 18:3; 1KI 1:9, 1KI 8:5; JHN 2:14

The symbolic importance of sheep**Israel without a leader**

1KI 22:17 See also NUM 27:16–27:17; 2SA 24:17; ZEC 10:2, ZEC 13:7; MAT 26:31

Helplessness

ISA 53:7; MAT 9:36 See also PSA 44:11, PSA 49:14; JER 12:3; MAT 10:16; ROM 8:36; PSA 44:22

Judgment

MAT 25:32–25:33 See also EZK 34:17

Sin

ISA 53:6; 1PE 2:25 See also PSA 119:176; EZK 34:16; MAT 18:12

The people that belong to God

PSA 100:3 See also PSA 74:1, PSA 78:52, PSA 79:13; JER 23:1, JER 50:6; EZK 34:11–34:15; MIC 2:12

Jesus Christ's care for his own

LUK 12:32; JHN 10:1–10:16, JHN 10:26–10:30 See also JHN 21:16–21:17; HEB 13:20

A picture of God's future blessings

ISA 5:17

4687: snake

A reptile, often associated with cunning and danger, or occasionally with satanic temptation.

Snakes as crawling reptiles

GEN 3:14 See also ISA 65:25; MIC 7:17

Snakes are dangerous**Both to animals and human beings**

GEN 49:17 See also GEN 3:15; EXO 4:3, EXO 7:9–7:13; PRO 23:32; ECC 10:8, ECC 10:11; ISA 30:6; ACT 28:3–28:6

Some are poisonous

ISA 14:29 See also DEU 8:15, DEU 32:33; JOB 20:14, JOB 20:16; REV 9:19

They were sometimes used to bring God's judgment

1CO 10:9 See also NUM 21:4–21:6; AMO 5:19, AMO 9:3

They may be overcome

PSA 91:13 See also MRK 16:18; LUK 10:19

One day they will be rendered harmless

ISA 11:8

Snakes used symbolically**Of Israel's enemies**

See also ISA 27:1; JER 46:22, JER 51:34

Of cunning and intelligence

MAT 10:16

Of something harmful

MAT 7:9–7:10 parallel LUK 11:11

Of the ungodly

PSA 58:4–58:5 See also PSA 140:3; MAT 3:7, MAT 12:34, MAT 23:33; ROM 3:13

Of Satan

REV 12:9 See also GEN 3:1–3:13; 2CO 11:3; REV 20:2

Of salvation

JHN 3:14–3:15 See also NUM 21:7–21:9; 2KI 18:4

4690: wings

Limbs which enable flight. In Scripture these are mainly used either of angelic beings or in various symbolic senses, especially of God's protection.

Wings of birds or insects

GEN 7:14; ; LEV 1:17; ; JOB 39:13, JOB 39:26; ; ISA 18:1

Clean and unclean winged creatures

LEV 11:13–11:25; ; DEU 14:11–14:20; ; ACT 10:12–10:15

Wings of angelic beings**Cherubim**

EXO 25:20 See also EXO 37:9; 1KI 8:6–8:7 parallel 2CH 5:7–5:8; 1CH 28:18; 2CH 3:11–3:13; EZK 1:5–1:25, EZK 3:13, EZK 10:5–10:22

Other angelic beings

ISA 6:2 See also ISA 6:6; REV 4:8

Wings as a metaphor of protection**Birds protect their young**

DEU 32:11; ; ISA 34:15; ; MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34

God's protection likened to a bird's wings

PSA 91:4 See also EXO 19:4; RUT 2:12; PSA 17:8, PSA 36:7, PSA 57:1, PSA 61:4, PSA 63:7; ISA 31:5

Egypt's protection likened to an eagle's wings

EZK 17:7 Zedekiah's fruitless appeal to Egypt for help against Babylon

Wings as a metaphor for God's judgment**Judgment on Israel**

DEU 28:49 See also ISA 8:7–8:8; EZK 17:3–17:4; HOS 8:1; HAB 1:8; ZEC 5:9

Judgment on others

JER 48:40, JER 49:22; ; REV 9:9

Other figurative uses of wings**God rides on the wings of the wind**

2SA 22:11 parallel PSA 18:10 See also PSA 104:3

God renews his people's strength

ISA 40:31

Israel described as a winged bird

See also PSA 68:13; ISA 10:14

Wings symbolise the ability to escape

PSA 55:6 See also REV 12:14

Wings symbolise instability

PRO 23:5 See also ECC 10:20

Wings symbolise strength

DAN 7:6 See also DAN 7:4

Wings of the dawn

PSA 139:9

Wings of the sun

MAL 4:2 God is likened to the rays of the sun.

4693: wool**Wool used for clothing**

EZK 34:3 See also LEV 13:47–13:48; DEU 22:11; PRO 31:13; ISA 51:8; EZK 44:17

Wool used in sacrificial ritual

NUM 19:6; ; HEB 9:19

Wool as a valuable commodity

2KI 3:4 See also DEU 18:4; EZK 27:18; HOS 2:5, HOS 2:9

Figurative use of wool

ISA 1:18 See also PSA 147:16; DAN 7:9; REV 1:14

4696: yoke

The wooden collar which joins two animals, usually oxen, to enable them to pull together. Used metaphorically the term may denote the partnership of those who share a yoke or, more usually, the subjection of those under a yoke. As his covenant partners God's people are yoked to him and he will break the oppressive yoke of their enemies.

Literal references to yokes

1SA 6:7; 1KI 19:19 See also JOB 1:3, JOB 42:12; LUK 14:19; NUM 19:2; DEU 21:32; SA 24:22; 1KI 19:21

God's yoke

JER 2:20 See also JER 5:5; **MAT 11:29–11:30**

The yoke as a symbol of partnership**Partnership in Jesus Christ's service**

PHP 4:3

Unsuitable partnerships

2CO 6:14–6:16 GEN 24:3–24:4; ; 1KI 11:4; ; 1CO 7:39; NUM 25:2–25:3; ; PSA 106:28; ; 1CO 10:18–10:21; 1CO 5:9–5:10 too close association with the immoral

The yoke as a symbol of subjection**The yoke of the law**

ACT 15:10 See also MAT 23:4; GAL 5:1

Israel under the yoke of enemies

DEU 28:47–28:48; JER 27:2 Jeremiah symbolically portrays the coming Babylonian exile. See also ISA 47:6; JER 27:8, JER 27:11–27:13; JER 28:2–28:4, JER 28:10–28:14 LAM 1:14, LAM 3:27; HOS 10:11

The yoke of other masters

GEN 27:40 Esau will throw off the yoke of Jacob.; 1KI 12:4 parallel 2CH 10:4; ; 1KI 12:9–12:11 parallel 2CH 10:9–10:11; ; 1KI 12:14 parallel 2CH 10:14; ISA 58:6, ISA 58:9; 1TI 6:1 Slaves are to respect their masters.

God breaks the yoke of oppression

EZK 34:27; HOS 11:4 EXO 6:6–6:7; ; LEV 26:13; ; EZK 30:18; ISA 9:4, ISA 10:27, ISA 14:25; ; NAM 1:13; JER 30:8 Babylon's yoke broken

4800: Natural and supernatural phenomena

- 4801: black
- 4802: blight
- 4803: breadth
- 4804: breath
- 4805: clouds
- 4806: cold
- 4807: colours
- 4808: crimson
- 4809: darkness
- 4813: depth
- 4814: dew
- 4815: drought
- 4819: dryness
- 4820: earthquake
- 4821: east
- 4822: famine
- 4826: fire
- 4827: frost
- 4828: hail
- 4829: heat
- 4830: height
- 4831: largeness
- 4832: length

- 4833: light
- 4838: lightning
- 4839: mildew
- 4840: mist
- 4841: narrowness
- 4842: north
- 4843: plague
- 4844: rain
- 4845: rainbow
- 4846: shadow
- 4847: smallness
- 4848: smoke
- 4849: snow
- 4850: south
- 4851: storm
- 4852: thunder
- 4853: weather
- 4857: west
- 4858: whirlwind
- 4859: white
- 4860: wind

4801: black

A dark colour often associated with impending judgment or with evil.

Black as descriptive of colour

MAT 5:36 See also EXO 10:15 the plague of locusts; LEV 11:13–11:14 parallel DEU 14:12–14:13 unclean food; LEV 13:31; DEU 4:11; 1KI 18:45; JOB 28:3, JOB 30:28, JOB 30:30; SNG 5:11; LAM 4:7–4:8 ZEC 6:2, ZEC 6:6; REV 6:5 REV 6:12

Black as the opposite of light

JOB 3:5 Job cursing the day of his birth. See also ISA 5:30, ISA 45:7; AMO 5:8

Black in the setting of impending judgment

JOL 2:2 See also AMO 8:9; ZEP 1:15

Black as a symbol of evil

JOB 34:22 See also JHN 3:19; 2PE 2:17; JUD 1:13

4802: blight

A disease ruinous to crops. In the OT blight was seen as evidence of God's judgment.

Blight as punishment from God

DEU 28:22 See also HOS 9:16; AMO 4:9; HAG 2:17

Deliverance from blight

1KI 8:37–8:39 parallel 2CH 6:28–6:30

Blight as a symbol of sorrow

PSA 102:4

4803: breadth

Breadth as a measurement

ISA 40:12 See also GEN 6:15 Noah's ark EXO 25:10, EXO 27:1, EXO 27:12–27:13, EXO 37:25 DEU 3:11 Og's bed; 1KI 6:21KI 7:2; 2CH 3:3, 2CH 4:1; EZR 6:3 EZK 40:7, EZK 40:42, EZK 41:9–41:12 EZK 45:1–45:3, EZK 48:13–48:15 ZEC 2:2 Jerusalem; ZEC 5:2 the flying scroll; REV 21:16 the new Jerusalem

Breadth indicating large areas

GEN 13:17 See also 2SA 22:37 parallel PSA 18:36; JOB 37:10; ISA 8:7–8:8, ISA 30:23, ISA 33:21; MAT 7:13–7:14

Breadth of understanding

1KI 4:29

Breadth of Jesus Christ's love

EPH 3:14–3:19

4804: breath

The imagery of breath is often used to convey spiritual essence and power, unseen except in its effects, including aspects of the person and work of the Holy Spirit. The main Hebrew and Greek words translated as "breath" in the NIV are also translated as "spirit" and "wind".

The breath of life

Life imparted by God

GEN 2:7; ACT 17:25 See also GEN 1:30, GEN 6:17, GEN 7:15, GEN 7:22; JOB 27:3, JOB 33:4; PSA 104:30; ISA 42:5, ISA 57:16; JER 38:16; REV 11:11

Life recalled by his sovereign will

ECC 12:7 See also 1KI 17:17; JOB 34:14–34:15; PSA 104:29; ISA 40:7

The breath of God

An emblem of the Holy Spirit

JHN 20:21–20:22 See also EZK 37:5, EZK 37:14

God's creative breath

PSA 33:6 See also GEN 1:2; JOB 26:13, JOB 33:4

God's enlightening breath

JOB 32:8 See also JHN 14:26, JHN 16:13–16:15; 2TI 3:16–3:17; 2PE 1:20–1:21

God's regenerating breath

EZK 37:4–37:14 See also JHN 3:5–3:8; 1TH 1:4–1:5; TIT 3:5

God's empowering breath

ACT 2:1–2:4 See also ISA 11:2, ISA 61:1; JOL 2:28–2:29; JHN 20:21–20:22; ACT 1:8

God's destroying breath

2TH 2:8 See also EXO 15:10; 2SA 22:16 parallel PSA 18:15; JOB 4:9, JOB 15:30; ISA 11:4, ISA 30:28, ISA 30:33, ISA 40:24, ISA 59:19; EZK 21:31

4805: clouds

A natural feature of the sky, often associated with God's judgment, presence and glory.

Clouds as a natural phenomenon

Rain clouds

1KI 18:44–18:45 See also GEN 9:13–9:16; JOB 36:28; ECC 11:3; LUK 12:54

Clouds representing the sky

JOB 20:6, JOB 35:5; ; ISA 14:14; ; JER 51:9

Clouds subject to God's sovereign control

JOB 37:13 See also JDG 5:4; JOB 26:8; PSA 135:7, PSA 147:8; PRO 3:20, PRO 8:28; ISA 5:6; JER 10:13, JER 51:16; ZEC 10:1

Clouds expressing the mystery of God's world

JOB 37:15–37:16 See also JOB 22:14, JOB 26:9, JOB 36:29, JOB 38:9, JOB 38:37; ECC 11:4

Clouds of smoke

LEV 16:13; ; JDG 20:38

Clouds as symbols of spiritual truths

A symbol of judgment

EZK 30:3 See also EZK 30:18, EZK 34:12; JOL 2:2; ZEP 1:15

A symbol of blessing

ISA 45:8

A symbol of impermanence

JOB 7:9 See also JOB 30:15; PRO 16:15; HOS 6:4, HOS 13:3

Other positive symbolic uses

ISA 25:5, ISA 44:22; ; HEB 12:1

Other negative symbolic uses

PRO 25:14; ; ECC 12:2; ; JUD 1:12

Clouds as a symbol of God's presence and glory

Revealing God's majesty

NAM 1:3 See also JOB 37:11; PSA 97:2; ISA 30:27, ISA 30:30 DEU 33:26; PSA 68:4, PSA 104:3; JER 4:13

The cloud of God's presence

EXO 13:21–13:22 NUM 9:15–9:22, NUM 10:11–10:12, NUM 10:34, NUM 11:25, NUM 14:14; ; DEU 31:15; ; NEH 9:12, NEH 9:19; ; PSA 78:14, PSA 99:7, PSA 105:39; EXO 14:19–14:20, EXO 14:24; ; 1CO 10:1–10:2; ; REV 14:14

The cloud of God's awesomeness

LEV 16:2 See also EXO 19:9, EXO 19:16, EXO 34:5; NUM 12:5, NUM 12:10; DEU 4:11, DEU 5:22

The cloud of God's glory

1KI 8:10–8:12 parallel 2CH 5:13–6:1 See also EXO 16:10, EXO 24:15–24:18, EXO 33:9–33:10, EXO 40:34–40:38; NUM 16:42; EZK 1:28

Clouds revealing Jesus Christ's glory

MAT 17:5 parallels MRK 9:7, LUK 9:34 Jesus Christ's transfiguration; **ACT 1:9** Jesus Christ's ascension; **REV 1:7** See also DAN 7:13 MAT 24:30 parallels MRK 13:26, LUK 21:27; MAT 26:64 parallel MRK 14:62; 1TH 4:17

4806: cold

Cold as part of the seasonal rhythm of the year

GEN 8:22 See also JOB 37:9

Cold as an aspect of the night

GEN 31:40 See also JOB 24:7; JER 36:30

Cold as a source of discomfort

2CO 11:27 See also PRO 25:20; JHN 18:18; ACT 28:2

Cold as a source of refreshment

PRO 25:25 See also PRO 25:13; MAT 10:42

4807: colours

A wide range of colours are mentioned in Scripture, some being used symbolically.

Colours mentioned in Scripture

White

GEN 49:12; 2KI 5:27

Blue

EST 1:6; EZK 27:24 See also EXO 26:1, EXO 39:22

Yellow

REV 9:17 See also LEV 13:30

Green

MRK 6:39 An indication as to the season; the grass is green in Galilee in spring. GEN 1:30; ; PSA 23:2; ; JER 17:8; ; REV 8:7

Red

2KI 3:22; MAT 16:2 See also GEN 25:30; EXO 36:19; REV 12:3

Purple

MRK 15:17 NUM 4:13; ; PRO 31:22; ; DAN 5:7; ; ACT 16:14

Scarlet

ISA 1:18 See also GEN 38:28; EXO 35:23 Purple, scarlet, crimson and red are closely related and sometimes

interchangeable in Scripture; NUM 4:8; SNG 4:3; MAT 27:28; REV 17:4

Crimson

ISA 63:1 See also 2CH 2:7

Black

SNG 5:11 See also REV 6:12

The whole spectrum

EZK 1:28 See also REV 4:3, REV 10:1

Colours used symbolically

REV 6:2 White here symbolises conquest; **REV 17:3** See also REV 6:4 bloodshed and war; REV 6:8 deathREV 7:9, REV 19:14, REV 19:11 REV 20:11 holiness

4808: crimson

A deep red colour used interchangeably with scarlet and sometimes with purple. It has associations with blood and richness.

The richness of crimson used for ornamentation

EXO 25:3–25:4, EXO 28:6 It was used extensively in the construction of the tabernacle; **2CH 2:7** See also 2CH 2:14, 2CH 3:14

Crimson associated with splendour and prosperity

2SA 1:24; REV 18:16 See also PRO 31:21; JER 4:30; NAM 2:3; MAT 27:28 parallel MRK 15:17; REV 18:12

Crimson associated with blood and sin

ISA 1:18 See also LEV 14:3–14:6, LEV 14:49–14:53; NUM 19:6; ISA 63:1–63:3; HEB 9:19; REV 17:3–17:4

Everyday use of the colour crimson

GEN 38:28; ; JOS 2:17–2:18; ; SNG 4:3

4809: darkness

The absence of light. Often used figuratively as a symbol of sin, chaos or the absence of God.

4810: darkness, natural

Scripture stresses that God is able to be present and known, even in the darkest aspects of the world.

Darkness as a symbol of the terrifying majesty of God

EXO 20:18–20:21; PSA 97:2 See also DEU 4:11–4:12, DEU 5:22–5:24; HEB 12:18–12:21

God is the source of natural darkness

ISA 45:7 See also GEN 1:2–1:5, GEN 1:16–1:18; JOB 26:10; PSA 74:16, PSA 104:19–104:20

God's eye penetrates the darkness

JOB 34:21–34:22; PSA 139:11–139:12 See also DAN 2:22; AMO 5:8–5:9; 2CO 4:6

Miracles involving natural darkness

MAT 27:45 parallels MRK 15:33, LUK 23:44–23:45 See also EXO 10:21–10:23, EXO 14:19–14:20; JOS 24:6–24:7; PSA 105:26–105:28; ISA 50:3; ACT 2:19–2:20; JOL 2:30–2:32; ACT 13:9–13:12

Natural darkness used poetically

2SA 22:10–22:12 parallel PSA 18:9–18:11; ; JOB 3:1–3:10

4811: darkness, as a symbol of sin

Darkness is often used in Scripture as a symbol of sin and its effects. It is often contrasted with light, as a symbol of forgiveness and the presence of God.

Darkness as a symbol of sin

JHN 3:19–3:20 See also JOB 24:16–24:17; PRO 2:12–2:15, PRO 4:19; ISA 5:20, ISA 29:15; MAT 6:23; LUK 22:53 Jesus Christ arrested; ROM 1:21ROM 13:12; 2CO 6:14; EPH 5:8–5:12 1JN 1:5–1:6

Darkness as a symbol of the effects of sin

Darkness symbolising ignorance of the truth

2CO 4:4 See also PSA 82:5; ISA 8:20; 2CO 3:14–3:15; EPH 4:18

Darkness symbolising the inability to find the right way

JHN 12:35 See also JOB 12:24–12:25; ISA 59:9–59:10; MAT 5:14; 1JN 2:9, 1JN 2:11

Darkness symbolises times of trial

JOB 3:3–3:6, JOB 19:8, JOB 23:16–23:17, JOB 30:26; ; PSA 107:10, PSA 143:3; ; ECC 11:8

Darkness symbolises death and the grave

JOB 10:20–10:22 See also PSA 49:19, PSA 88:10–88:12

God's provision for the darkness of sin

God himself is a remedy for darkness

2SA 22:29 See also PSA 18:28, PSA 30:5, PSA 91:4–91:7; ISA 42:16, ISA 50:10; MIC 7:8

God will deliver from darkness

ISA 9:2 See also MAT 4:16; PSA 107:13–107:14; ISA 29:18, ISA 49:8–49:9; LUK 1:78–1:79; ACT 26:17–26:18; COL 1:13; 1TH 5:4–5:5; 1PE 2:9

God's Son saves believers from darkness

JHN 8:12 See also JHN 1:4–1:5, JHN 12:46; 1CO 4:5; 2CO 4:6; GEN 1:3; EPH 5:8; 2PE 1:19; 1JN 2:8

God's people rescue others from darkness

ISA 42:6–42:7 See also ISA 60:1–60:5

4812: darkness, and God's judgment

Darkness is used figuratively of God's present and final judgment upon individuals, unfaithful Israel and the heathen nations.

Darkness as a symbol of judgment upon ungodly individuals

MAT 25:30 See also ISA 2:9–2:10; JOB 5:13–5:14, JOB 12:25, JOB 15:22–15:23, JOB 15:30, JOB 18:5–18:6, JOB 18:18, JOB 20:24–20:26, JOB 22:10–22:11 Eliphaz reasons on the assumption that Job's suffering proves his wickedness; PSA 35:5–35:6; ISA 8:22; JER 23:11–23:12; MAT 22:13; 2PE 2:17; JUD 1:13; REV 16:10–16:11

Darkness as a symbol of judgment upon unfaithful Israel

DEU 28:28–28:29; ISA 5:29–5:30 This will be fulfilled at the time of Israel's captivity. See also ISA 59:9–59:10; ROM 11:10; JER 4:27–4:28, JER 13:16; LAM 3:2, LAM 3:6; MAT 8:12

Darkness as a symbol of judgment upon heathen nations

ISA 47:5–47:7; ; EZK 30:18, EZK 32:7–32:8; ; NAM 1:8

Darkness as a symbol of judgment at the day of the Lord

JOL 2:31 See also ISA 13:9–13:10, ISA 34:4; JOL 2:1–2:2, JOL 2:10, JOL 3:14–3:15; AMO 5:18–5:20, AMO 8:9; ZEP 1:14–1:15; ZEC 14:6; MAT 24:29; ACT 2:19–2:20; 1TH 5:1–5:3; REV 6:12–6:17

4813: depth

Depth as a literal measurement

GEN 7:20 See also 1KI 7:31, 1KI 7:35; EZK 40:6, EZK 40:9, EZK 40:30, EZK 43:13; ACT 27:28

Depth indicating the strength of human emotions

2CO 2:4 See also LAM 3:60

Depth as a characteristic of wisdom

ROM 11:33; ; PHP 1:9

Depth representating the immeasurability of God

ROM 11:33

Depth used to express the love of God

ROM 8:38–8:39 See also EPH 3:16–3:19

4814: dew

The nightly condensation of moisture from the atmosphere

SNG 5:2 See also JDG 6:36–6:40 Gideon's sign; DAN 4:25, DAN 5:21

Dew as a sign of God's blessing and provision

DEU 33:13 See also GEN 27:28; JOB 38:28; PRO 3:19–3:20; HOS 14:5; ZEC 8:12

Dew associated with manna

EXO 16:13–16:14; ; NUM 11:9

Lack of dew a sign of God's judgment

1KI 17:1 See also GEN 27:39; 2SA 1:21; HAG 1:10

Dew used metaphorically

DEU 32:2; PSA 110:3; ISA 26:19 See also 2SA 17:12; JOB 29:19; PSA 133:3; PRO 19:12; ISA 18:4; HOS 6:4, HOS 13:3; MIC 5:7

4815: drought

A severe long-term absence of water or drink of any kind, leading to disaster for the people affected in this way. Scripture provides examples of such droughts, while also indicating the possibility and dangers of long-term spiritual thirst arising through disobedience or lack of faith.

4816: drought, physical

Drought arises through the absence of rain, leading to severe hardship for those who are affected by it.

Drought may be a sign of God's displeasure

DEU 11:17 See also DEU 28:22–28:24; 2SA 1:21; 1KI 17:1; PSA 107:33–107:34; ISA 5:6, ISA 5:13; JER 2:2–2:3, JER 14:1–14:6, JER 50:38; EZK 22:23–22:24; AMO 4:7; HAG 1:11; JAS 5:17

The response of believers to drought

It tests their faith

1KI 17:7; HAB 3:17–3:18 See also DEU 8:15; ISA 41:17, ISA 48:20–48:21; JER 2:5–2:6; HOS 13:5

It gives opportunity to help others

ACT 11:28–11:29 See also GEN 41:56–41:57; 1KI 17:9, 1KI 18:1–18:4

Rain is a sign of God's general favour or of his forgiveness

His general favour

ACT 14:17 See also GEN 27:28; JOB 5:10, JOB 38:25–38:28; PSA 65:9–65:10, PSA 147:8; JER 5:24, JER 14:22; MAT 5:45

His response to repentance

JOL 2:12, JOL 2:23 See also MAL 3:10

His response to obedience

DEU 11:13–11:14 See also LEV 26:3–26:4

His response to prayer

JAS 5:18 See also 1KI 8:35–8:36, 1KI 18:36–18:46; ZEC 10:1

4817: drought, spiritual

Scripture indicates that believers, both as individuals and communities, may go through periods in which they fail to experience the refreshing and life-giving presence of God. One cause of such spiritual thirst is unbelief. Scripture also indicates ways in which this thirst may be relieved.

Spiritual drought in unbelievers

PSA 68:6 See also ISA 29:7–29:8

The remedy for spiritual drought is to be found in Jesus Christ

JHN 7:37–7:39 See also ISA 45:8, ISA 55:1; JHN 4:13–4:14; TIT 3:5–3:7; REV 22:17

The experience of spiritual drought in believers

PSA 63:1 See also PSA 143:6; EZK 19:10–19:14

The cause of spiritual drought in believers

Unconfessed sin

PSA 32:3–32:4 See also PSA 66:18; ISA 1:28–1:30

Spiritual depression

PSA 42:1–42:2

Self-reliance

JER 2:13 See also JER 17:5–17:6

God's judgment

AMO 8:11

The remedy for spiritual drought in the lives of believers

Through confession

1JN 1:8–1:9 See also PSA 32:5, PSA 51:12; 1JN 3:19–3:22

Through Scripture

PSA 1:2–1:3 See also DEU 32:1–32:2; ISA 55:10–55:11

Through Jesus Christ

JHN 6:35 See also JHN 7:37–7:39; JAS 5:7–5:8

Through the Holy Spirit

ISA 44:3 See also ISA 32:13–32:15; ROM 15:13

Finally in heaven

REV 7:16–7:17

4819: dryness

A lack of moisture, often due to lack of rain or a period of drought, leading to vegetation drying up. Dryness is often used as a symbol of hopelessness or of the absence of God's blessing.

The dryness of river beds

Evaporation and recession of floodwaters

GEN 8:13–8:14 See also GEN 8:1–8:11

God's drying up of rivers to allow his people to cross

JOS 4:23 See also EXO 14:10–14:31; JOS 2:10, JOS 3:1–3:17, JOS 5:1; PSA 106:7–106:11; ISA 11:15, ISA 51:10

Other instances of rivers drying up

1KI 17:7 See also 2KI 19:24 parallel ISA 37:25; PSA 74:15; ISA 15:6, ISA 19:4–19:10, ISA 42:15, ISA 44:24–44:27, ISA 50:2; JER 48:34, JER 51:36; EZK 30:12; JOL 1:20; NAM 1:4

The dryness of vegetation

PSA 37:2 See also JOB 8:11–8:12, JOB 8:19, JOB 14:2, JOB 15:30; ISA 34:4 on the day of the LORD; ISA 40:7–40:8; JER 8:13, JER 12:4; EZK 19:10–19:14; HOS 9:16; MAT 13:3–13:6 parallels MRK 4:2–4:6, LUK 8:4–8:6 the parable of the sower; MAT 21:19–21:20 parallel MRK 11:20–11:21 the fig-tree withers

Physical dryness

EZK 37:11 See also PSA 102:4, PSA 102:11; PRO 17:22; ZEC 11:17

Dryness indicative of desolation and hopelessness

JOL 1:12 See also ISA 24:7, ISA 33:9; JER 23:10; JOL 1:10, JOL 1:17; ZEC 9:5, ZEC 10:11

Dryness indicating God's withholding of moisture due to sin

DEU 28:22–28:24; ; 1KI 8:35–8:36

4820: earthquake

Earthquakes as natural events

AMO 1:1 See also 1SA 14:15; ZEC 14:5; ACT 16:26

Earthquakes remain under God's sovereignty

PSA 75:3 See also PSA 46:2–46:3

Earthquakes as a demonstration of God's power

PSA 77:18 See also EXO 19:18; NUM 16:31–16:32; JDG 5:5; 2SA 22:8 parallel PSA 18:7; ISA 29:6; NAM 1:5; ACT 16:26; REV 11:19

Elijah and the earthquake on Mount Horeb

1KI 19:11–19:12

The earthquake accompanying Jesus Christ's death and resurrection

MAT 28:2 See also MAT 27:54

Earthquakes among the signs of the end time

MAT 24:7 parallels MRK 13:8, LUK 21:11 See also ISA 24:19–24:20; EZK 38:19–38:20; REV 6:12, REV 8:5, REV 11:13, REV 16:18

4821: east

The geographical direction often identified by the position of the rising sun. Many of Israel's invaders came from the east, often giving the term a negative association in OT writings.

East as a point of the compass

GEN 2:8; MAT 2:1–2:2 See also GEN 4:16, GEN 13:11, GEN 13:14; DEU 3:27; PSA 107:3; LUK 13:29; REV 21:13

East and west used to demonstrate vast extent

GEN 28:14; ISA 43:5 See also 1CH 12:15; JOB 23:8; PSA 75:6, PSA 103:12; ZEC 8:7; MAT 8:11, MAT 24:27; LUK 13:29

East identified by the rising sun

NUM 2:3 See also JOS 1:15, JOS 19:12; PSA 50:1, PSA 113:3; ISA 41:25, ISA 45:6

The east wind

JOB 15:2 The east wind blows straight out of the desert; **PSA 48:7** See also GEN 41:6; EXO 10:13; ISA 27:8; JER 4:11, JER 18:17; EZK 17:10, EZK 27:26; HOS 13:15; JON 4:8

Military threat from the east

JDG 6:33 See also JDG 10:8; 1CH 5:10; ISA 9:12, ISA 46:11

4822: famine

A severe long-term absence of food, leading to disaster for the people affected in this way. Scripture provides examples of such famines, while also indicating the possibility and dangers of spiritual famine arising through disobedience or lack of faith.

4823: famine, physical

A serious shortage of food caused by drought, war or natural disasters. Famine is seen as a sign of God's judgment on Israel.

Examples of famines

In the days of Abraham

GEN 12:10 See also GEN 26:1

In the days of Joseph

GEN 41:53–41:57; ; ACT 7:11

In the days of Ruth

RUT 1:1

In the days of David

2SA 21:1

In the days of Elijah

1KI 18:1–18:5; ; LUK 4:25

In the days of Elisha

2KI 4:38, 2KI 6:25

In the days of the prophets

ISA 51:19; ; JER 44:13; ; EZK 7:15; ; JOL 1:10–1:12

In the days of Claudius

ACT 11:28

In the last days

MAT 24:7 parallels MRK 13:8, LUK 21:11

Natural causes of famine

See also DEU 28:22 crop disease 1KI 18:1–18:2; JER 14:1–14:6 2KI 6:24–6:25, 2KI 25:1–25:3 JOL 1:4 locusts

Spiritual causes of famine

The disobedience of God's people

DEU 28:15–28:18 See also DEU 28:22–28:24, DEU 28:38–28:40, DEU 28:42, DEU 28:51, DEU 28:53, DEU 32:24; JDG 6:1–6:5; 2SA 21:1, 2SA 24:13 parallel 1CH 21:11–21:12; ISA 51:19–51:20; JER 5:17, JER 11:22, JER 14:11–14:18, JER 18:21, JER 29:17–29:18, JER 32:24; EZK 5:16–5:17, EZK 6:11–6:12, EZK 14:13

God's judgment on the ungodly

GEN 41:28–41:30; ; ISA 14:29–14:30; ; REV 6:8, REV 18:8

The effects of famine

Desperation and death

LAM 4:9 See also GEN 47:13, GEN 47:20; DEU 28:53; 2KI 7:3–7:4; NEH 5:3; JER 52:6; LUK 15:14–15:16, LUK 23:28–23:29

God's people seek him and return to him

JDG 6:6 See also 2SA 21:1; LUK 15:17–15:18

God's provision in famine

He gives warnings beforehand

GEN 41:25–41:27; ; 1KI 17:1; ; 2KI 8:1; ; ACT 11:28

He gives wisdom to men

GEN 41:33–41:36, GEN 42:1–42:2, GEN 45:11, GEN 47:4; ; PSA 105:16–105:22; ; ACT 7:10–7:11

He provides for his people

JOB 5:20 See also GEN 26:1–26:3; 1KI 17:2–17:16 Sometimes he provides miraculously; PSA 33:18–33:19, PSA 37:19; EZK 34:29, EZK 36:29–36:30

He sends deliverance

2KI 7:1–7:9, 2KI 7:16; ; JER 32:36–32:37

Responses to famine

Accepting God's chastisements

JER 27:12–27:13, JER 38:2–38:3, JER 42:13–42:17, JER 44:27

Caring for one's family

GEN 45:11; ; RUT 1:1; ; 2KI 8:1–8:2

Helping those in need

ACT 11:29–11:30

Praying

1KI 8:35–8:40 parallel 2CH 6:26–6:31

Trusting in the Lord

ROM 8:35–8:37

4824: famine, spiritual

A state of spiritual hunger arising from a failure to experience the presence and joy of God. Scripture describes such experiences, indicates one ultimate cause to be unbelief and points to ways in which this famine can be relieved.

The experience of spiritual famine

God's word is withheld

AMO 8:11–8:12 See also ISA 3:1; PSA 74:9; LAM 2:9; EZK 7:26; LUK 23:8–23:9

God's Spirit is withheld

PSA 51:11 See also PSA 107:33–107:34

Causes of spiritual famine

Sin

ISA 59:2

Unbelief

ACT 13:46 See also ACT 28:25–28:28

Worldliness

ISA 55:2

False beliefs

ISA 8:19–8:22

Self-satisfaction

REV 3:17 It is possible to be well-fed physically but famished spiritually.

Testing God

See also PSA 78:18–78:19, PSA 78:29–78:31

God testing his servants

JOB 23:3, JOB 23:8–23:10

Consequences of spiritual famine

Spiritual weakness

PSA 119:81 See also PSA 84:2

Loss of hope and joy

JOL 1:16 See also PSA 51:12

Relief of spiritual famine

Relief is promised to God's people

PSA 107:9 See also PSA 85:8–85:13; ISA 58:11, ISA 65:21; AMO 9:13–9:15

Relief comes through Jesus Christ

JHN 6:35 See also ISA 9:1–9:3; LUK 1:53; JHN 6:32–6:33, JHN 6:48, JHN 6:50, JHN 6:58; 1CO 10:3–10:4

Relief comes by the word

ISA 55:10–55:11 See also MAT 4:4 parallel LUK 4:4; DEU 8:3

Relief comes by the Spirit

ACT 2:17 See also JOL 2:28; PSA 107:35–107:38; ISA 35:1–35:10, ISA 44:3

Final relief is found in heaven

REV 7:16 See also ISA 49:9–49:10; PSA 16:11; REV 21:6

Conditions of relief from spiritual famine

It is offered freely

ISA 55:1 See also JHN 7:37; REV 22:17

It is for those who desire it

MAT 5:6 See also LUK 6:21

It is for those who pray

PSA 107:4–107:9; ; JAS 5:16

It is for those who repent

PSA 81:8–81:10; ; ISA 64:9–64:10; ; HOS 14:1–14:8; ; JOL 2:13–2:14

It is for those who have patience

JAS 5:7 See also PSA 126:4–126:6; ECC 11:1; JHN 4:35; JAS 5:16–5:18

4826: fire

Scripture shows fire being used in a variety of ways in this world. Fire is often mentioned as a symbol, denoting God's presence and power, his judgment or his purifying work.

Domestic uses of fire

ISA 50:11; ; JER 36:22; ; MAT 5:15; ; MRK 14:67 parallels LUK 22:55, JHN 18:18; ; JHN 21:9; ; ACT 28:2

Cremation

1SA 31:12 See also JOS 7:25; AMO 6:10

Fire as an instrument of punishment

LEV 20:14 See also GEN 38:24; LEV 20:14, LEV 21:9; JDG 9:49; DAN 3:6

Fire as an instrument of divine judgment**In general terms**

2PE 3:10 See also GEN 19:24; LEV 10:2; NUM 11:1, NUM 16:35; 2TH 1:7-1:8

Eternal fire

REV 20:10 See also ISA 33:14, ISA 66:24; MAT 3:12 parallel LUK 3:17; MAT 18:8 parallel MRK 9:43; MAT 25:41; REV 14:10-14:11

Fire used in worship

NUM 28:2 See also LEV 24:7; 1SA 7:9; 2CH 13:11; EZR 3:3

Prayers answered by fire

1CH 21:26 See also 1KI 18:38; 2KI 1:10; 2CH 7:1

Symbolic significance of fire**God's presence and power**

EXO 3:2; ACT 2:3 See also EXO 13:21, EXO 19:18; LEV 9:24; DEU 4:36; JDG 6:21, JDG 13:20; 2KI 2:11; PSA 50:3, PSA 97:3; JER 23:29

Judgment

MAL 4:1 See also DEU 4:24; ISA 66:15-66:16; JER 5:14, JER 48:45; EZK 22:20; AMO 1:4; 1CO 3:15

Purification or refinement

1PE 1:7 See also NUM 31:23; ISA 48:10; ZEC 13:9; MAL 3:2; 1CO 3:13; REV 3:18

Zeal

JHN 2:17 See also PSA 69:9; JER 20:9; LUK 24:32; 2TI 1:6

The power to destroy

JAS 3:6 See also PRO 6:27-6:29, PRO 16:27; ISA 9:18, ISA 43:2

4827: frost

A covering of the ground with fine particles of ice, characteristic of cold weather.

Frost is under God's control

PSA 147:16 See also JOB 38:29

Frost will be absent on the day of the LORD

ZEC 14:6

4828: hail**Hail as destructive**

JOS 10:11; ; EZK 13:11-13:13

Hail as a sign of the power of God

JOB 38:22-38:23; ; PSA 105:32, PSA 147:17-147:18; ; ISA 28:2; ; HAG 2:17

Hail as one of the ten plagues of Egypt

EXO 9:18-9:33

Hail as an aspect of the final divine judgment

REV 8:7, REV 11:19, REV 16:21

4829: heat**The heat of the sun**

ISA 4:6 See also GEN 8:22, GEN 18:1, GEN 31:40; DEU 28:22 Scorching heat was a curse for disobedience; 1SA 11:11; 2SA 4:5; NEH 7:3; JOB 24:19; PSA 19:6; ISA 18:4, ISA 49:10 relief from heat in the promised restoration of Israel; JER 36:30; HOS 13:5; JON 4:8; MAT 20:12; LUK 12:55 Jesus Christ on interpreting the times; JAS 1:11; REV 7:16

Artificial heat

ACT 28:3 See also 1KI 19:6; EZK 24:11; DAN 3:22; HOS 7:7; 1TI 4:2

Bodily heat

LAM 5:10

Heat associated with action in battle

1SA 14:22; ; ISA 21:15

Heat associated with anger

ISA 25:4-25:5 See also EXO 11:8; 2KI 23:26; PSA 39:3, PSA 78:49; EZK 38:18

Heat associated with judgment

2PE 3:12; ; REV 16:9

Heat referring to animals entering period of fertility

GEN 30:41–30:42; ; JER 2:24

4830: height

Height as a measurement

1KI 6:10 See also GEN 6:15; EXO 27:1; 1KI 6:2, 1KI 6:26; 2CH 4:1–4:2; NEH 4:6; EST 5:14; JER 52:21–52:22; EZK 43:13; REV 21:16

Height in relation to physical stature

1SA 16:7 See also EZK 19:11, EZK 31:10, EZK 31:14; DAN 4:10

Mountain peaks described as heights

JDG 6:26 See also NUM 23:3; ISA 22:16

Height equivalent to zenith

DAN 8:8

Height used as a metaphor

REV 2:5

Height used to express the love of God

ROM 8:38–8:39 See also EPH 3:16–3:19

4831: largeness

Large flocks and herds

JOB 1:3 See also GEN 30:43; EXO 12:38; NUM 32:1; JOS 22:8; 2SA 12:1–12:3; JER 49:32

Large cities

DEU 9:1 See also NUM 13:28; DEU 1:28, DEU 6:10; JOS 10:2, JOS 14:12; 1KI 4:13; NEH 7:4

Large armies

JOS 11:4 See also NUM 20:20; 2KI 18:17; 2CH 24:24; EZK 17:15; DAN 11:11–11:13, DAN 11:25; JOL 2:2

Large crowds of people

MAT 4:25 See also 2CH 15:9, 2CH 30:5, 2CH 30:13; EZR 10:1; MAT 8:1, MAT 20:29 parallel MRK 10:46; MAT 26:47; MRK 4:1, MRK 6:34; LUK 5:29, LUK 7:11–7:12, LUK 23:27; JHN 12:9

4832: length

Length as measurement

LEV 19:35 See also GEN 6:15; EXO 26:12; 2SA 8:2; 2CH 3:8EZK 40:5, EZK 40:11, EZK 40:20, EZK 41:4, EZK 41:8, EZK 41:12, EZK 41:15, EZK 42:10–42:11 ACT 12:10; REV 21:16

Length of land

GEN 13:17 See also EZK 48:8, EZK 48:13, EZK 48:18, EZK 48:21

Length of life

PSA 90:10 See also PSA 21:4; PRO 10:27

Length of time

EXO 12:40 See also 2SA 2:11

Length of Jesus Christ's love

EPH 3:14–3:19

4833: light

The brightness that enables sight in the darkness. Scripture often uses light as a symbol of the saving presence of God in a fallen world, with darkness being used as a symbol of sin or the absence of God.

4834: light, natural

Scripture stresses that every source of light (sun, moon and stars) is created by God, and subject to him.

God is the source of natural light

GEN 1:3–1:5 See also GEN 1:14–1:18; 2SA 22:13–22:15; JOB 41:18–41:21; PSA 8:3–8:4, PSA 74:16, PSA 97:4, PSA 136:7–136:9; ISA 45:7; JER 31:35; JAS 1:17

God controls natural light

PSA 104:19 See also JOB 9:7, JOB 36:30–36:32; PSA 121:5–121:6; MAT 5:45; 2CO 4:6

Miracles involving natural light

The pillars of cloud and fire

EXO 13:21–13:22, EXO 14:20; ; DEU 1:31; ; NEH 9:12, NEH 9:19; ; PSA 78:14, PSA 105:39

Other miracles

EXO 9:23–9:24, EXO 10:23; ; ISA 38:8; ; HAB 3:11; ; LUK 23:44–23:45; ; ACT 9:3, ACT 22:6, ACT 22:9, ACT 22:11, ACT 26:13

Natural light associated with angels

MAT 28:3; ; LUK 24:4; ; ACT 12:7

Natural light used figuratively

The sun

REV 1:16 See also ISA 30:26; LUK 21:25; REV 12:1

Lightning

LUK 9:29 parallels MAT 17:2, MRK 9:2 See also EZK 1:4; DAN 10:6; HOS 6:5; LUK 10:18, LUK 17:24

Light

PSA 104:2 See also EZK 1:26–1:28

4835: light, spiritual

Light is often used in Scripture as a symbol of the presence of God in the world. It is often especially associated with the word of God, the salvation brought about by God, or the person of Jesus Christ.

Light as a symbol of God

God's purity

1JN 1:5 See also JOB 25:4–25:6; ISA 5:20; 1JN 1:7

God's glory

REV 21:23 See also PSA 76:4, PSA 84:11; ISA 60:19–60:20; HAB 3:4; 1TI 6:15–6:16

God's knowledge

PSA 90:8, PSA 139:11–139:12; ; DAN 2:22; ; 1CO 4:5

God's unchangeability

JAS 1:17

God's vengeance

See also PSA 94:1; ISA 10:17

Satan as an imitator of light

2CO 11:14

Light as a symbol of God's favour towards his people

EZR 9:8 See also NUM 6:25; JOB 3:20, JOB 29:2–29:3; PSA 4:6, PSA 31:16, PSA 44:3, PSA 67:1, PSA 80:3, PSA 80:7; MIC 7:8–7:9; REV 22:5

Light as a symbol of God's word

As perceived by believers

PSA 119:105 See also PSA 19:8, PSA 119:130; 2PE 1:19

As perceived by unbelievers

JHN 3:20 See also JOB 24:13–24:17; JHN 1:5

Light as a symbol of salvation

1PE 2:9 See also ISA 9:2, ISA 51:4; ACT 26:23; EPH 5:14; COL 1:12; 1JN 2:8

Light as a symbol of Jesus Christ

Foretold in the OT

NUM 24:17 See also ISA 9:2, ISA 42:6–42:7, ISA 49:6, ISA 53:11; MAL 4:2

Revealed in the NT

JHN 8:12 See also MAT 4:16, MAT 17:2; LUK 1:78–1:79, LUK 2:32; JHN 1:4–1:9, JHN 9:5, JHN 12:35–12:36, JHN 12:46; ACT 13:47; 2CO 4:6; HEB 1:3; REV 1:16, REV 22:16

4836: light, and people of God

Scripture often uses light as a symbol of the people of God, and especially the manner in which believers are

able and required to reflect the glory of God in a dark world of sin.

The people of God as the light of the world

MAT 5:14–5:16 See also PSA 37:5–37:6; PRO 4:18, PRO 13:9; ISA 58:8–58:10, ISA 60:1–60:5, ISA 62:1; DAN 12:3; LUK 2:32; ACT 13:47

Examples of believers acting as light to the world

Moses on Mount Sinai: EXO 34:29–34:30, EXO 34:35; 2SA 23:3–23:4 the righteous ruler, fully realised in Jesus Christ; ; JOB 29:21–29:25 Job as a counsellor; ; JHN 5:35 John the Baptist; ; ACT 6:15 Stephen; ; PHP 2:15 the Philippian church

God is the source of the light of his people

God and his law as the source of light

PSA 27:1, PSA 118:27 See also JDG 5:31; JOB 11:13–11:17, JOB 22:27–22:28; PSA 19:8, PSA 34:5, PSA 56:13, PSA 97:11; PRO 6:23; ECC 8:1; ISA 60:19–60:20; JHN 1:5

The gospel of forgiveness as a source of light

ACT 26:17–26:18 See also JOB 33:28–33:30; PSA 112:4; ISA 9:2, ISA 29:18; MAT 4:16; JHN 3:19–3:21; EPH 1:18, EPH 5:27; HEB 6:4, HEB 10:32

The people of God are called to live in his light

EPH 5:8–5:14, 1JN 1:7 See also PSA 36:9, PSA 89:15; ISA 2:5; LUK 16:8; JHN 9:4, JHN 12:35–12:36; ROM 13:12; 1TH 5:5–5:6; 1JN 2:8–2:10

4838: lightning

Lightning as an aspect of heavy rain storms

EXO 9:23–9:24

Lightning as a symbol

A symbol of the power of God

JOB 36:30–36:33 See also 2SA 22:13, 2SA 22:15; JOB 37:3, JOB 37:11, JOB 37:15, JOB 38:24, JOB 38:35, PSA 18:12–18:14, PSA 77:18, PSA 78:48, PSA 105:32, PSA 97:4, PSA 135:7, PSA 144:6; JER 10:12–10:13; REV 16:18

A symbol of brightness

MAT 28:3, LUK 9:29 See also EZK 21:10, EZK 21:15, EZK 21:28; DAN 10:6; HAB 3:11; ZEC 9:14; LUK 24:4

Lightning as “fire from heaven”

JOB 1:16 See also 2KI 1:10–1:12; LUK 9:54; REV 20:9

Lightning as a sign of the presence of God

EXO 19:16 At Mount Sinai; **REV 4:5** See also EXO 20:18; EZK 1:4, EZK 1:13–1:14; REV 8:5, REV 11:19

Lightning used metaphorically

MAT 24:27 parallel LUK 17:24 See also HOS 6:5; NAM 2:4; LUK 10:18

4839: mildew**A fungal plant disease, often seen as a sign of God's judgment**

DEU 28:22; AMO 4:9 See also 1KI 8:37 parallel 2CH 6:28; HAG 2:17

Regulations concerning mildew

LEV 13:47-13:59, LEV 14:34-14:57

4840: mist**Mist is a natural phenomenon****Mist as a source of water**

GEN 2:5-2:6 NIV footnote at verse 6

Mist as a barrier to effective vision

ACT 13:11

Mist as a symbol**Of a lack of substance or permanence**

HOS 6:4; JAS 4:14 See also HOS 13:3; 2PE 2:17

Of God's forgiveness

ISA 44:22

4841: narrowness

A state in which something is confined and restricted, lacking in breadth. It usually has pejorative implications, but Jesus Christ described the way of salvation in terms of narrowness.

Narrowness equated with no escape

NUM 22:24-22:26 See also PRO 23:26-23:28

Narrowness associated with discomfort

ISA 28:20

The narrow gate

MAT 7:13-7:14 See also LUK 13:22-13:30

Narrowness in the architecture of the temple

1KI 6:4 See also EZK 40:16, EZK 40:25, EZK 41:16, EZK 41:26, EZK 42:5

4842: north

The geographical direction opposite to south, often used to demonstrate the vast extent between the two.

North as a point of the compass

JOB 37:22 See also GEN 13:14; DEU 2:3; JOS 18:5; ECC 11:3; ISA 14:31; JER 1:13-1:15, JER 3:18 Although geographically situated to the east of Israel, invaders from Mesopotamia had to enter the country from the north, following the land route around the desert areas; JER 46:6; EZK 8:5, EZK 26:7; AMO 8:12; ZEP 2:13

North and south used to demonstrate vast extent

GEN 28:14 See also JOB 23:9; ISA 43:6; EZK 20:47, EZK 21:4; DAN 8:4; ZEC 6:6

The north wind

PRO 25:23 See also ECC 1:6; SNG 4:16; EZK 1:4

4843: plague

Affliction with disease, destruction or environmental disaster as an expression of divine judgment, usually resulting in death. The purpose may be as a punishment or to encourage repentance.

The nature of plague

EZK 6:11-6:12 See also 2CH 20:9; JER 14:12, JER 27:8; EZK 14:21; REV 6:8

Plagues sent upon Egypt**Plagues described**

EXO 7:17-7:18, EXO 8:5-8:6, EXO 8:16-8:17, EXO 8:21, EXO 8:24, EXO 9:6, EXO 9:9-9:10, EXO 9:22-9:25, EXO 10:4-10:6, EXO 10:13-10:15, EXO 10:21-10:23, EXO 11:4-11:6, EXO 12:29-12:30

Plagues withdrawn in answer to prayer

EXO 8:12-8:13, EXO 8:29, EXO 9:29, EXO 9:33, EXO 10:18-10:19

Plagues recalled and celebrated

PSA 78:41-78:51, PSA 105:26-105:36, PSA 135:8-135:9; ; AMO 4:10; ; ACT 7:36

Plagues sent upon Israel**Plagues threatened for breaking God's covenant**

LEV 26:23-26:26 See also LEV 26:14-26:16; DEU 28:20-28:24

Plagues experienced in fulfilment of God's covenant

EXO 32:33-32:35; ; NUM 11:31-11:34, NUM 14:36-14:38, NUM 16:41-16:50, NUM 25:3-25:9; ; 2SA 24:11-24:17 parallel 1CH 21:9-21:17; ; JOL 1:2-1:12; ; AMO 4:6-4:11

Plagues withdrawn after intercession or obedience

NUM 14:10-14:20, NUM 16:46-16:48, NUM 21:6-21:9, NUM 25:6-25:11; ; 2SA 24:18-24:25 parallel 1CH 21:18-21:26; ; 1KI 8:37-8:40 parallel 2CH 6:28-6:31; ; PSA 106:23, PSA 106:28-106:31

Plagues announced by prophets as God's judgment

JER 21:5–21:10 See also JER 24:10, JER 29:17–29:19, JER 34:17, JER 44:13; EZK 5:12, EZK 5:17, EZK 33:27

Plagues sent upon other nations

1SA 5:6–5:12; ; ISA 19:22; ; JER 28:8; ; EZK 28:22–28:23; ; HAB 3:5–3:6; ; ZEC 14:12–14:15

Apocalyptic visions of plague as God's judgment

LUK 21:11 parallels MAT 24:7, MRK 13:8 See also REV 6:8, REV 11:6, REV 15:1, REV 15:6–15:8, REV 16:1–16:21, REV 18:4–18:8, REV 22:18

Divine protection from plague

PSA 91:3–91:8 See also EXO 8:22–8:23, EXO 9:4, EXO 9:6, EXO 9:26, EXO 10:23, EXO 11:7, EXO 12:13, EXO 12:23, EXO 12:27; 2CH 20:9

4844: rain**Rain as a natural phenomenon**

2SA 21:10; ; 1KI 18:41, 1KI 18:44; ; EZR 10:9; ; ECC 11:3; ; ISA 4:6; ; LUK 12:54; ; HEB 6:7

Associated with cold weather

ACT 28:2

God controls the rain

GEN 2:5; JER 51:16 See also 1KI 18:1; JOB 5:10, JOB 28:26, JOB 37:6, JOB 38:25; PSA 68:8, PSA 135:7, PSA 147:8; JER 10:13, JER 14:22

God's bounty in giving rain to Israel

DEU 28:12 See also LEV 26:4; DEU 11:14

God's bounty in giving rain to all humanity

MAT 5:45; ACT 14:17 See also ZEC 10:1

God's punishment through rain and flood

GEN 7:4 See also EXO 9:33–9:34; 1SA 12:17–12:18; EZK 38:22

God's punishment through drought

DEU 11:17 See also 1KI 8:35–8:36 parallel 2CH 6:26–6:27; 1KI 17:1; ISA 5:6; AMO 4:7; ZEC 14:17–14:18; JAS 5:17; REV 11:6

Rain as a symbol of spiritual truth**God's power to save**

ISA 55:10–55:11 See also 2SA 23:4; ISA 45:8

God's powerful anger

EZK 13:11–13:13 See also 2SA 22:12; JOB 20:23; ISA 28:2

Power of circumstances

MAT 7:27 See also MAT 7:25

Rain in other imagery

Ability to satisfy: DEU 32:2; ; JOB 29:23; ; PSA 72:6; ; PRO 16:15; PRO 25:14; ; JUD 1:12; PRO 25:23, PRO 26:1

The rainbow

GEN 9:14–9:16 a sign of God's covenant; ; EZK 1:28; ; REV 4:3, REV 10:1

4845: rainbow

An arch of colours in the sky, formed by the sun's rays passing through raindrops. It was the sign of God's covenant with Noah, established in the aftermath of the great flood.

The rainbow as a sign of God's covenant with Noah

GEN 9:12–9:17

The rainbow as a sign of God's glory

EZK 1:28; ; REV 4:3, REV 10:1

4846: shadow

Primarily a symbol of protection, of the brevity of life and of the experience of death, in contrast to God's character and work.

Shadow as a general symbol of protection

ISA 30:2–30:3 See also JDG 9:15; JER 48:45; HOS 14:7; JON 4:5–4:6; MRK 4:32

A symbol of God's protection

PSA 91:1 See also PSA 17:8, PSA 36:7, PSA 57:1, PSA 63:7, PSA 121:5; ISA 4:5–4:6, ISA 25:4–25:5, ISA 49:2, ISA 51:16

A symbol of the protection given by God's chosen one

ISA 32:2; ; LAM 4:20; ; EZK 17:22–17:23

Shadow as a symbol of life**Of the brevity of life**

PSA 144:4 See also 1CH 29:15; JOB 8:9, JOB 14:2; PSA 102:11, PSA 109:23; ECC 6:12, ECC 8:13

Of life's sadness and despair

ISA 59:9 See also JOB 3:3–3:5, JOB 7:2–7:3, JOB 16:16, JOB 17:7

Shadow as a symbol of the experience of death

JOB 38:17; PSA 23:4 See also JOB 10:21–10:22

Shadow in contrast to God**Shadow contrasts with God's unchanging nature**

JAS 1:17

God's light pierces all shadow

JOB 12:22 See also JOB 34:22; PSA 139:11–139:12; DAN 2:22

God's salvation reaches to those whose life is in shadow

MAT 4:16 See also ISA 9:2; ISA 60:1–60:2; LUK 1:79

OT ceremonies as a shadow of the reality in Jesus Christ

COL 2:16–2:17 See also HEB 8:5; HEB 10:1

Real shadows

JDG 9:36; ; NEH 13:19; ; SNG 2:17; SNG 4:6; ; JER 6:4

Real shadows involved in miracles

2KI 20:9–20:11 parallel ISA 38:8; ; ACT 5:15

4847: smallness**Smallness with regard to size**

JAS 3:4–3:5 See also GEN 19:20; EXO 12:4; JOS 17:15; 1KI 17:13; 1KI 18:44; 1KI 20:27; 2KI 4:10; 2KI 6:1; PRO 30:24–30:28 smallness equated with wisdom; ECC 9:14; ISA 49:19–49:20; MIC 5:2; MAT 7:14; MAT 17:20; LUK 17:6; ACT 27:16

Smallness with regard to importance and social standing

DEU 1:17 See also 1KI 22:31 parallel 2CH 18:30; 2CH 15:13; JOB 3:16–3:19; PSA 115:13; JER 49:15 parallel OBA 1:2; ACT 26:22; REV 11:18; REV 13:16; REV 19:5; REV 19:18; REV 20:12

Smallness with regard to insignificance

1SA 18:23 See also 1SA 15:17; 1SA 20:2; 1KI 2:20; ISA 49:6; LUK 19:17

Smallness with regard to weakness

AMO 7:2–7:5

4848: smoke**Smoke associated with the divine presence**

EXO 19:18; ISA 6:4 See also EXO 20:18; PSA 104:32; PSA 144:5; ISA 4:5; REV 15:8

Smoke associated with divine judgment

ISA 9:18–9:19 See also GEN 15:17; GEN 19:28 the destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah; 2SA 22:9 parallel PSA 18:8; ISA 30:27; ISA 34:10; JOL 2:30; NAM 2:13; ACT 2:19; REV 14:11; REV 18:9; REV 18:18; REV 19:3

Smoke associated with the offering of incense

LEV 16:13 See also REV 8:4

Smoke associated with warfare

JOS 8:20–8:21; ; JDG 20:38; JDG 20:40

Smoke used poetically**For something insubstantial**

HOS 13:3 See also PSA 37:20; PSA 68:2; ISA 51:6

In various other ways

PRO 10:26 See also JOB 41:20; PSA 119:83; SNG 3:6; ISA 14:31; ISA 65:5; REV 9:2–9:3; REV 9:17–9:18

4849: snow**Snow in winter**

2SA 23:20 parallel 1CH 11:22 See also PRO 31:21

Snow all year round on Mount Lebanon

JER 18:14

Melting snow forms temporary streams

See also JOB 6:16; JOB 24:19

Snow under divine control

PSA 148:8 See also JOB 37:6; JOB 38:22; PSA 147:16; ISA 55:10–55:11

Snow as a symbol of whiteness

EXO 4:6; REV 1:14 See also NUM 12:10; 2KI 5:27; LAM 4:7; DAN 7:9; MAT 28:3

Snow as a symbol of purity

PSA 51:7; ISA 1:18

4850: south

The geographical direction opposite to north, often used to demonstrate the vast extent between the two.

South as a point of the compass

JOB 9:9; MAT 12:42 parallel LUK 11:31 See also GEN 13:14; NUM 10:6; DEU 33:2; 1SA 23:19; JOB 39:26; DAN 8:9; ACT 21:3

South and north used to demonstrate vast extent

ISA 43:6 See also GEN 28:14; JOB 23:9; EZK 20:47; EZK 21:4

4851: storm**Storms and bad weather**

EXO 9:24; MAT 8:24 parallel LUK 8:23 **ACT 27:15** See also JOB 36:33; ISA 4:6; ACT 27:18; ACT 27:20; 2PE 2:17

The storms of life

JOB 30:22; PRO 1:27 See also JOB 9:17; PSA 55:8; PRO 10:25; ISA 25:4, ISA 32:2, ISA 54:11; JER 25:32; EZK 38:9; MAT 7:24–7:27; JAS 1:6

God controls storms

JON 1:4; NAM 1:3; ZEC 10:1 See also PSA 83:15, PSA 107:29; JER 11:16, JER 23:19, JER 30:23

Jesus Christ stills the storm

LUK 8:24 parallels MAT 8:26, MRK 4:39

4852: thunder

Thunder as an aspect of violent weather

JOB 28:26 See also JOB 36:29, JOB 36:33; PSA 93:4; JER 10:13, JER 51:16

Thunder as a sign of the presence of God

EXO 19:16 See also EXO 20:18; ISA 12:17–12:18; JOB 26:14, JOB 37:4–37:5, JOB 40:9; PSA 18:13, PSA 29:3, PSA 68:33, PSA 81:7; JHN 12:29; REV 4:5, REV 6:1, REV 8:5, REV 10:3–10:4, REV 11:19, REV 14:2, REV 19:6

Thunder as an expression of the judgment of God

ISA 2:10 See also EXO 9:23, EXO 9:28–9:29, EXO 9:33–9:34; 1SA 7:10; 2SA 22:14; PSA 77:17–77:18, PSA 104:7; ISA 29:6, ISA 30:30, ISA 33:3; JER 25:30; JOL 2:11, JOL 3:16; AMO 1:2; REV 16:18

The thunder of horses' hoofs

JDG 5:22 See also REV 9:9

The Sons of Thunder

MRK 3:17

4853: weather

Patterns of climatic conditions, such as wind and rain, which were of major importance to the rural economies of the Near East. Scripture stresses the sovereignty of God over the weather and sees it as a possible means of judgment or reward.

4854: weather, God's sovereignty over

The weather is under the control of God, who alone is able to direct it.

The weather is under God's control

JOB 28:25–28:27; MAT 8:26–8:27 parallels MRK 4:39–4:41, LUK 8:24–8:25 See also JOB 5:10, JOB 26:8–26:9, JOB 26:13, JOB 37:1–37:18; PSA 135:7, PSA 147:8, PSA 147:16–147:18, PSA 148:8; JER 10:13

God alone understands the mysteries of the weather

PRO 3:19–3:20; JHN 3:8 See also JOB 36:26–36:33, JOB 38:22–38:30, JOB 38:34–38:35, JOB 38:37; ECC 11:3–11:5

Israel's economy was dependent on the weather

LEV 26:4 See also DEU 11:10–11:15, DEU 28:12; JER 5:24; HOS 6:3

The weather demonstrates God's goodness and mercy

GEN 8:22; MAT 5:45; ACT 14:17 See also GEN 9:14–9:16; DEU 33:13–33:14; PSA 68:7–68:9; ISA 30:23, ISA 49:10; JOL 2:23; ZEC 10:1

The weather as a demonstration of God's direct intervention

JON 1:4 See also EXO 14:21; NUM 11:31; PSA 78:26; JON 4:8

The weather as an answer to prayer

JAS 5:17–5:18 See also 1SA 12:17–12:18; 1KI 8:35–8:36 parallel 2CH 6:26–6:27; 1KI 18:41–18:44

The weather can cause suffering

GEN 31:40; ACT 28:2 See also EZR 10:9; JOB 1:16, JOB 1:18–1:19; MAT 20:12; JHN 18:18; ACT 27:15

4855: weather, as God's judgment

The weather can be seen as an expression of God's judgment and grace, as well as providing insights concerning human nature.

The weather as an expression of God's judgment

Judgment in battle

JOS 10:11 See also 2SA 22:10–22:15; ISA 30:30; EZK 38:22

Judgment in general

1KI 17:1; HAG 1:10–1:11 See also GEN 7:11–7:12; EXO 9:22–9:26; LEV 26:18–26:19; DEU 11:17, DEU 28:22–28:24; JER 3:3, JER 14:1–14:6; EZK 22:24; AMO 4:7; ZEC 14:17–14:19

The weather as a source of spiritual insight

About the shortness of life

JAS 4:14 See also JOB 7:9, JOB 24:19, JOB 30:15; HOS 13:3; JAS 1:11

About empty profession

HOS 6:4 See also JOB 6:15–6:17; PRO 25:14; 2PE 2:17

About God's judgment

JER 23:19 See also JER 4:11; HOS 8:7

About God's salvation

ISA 55:10–55:11 See also ISA 44:22, ISA 45:8

About righteous rule

2SA 23:3–23:4 See also PSA 72:6; PRO 16:15; ISA 25:4–25:5

About wholesome teaching

DEU 32:2 See also JOB 29:23

About the troubles of life

MAT 7:24–7:27

About the signs of the times

MAT 16:2–16:3 See also LUK 12:54–12:56

4857: west

The geographical direction often identified by the position of the setting sun.

West as a point of the compass

EXO 10:19; LUK 12:54 See also GEN 13:14; EXO 27:12; NUM 34:6; DEU 3:27; JOS 5:1; 2SA 13:34; 1KI 4:24, 1KI 7:25; JOB 18:20; ISA 24:14, ISA 49:12, ISA 59:19; HOS 11:10; REV 21:13

West and east used to demonstrate vast extent

PSA 103:12; MAT 24:27 See also JOB 23:8; PSA 75:6; ISA 43:5; ZEC 8:7, ZEC 14:4; MAT 8:11

West identified by the setting sun

DEU 11:30; PSA 113:3 See also PSA 50:1; ISA 45:6; MAL 1:11

4858: whirlwind

A violent wind, often associated with the presence and activity of God.

The presence of God in whirlwinds

In replying to Job

JOB 38:1

In the forces of nature

PSA 77:18

In taking Elijah up to heaven

2KI 2:11 See also 2KI 2:1; NAM 1:3

Whirlwinds as symbols of disaster or divine judgment

ISA 40:24; JER 23:19 See also PRO 1:27; ISA 5:28, ISA 21:1, ISA 66:15; JER 4:13; HOS 4:19, HOS 8:7; ZEC 7:14

4859: white

A symbol of purity and regeneration reflecting godliness, and also a symbol of victory.

White used symbolically**Of purity and holiness**

MAT 17:1–17:2 parallel MRK 9:2–9:3 See also DAN 7:9; MAT 28:2–28:3 parallel MRK 16:5; JHN 20:12; ACT 1:10; REV 1:12–1:14, REV 4:4, REV 6:1–6:2, REV 19:11–19:14, REV 20:11

Of forgiveness and regeneration

ISA 1:18 See also PSA 51:7; REV 3:4–3:5, REV 3:18, REV 6:11, REV 7:9, REV 7:13–7:14

Of superficial righteousness

MAT 23:27 See also EZK 13:10–13:15, EZK 22:28; ACT 23:3

Of joy

ECC 9:7–9:8

White used descriptively

EST 1:6; LAM 4:7 See also GEN 30:37, GEN 49:12; EXO 16:31 the manna; LEV 11:18 LEV 13:3–13:4, LEV 13:38–13:39; 2KI 5:27 JDG 5:10–5:11; EST 8:15; JOB 6:6, JOB 41:32; JOL 1:7 ZEC 1:8, ZEC 6:1–6:6 MAT 5:36; REV 2:17

4860: wind

In Hebrew the same word can denote “breath”, “wind” or “spirit”. Scripture describes the powerful effect of wind, and uses the image figuratively to speak of God’s power and presence in the world.

The origins of the wind

EXO 14:21–14:22; PSA 78:26; AMO 4:13 See also GEN 8:1 A wind caused the flood waters to recede; EXO 10:13–10:14 An east wind brought the plague of locusts on Egypt; EXO 10:19; NUM 11:31 A wind brought quail to feed the Israelites; JOB 28:25; PSA 107:25, PSA 135:7, PSA 148:7–148:8; ISA 11:15; JER 10:13; EZK 13:13; JON 1:4, JON 4:8

The effects of the wind

1KI 19:11; EZK 27:26; ACT 27:13–27:15 See also GEN 41:5–41:6; JOB 1:18–1:19, JOB 37:9, JOB 37:17–37:18; DAN 7:2; MAT 14:24; LUK 12:55; JHN 6:16–6:18; JAS 3:4

Wind used figuratively**As an image of the Holy Spirit**

JHN 3:8 The Greek word for “spirit” is the same as that for “wind”, allowing Jesus Christ to play on the double meaning of the word.

As an image of spiritual instability

JAS 1:6

As an image of destruction

PSA 103:15–103:16; MAT 7:24–7:27 See also JOB 21:17–21:18; PSA 1:4, PSA 48:7; ISA 17:13, ISA 32:2; JER 4:11–4:12,

JER 22:22; EZK 19:12; DAN 2:34–2:35; HOS 8:7; AMO 1:14; HAB 1:9; EPH 4:14; JUD 1:12; REV 6:12–6:13

As an image of something insubstantial

ECC 1:14 See also JOB 6:26; PRO 11:29; PRO 27:15–27:16; ISA 26:18; JER 5:13; HOS 12:1

4900: Time

- 4903: time
- 4906: abolition
- 4909: beginning
- 4912: chance
- 4915: completion
- 4918: dawn
- 4921: day
- 4924: delay
- 4930: end
- 4933: evening
- 4936: fate
- 4942: fulness
- 4945: history
- 4948: hour
- 4951: month
- 4954: morning
- 4957: night
- 4960: noon
- 4963: past, the
- 4966: present, the
- 4969: seasons
- 4975: week
- 4978: year

4903: time

A creation of God which marks the duration of life and which is measured by changes in the created order. The flow of time is directed by God who appoints particular “times” within his unfolding purposes. Because human life is brief, time should be used properly, making the most of every opportunity.

Time as a creation of God

Time began at creation

GEN 1:5 See also 1CO 2:7

Time is marked by change in the created order

GEN 1:14 The main divisions of time were based upon the phases of the sun and moon. See also PSA 104:19; JER 33:20

The timelessness of God

PSA 90:2 See also GEN 1:1; PSA 93:2; PRO 8:22–8:26; HAB 1:12; JHN 1:1–1:2

God’s perception of time

2PE 3:8 See also PSA 90:4

Measurement of time

Divisions of time

GEN 1:8 A day was marked by the regular cycle of evening and morning; ; NUM 28:14 Months were determined by the regular phases of the moon; ; 1KI 4:7 The year consisted of twelve lunar months; ; JHN 11:9 An hour was one twelfth of the period of daylight.

Indefinite periods of time

1SA 1:22; ; JER 32:14; ; LUK 20:9; ; ACT 14:28, ACT 18:23

Recurring times and seasons

God’s seasonal provision

DEU 11:14 See also LEV 26:4; DEU 28:12; PSA 145:15–145:16; JER 5:24; ACT 14:17

Appointed times for festivals

LEV 23:4 See also EXO 13:10, EXO 23:15 parallel EXO 34:18; NUM 9:2–9:3

A right time for every activity

ECC 3:1–3:8 See also ECC 3:11, ECC 8:6; JER 8:7

Times of human life in God’s hands

PSA 31:15, PSA 139:16 See also JOB 14:5; DAN 2:21; ACT 17:26

Appointed times within God’s unfolding purpose

The time of fulfilment of promise

The time of Isaac’s birth: GEN 21:2; ; ROM 9:9; LUK 1:20 the time of John the Baptist’s birth; ; ACT 7:17 the time of Israel’s possession of the land

The time of Israel’s deliverance

PSA 102:13 See also HAB 2:3, HAB 3:16

The time of Jesus Christ’s coming

GAL 4:2–4:4 See also MRK 1:15; LUK 19:44; 1TI 2:6; TIT 1:3

The time of Jesus Christ’s death

JHN 12:23 See also MAT 26:18; JHN 2:4, JHN 8:20, JHN 13:1; ROM 5:6; 1PE 1:11

The time of Jesus Christ’s return

1CO 4:5 See also MAT 24:36; EPH 1:10; HEB 9:28; 1TI 6:15

The time of God’s judgment

PSA 75:2; ; EZK 7:7–7:8, EZK 24:14; ; ZEP 2:2; ; MAT 8:29; ; REV 11:18

The appointed time of the end

DAN 8:19, DAN 11:27, DAN 11:29; ; MRK 13:32; ; ACT 1:6–1:7

The time between Jesus Christ’s first and second coming

The time of salvation

2CO 6:2 The time of salvation lies between the two comings of Jesus Christ. See also ISA 49:8; HEB 11:13

The end times

ACT 2:17; ; HEB 1:2; ; 1PE 1:20; ; 1JN 2:18

Proper use of time

Recognising the brevity of human life

PSA 90:12 See also PSA 39:4–39:6; PRO 27:1; JAS 4:14

Seeking God

ISA 55:6 See also PSA 32:6, PSA 69:13, PSA 95:7–95:8; ECC 12:1, ECC 12:6–12:7

Looking to eternal realities

1CO 7:29–7:31 See also PSA 10:6; ISA 56:12; LUK 12:16–12:21; ROM 13:11–13:12; JAS 5:7–5:9

Making the most of opportunities

COL 4:5 See also GAL 6:10; EPH 5:16

4906: abolition

The final ending and elimination of practices or states of affairs. Scripture looks forward to God's final abolition of the present order, through the inauguration of the new Jerusalem.

Things to be abolished in the kingdom of God

War and destruction

HOS 2:18 See also PSA 46:9–46:10; ISA 9:5; ZEC 9:10

Illness and suffering

EXO 23:25–23:26 See also EXO 15:26; DEU 7:15; ISA 53:4; MAT 8:16–8:17 parallels MRK 1:32–1:34, LUK 4:40–4:41

Sin

ROM 6:6 See also EZK 36:25–36:26 God speaks here of his abolition of sinful, human hard-heartedness; ROM 8:3–8:4; HEB 9:26

Death and mourning

1CO 15:24–15:26; REV 21:1–21:4 See also ISA 25:7–25:8, ISA 65:17–65:20; 1CO 15:54–15:55; 2TI 1:10; REV 20:13–20:14

The abolition of idolatry in Israel

Israel was commanded to abolish Canaanite worship

EXO 23:24 See also EXO 34:13; NUM 33:50–33:52; DEU 12:2–12:3

The abolition of mediums and spiritists

DEU 18:9–18:12; ; ISA 28:3–28:9; ; 2KI 23:24

In Asa's reign

1KI 15:11–15:13 parallel 2CH 14:2–14:3

In Hezekiah's reign

2KI 18:4 parallel 2CH 31:1

In Josiah's reign

2KI 23:4–23:20 parallels 2CH 34:3–34:7, 2CH 34:33

The abolition of the temple

Sacrifice in the temple abolished

DAN 11:31 Antiochus Epiphanes abolished the daily sacrifice in the temple in 168 B.C., thereby attacking the symbolic centre of Israel's life. See also DAN 12:11

Jesus Christ was accused of seeking to abolish the temple

MAT 26:61 parallel MRK 14:58 See also MAT 21:12–21:13 parallels MRK 11:15–11:17, LUK 19:45–19:46 Jesus Christ's action may have been understood as a symbolic abolition of a defiled sacrificial system; MAT 27:39–27:40 parallel MRK 15:29–15:30; ACT 6:14

The final abolition of the temple in the new Jerusalem

REV 21:22

Abolition and the law

The law has not been abolished

MAT 5:17–5:19 See also ROM 3:31

The law has been abolished as an instrument of condemnation

COL 2:13–2:14 See also 2CO 3:6–3:17; EPH 2:14–2:16; HEB 10:1–10:10

The law does not abolish God's promises

GAL 3:17–3:18 God did not abolish his promise of righteousness to Abraham when he gave the law, because the promise was not conditional upon keeping the law but is received by faith. See also ROM 4:14

The offence of the cross is abolished by accepting circumcision

GAL 5:11 Jews found offensive the Christians' claim that salvation did not come through keeping the law, but instead through faith in a crucified Messiah, whom the law had cursed. Paul regarded "the offence of the cross" as central to the gospel, and refused to make salvation conditional upon circumcision and obedience to the law. See also 1CO 1:22–1:24, 1CO 2:2; GAL 3:13, GAL 5:2, GAL 6:14–6:15

4909: beginning

A starting point, origin or source. The beginning often refers to the time of or before the creation of the world. God is described as the Beginning and the End, denoting the eternity of his existence. Jesus Christ's coming marks a new beginning both for God's people and, finally, for all creation.

Beginning as the starting point

As the source

PSA 111:10 See also PRO 1:7, PRO 9:10; MIC 1:13 the source of Israel's sin; COL 1:18 Jesus Christ as the source of the church's life

As the origin

JOB 8:7; ; ACT 26:4; ; HEB 7:3

As the commencement

LEV 23:5; ; JDG 7:19; ; 1KI 6:1 parallel 2CH 3:1; ; LUK 23:54; ; 1JN 2:7; ; 2JN 1:5

The beginning: before the creation

PRO 8:22–8:23

Jesus Christ's existence predates the creation

JHN 17:5 See also JHN 1:1–1:2, JHN 8:58; COL 1:15–1:17; 1JN 1:1, 1JN 2:13–2:14

Salvation planned before the creation

EPH 1:3–1:4 See also 1CO 2:7; 2TH 2:13; 2TI 1:9; TIT 1:2

The beginning: the creation

GEN 1:1; HEB 1:10 See also PSA 102:25; ISA 40:21; DAN 12:1; MAT 24:21 parallel MRK 13:19

Marriage ordained from the beginning

MAT 19:4–19:6 parallel MRK 10:6–10:9 See also GEN 1:27, GEN 2:24

The beginning of Israel's nationhood

EXO 12:2 See also 2SA 7:10 parallel 1CH 17:9; ISA 52:4; JER 2:2–2:3

New beginnings for God's people

For Israel

HOS 2:14–2:15 See also ISA 1:26, ISA 43:18–43:19, ISA 44:26, ISA 61:4; JER 33:7–33:9

For believers

2CO 5:17 See also 2CO 4:6; EPH 2:10

A new creation

ISA 65:17 See also ISA 66:22; 2PE 3:13; REV 21:1

Beginnings of significant events

The rebuilding of Jerusalem

NEH 2:18; ; HAG 1:14

Jesus Christ's ministry

MAT 4:17 See also MRK 1:1, MRK 1:15; LUK 3:23; ACT 1:1

The beginning of signs of the end

MAT 24:7–24:8 parallel MRK 13:8; ; LUK 21:28

The beginning and the end

Implying all-inclusiveness

GEN 44:12; ; DEU 31:24; ; 1SA 3:12; ; MAT 20:8

The beginning and end contrasted

PRO 20:21; ; ECC 7:8; ; 2PE 2:20

Completing what is begun

PHP 1:6 See also 2CO 8:6; GAL 3:3; HEB 3:14; REV 2:5, REV 2:19

God as the Beginning and the End

ISA 44:6; REV 21:6 See also ISA 41:4, ISA 48:12; REV 1:17, REV 2:8, REV 22:13

Satan as sinful from the beginning

JHN 8:44 See also 1JN 3:8

4912: chance

The occurrence of events at random, as undesigned happenings. While people may perceive events as random, in Scripture all events are subject to God's sovereignty.

Chance in human life

Chance events

2CH 18:33–18:34 parallel 1KI 22:34–22:38 See also 1SA 6:7–6:9; PRO 26:10

Human life seems to be governed by chance, not merit

ECC 9:11 See also ECC 2:17–2:19

Providence at work through apparent chance

JON 1:17 See also RUT 2:3; LUK 23:44–23:45 parallels MAT 27:45, MAT 27:51, MRK 15:33, MRK 15:38; ACT 16:26

Chance events overruled by God's sovereignty

The casting of lots and the element of chance

PRO 16:33 See also NUM 33:53–33:54; JDG 20:8–20:10; NEH 10:34, NEH 11:1; LUK 23:34 parallels MAT 27:35, MRK 15:24; ACT 1:23–1:26

Urim and Thummim, seeming to be dependent on chance

EXO 28:29–28:30 The Urim and Thummim were used by the high priest to declare God's will. It was a form of casting lots showing either an affirmative or negative response to an enquiry. See also NUM 27:21; 1SA 28:4–28:6; EZR 2:62–2:63 parallel NEH 7:64–7:65

4915: completion

The bringing to fulfilment of a work, such as the work of creation or redemption.

Creation was completed by the seventh day

GEN 2:1–2:2; DEU 32:4 See also GEN 1:3–1:4 Genesis chapter 1 records the creation completed on each successive day as being “good”; EXO 20:11; JHN 1:3; COL 1:16; HEB 1:2, HEB 4:3, HEB 11:3

All things are completed in God’s time

GAL 4:4 See also GEN 15:16; DAN 9:24; MRK 1:15; ROM 5:6; EPH 1:10

The work of redemption is a completed work

Jesus Christ brought his earthly work to completion
JHN 17:4, JHN 19:30 See also JHN 4:34, JHN 5:36

Jesus Christ will present his church complete to his Father

JHN 6:37–6:40, JHN 6:45, JHN 17:24

Jesus Christ makes his people complete in himself

EPH 3:19; PHP 1:6; COL 2:10 See also JHN 15:11, JHN 16:24; ROM 15:14; COL 2:2; JAS 1:4

Believers are to complete their God- given work

ACT 20:24 See also ACT 14:26; ROM 15:28; COL 4:17; 2TI 4:7

The completion of the age

This world will come to an end

ISA 65:17 See also ISA 66:22; MAT 19:28; EPH 1:9–1:10; HEB 1:11–1:12; 2PE 3:10–3:12; REV 21:1–21:5

There will be a final separation of the righteous and wicked

MAT 13:36–13:43, MAT 13:47–13:50, MAT 25:32–25:41; ; 2TH 1:8–1:10

4918: dawn

The time marked by the rising of the sun. It signals the end of night and relief from its attendant concerns, and the approach of daylight with the opportunity for renewed daily activity. The light of dawn following darkness is a symbol of hope and vindication, fulfilled especially in the coming of the Messiah through whom God’s new age dawns.

Dawn as the end of the night

It ends the darkness of the night

AMO 5:8 See also 2SA 23:4; JOB 41:18

It signals the end of nightly activity

GEN 32:22–32:26; ; JDG 19:25–19:26; ; 1SA 14:36, 1SA 25:36; ; 2SA 2:32, 2SA 17:22; ; SNG 2:16–2:17

Waiting for the dawn to bring relief

PSA 130:6 See also JOB 7:3–7:4; PSA 46:5; ISA 21:12, ISA 38:13; ACT 27:29

Dawn as the beginning of a new day

It provides the earliest opportunity of the day

DAN 6:19 First light provides the earliest opportunity for action and implies urgency. See also GEN 19:15; JOS 6:15 Dawn was a common time for military campaigns to begin; JDG 9:33, JDG 16:2; 1SA 19:11; MAT 28:1 parallels MRK 16:2, LUK 24:1 Women visit Jesus Christ’s tomb at dawn; MRK 1:35 parallel LUK 4:42 Jesus Christ prays at dawn; LUK 22:66; JHN 8:2; ACT 27:33

Important activity begins at dawn

NEH 4:21 See also NEH 8:3

Dawn as a symbol of blessings to come

The Messiah brings a new dawn

ISA 9:2; REV 22:16 See also NUM 24:17; MAT 4:16; LUK 1:78–1:79; JHN 1:4–1:5, JHN 8:12

A symbol of hope and vindication

PSA 37:6, PSA 112:4 See also JDG 5:31; PSA 57:8 parallel PSA 108:2; PRO 4:18; ISA 58:8, ISA 60:1–60:3, ISA 62:1

A symbol of God’s coming in glory

HAB 3:3–3:4 See also MAL 4:2

A symbol of renewal

PSA 110:3

Dawn as a symbol of God’s revelation

1JN 2:8 See also ISA 8:20; 2PE 1:19

Dawn as a time of reckoning

Darkness at dawn as a picture of judgment

ISA 13:10–13:11 See also JOB 3:9; AMO 4:13

The light of dawn exposes the wicked

JOB 38:12–38:13; ; JHN 3:19–3:20; ; EPH 5:11–5:13

4921: day

A period of 24 hours or, as distinct from night, the period of daylight. The term may also be used more generally to refer to a point in time. Daylight is used figuratively to describe the illumination afforded to believers, who are urged to use the opportunities it presents and to avoid the evil usually associated with darkness.

Day and daylight

Day as a period of 24 hours

GEN 1:8; ; MAT 20:19; ; JHN 4:43, JHN 11:6

Day as the period of daylight

GEN 1:5 See also GEN 1:14–1:18, GEN 8:22; PSA 74:16; JER 33:20

Daylight gives opportunity for activity

A time for human endeavour

JHN 11:9–11:10 See also JOS 10:12–10:13; ACT 27:29

A time of spiritual opportunity

JHN 9:4–9:5 See also JHN 12:35–12:36

Daylight allows things to be seen

Daylight activities are seen by all

2SA 12:11–12:12; ; EZK 12:3–12:4; ; MAT 10:27 parallel LUK 12:3

Examples of those avoiding daylight

JDG 6:27 Gideon; ; JHN 3:2 Nicodemus

Daylight activities should be decent

ROM 13:12–13:13 See also EPH 5:8–5:14; 1TH 5:5–5:8; 2PE 2:13

Six working days ordained

EXO 20:8–20:11 parallel DEU 5:12–5:15

Particular days of the week

The Sabbath (Saturday)

EXO 20:8–20:10 parallel DEU 5:12–5:15 The Sabbath was reckoned from sunset on Friday to sunset on Saturday. See also LUK 4:16; COL 2:16; HEB 4:4

The Day of Preparation for the Sabbath (Friday)

MRK 15:42 parallel LUK 23:54; ; JHN 19:31

The first day of the week (Sunday)

ACT 20:7 See also MRK 16:2 parallels LUK 24:1; JHN 20:1; MRK 16:9; 1CO 16:2; REV 1:10

Festival days

LEV 23:5–23:6 Passover and Unleavened Bread; ; LEV 23:27–23:28 the Day of Atonement; LEV 23:34–23:36; ; JHN 7:37; NUM 28:26 the day of firstfruits

Day as a point in time

The day of salvation

2CO 6:2 See also ISA 25:9; ISA 49:8

God sends the day of disaster

DEU 32:35; ; JER 17:18; JER 51:2; ; MRK 13:19

God helps on the day of distress

PSA 86:7 See also GEN 35:3; 2SA 22:19 parallel PSA 18:18; 2KI 19:3–19:4 parallel ISA 37:3–37:4; PSA 94:13; JER 17:17

The final days of time

The last days

ACT 2:17–2:18 See also JOL 2:28–2:29; ISA 2:2 parallel MIC 4:1; HOS 3:5; 1TI 4:1; 2TI 3:1; HEB 1:2; 1PE 1:20

The day of the LORD

ISA 13:9–13:11 JER 30:7–30:9; ; ZEP 3:16–3:17; ; PHP 1:6; ; 2TI 1:12; JOL 2:1–2:2; ; OBA 1:15; ; ZEP 1:14–1:15; 1TH 5:2; ; 2PE 3:10

The last day

JHN 6:39–6:40 See also JHN 11:24; JHN 12:48

References to specific periods of days at the end of history

DAN 12:11–12:12; ; REV 11:3; REV 12:6

God's different perception of time

2PE 3:8 See also PSA 90:4

4924: delay

A postponement or pause, which can result from a deliberate decision or a failure to achieve the intended objective in the time available. Scripture stresses that apparent delays on the part of God are due to his love and wisdom, especially to give sinners time for repentance.

4925: delay, divine

Delays by God do not result from any failure on his part, but reflect unrealistic human expectations concerning his actions. God delays his vengeance in order to give time for human repentance.

God delays to allow for repentance

To give time for repentance

LUK 13:6–13:9; ROM 2:4; 2PE 3:8–3:9 See also MAT 3:7–3:11 parallel LUK 3:7–3:10; 1TI 2:4; JAS 5:7; REV 2:21

In response to repentance

1KI 21:29 See also 1KI 21:21–21:28

Where there is no repentance, God does not delay

EZK 12:25 See also EZK 21:24–21:26; REV 2:16

God delays judgment for the sake of his name

ISA 48:9 See also NEH 9:30–9:31

Jesus Christ delayed visiting Lazarus for God's glory

JHN 11:1–11:6 See also JHN 11:11–11:23; JHN 11:38–11:44

The giving of the Holy Spirit was delayed until Pentecost

LUK 24:49 See also ACT 1:4; ACT 2:1–2:4

God acts when he wants and nothing can delay him

HEB 10:37 Referring to the second coming of Jesus Christ. See also HAB 2:3 Referring to the LORD's delay

in sending the Babylonians to conquer Judah and take her inhabitants into exile; REV 22:20

Other examples of delay

EXO 32:1

4926: delay, human

Human delay is often the result of fear, indecision or disobedience to God. Scripture indicates that delay is to be avoided.

Examples of delay as a result of fear

Israel entering the promised land

NUM 13:31–13:32 See also NUM 13:1–13:3, NUM 13:17–13:20, NUM 13:27–13:30, NUM 14:33–14:35

Gideon responding to God's call

JDG 6:36–6:40

Examples of delay as a result of disobedience

Lot escaping from Sodom

GEN 19:16 See also GEN 19:12–19:15

Jonah going to Nineveh

JON 1:3 See also PSA 119:60; JON 1:1–1:2, JON 3:1–3:3
Jonah obeyed the second time.

Nothing should delay believers from following Jesus Christ

MAT 8:21–8:22 parallel LUK 9:59–9:60 See also MAT 9:9; MRK 1:20; LUK 14:15–14:24, LUK 19:5–19:6

People should not delay in the matter of salvation

ISA 55:6 See also AMO 6:3; ACT 24:24–24:26; 2CO 6:2; HEB 2:3

Believers are not to delay in fulfilling their vows to God and obligations to others

ECC 5:4 See also LEV 19:13; DEU 23:21; PSA 61:8

Examples of human responses to delay

Sarah's wrong response brought trouble

GEN 16:1–16:6

Saul's wrong response cost him the kingship

1SA 13:11–13:12 See also 1SA 13:8–13:10, 1SA 13:13–13:14

Jacob responded with patience

GEN 29:20–29:30

Paul responded by giving instructions to Timothy

1TI 3:14–3:15

Daniel responded by praying

DAN 9:19 See also DAN 9:1–9:23, DAN 10:10–10:13
Gabriel explains the reason for the delay.

David responded by calling on the LORD

PSA 13:1, PSA 40:17, PSA 141:1

4930: end

A limit in time or space, or the outcome of a sequence of actions or events. God knows the end from the beginning. He is without limit: he exercises control over the furthest reaches of the world, and will bring to an end earthly powers, human life and the present age. Those who persevere to the end will be saved.

God is without limit

HEB 1:12 See also PSA 102:26–102:27; DAN 6:26, DAN 7:14; MAT 24:35 parallels MRK 13:31, LUK 21:33; LUK 1:33

God is the Beginning and the End

REV 21:6 See also ISA 44:6; REV 22:13

God brings earthly powers to an end

ISA 13:11; DAN 2:44 See also PSA 89:44; ISA 21:16, ISA 23:9; JER 48:2 Moab; JER 49:37 Elam; EZK 7:2–7:6 Israel; EZK 26:21 Tyre; EZK 30:18 Egypt; DAN 5:26 Babylon

Persevering to the end

MAT 10:22, MAT 24:13; ; PHP 1:6; ; HEB 3:14, HEB 10:36

4933: evening

The time between the fading of daylight and nightfall. The onset of darkness marks the end of the working day and is a time for rest and refreshment. It is an assigned time for sacrifice and an opportunity for reflection and prayer. The evening also brings dangers.

Evening marks the end of the day

Evening and God's work of creation

GEN 1:5

The onset of darkness

PRO 7:9 PSA 102:11, PSA 109:23; JER 6:4

Days reckoned from evening to evening

EXO 12:18; ; LEV 23:32 The Sabbath began at sunset on Friday.

Ritual uncleanness lasts until evening

LEV 11:39–11:40, LEV 17:15; ; NUM 19:7–19:8; ; DEU 23:11

Waiting on God until evening

JOS 7:6 See also JDG 20:23, JDG 20:26–20:27, JDG 21:2–21:3

Mourning until evening

2SA 1:12

City gates shut at evening

JOS 2:5; ; 2KI 7:9-7:11; ; NEH 13:19; ; EZK 46:2

Executed criminals to be buried by evening

DEU 21:22-21:23; ; JOS 8:29, JOS 10:26; ; MAT 27:57-27:58
parallels MRK 15:42-15:43, LUK 23:52-23:54; ; JHN 19:31

Evening as a time for refreshment

A time to rest from labour

PSA 104:23; LUK 21:37 See also JDG 19:16; RUT 2:17; JOB 7:2; ZEP 2:7; MAT 20:8; MRK 4:35-4:38 parallels MAT 8:23, LUK 8:22-8:23

A time to rest from travel

JDG 19:9 See also GEN 19:1-19:2; NUM 9:21; LUK 24:29

A time to return home

MAT 21:17 See also GEN 30:16; MRK 11:11, MRK 11:19; JHN 6:16-6:17

A time to eat

EXO 16:12; ; 1KI 17:6; ; MAT 14:15; ; JHN 13:2

A time for reflection and prayer

GEN 24:63 See also PSA 55:17, PSA 141:2; MAT 14:23
parallel MRK 6:46

Evening religious duties

The evening sacrifice

EXO 29:38-29:41 See also NUM 28:8; 1CH 16:40; EZR 3:31KI 18:29; EZR 9:4-9:5; DAN 9:21

Lighting the lamps in the sanctuary

EXO 30:8 See also EXO 27:21 parallel LEV 24:3

The Passover sacrifice

EXO 12:6 See also LEV 23:5; NUM 9:2-9:5; DEU 16:6; JOS 5:10; MAT 26:20 parallel MRK 14:17-14:18; LUK 22:14

Adulterous behaviour in the evening

2SA 11:2-11:4; ; JOB 24:15; ; PRO 7:14-7:20

Other evening activities

MAT 8:16 parallels MRK 1:32, LUK 4:40 People came to Jesus Christ after sunset, when the Sabbath was over. See also GEN 24:11 Water collected in the evening, the coolest time of the day; MAT 16:2 Red sky in the evening as a sign of fair weather

The dangers of the evening

ISA 17:14; ZEP 3:3 Israel's rulers are likened to wolves who prowl in the evening looking for food. See also 2KI 7:7; PSA 59:6; HAB 1:8

4936: fate

A hidden power which some believe to control and determine everything that happens in such a way that

it is impossible to prevent or change things. Scripture stresses both the sovereignty of God and human responsibility and has no place for this pagan notion. The term is also used in a looser sense, to mean "end" or "destiny".

4937: fate, and fatalism

The belief that all things are predetermined, especially by the stars, removing human freedom and responsibility. Scripture affirms human freedom and responsibility and declares that the sun, moon and stars are all part of God's creation and are subject to him.

The heavenly bodies subject to God's authority

The heavenly bodies are created by God

GEN 1:14-1:18; ; JOB 9:9; ; PSA 8:3, PSA 74:16, PSA 148:3-148:5; ; AMO 5:8

The heavenly bodies are subject to the rule and providence of God

ISA 40:26 See also JOB 38:31-38:32; PSA 104:19; JER 31:35; MAT 5:45

The biblical rejection of fatalism in human choice

Human beings are free to choose between right and wrong

DEU 11:26-11:28 See also DEU 30:15-30:19; EZK 18:21-18:23

Human beings are free to call upon the name of the Lord

JOL 2:32; ; ACT 2:21; ; ROM 10:11-10:13

Human beings are free to seek the Lord

1CH 28:9; ; ISA 55:6

Human beings are free to come to the Lord

REV 22:17 See also MAT 11:28

4938: fate, and final destiny

The final destiny or predetermined end of individuals, groups or nations.

Death, the fate of humanity

ECC 7:2 See also ECC 2:14-2:16, ECC 3:19-3:22, ECC 9:2-9:6; HEB 9:27

The fate of the ungodly

ISA 65:11-65:12 See also JOB 8:11-8:19; PSA 49:13-49:20, PSA 73:17; EPH 5:5-5:6; 2PE 2:4-2:9

The fate of the godly

The fate of the godly in terms of God's rewards

2PE 1:10–1:11 See also MAT 5:3–5:10, MAT 25:34; LUK 6:20–6:22; 1CO 2:7; JAS 1:12, JAS 2:5

The fate of the godly in terms of present suffering

2TI 3:12 See also JHN 15:20; 1TH 3:1–3:4; 1PE 4:12–4:14

The fate of individuals

LUK 2:34–2:35 See also 1KI 20:37–20:42, 1KI 21:17–21:26; LUK 22:22 parallels MAT 26:24, MRK 14:21

The fate of human regulations, institutions and earthly realms

DAN 7:27 See also JOB 12:23–12:25; ISA 34:1–34:4; DAN 2:21; MAT 24:35 parallels MRK 13:31, LUK 21:33; COL 2:20–2:22; REV 18:1–18:3

4942: fulness

The totality of something, as it is brought to completion by being filled. Jesus Christ is seen as expressing the full nature and purposes of God, so that believers may rest assured that, through Christ, they know God as he really is. Believers are also being brought to fulness through the gospel, although the final fulness of joy and understanding will take place only in the future kingdom of God.

Jesus Christ, the fulness of God

Jesus Christ, the fulness of God's nature

COL 2:9–2:10 See also COL 1:19

Jesus Christ, the fulness of God's attributes

JHN 1:14 See also JHN 1:16

Christians and the church enjoy fulness through Jesus Christ

EPH 4:11–4:13 See also JHN 10:10; EPH 1:22–1:23, EPH 3:14–3:19; COL 2:9–2:10

Believers receive fulness of joy from God

1PE 1:8–1:9 See also PSA 16:11; JHN 17:13; ACT 16:29–16:34; ROM 15:13

The fulness of knowledge and understanding

Fulness of understanding comes through Jesus Christ

COL 2:2–2:3 See also ROM 15:14; COL 1:9; PHM 1:6

Fulness of understanding is only fully realised when believers see God face to face

1CO 13:12

Believers should be constantly filled with the Holy Spirit

EPH 5:18 See also ACT 2:1–2:4, ACT 4:31, ACT 6:3–6:4, ACT 13:52

Believers receive the fulness of God's love through Jesus Christ

1JN 4:12 See also 1JN 4:16–4:18

God works out his purposes in the fulness of time

EPH 1:9–1:10 See also LUK 21:24 Whatever the precise meaning of the phrase “the times of the Gentiles”, it clearly indicates the sovereignty of God over times and events; GAL 4:1–4:5

Fulness indicating the completion of God's saving activity amongst both Jews and Gentiles

ROM 11:25 See also ROM 11:11–11:12

4945: history

In Scripture, more than a record of and reflection on past events, but a process under God's control which has as its goal the eventual fulfilment of his purposes and through which he makes himself known. The goal of history is realised in Jesus Christ, through whom the age of salvation is inaugurated. Both the OT and NT point to the importance of faith rooted in historical events.

God is active in history

God's control over historical events

DAN 2:21; ACT 17:26 See also GEN 45:5–45:8; 1KI 12:15 parallel 2CH 10:15; DAN 4:25, DAN 7:25; AMO 9:7

God's saving purposes worked out through history

EPH 1:11 See also ISA 14:24–14:27, ISA 37:26, ISA 41:4, ISA 46:10–46:11; ACT 1:7, ACT 2:23

God is known through his people's history

God is known to his people

ISA 46:9 See also EXO 10:2; DEU 4:32–4:35; PSA 77:11–77:15; ISA 43:10–43:13, ISA 44:6–44:8; MIC 6:5

God is revealed to the nations

PSA 126:2 See also 1KI 8:56–8:60

The Israelites were called to remember their history

The past was recalled in festivals

LEV 23:42–23:43; DEU 16:1–16:6

The past was recounted to successive generations

PSA 78:2–78:7 See also DEU 32:7–32:9; JDG 6:13; PSA 44:1–44:3

Jesus Christ as the centre of the history of salvation

He is its beginning and end

REV 22:13 See also REV 1:8, REV 1:17, REV 2:8

God's saving purposes in history fulfilled in Jesus Christ

EPH 1:9–1:10 See also ROM 5:6; GAL 4:4; COL 1:17

Jesus Christ inaugurates God's new age

COL 1:18 See also DAN 7:13–7:14; MRK 1:15; MAT 12:28 parallel LUK 11:20; EPH 2:7

The Christian faith is based on the historical facts of salvation

Testimony passed on by eye-witnesses

LUK 1:1–1:4 See also HEB 2:3; 1PE 5:1; 2PE 1:16; 1JN 1:1–1:3

Remembering Jesus Christ's death

1CO 11:23–11:25 parallel LUK 22:19–22:20

Jesus Christ's resurrection as historical fact

ACT 1:3 See also LUK 24:1–24:3, LUK 24:39; JHN 20:27; 1CO 15:3–15:8

Historical references in the NT

LUK 1:1–1:2; ; MAT 2:1; ; LUK 3:1–3:2; ; MAT 14:3–14:4 parallel MRK 6:17–6:18; ; ACT 5:37

Landmarks in salvation history

The creation

GEN 1:1, GEN 2:7

The fall

GEN 3:6–3:7; ; ROM 5:12

The call of Abraham

GEN 12:1–12:3; ; HEB 11:8

The exodus from Egypt

EXO 13:3, EXO 19:4–19:6

The birth of Jesus Christ

JHN 1:14; ; HEB 1:1–1:2

Jesus Christ's death and resurrection

1CO 15:3–15:4; ; PHP 2:6–2:11; ; HEB 1:3–1:4

4948: hour

One twelfth of the period of daylight between sunrise and sunset. Measurement of time in biblical days was often approximate, referring most frequently to the broad divisions of time marked by the third, sixth and ninth hours. The term also denotes a significant or appointed moment or period of time, especially the hour of Jesus Christ's suffering and his return.

Hour as a period of time

A measured interval

JHN 11:9 See also MAT 20:9–20:12 The working day lasted twelve hours; LUK 22:59; ACT 19:34; REV 8:1

Symbolising a brief time

MAT 6:27 parallel LUK 12:25 See also MAT 26:40 parallel MRK 14:37REV 17:12, REV 18:10, REV 18:17, REV 18:19

Symbolising a significant period

ECC 9:12 See also LUK 22:53 Darkness provides an hour of opportunity for the powers of evil.

Hours denoting specific times of day

MAT 20:3–20:5 The third, sixth and ninth hours marked the principal divisions of the day.

The third hour: 9 a.m

MRK 15:25 See also ACT 2:15

The sixth hour: noon

JHN 4:6 See also GEN 43:16; 1KI 18:27; JOB 5:14; MAT 27:45 parallels MRK 15:33, LUK 23:44

The ninth hour: 3 p.m

MAT 27:46 parallel MRK 15:34 See also ACT 3:1, ACT 10:30

Midnight

EXO 11:4 See also PSA 119:62; MAT 25:6; MRK 13:35; ACT 16:25

Other hours of the day

JHN 4:52 the seventh hour: 1 p.m.; ; JHN 1:39 the tenth hour: 4 p.m.; ; MAT 20:6 the eleventh hour: 5 p.m.

A particular unnamed time of day

MAT 8:13 See also MAT 15:28; LUK 22:14; ACT 16:33; REV 11:13

Hour as an appointed time in God's purpose

The hour of Jesus Christ's suffering

JHN 12:23–12:24 See also MAT 26:45 parallel MRK 14:41; MRK 14:35; JHN 12:27

The unexpected hour of Jesus Christ's return

MAT 24:36 parallel MRK 13:32 See also MAT 24:42–24:44 parallel LUK 12:39–12:40; MAT 25:13

The time before Jesus Christ's return

ROM 13:11 See also 1JN 2:18

The hour of God's judgment

REV 14:7

4951: month

A thirty-day period of the year measured from one new moon to the next. There were twelve months in the year, with a thirteenth inserted periodically to bring

the lunar calendar into line with the solar year. Early month names may have been linked with the seasons. After the exile, Babylonian names were adopted.

Months marked by the new moon

NUM 28:11–28:14 Special sacrifices marked the first day of each month. See also PSA 81:3; ISA 66:23; EZK 46:6; AMO 8:5 No work was done on the first day of the month.

Months as periods of 30 days

DEU 21:13 The prescribed period of mourning was 30 days (a month). See also NUM 20:29; DEU 34:8

The first month: Abib/Nisan

EXO 12:2 Abib, meaning “young head of grain” was the Canaanite name for Israel’s first month. Modern equivalent: March-April. See also EXO 40:2; NUM 9:1

Feasts in the month of Abib

DEU 16:1 Passover celebrated on 14th Abib. See also EXO 13:4, EXO 23:15 the Feast of Unleavened bread (15th–21st); LEV 23:5–23:6 parallel NUM 28:16–28:17; LEV 23:10–23:11 The first sheaf of barley was brought to the priest on 16th Abib. NEH 2:1; EST 3:7

The second month: Ziv

1KI 6:1 Ziv was the pre-exilic name; the post-exilic name, Iyyar, does not appear in the Bible. Modern equivalent: April-May. See also 1KI 6:37; NUM 9:11 A late Passover might be held on 14th Ziv; 2CH 30:13–30:15 Hezekiah’s celebration of the Passover was in the second month.

The third month: Sivan

EST 8:9 Modern equivalent: May-June. See also EXO 19:1; EZK 31:1

Pentecost celebrated in the month of Sivan

LEV 23:15–23:16 on 6th Sivan

The fourth month: Tammuz

EZK 1:1 modern equivalent: June-July; ; EZK 8:14 Tammuz was a fertility goddess; her annual death was mourned in the month named after her.

The fifth month

NUM 33:38 The name of the fifth month, Ab, does not appear in the Bible. Modern equivalent: July-August; ; 2KI 25:8

The sixth month: Elul

NEH 6:15 Modern equivalent: August-September. See also EZK 8:1; HAG 1:1; LUK 1:26

The seventh month: Ethanim

1KI 8:2 Ethanim is the pre-exilic name; its Babylonian equivalent, Tishri, does not appear in the Bible. Modern equivalent: September-October.

Feasts and sacred days in the month of Ethanim

See also LEV 23:23–23:24 parallel NUM 29:1 The Feast of Trumpets (1st). This is celebrated today as the Jewish New Year (Rosh Hashanah); LEV 23:27 parallel NUM 29:7 the Day of Atonement (10th); LEV 23:34 parallel NUM 29:12 the Feast of Tabernacles (15th–21st); LEV 23:36 Solemn Assembly (22nd)

The eighth month: Bul

1KI 6:38 Bul’s post-exilic equivalent, Marcheshvan, is not mentioned in the Bible. Modern equivalent: October-November. See also 1KI 12:32–12:33 Jereboam offset Israel’s religious calendar by one month. This is the alternative Feast of Tabernacles (15th); ZEC 1:1

The ninth month: Kislev

ZEC 7:1 Modern equivalent: November-December. See also NEH 1:1; HAG 2:18

Hanukkah celebrated in the month of Kislev

JHN 10:22 the Feast of Dedication of the Temple (25th)

The tenth month: Tebeth

EST 2:16 modern equivalent: December-January; ; JER 39:1

The eleventh month: Shebat

DEU 1:3 modern equivalent: January-February; ; ZEC 1:7

The twelfth month: Adar

EST 8:12 Modern equivalent: February-March. See also EST 3:13, EST 9:1

Purim celebrated in the month of Adar

EST 9:20–9:22 the Feast of Purim (14th–15th)

4954: morning

The period of time roughly between dawn and noon. Morning was an assigned time for worship, sacrifice and prayer. The morning light uncovers events of the night and provides opportunity for renewed daily activity. God’s blessings are received new every morning, and the start of a new day symbolises renewal and hope.

Morning as the start of a new day

The period of time created by God

GEN 1:5 See also GEN 1:8; EXO 18:13–18:14 The working day is reckoned from morning till evening; EXO 27:21 The night is reckoned from evening till morning; JOB 38:12

The transience of morning mist

ISA 44:22; ; HOS 6:4, HOS 13:3

Morning as a symbol of renewed hope**PSA 30:5** See also PSA 130:6; ISA 21:11–21:12, ISA 26:19**The Messiah brings a new morning****MAL 4:2; 2PE 1:19** See also LUK 1:78–1:79; ROM 13:12; 1JN 2:8; REV 2:28, REV 22:16**The sky in the morning**

MAT 16:3

Morning as an opportunity for activity**A time for travel**

GEN 19:2, GEN 22:3, GEN 31:55; ; NUM 9:21, NUM 22:21; ; JOS 3:1; ; ISA 17:20

A time for battle

JOS 8:10–8:14; ; JDG 9:33; ; 2KI 3:21–3:23; ; 2CH 20:20

A time to begin daily labour**RUT 2:7** See also ECC 11:6; MAT 20:1**A time to begin important activity****EXO 9:13, EXO 34:2–34:4** See also EXO 7:15, EXO 8:20; 1KI 18:26; ACT 23:12, ACT 28:23**A time to respond to nightly revelation**

GEN 20:8, GEN 28:18, GEN 41:8

A time to administer justice

JER 21:12; ; ZEP 3:5

Morning as a time of revelation**A time of discovery****GEN 29:25; 2KI 19:35** parallel ISA 37:36 See also GEN 19:27–19:28; JDG 6:28; 1SA 5:4; ISA 17:14; 1KI 3:21; 2KI 6:15; ACT 12:18; 1CO 4:5**Morning brings God's revelation****EXO 16:7–16:8** See also NUM 16:5; JOS 7:14; 1SA 9:19; ISA 50:4; EZK 12:8**Morning devotions****A time for offering sacrifices****EZK 46:13–46:15** See also EXO 29:38–29:40, EXO 36:3; NUM 28:3–28:5; 1CH 16:40; 2CH 2:4, 2CH 13:11, 2CH 29:20–29:21; JOB 1:5**A time for prayer****PSA 88:13** See also PSA 5:3, PSA 55:17; MRK 1:35**A time to praise God****PSA 92:1–92:3** See also 1CH 23:30; PSA 59:16, PSA 65:8**Priestly duties each morning**

EXO 30:7 burning incense; ; LEV 6:12 making the burnt offering

God's blessings are received new each morning**LAM 3:22–3:23** See also EXO 16:12–16:15 God's provision of manna in the desert; 1KI 17:6 God supplies Elijah with food; PSA 90:14; ISA 33:2**4957: night**

The period of darkness between evening and morning. It is generally a time for the cessation of daily activity and for sleep, but, because darkness also gives an opportunity for evil, there is need to be watchful. The term may also be used figuratively to refer to evil or to a period of distress. Night-time also provides opportunity for contemplation and for prayer.

Night distinguished from day**GEN 1:5** See also GEN 1:14–1:18; PSA 74:16**Night as a time for rest and sleep****Rest from daily activity**

JDG 19:9; ; ECC 2:23; ; JHN 9:4, JHN 11:9–11:10

Sleep

GEN 15:12, GEN 28:11; ; JOB 4:13

Activity day and night implies continuity and commitment**Weeping**

PSA 42:3; ; JER 9:1, JER 14:17

Prayer

NEH 1:6; ; PSA 88:1; ; LUK 18:7; ; 1TH 3:10

Meditation

JOS 1:8; ; PSA 1:2

Worship

LUK 2:37; ; ACT 26:7; ; REV 4:8, REV 7:15

Work

1CH 9:33; ; 1TH 2:9; ; 2TH 3:8

The watches of the night**In OT times: three watches**

LAM 2:19 the first watch: sunset to midnight; ; JDG 7:19 the second watch: midnight to 3 a.m.; ; EXO 14:24 the last watch: 3 a.m. to dawn

In NT times: four watches**MRK 13:35** See also MAT 14:25 parallel MRK 6:48; LUK 12:38**Night associated with evil****The period when evil is at work****JHN 13:30** Night symbolises the darkness in Judas' soul, and denotes, too, the time of activity of the

powers of darkness. See also JOB 30:26; PRO 4:19; LUK 22:53

Opportunity for evil

1CO 4:5 Evil flourishes under cover of darkness. See also PRO 2:13; JHN 3:19–3:20; JOB 24:14 Murder; PRO 7:8–7:9 Adultery; 1TH 5:7 Drunkenness; JER 49:9 parallel OBA 1:5 Theft

Believers do not belong to the night

1TH 5:5 See also JHN 12:35–12:36; ROM 13:12; EPH 5:8; COL 1:13

Believers are to remain watchful

1TH 5:6 See also MAT 24:42–24:44, MAT 25:13; MRK 13:36–13:37

Night associated with distress

Gloom caused by distress

PSA 107:13–107:14; ; ISA 9:2, ISA 59:9

Night as a time of weeping

PSA 6:6, PSA 30:5; ; LAM 1:2

Night as an opportunity to seek God

In prayer

LUK 6:12 See also 1SA 15:11; PSA 22:2, PSA 119:62

In worship

ACT 16:25 See also JOB 35:10; PSA 42:8, PSA 77:6, PSA 139:1–139:2, PSA 149:5; ISA 30:29

In contemplation

PSA 63:6 See also PSA 119:55; ISA 26:9

Night as an opportunity to receive revelation

God's voice at night

1SA 3:4

God's revelation through visions

2CH 7:12; ; DAN 2:19, DAN 7:2; ; ZEC 1:8; ; ACT 18:9, ACT 23:11

God's revelation through dreams

GEN 20:3, GEN 31:24; ; 1KI 3:5; ; JOB 33:15

No night in heaven

REV 21:25, REV 22:5

4960: noon

The mid-point between sunrise and sunset when the sun is at its brightest. Noon is a time to seek shelter from the heat of the day. The darkening of the midday sun and the surprise attack of the enemy at noon are signs of God's judgment. The brilliance of the noonday sun is likened to the glory of Jesus Christ and to the vindication of God's people.

Noon as a time of severe heat

Shelter from the noonday heat

ISA 4:5–4:6 See also ISA 16:3 Moab likens asylum sought from Judah to shelter from the noonday sun; ISA 25:4

Time to rest from the sun's heat

2SA 4:5 See also GEN 18:1**SNG 1:7** See also RUT 2:7 Ruth rests from her gleaning at noon; 1SA 11:11 Saul's army halts its destruction of the Ammonites at midday; 1KI 20:16 Israel's enemies relax at midday, unaware of the imminence of battle; MAT 20:12 Workers in the vineyard might have been expected to rest during the hottest part of the day; JHN 4:6 Jesus Christ rests from his journey by the well of Sychar.

Noon as a natural break in the day

1KI 18:26–18:29; ; NEH 8:3

Noon as a time for prayer

PSA 55:16–55:17 The devout Jew prayed three times daily. See also DAN 6:10; ACT 10:9

Noon as a time of God's judgment

A time of unexpected destruction

JER 15:8 Armies usually attacked at dawn; a noon raid would take the people by surprise. See also JER 6:4, JER 20:16; ZEP 2:4

Darkness at noon is a sign of God's judgment

JOB 5:14; AMO 8:9 See also DEU 28:29; ISA 59:9–59:10**MAT 27:45** parallels MRK 15:33, LUK 23:44–23:45 The noonday sun is darkened following the crucifixion.

The noonday sun as a symbol of glory

The glory of Jesus Christ

REV 1:16 See also MAT 17:2

The vindication of God's people

JDG 5:31 See also JOB 11:17; PSA 37:6; ISA 58:10; MAT 13:43

Events that occurred at noon

Joseph invites his brothers to eat with him at noon: GEN 43:16, GEN 43:26; JOS 10:12–10:13 The sun stops in the middle of the sky, allowing Joshua to defeat the Amorites; ; 2KI 4:18–4:20 The Shunammite woman's son dies at noon.; ACT 22:6, ACT 26:13

4963: past, the

Jesus Christ transforms the past and sets people free to live in a new way. God's people should remember former blessings but not return to former sins.

Recalling God's work in the past

Remembering God's work of creation

EXO 20:11; ; PSA 104:5–104:9, PSA 136:1–136:9

Remembering God's saving works

PSA 105:5 parallel 1CH 16:12 See also DEU 8:2; JOS 24:2; 1SA 12:6; NEH 9:7; PSA 106:6, PSA 114:1, PSA 136:10, PSA 143:5; ISA 51:1–51:2; MIC 6:5

Remembering God's work in Jesus Christ

2TI 2:8 See also 1CO 11:23–11:26 One of the purposes of the Lord's Supper is to remember Jesus Christ and his death on the cross.

Learning from the past

ROM 15:4 See also DEU 4:9, DEU 32:7; ZEC 1:4; 1CO 10:6, 1CO 10:11; HEB 12:16; 1PE 3:5–3:6; 1JN 3:12

Rediscovering God's word from the past

2KI 22:8–22:13 parallel 2CH 34:15–34:21 See also 2KI 23:1–23:3 parallel 2CH 34:29–34:31; 2KI 23:21–23:23

Leaving the past behind

Jesus Christ sets believers free from the past

2CO 5:17 See also ISA 65:16; GAL 4:3–4:5; COL 1:13–1:14

Warnings not to rely on or be preoccupied with the past

ISA 43:18 This can mean either that God is not to be restricted to his past actions or that Israel should forget their former sins. See also PHP 3:13–3:14

Dangers of the past

The danger of ignoring the past

PSA 78:11 See also EXO 1:8; DEU 32:18; PSA 106:13, PSA 106:21; HOS 2:13

The danger of lapsing into past sins

GAL 4:8–4:9 See also HEB 6:4–6:6; 2PE 1:9; REV 2:4–2:5, REV 3:3

Jesus Christ supersedes God's revelation in the past

Jesus Christ supersedes earlier expectations

ACT 17:30 See also ACT 14:15–14:16

Jesus Christ supersedes earlier covenants

HEB 7:22 See also HEB 1:1–1:2, HEB 8:13, HEB 9:14–9:15, HEB 10:15–10:18; JER 31:33–31:34; HEB 12:24

Jesus Christ reveals God's past mystery

COL 1:26–1:27 See also ROM 16:25–16:26; 1CO 2:7; EPH 1:9, EPH 3:2–3:6, EPH 3:9

4966: present, the

God's blessings are available now and are to be received in faith and contentment. It is dangerous to live only for current blessings and pleasures.

Blessings promised for the present

The blessing of God's presence now

HAG 1:13 See also DEU 31:6; 1KI 8:57

The blessing of Jesus Christ's presence now

MAT 1:23 See also ISA 7:14, ISA 8:8, ISA 8:10; MAT 18:20, MAT 28:20; JHN 14:18; ACT 18:10

The blessing of the Spirit's presence now

JHN 14:16–14:17 See also JHN 14:25–14:27, JHN 16:7, JHN 16:13–16:16

Other blessings given in the present

MRK 10:29–10:30 parallels MAT 19:29, LUK 18:29–18:30 See also EXO 23:25; 1KI 3:13 parallel 2CH 1:12; PSA 121:3–121:8; MAT 6:33; 1TI 4:8; 1PE 1:9

Future blessings are partially fulfilled in the present

EPH 1:13–1:14 See also ROM 8:23, ROM 8:30; 2CO 1:22, 2CO 5:5; EPH 1:3; HEB 12:22–12:24

Prayer for present provision and blessing

LUK 11:3 parallel MAT 6:11 GEN 28:20; ; PRO 30:8; MAT 6:13 parallel LUK 11:4 prayers for spiritual provision

The secret of contentment in the present

PHP 4:10–4:13 See also 1TI 6:6–6:8

The dangers of living for the present

ECC 3:12–3:13 Ecclesiastes in particular reflects upon the emptiness of life without God. Though the good things of the present life are a gift from God and to be valued as such, they cannot bring ultimate fulfilment; **LUK 12:15–12:20** See also ECC 2:24, ECC 5:18, ECC 8:15, ECC 9:7, ECC 9:9; ISA 22:13; 1CO 15:32; PHP 3:19; 1TI 6:9–6:10; JAS 4:13–4:17; 1TI 6:17

The challenge of the present

The challenge to respond to God now

2CO 6:2 See also DEU 4:39–4:40, DEU 5:1, DEU 7:11, DEU 10:13, DEU 30:15–30:16; PSA 95:7–95:8; ISA 55:6; HOS 10:12; HEB 3:7

The challenge to serve God now

EPH 5:15–5:16 See also GAL 6:10; COL 4:5

4969: seasons

The main periods of the year which each have their own distinctive weather. In life, the varied periods of human experience.

4970: seasons, of the year

Distinctive periods of the year marked by certain climatic conditions. Seasons are examples of God's perfect order in the world. They represent the balanced cycle of creation which is sustained by God and through which his provision and mercy are made known.

Seasons are appointed by God

Seasons are created by God

PSA 74:16–74:17 See also GEN 1:14, GEN 8:22; PSA 104:19

Seasons are sustained by God

JER 5:24 See also JOB 38:32–38:33; EZK 34:26; ACT 14:17

The agricultural seasons of Palestine

The dry and rainy seasons

JOL 2:23 The rainy season, accounting for over 90 per cent of the national rainfall, runs from October to March/April. Its beginning is marked by the autumn rains in October/November; the lighter spring showers in April/May announce the coming of the dry season. See also EZR 10:13; HOS 6:3; JAS 5:7; LEV 26:3–26:4; DEU 11:13–11:14, DEU 28:12

Seedtime and harvest

PRO 20:4 Ploughing and sowing take place from October to December when the autumn rains have begun to soften the ground. Most crops are harvested between April and June. See also EXO 34:21; NUM 13:20; JOB 5:26; PSA 1:3

Spring

Spring rain as a sign of blessing

JOB 29:23 The gentle spring rains signal the approach of harvest; ; **PRO 16:15**; ; **JER 3:3**; ; **ZEC 10:1**

Spring as a time of growth

SNG 2:11–2:13 Spring marks a pleasant interval between the heavy winter rains and the onset of the dry season. See also **PRO 27:25**; **JOL 2:22**; **MAT 24:32** parallels **MRK 13:28**, **LUK 21:29–21:30**

Spring as a time for war

2SA 11:1 parallel **1CH 20:1** The time following the spring harvest (May/June), when agricultural commitments are reduced; ; **1KI 20:26**; ; **2KI 13:20**

Festivals celebrated in spring

LEV 23:5–23:6 parallel **NUM 28:16–28:17** Passover and Unleavened Bread; ; **LEV 23:10** offering the firstfruits of the barley harvest; ; **LEV 23:15–23:16** parallel **DEU 16:9–16:10** The Feast of Weeks celebrated the ingathering of the grain harvest.

Summer

A period of intense heat

PSA 32:4 See also **JOB 6:17**

A time for harvesting summer fruit

JER 8:20 See also **PRO 10:5**; **JER 40:10–40:12** Grapes, olives and figs are harvested in July/September; **MIC 7:1**

A time to store harvested grain

PRO 6:8, **PRO 30:25**

Autumn

The breaking of the summer drought

PSA 84:6 Autumn is the start of the rainy season and corresponds to the time of ploughing and sowing.

Festivals celebrated in autumn

See also **LEV 23:24** parallel **NUM 29:1** the Feast of Trumpets; **LEV 23:27** parallel **NUM 29:7** the Day of Atonement; **LEV 23:34** parallel **NUM 29:12** the Feast of Tabernacles

Winter

A time of inclement weather

JOB 37:6–37:10 See also **ISA 55:10**; **JER 36:22**

A time when travelling is difficult

MAT 24:20 parallel **MRK 13:18**; ; **2TI 4:21**; ; **ACT 27:12**; ; **1CO 16:6**; ; **TIT 3:12**

Celebration of the Feast of Dedication

JHN 10:22 The Feast of Dedication (Hannukah) commemorates the rededication of the temple by Judas Maccabeus in 165 B.C.

4971: seasons, of life

Appropriate or appointed periods of time which are part of the variety and development of human life and experience and which influence human affairs. The times and seasons for individuals and nations are set by God, who works all things together towards the final fulfilment of his purposes.

The seasons of life are appointed by God

The seasons of individual lives

ECC 3:1–3:8; **PSA 31:15** See also **JOB 14:5**; **PSA 139:16**; **ECC 3:11**; **ROM 8:28**; **JAS 4:13–4:15**

The seasons of nations and the world**DAN 2:21; ACT 17:26** See also DAN 4:17, DAN 7:25; ACT 1:7**A time to die****The transience of human life****PSA 103:15–103:16** See also JOB 7:6–7:8, JOB 14:1–14:2; PSA 37:2, PSA 102:11; ECC 6:12**Death comes at its appointed time****JOB 5:26** See also GEN 47:29; 1KI 2:1; LUK 12:20**Times of sadness and joy****A time to mourn**

GEN 27:41, GEN 37:34, GEN 50:3–50:4; ; DEU 34:8; ; JER 4:28

A time to rejoice**JHN 16:21–16:22** See also DEU 28:47; EST 9:22; ISA 61:2–61:3**A time to speak**

PRO 15:23, PRO 25:11; ; 2TI 4:2 Christians are to be always ready to share the gospel.

Times appointed for the world**The rise and fall of nations**

DAN 2:37–2:45, DAN 8:19–8:25, DAN 11:2–11:4, DAN 11:24–11:27; ; LUK 21:24

The time to receive God's salvation**2CO 6:2** See also ISA 49:8, ISA 55:6; HEB 4:7**The time of God's judgment**

DEU 32:35; ; EZK 30:3; ; ZEP 2:2; ; ACT 17:31

Times appointed for God's people**Times for worship****LEV 23:4** See also EXO 34:18; NUM 9:2–9:3, NUM 10:10**Times of blessing****PSA 102:13** See also EZK 34:26; ACT 3:19, ACT 7:17**A time of vindication****DAN 7:21–7:22** See also ACT 1:6; ROM 8:18; 1PE 5:6**Times of testing**

PSA 66:10; ; EZK 21:3; ; MAT 13:21 parallels MRK 4:17, LUK 8:13; ; 1PE 1:6–1:7; ; REV 2:10

Times for withdrawal or solitude**MRK 1:35** See also 1KI 17:2–17:6; MRK 6:30–6:32; GAL 1:17**Waiting for God's appointed time****HAB 2:3** See also ROM 8:23–8:25; HEB 9:28, HEB 11:13**Times appointed for Jesus Christ****The appointed time of his birth**

GAL 4:4

The appointed time of his death**JHN 12:23** See also MAT 26:18; MRK 14:41; LUK 9:51; JHN 2:4, JHN 7:6–7:8, JHN 12:27, JHN 13:1**The appointed time of his return**

LUK 21:8; ; ACT 3:20–3:21, ACT 17:31; ; 1CO 4:5; ; REV 1:3

4975: week

The pattern of weeks provides a useful framework for marking time in agricultural and religious life. The story of creation is described in terms of seven days and illustrates a cycle of work and rest. Feasts and other rituals last for a certain number of weeks.

The seven days of creation**GEN 2:1–2:3** See also GEN 1:5, GEN 1:8, GEN 1:13, GEN 1:19, GEN 1:23, GEN 1:31**The Sabbath-rest****DEU 5:12–5:14** parallel EXO 20:8–20:11 See also EXO 34:21, EXO 35:2; HEB 4:3–4:4, HEB 4:8–4:10**Seven-day intervals or periods****After building the ark Noah had seven days' notice of the flood****GEN 7:4****Noah sent out the dove at seven-day intervals**

See also GEN 8:8–8:12

Marching round Jericho**HEB 11:30** See also JOS 6:12–6:15**Other examples of seven-day intervals or periods**

EXO 7:25, EXO 29:30; ; 1SA 10:8, 1SA 11:3, 1SA 13:8; ; 1KI 20:29; ; 1CH 9:25; ; ACT 20:6, ACT 21:4, ACT 28:14

Rituals lasting seven days**Menstrual impurity****LEV 15:19****Initial period of uncleanness after childbirth****LEV 12:1–12:2** This would be fourteen days if the child were a girl (Lev 12:5).**Mourning****GEN 50:10** See also 1SA 31:13 parallel 1CH 10:12; JOB 2:13; EZK 3:15**The Feast of Weeks****DEU 16:9–16:10** See also EXO 34:22; LEV 23:15–23:21; NUM 28:26–28:31

Feasts lasting seven days

Wedding feasts

GEN 29:27 See also JDG 14:10–14:12

The Feast of Unleavened Bread

EXO 34:18 See also LEV 23:5–23:8; 2CH 30:21–30:23, 2CH 35:17; EZR 6:22

The Feast of Tabernacles

LEV 23:34 See also LEV 23:36; NEH 8:18

Dedication of the temple

1KI 8:65 parallel 2CH 7:8–7:9

Daniel's “weeks”

DAN 9:24 “sevens” may also be translated “weeks”. See also DAN 9:25–9:27

God promises that times and seasons will always continue

JER 5:24 See also GEN 8:22

4978: year

A period of twelve months, with additional periods inserted to bring the lunar year into line with the solar year. Certain calendar years have special significance. The term also denotes an indeterminate time when God will intervene to restore his people and punish his enemies.

The year made up of 12 months

1KI 4:7 See also 1CH 27:1–27:15; EST 2:12; DAN 4:29; REV 22:2

The start of the year

The start of the religious year

EXO 12:2 The exodus from Egypt in Abib (March April) marked a new beginning in the life of God's people. See also LEV 23:5 parallel NUM 28:16 Abib is referred to as the first month; 2CH 35:1; EZR 6:19

The start of the agricultural year

EXO 23:16 The Feast of Ingathering (or Tabernacles) was celebrated in the seventh month. See also EXO 34:22; LEV 23:23–23:24 parallel NUM 29:1

God's blessing through the year

PSA 65:9–65:13 See also DEU 11:11–11:15, DEU 28:12

A thousand years as one day

PSA 90:4; ; 2PE 3:8

Special years

The sabbatical year

LEV 25:1–25:7 See also EXO 23:10–23:11; LEV 25:20–25:22 God's provision for the seventh year **DEU 15:1** DEU 15:9; NEH 10:31; DEU 31:10–31:13 the law of God to be read every seventh year at the Feast of Tabernacles

The Year of Jubilee

LEV 25:8–25:10 The Year of Jubilee began in the seventh month. See also LEV 25:11–25:12 The Year of Jubilee is a sabbath year; LEV 25:13 Each Hebrew is to return to his family property; LEV 25:28 Land is returned to its original owner; LEV 25:40 Hebrew slaves are to be released; LEV 25:54

Hebrew slaves released in the seventh year

EXO 21:2 parallel DEU 15:12 See also JER 34:14

The year of the LORD's favour

ISA 61:1–61:3 This has echoes of the Year of Jubilee and points to the time when God will restore his people. See also LUK 4:18–4:21; ISA 49:8–49:9; 2CO 6:2 **ISA 63:4** Salvation for God's people is accompanied by judgment on his enemies.

The year of punishment

See also JER 11:23, JER 23:12, JER 48:44